

CICERO

LETTERS TO ATTICUS

WITH AN ENGLISH TRANSLATION BY

E. O. WINSTEDT, M.A.

OF MAGDALEN COLLEGE, OXFORD

IN THREE VOLUMES

I



LONDON: WILLIAM HEINEMANN
NEW YORK: G. P. PUTNAM'S SONS
MCMXIX.

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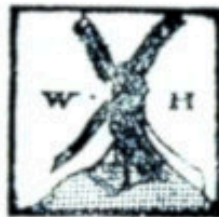
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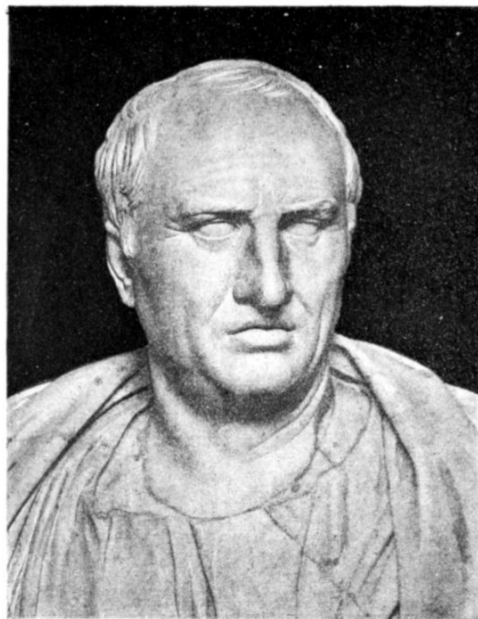
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LETTERS TO ATTICUS
I



CICERO.

*BUST IN THE CAPITOLINE
MUSEUM, ROME.*

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INTRODUCTION

The letters contained in this volume cover a large and important period in Cicero's life and in the history of Rome. They begin when he was 38 years of age; and at first they are not very numerous. There are only two of that year (68 B.C.), six of the following year, one of the year 66, when he held the praetorship, and two of 65. Then there is a gap in his correspondence. No letters at all survive from the period of his consulship and the Catilinarian conspiracy; and the letters to Atticus do not begin again until two years after that event. Thereafter they are sufficiently frequent to justify Cornelius Nepos' criticism, that reading them, one has little need of an elaborate history of the period. There are full—almost too full—details, considering the frequent complaints and repetitions, during the year of his banishment (58–57 B.C.), and the correspondence continues unbroken to the year 54. Then after a lapse of two years or more, which Atticus presumably spent in Rome, it begins again in 51, when Cicero was sent to Cilicia as pro-consul, much against his will; and the volume ends with a hint of the trouble that was brewing between Caesar and Pompey, as Cicero was returning to Rome towards the end of the next year.

The letters have been translated in the traditionary order in which they are usually printed. That order, however, is not strictly chronological; and, for the convenience of those who would read them in their historical order, a table arranging them so far as possible in order of date has been drawn up at the end of the volume.

For the basis of the text the Teubner edition has been used; but it has been revised by comparison with more recent works and papers on the subject. Textual notes have only been given in a few cases where the reading is especially corrupt or uncertain; and other notes too have been confined to cases where they seemed absolutely indispensable. For such

notes and in the translation itself, I must acknowledge my indebtedness to predecessors, especially to Tyrrell's indispensable edition and Shuckburgh's excellent translation.

There remain two small points to which I may perhaps call attention here in case they should puzzle the general reader. The first is that, when he finds the dates in this volume disagreeing with the rules and tables generally given in Latin grammars and taught in schools, he must please to remember that those rules apply only to the Julian Calendar, which was introduced in 45 B.C., and that these letters were written before that date. Before the alterations introduced by Caesar, March, May, July and October had 31 days each, February 28, and the other months 29. Compared with the Julian Calendar this shows a difference of two days in all dates which fall between the Ides and the end of the months January, August and December, and of one day in similar dates in April, June, September and November.

The second point, which requires explanation, is the presence of some numerals in the margin of the text of letters 16 to 19 of Book IV. As Mommsen pointed out, the archetype from which the existent MSS. were copied must have had some of the leaves containing these letters transposed. These were copied in our MSS. in the wrong order, and were so printed in earlier editions. In the text Mommsen's order, with some recent modifications introduced by Holzapfel, has been adopted; and the figures in the margin denote the place of the transposed passages in the older editions, the Roman figures denoting the letter from which each particular passage has been shifted and the Arabic numerals the section of that letter.

The following signs have been used in the apparatus criticus:—

M = the *Codex Mediceus* 49, 18, written in the year 1389 A.D., and now preserved in the Laurentian Library at Florence. *M*¹ denotes the reading of the first hand, and *M*² that of a reviser.

Δ = the reading of *M* when supported by that of the *Codex Urbinas* 322, a MS. of the 15th century, preserved in the Vatican Library.

E = *Codex Ambrosianus* E, 14, a MS. probably of the 14th century, in the Ambrosian Library at Milan.

N = the *Codex ex abbatia Florentina* n. 49 in the Laurentian Library, written in the 14th or 15th century.

P = No. 8536 of the Latin MSS. in the Bibliothèque Nationale at Paris, a MS. of the 15th century.

R = No. 8538 of the same collection, written in the year 1419. These four MSS. *E*, *N*, *P*, *R*, with some others form a separate class; and

Σ = the reading of all the MSS. of this class, or of a preponderant number of them.

C = the marginal readings in Cratander's edition of 1528, drawn from a MS. which is now lost.

Z = the readings of the lost *Codex Tornaesianus*, *Z*^b denoting the reading as preserved by Bosius, and *Z*^l that testified to by Lambinus.

I = the reading of the *editio Jensoniana* published at Venice in 1470.

Rom. = the edition published at Rome in 1470.

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CICERO'S LETTERS TO ATTICUS

BOOK I

ego accepi in senatu, ut soleo, sed nihil est illo homine lentius. Metellus est consul egregius et nos amat, sed imminuit auctoritatem suam, quod habet dicis causa promulgatum illud idem de Clodio. Auli autem filius, o di immortales! quam ignavus ac sine animo miles! quam dignus, qui Palicano, sicut facit, os ad male audiendum cotidie praebeat! Agraria autem promulgata est a Flavio sane levis eadem fere, quae fuit Plotia. Sed interea πολιτικὸς ἀνὴρ οὐδ' ὄναρ quisquam inveniri potest; qui poterat, familiaris noster (sic est enim; volo te hoc scire) Pompeius togulam illam pictam silentio tueretur suam. Crassus verbum nullum contra gratiam. Ceteros iam nosti; qui ita sunt stulti, ut amissa re publica piscinas suas fore salvas sperare videantur. Unus est, qui curet constantia magis et integritate quam, ut mihi videtur, consilio aut ingenio, Cato; qui miseros publicanos, quos habuit amantissimos sui, tertium iam mensem vexat neque iis a senatu responsum dari patitur. Ita nos cogimur reliquis de rebus nihil discernere, antequam publicanis responsum sit. Quare etiam legationes reiectum iri puto.

Nunc vides quibus fluctibus iactemur, et, si ex iis, quae scripsimus tanta, etiam a me non

usual reception in the Senate; but he is the most phlegmatic of mortals. Metellus is an excellent consul and an admirer of mine; but he has lessened his influence by making, only for form's sake, the very same proposal about Clodius. But Aulus' son—heavens above! what a cowardly and spiritless wretch for a soldier! Just fit to be exposed, as he is, to the daily abuse of Palicanus. An agrarian law has been proposed by Flavius,—a very paltry production, almost identical with the Plotian law. And in the meantime not the ghost of a real statesman is to be found. The man who could be one, my intimate friend—for so he is, I would have you to know—Pompey, wraps that precious triumphal cloak of his around him in silence. Crassus never utters a word to risk his popularity. The others you know well enough—fools who seem to hope that their fish-ponds may be saved, though the country go to rack and ruin. There is one who can be said to take some pains, but, according to my view, with more constancy and honesty than judgement and ability—Cato. It is now three months that he has been worrying those wretched tax-collectors, who used to be great friends of his, and won't let the Senate give them an answer. So we are forced to suspend all decrees on

scripta perspicis, revise nos
aliquando et, quamquam sunt haec

other subjects until the tax-collectors
have had an answer. And I suppose
even the embassies^[37] will have to be
postponed for the same reason.

Now you see the storm we have to
weather; and, as you can grasp from
what I have written with such
emphasis, something of what I have
left unwritten, come and see me
again, for it is high time. Though

³⁷. Foreign embassies were received in
February.

fugienda, quo te voco, tamen fac
ut amorem nostrum tanti aestimes, ut
eo vel cum his molestiis perfrui
velis. Nam, ne absens censeare,
curabo edicendum et proponendum
locis omnibus; sub lustrum autem
censeri germani negotiatoris est.
Quare cura, ut te quam primum
videamus. Vale.

XI Kal. Febr. Q. Metello, L.
Afranio coss.

what I invite you to you might
well avoid, let your affection for me
conquer even your objection under
such unpleasant circumstances. I will
see to it that notice is given and
posted up everywhere, that you may
not be entered on the census list as
absent. But to get put on the roll just
before the census is too thoroughly
tradesman-like. So let me see you as
soon as possible. Farewell.

Jan. 20 in the consulship of C.
Metellus and L. Afranius.

XIX

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae Id. Mart.
a. 694*

Non modo si mihi tantum esset otii, quantum est tibi, verum etiam si tam breves epistulas vellem mittere, quam tu soles, facile te superarem et in scribendo multo essem crebrior quam tu. Sed ad summas atque incredibiles occupationes meas accedit, quod nullam a me volo^[38] epistulam ad te sine argumento ac sententia pervenire. Et primum tibi, ut aequum est civi amanti patriam, quae sint in re publica, exponam; deinde, quoniam tibi amore nos proximi sumus, scribemus etiam de nobis ea, quae scire te non nolle arbitramur.

Atque in re publica nunc quidem maxime Gallici belli versatur metus. Nam Haedui fratres nostri pugnam nuper malam^[39] pugnarunt, et Helvetii sine dubio sunt in armis excursionesque in provinciam faciunt. Senatus decrevit, ut consules duas Gallias sortirentur, delectus haberetur, vacationes ne valerent, legati cum auctoritate mitterentur, qui adirent Galliae civitates darentque operam, ne eae se cum

XIX

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Rome March 15, B.C.
60*

I had as much time as you have, or if I could bring myself to write such short letters as you generally write, I could beat you hollow and write far more frequently than you write. But on the top of my inconceivable stress of work, you have to add my habit of never sending you a letter without a theme and a moral. First, as one ought to a loyal citizen, I will give you a sketch of political events, and then, as I am the nearest in your affection, I will tell you any of my own affairs that I think you would not be disinclined to know.

In politics then at the present minute fears of war in Gaul are the main topic: for "our brothers" the Aedui have had a disastrous battle recently, and the Helvetii are undoubtedly in arms and making raids on our province. The Senate has decreed that the consuls should cast lots for the two Gauls, that levies should be made, furloughs cancelled, and ambassadors with full

Helvetiis coniungerent. Legati sunt Q. Metellus Creticus et L. Flaccus et, τὸ ἐπὶ τῇ φακῇ μύρον, Lentulus

[38](#). volo *Baiter*: solo *MSS*.

[39](#). pugnare pueri (or puer) malam (or in alam or male) *MSS*.: the reading of the text is that of *Boet*.

Clodiani filius. Atque hoc loco illud non queo praeterire, quod, cum de consularibus mea prima sors exisset, una voce senatus frequens retinendum me in urbe censuit. Hoc idem post me Pompeio accidit, ut nos duo quasi pignora rei publicae retineri videremur. Quid enim ego aliorum in me ἐπιφωνήματα exspectem, cum haec domi nascantur?

Urbanae autem res sic se habent. Agraria lex a Flavio tribuno pl. vehementer agitabatur auctore Pompeio; quae nihil populare habebat praeter auctorem. Ex hac ego lege secunda contionis voluntate omnia illa tollebam, quae ad privatorum incommodum pertinebant, liberabam agrum eum, qui P. Mucio, L. Calpurnio consulibus publicus fuisset, Sullanorum hominum possessiones confirmabam, Volaterranos et Arretinos, quorum agrum Sulla publicarat neque diviserat, in sua possessione retinebam; unam rationem non reiciebam, ut ager hac adventicia pecunia emeretur, quae ex

powers sent to visit the Gallic states and prevent them from joining the Aedui. The ambassadors are Quintus Metellus Creticus, and Lucius Flaccus, and—"the caper sauce on

lenten fare"[\[40\]](#)—Lentulus, son of Clodianus. And I cannot forbear adding here that when my lot came up first in the ballot among the ex-consuls, the Senate were unanimous in declaring that I should be kept in Rome. The same happened to Pompey after me, so that we two appear to be kept as pledges of the State. Why should I look for the "bravos" of strangers when these triumphs bloom for me at home?

Well, this is the state of affairs in the city. The agrarian law was zealously pushed by the tribune Flavius with the support of Pompey, though its only claim to popularity was its supporter. My proposal to remove from the law any points which encroached on private rights was favourably received by a public meeting. I proposed to exempt from its action such land as was public in the consulship of P. Mucius and L. Calpurnius,[\[41\]](#) to confirm Sulla's veterans in their possessions, to allow the people of Volaterra and Arretium to retain in their holding their land which Sulla had made

novis vectigalibus per quinquennium reciperetur. Huic toti rationi agrariae senatus adversabatur suspicans Pompeio novam quandam potentiam quaeri; Pompeius vero ad voluntatem perferendae legis incubuerat. Ego autem magna cum agrariorum gratia confirmabam omnium privatorum

public land, but had not distributed: the only clause I did not reject was that land should be purchased by this wind-fall which will come in from the new foreign revenues in the next five years. The Senate was opposed to the whole agrarian scheme, suspecting that Pompey was aiming at getting some new powers. Pompey had set his heart on carrying the law through. I on the other hand, with the full approval of the applicants for land, was for securing the holdings of all private

[40](#). Lit. “myrrh oil on lentils”; referring to a line in the *Phoenissae* of Strattis.

[41](#). 133 B.C., the year before the agrarian law of Tiberius Gracchus.

possessiones; is enim est noster exercitus, hominum, ut tute scis, locupletium; populo autem et Pompeio (nam id quoque volebam) satis faciebam emptione, qua constituta diligenter et sentinam urbis exhauriri et Italiae solitudinem frequentari posse arbitrabar. Sed haec tota res interpellata bello refrixerat. Metellus est consul sane bonus et nos admodum diligit; ille alter nihil ita est, ut plane, quid emerit, nesciat. Haec sunt in re publica, nisi etiam illud ad rem publicam putas pertinere, Herennium quendam, tribunum pl., tribulem tuum sane hominem nequam atque egentem, saepe iam de P. Clodio ad

persons—for, as you know, the strength of our party consists in the rich landed gentry—while at the same time I fulfilled my desire to satisfy Pompey and the populace by supporting the purchase of land, thinking that, if that were thoroughly carried out, the city might be emptied of the dregs of the populace, and the deserted parts of Italy peopled. But the matter has cooled off now this war has interrupted it. Metellus is an excellent consul and a great admirer of mine. The other one is an utter nonentity and clearly bought a pig in a poke when he got the consulship. That is all my political news, unless you think this

plebem traducendo agere coepisse. Huic frequenter interceditur. Haec sunt, ut opinor, in re publica.

Ego autem, ut semel Nonarum illarum Decembrium iunctam invidia ac multorum inimiciis eximiam quandam atque immortalem gloriam consecutus sum, non destiti eadem animi magnitudine in re publica versari et illam institutam ac susceptam dignitatem tueri, sed, posteaquam primum Clodi absolute levitatem infirmitatemque iudiciorum perspexi, deinde vidi nostros publicanos facile a senatu diiungi, quamquam a me ipso non divellerentur, tum autem beatos homines, hos piscinarios dico amicos tuos, non obscure nobis invidere, putavi mihi maiores quasdam opes et firmiora praesidia esse quaerenda. Itaque primum, eum qui nimium diu de rebus nostris tacuerat. Pompeium

has a bearing on politics. One Herennius, a tribune and fellow tribesman of yours, and a man of no character or position, has begun frequently proposing the transference of P. Clodius from a patrician to a plebeian; and his proposals are vetoed by many of his colleagues. This, I think, is all the public news.

For myself, ever since that December day when I won such splendid and immortal glory, though it carried with it much envy and enmity, I have not ceased to employ the same high-minded policy and to keep the position I have won and taken up. But, as soon as the acquittal of Clodius showed me the uncertainty and instability of the law courts, and I saw too how easily our friends the tax-gatherers could be estranged from the Senate, though they might not sever their connection with me, while the well-to-do—your friends with the fish-ponds, I mean—took no pains to disguise their envy of me, I bethought me that I had better look out for some stronger support and more secure protection. So firstly I brought Pompey, the man who had held his peace too long about

adduxi in eam voluntatem, ut in senatu non semel, sed saepe multisque verbis huius mihi salutem

my achievements, into a frame of mind for attributing to me the salvation of the empire and the world

imperii atque orbis terrarum adiudicarit; quod non tam interfuit mea (neque enim illae res aut ita sunt obscurae, ut testimonium, aut ita dubiae, ut laudationem desiderent) quam rei publicae, quod erant quidam improbi, qui contentionem fore aliquam mihi cum Pompeio ex rerum illarum dissensione arbitrarentur. Cum hoc ego me tanta familiaritate coniunxi, ut uterque nostrum in sua ratione munitior et in re publica firmior hac coniunctione esse possit. Odia autem illa libidinosae et delicatae iuventutis, quae erant in me incitata, sic mitigata sunt comitate quadam mea, me unum ut omnes illi colant; nihil iam denique a me asperum in quemquam fit nec tamen quicquam popolare ac dissolutum, sed ita temperata tota ratio est, ut rei publicae constantiam praestem, privatis meis rebus propter infirmitatem bonorum, iniquitatem malevolorum, odium in me improborum adhibeam quandam cautionem et diligentiam atque ita, tametsi his novis amicitiiis implicati sumus, ut crebro mihi vafer ille Siculus insusurret Epicharmus cantilenam illam suam:

Νᾶφε καὶ μέμνασ' ἀπιστεῖν· ἄρθρα ταῦτα τῶν
φρενῶν.

Ac nostrae quidem rationis ac vitae quasi quandam formam, ut

not once only, but time after time and with emphasis in the House. That was not so much for my own benefit—for my achievements were neither so obscure that they required evidence, nor so dubious that they required puffing up—but for the State's sake, for there were some ill-natured persons who thought that there was a certain amount of disagreement between Pompey and myself, owing to a difference of opinion about those matters. With him I have formed such an intimate connection that both of us are strengthened in our policy and surer in our political position through our coalition. The dislike which had been aroused against me among our dissipated and dandified youths has been smoothed away by my affability, and now they pay me more attention than anyone. In short I avoid hurting anyone's feelings, though I do not court popularity by relaxing my principles; indeed my whole conduct is regulated so, that, while I preserve my firmness in public life, in my private affairs the weakness of the loyal party, the prejudice of the disaffected and the hostility of the disloyal makes me move with some care and caution, and, involved though I am in my new friendships, I frequently have the refrain of Epicharmus, that subtle Sicilian, ringing in my ears:

opinor, vides.

De tuo autem negotio saepe ad me scribis. Cui mederi nunc non possumus; est enim illud senatus

Be sober of head, and mistrustful of friends;
Hinges are these on which wisdom depends.

There you have, I think, an outline sketch of my rule of life.

You keep writing about that business of yours; but at present I have no remedy for it. The decree

consultum summa pedariorum voluntate nullius nostrum auctoritate factum. Nam, quod me esse ad scribendum vides, ex ipso senatus consulto intellegere potes aliam rem tum relatam, hoc autem de populis liberis sine causa additum. Et ita factum est a P. Servilio filio, qui in postremis sententiam dixit, sed immutari hoc tempore non potest. Itaque conventus, qui initio celebrabantur, iam diu fieri desierunt. Tu si tuis blanditiis tamen a Sicyoniis nummulum aliquid expresseris, velim me facias certiore.

Commentarium consulatus mei Graece compositum misi ad te. In quo si quid erit, quod homini Attico minus Graecum eruditumque videatur, non dicam, quod tibi, ut opinor, Panhormi Lucullus de suis historiis dixerat, se, quo facilius illas probaret Romani hominis esse, idcirco barbara quaedam et σόλοικα dispersisse; apud me si quid erit eius modi, me imprudente erit et invito. Latinum si perfecero, ad te mittam. Tertium poema exspectato, ne quod

was passed by the enthusiasm of the silent members^[42] without any support from our party. For as to my signature which you find attached to it, you can see from the decree itself that it was quite a different matter which was brought forward, and this clause about the free peoples was added without rhyme or reason. It was the work of P. Servilius the younger, who was one of the last to speak: but it cannot be altered at the present time. So the meetings which at first were held about it have ceased long ago. If, however, you should manage to squeeze a few pence out of the Sicyonians, please let me know.

I have sent you a copy of my account of my consulship in Greek. If there is anything in it, which to your Attic taste seems bad Greek or unscholarly, I will not say what Lucullus said to you—at Panhormus, I think—about his history, that he had interspersed a few barbarisms and solecisms as a clear proof that it was the work of a Roman. If there is anything of the kind in my work, it is

genus a me ipso laudis meae praetermittatur. Hic tu cave dicas: Τίς πατέρ' αἰνήσει; Si est enim apud homines quicquam quod potius sit, laudetur, nos vituperemur, qui non potius alia laudemus; quamquam non ἐγκωμιαστικά sunt haec, sed ἱστορικά, quae scribimus.

Quintus frater purgat se mihi per litteras et adfirmat nihil a se cuiquam de te secus esse dictum.

Verum haec nobis coram summa cura et diligentia sunt agenda; tu modo nos revise aliquando. Cossinius hic, cui dedi litteras, valde mihi bonus homo et non levis et amans tui visus est et talis, qualem esse eum tuae mihi litterae nuntiant. Idibus Martiis.

there without my knowledge and against my will. When I have finished the Latin version, I will send it to you. In the third place you may expect a poem, not to let slip any method of singing my own praises. Please don't quote "Who will praise his sire?"^[43] For if there is any more fitting subject for eulogy, then I am willing to be blamed for not choosing some other subject. However my compositions are not panegyrics at all but histories.

My brother Quintus has written exculpating himself and declaring that he never said a word against

⁴². Members who did not speak, but only took part in the division (*pedibus ire in sententiam*).

⁴³. The whole proverb is found in Plutarch's Life of Aratus, τίς πατέρ' αἰνήσει εἰ μὴ κακοδαίμονες υἱοί.

you to anyone. But that is a point we have to discuss very carefully when we meet, if only you will come and see me some time. This Cossinius, to whom I have given the letter, seems to me a very good steady sort of fellow, and devoted to you, exactly as you described him in your letter. March 15.

XX

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae m. Maio
a. 694*

Cum e
Pompeiano

me Romam recepissem a. d. iv Idus
Maías, Cincius noster eam mihi abs
te epistulam reddidit, quam tu Idibus
Febr. dederas. Ei nunc epistulae
litteris his respondebo. Ac primum
tibi perspectum esse iudicium de te
meum laetor, deinde te in iis rebus,
quae mihi asperius a nobis atque
nostris et iniucundius actae
videbantur, moderatissimum fuisse
vehementissime gaudeo idque neque
amoris mediocris et ingenii summi
ac sapientiae iudico. Qua de re cum
ad me ita suaviter, diligenter,
officiose, humaniter scripseris, ut
non modo te hortari amplius non
debeam, sed ne exspectare quidem
abs te aut ab ullo homine tantum
facilitatis ac mansuetudinis
potuerim, nihil duco esse
commodius quam de his rebus nihil
iam amplius scribere. Cum erimus
congressi, tum, si quid res feret,
coram inter nos conferemus.

Quod ad me de re publica scribis,
disputas tu quidem et amanter et
prudenter, et a meis consiliis ratio
tua non abhorret; nam neque de statu

XX

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Rome, May, B.C. 60

On my return from my villa at
Pompeii on the 12th of May, our
friend Cincius passed on to me your
letter which was dated the 13th of
February. That is the letter which I
shall now answer. And first I must
say how delighted I am that you
fully understood my opinion of you:
next how very glad I am that you
showed such forbearance with regard
to the slights and unkindness which
in my opinion you had received from
me and mine: and I count it a sign of
affection more than ordinary and the
highest sense and wisdom. Indeed
your answer is so charmingly
worded and with such consideration
and kindness that not only have I
no further right to press you, but I
can never expect to experience such
courtesy and forbearance from you
or any other man. So I think it would
be best for me to say no more about
the matter in my letters. If any point
arises, we will discuss it together
when we meet.

nobis nostrae dignitatis est
recedendum neque sine nostris copiis
intra alterius praesidia veniendum, et
is, de quo scribis, nihil habet
amplum, nihil excelsum, nihil non

Your remarks about politics are
couched in friendly and prudent
terms, and your view does not differ
from my own—for I must not
withdraw from my dignified
position, nor must I enter another's
lines without any forces of my own,
and the man you mention has no
broad-mindedness and no high-
mindedness,

summissum atque popolare.
Verum tamen fuit ratio mihi fortasse
ad tranquillitatem meorum
temporum non inutilis, sed
mehercule rei publicae multo etiam
utilior quam mihi civium
improborum impetus in me reprimi,
cum hominis amplissima fortuna,
auctoritate, gratia fluctuantem
sententiam confirmassem et a spe
malorum ad mearum rerum laudem
convertissem. Quod si cum aliqua
levitate mihi faciendum fuisset,
nullam rem tanti aestimassem; sed
tamen a me ita sunt acta omnia, non
ut ego illi adsentiens levior, sed ut
ille me probans gravior videretur.
Reliqua sic a me aguntur et agentur,
ut non committamus, ut ea, quae
gessimus, fortuito gessisse videamur.
Meos bonos viros, illos quos
significas, et, eam quam mihi dicis
obtigisse, Σπάρταν non modo
numquam deseram, sed etiam, si ego
ab illa deserar, tamen in mea pristina
sententia permanebo. Illud tamen

nothing in him that is not low and
time-serving. Well, perhaps the
course I took was not opposed to my
own advantage and peace of life, but
I swear it was far more to the
advantage of the State than to mine
that I should be the means of
suppressing the attacks of the
disloyal, and of strengthening the
wavering policy of a man of the
highest position, influence and
popularity, and converting him from
pandering to the disloyal to approval
of my achievements. If I had had to
make any sacrifice of principle in so
doing, I should never have thought it
justifiable: but I managed it so that
he seemed to gain in principle by his
approval of me, more than I lost in
bowing to him. I will take care that
my actions now and in the future do
not convey the impression that what
I did in the past was done at
haphazard. My honest comrades, at
whom you hint, and the lot^[44] which
has fallen to me, as you say, I will
never desert. Nay, even if I am

velim existimes, me hanc viam
optimatē post Catuli mortem nec
praesidio ullo nec comitatu tenere.
Nam, ut ait Rhinton, ut opinor,

Οἱ μὲν παρ' οὐδέν εἰσι, τοῖς δ' οὐδέν μέλει.

Mihi vero ut inuideant piscinarii
nostri, aut scribam ad te alias aut in
congressum nostrum reservabo. A
curia autem nulla me res divellet, vel
quod ita rectum

deserted by it I will abide by my
ancient principles. But I would have
you please remember that, since the
death of Catulus, I am holding the
way for the conservative party
without a garrison and without a
comrade. For, as Rhinton, I think it
is, says:

Some are stark naught, and naught do others
reck.

How our friends of the fish-ponds
envy me, I will either tell you in
another letter, or keep it till we meet.
But from the Senate house nothing
shall tear me: either because that is
the right course, or

[44](#). Σπάρταν ἔλαχες ταύταν κόσμει is quoted
in full from Euripides' Telephus in Att. iv, 6, 2.

est, vel quod rebus meis maxime
consentaneum, vel quod, a senatu
quanti fiam, minime me paenitet.

De Sicyoniis, ut ad te scripsi
antea, non multum spei est in senatu;
nemo est enim, idem qui queratur.
Quare, si id exspectas, longum est;
alia via, si qua potes, pugna. Cum est
actum, neque animadversum est, ad
quos pertineret, et raptim in eam
sententiam pedarii cucurrerunt.
Inducendi senatus consulti maturitas
nondum est, quod neque sunt, qui
querantur, et multi partim
malevolentia, partim opinione
aequitatis delectantur.

because it is most consistent with
my position, or because I am by no
means dissatisfied with the Senate's
estimation of me.

As regards the Sicyonians, there is
very little hope to be placed in the
Senate, as I wrote you before: for
there is no one now to raise a
complaint. It would be tedious to
wait for them to move. Fight the
point in some other way, if you can.
When the law was passed, nobody
noticed to whom it applied, and the
dummy members plumped eagerly in
its favour. The time has not yet come
for rescinding the decree, because
there is no one who complains about

Metellus tuus est egregius consul; unum reprehendo, quod otium nuntiari e Gallia non magno opere gaudet. Cupit, credo, triumphare. Hoc vellem mediocrius; cetera egregia. Auli filius vero ita se gerit, ut eius consulatus non consulatus sit, sed Magni nostri ὑπώπιον.

De meis scriptis misi ad te Graece perfectum consulatum meum. Eum librum L. Cossinio dedi. Puto te Latinis meis delectari, huic autem Graeco Graecum invidere. Alii si scripserint, mittemus ad te; sed, mihi crede, simul atque hoc nostrum legerunt, nescio quo pacto retardantur.

Nunc, ut ad rem meam redeam, L. Papirius Paetus, vir bonus amatorque noster, mihi libros eos, quos Ser. Claudius reliquit, donavit. Cum mihi per legem Cinciam licere capere Cincius, amicus tuus, diceret,

it, and some favour it, partly from spite and partly from an idea of its justness.

Your friend Metellus is an excellent consul: I have only one fault to find with him, he is not at all pleased with the news of peace from Gaul. I take it he wants a triumph. I wish he would moderate that desire: in every other way he is excellent. The behaviour of Aulus's son makes his consulship not a consulship, but a blot on the scutcheon^[45] of our friend Pompey.

I have sent you one of my works, a history of my consulship in Greek. I have given it to L. Cossinius. I fancy you like my Latin work, but, being a Greek, envy this Greek one. If others write about it, I will send you copies; but I assure you, as soon as they read mine, they somehow or other don't hurry themselves about it.

Now to return to business. L. Papirius Paetus, my good friend and admirer, has offered me the books left to him by Ser. Claudius: and, as your friend Cincius said I could take them without breaking the

⁴⁵. Lit. "a black eye."

libenter dixi me accepturum, si attulisset. Nunc, si me amas, si te a me amari scis, enitere per amicos, clientes, hospites, libertos denique ac

Cincian law^[46], I said I would very willingly accept, if he brought them here. Now, as you love me, as you know I love you, stir up all your

servos tuos, ut scida ne qua depereat; nam et Graecis iis libris, quos suspicor, et Latinis, quos scio illum reliquisse, mihi vehementer opus est. Ego autem cotidie magis, quod mihi de forensi labore temporis datur, in iis studiis conquiesco. Per mihi, per, inquam, gratum feceris, si in hoc tam diligens fueris, quam soles in iis rebus, quas me valde velle arbitraris. ipsiusque Paeti tibi negotia commendo, de quibus tibi ille agit maximas gratias, et, ut iam invisas nos, non solum rogo, sed etiam suadeo.

friends, clients, guests, freedmen, nay even your slaves, to see that not a leaf is lost. For I have urgent necessity for the Greek works, which I suspect, and the Latin books, which I am sure, he left. Every day I seek my recreation, in such time as is left me from my legal labours, more and more in such studies. You will do me the greatest of favours, if you will show the same zeal in this as you generally do in matters about which you think I am really keen. Paetus' own affairs I recommend to your notice too, and he expresses his deepest gratitude. And I do more than ask you, I urge you, to pay me a visit soon.

⁴⁶. The *lex Cincia de donis et muneribus* (204 B.C.), which forbade taking presents for pleading causes.

**M. TULLI CICERONIS
EPISTULARUM AD
ATTICUM
LIBER SECUNDUS**

I

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae m. Iun. a.
694*

Kal.

Iuniis eunti mihi Antium, et gladiatores M. Metelli cupide relinquenti, venit obviam tuus puer. Is mihi litteras abs te et commentarium consulatus mei Graece scriptum reddidit. In quo laetatus sum me aliquanto ante de isdem rebus Graece item scriptum librum L. Cossinio ad te perferendum dedisse, nam, si ego tuum ante legissem, furatum me abs te esse diceres. Quamquam tua illa (legi enim libenter) horridula mihi atque incompta visa sunt, sed tamen erant ornata hoc ipso, quod ornamenta neglexerant, et ut mulieres ideo bene olere, quia nihil olebant, videbantur. Meus autem liber totum Isocratis myrothecium atque omnes eius discipulorum arculas ac non nihil etiam Aristoteliae pigmenta consumpsit. Quem tu Corcyrae, ut mihi aliis litteris significas, strictim attigisti, post autem, ut arbitror, a Cossinio accepisti. Quem tibi ego non essem ausus mittere, nisi eum lente ac fastidiose probavissem. Quamquam ad me scripsit iam Rhodo Posidonius se, nostrum illud ὑπόμνημα cum

CICERO'S LETTERS TO ATTICUS BOOK II

legeret, quod ego ad eum, ut ornatius de isdem rebus scriberet, miseram, non modo non excitatum esse ad scribendum, sed etiam plane deterritum. Quid quaeris? conturbavi Graecam nationem. Ita, vulgo qui instabant, ut darem sibi, quod ornarent, iam exhibere mihi molestiam destiterunt. Tu, si tibi placuerit

I

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Rome, June, B.C. 60

On the 1st of June I met your boy as I was on my way to Antium and glad to get away from M. Metellus's gladiatorial exhibition. He delivered your letter, and a memorial of my consulship written in Greek. I felt very glad that I gave L. Cossinius the book I had written in Greek on the same subject to take to you some time ago. For, if I had read yours first you would say that I had plagiarized from you. Though yours (which I read with pleasure) seemed to me a trifle rough and unadorned, yet its very lack of ornament is an ornament in itself, just as women were thought to have the best scent who used no scent. My book, on the other hand, has exhausted all the scent box of Isocrates, and all the rouge-pots of his pupils, and some of Aristotle's colours too. You scanned it through, as you tell me in another letter, at Corcyra, before you had received it from Cossinius, I suppose. I should never have dared to send it to you, if I had not revised it with leisure and care. I sent the

memoir to Posidonius too, asking him to write something more elaborate on the same subject; but he tells me that, far from being inspired to write by the perusal of it, he was decidedly put off. In fact, I have flabbergasted the whole Greek nation: so I have ceased to be plagued by the people who were always hanging about asking me to give them something of mine to polish up. If you like the

liber, curabis, ut et Athenis sit et in ceteris oppidis Graeciae; videtur enim posse aliquid nostris rebus lucis adferre. Oratiunculas autem, et quas postulas, et plures etiam mittam, quoniam quidem ea, quae nos scribimus adolescentulorum studiis excitati, te etiam delectant. Fuit enim mihi commodum, quod in eis orationibus, quae Philippicae nominantur, enituerat civis ille tuus Demosthenes, et quod se ab hoc refractariolo iudiciali dicendi genere abiunxerat, ut σεμνότερός τις καὶ πολιτικώτερος videretur, curare, et meae quoque essent orationes, quae consulares nominarentur. Quarum una est in senatu Kal. Ianuariis, altera ad populum de lege agraria, tertia de Othone, quarta pro Rabirio, quinta de proscriptorum filiis, sexta, cum provinciam in contione deposui, septima, cum Catilinam emisi, octava, quam habui ad populum,

book, you will see to it that Athens and other Greek towns have it in stock; for I think it may add some lustre to my achievements. I will send you the bits of speeches you ask for and some more too, as you find some interest in things which I write to satisfy young admirers. Your fellow-citizen, Demosthenes, gained a reputation by the speeches called the Philippics, in which he departed from the quibbling style of pleading we use in the law-courts, and appeared in the role of a serious politician. So I took a fancy to leave behind me also some speeches which may be called consular. One was delivered in the House on the 1st of January, another to the people on the agrarian law, the third on Otho, the fourth for Rabirius, the fifth for the sons of the proscribed, the sixth when I declined a province in a public assembly, the seventh when I drove Catiline out, the eighth before

postridie quam Catilina profugit, nona in contione, quo die Allobroges indicarunt, decima in senatu Nonis Decembribus. Sunt praeterea duae breves, quasi ἀποσπασμάτια legis agrariae. Hoc totum σῶμα curabo ut habeas; et, quoniam te cum scripta tum res meae delectant, isdem ex libris perspicies, et quae gesserim et quae dixerim; aut ne poposcisses; ego enim tibi me non offerebam.

Quod quaeris, quid sit, quo te arcessam, ac simul impeditum te negotiis esse significas neque recusas, quin, non modo si opus sit, sed etiam si velim, accurras, nihil sane est necesse, verum tamen videbare mihi tempora peregrinationis commodius posse describere. Nimis abes diu, praesertim cum sis in propinquis

locis, neque nos te fruimur, et tu nobis cares. Ac nunc quidem otium est, sed, si paulo plus furor Pulchelli progredi posset, valde ego te istim excitarem. Verum praeclare Metellus impedit et impedit. Quid quaeris? est consul φιλόπατρις et, ut semper iudicavi, natura bonus. Ille autem non simulat, sed plane tribunus pl. fieri cupit. Qua de re cum in senatu ageretur, fregi hominem et inconstantiam eius reprehendi, qui

the people the day after Catiline fled, the ninth in an assembly on the day when the Allobroges gave their information, the tenth in the House on the 5th of December. There are two more short ones, mere scraps of the agrarian law. I will see that you have the whole *corpus*; and, since both my writing and my achievements interest you, you will see from them what I have done, and what I have written. Or else you should not have asked for them: I was not the one to obtrude them.

You inquire why I ask you to come back, and hint that you are hindered by business. Still you don't refuse to come, if there is any need, or even if I wish it. There is no real necessity; but it does seem to me that you could arrange your times for going away more conveniently. You are away too long, especially when you are quite near, and

so I have no chance of enjoying your society and you lack mine. Just at present things are peaceful: but if that little beauty^[47] should be strong enough to indulge in any wilder freaks I should certainly be routing you out of your retreat. However, Metellus is holding him in nobly and will continue to do so. Most assuredly he is a thoroughly patriotic consul, and, as I always thought, an excellent fellow. Clodius does not

Romae tribunatum pl. peteret, cum in Sicilia hereditatem se petere dictitasset, neque magno opere dixi esse nobis laborandum, quod nihilo magis ei licitum esset plebeio rem publicam perdere, quam similibus eius me consule patriciis esset licitum. Iam, cum se ille septimo die venisse a freto, neque sibi obviam quemquam prodire potuisse, et noctu se introisse dixisset, in eoque se in contione iactasset, nihil ei novi dixi accidisse. "Ex Sicilia septimo die Romam; ante tribus horis Roma Interamnam. Noctu introisse; idem ante. Non est itum obviam; ne tum quidem, cum iri maxime debuit." Quid quaeris? hominem petulantem modestum reddo non solum perpetua gravitate orationis, sed etiam hoc genere dictorum. Itaque iam familiariter cum ipso cavillor ac iocor; quin etiam, cum candidatum deduceremus, quaerit ex me, num consuessem Siculis locum gladiatoribus dare. Negavi. "At ego," inquit, "novus

beat about the bush, he is quite plainly aiming at the tribunate. When the point was discussed in the Senate, I sat on him, accusing him of inconsistency, for seeking the tribunate now in Rome, when in Sicily he did nothing but repeat that what he wanted was an inheritance. However, I added, we need not put ourselves about on that point, as he would not be allowed to ruin the country if he becomes a plebeian any more than patricians of his kidney were allowed to in my consulship. Then, when he said he had come from the straits in a week, so that no one could go to meet him, and had entered the city at night, and boasted of the fact in a public speech, I said there was nothing new in that. "Seven days from Sicily to Rome: the other time three hours from Rome to Interamna. He came in at night: so he did before. No one met him now: nor did anyone meet him last time, when they certainly ought to have done so." In fact, I am taking the cheek out of him, not only by serious set speeches, but by quips of this kind too. So nowadays I bandy jests and banter with him quite familiarly. For instance, when we were escorting a candidate, he asked me whether I used to give the Sicilians seats at the gladiatorial shows. I said, "No." "Well," said he,

patronus instituam; sed soror, quae tantum habeat consularis loci, unum mihi solum pedem dat.” “Noli,” inquam “de uno pede sororis queri; licet etiam alterum tollas.” Non consulare, inquires, dictum. Fateor; sed ego illam odi male consularem. “Ea est enim seditiosa, ea cum viro bellum gerit” neque solum cum Metello, sed etiam cum Fabio, quod eos^[48] in hoc esse moleste fert.

Quod de agraria lege quaeris, sane iam videtur refrixisse. Quod me quodam modo molli brachio de Pompei familiaritate obiurgas, nolim ita existimes, me mei praesidii causa cum illo coniunctum esse, sed ita res erat instituta, ut, si inter nos esset aliqua forte dissensio, maximas in re publica discordias versari esset necesse. Quod a me ita praecautum atque provisum est, non ut ego de optima illa mea ratione decederem, sed ut ille esset melior et aliquid de populari levitate deponeret. Quem de meis rebus, in quas eum multi incitarant, multo scito gloriosius quam de suis praedicare; sibi enim bene gestae, mihi conservatae rei publicae dat testimonium. Hoc facere illum mihi quam prosit, nescio; rei publicae certe prodest. Quid? si etiam Caesarem, cuius nunc venti valde sunt secundi, reddo meliorem, num tantum obsum rei publicae? Quin etiam, si mihi nemo

“now I am their new patron, I intend to begin the practice: though my sister, who, as the consul’s wife, has such a lot of room, will not give me more than standing room.” “Oh, don’t grumble about standing room with your sister,” I answered. “You can always lie with her.” You will say it was not the remark for a consular to make. I confess it was not; but I hate the woman, so unworthy of a consul. “For she’s a shrew and wrangles with her mate,” and not only with Metellus, but with Fabius too, because she is annoyed at their interference in this affair.

You ask about the agrarian law. Interest in it seems to have cooled down. You give me a gentle fillip for my familiarity with Pompey. Please don’t imagine I have allied myself to him solely to save my skin: the position of affairs is such that, if we had had any disagreement, there would of necessity have been great discord in the State. Against that I have taken precautions and made provision without wavering from my own excellent policy, while making him more loyal and less the people’s weathercock. He speaks, I may tell you, far more glowingly about my achievements than about his own, though many have tried to set him against me, saying that he did his duty to the country, but I saved it. What good his statements will do

invideret, si omnes, ut erat aequum, faverent, tamen non minus esset probanda medicina, quae sanaret vitiosas partes rei publicae, quam quae exsecaret.

[48.](#) eos esse in hoc esse MSS.

Nunc vero, cum equitatus ille, quem ego in clivo Capitolino te signifero ac principe collocaram, senatum deseruerit, nostri autem principes digito se caelum putent attingere, si nulli barbati in piscinis sint, qui ad manum accedant, alia autem neglegant, nonne tibi satis prodesse videor, si perficio, ut nolint obesse, qui possunt? Nam Catonem nostrum non tu amas plus quam ego; sed tamen ille optimo animo utens et summa fide nocet interdum rei publicae; dicit enim tamquam in Platonis πολιτεία, non tamquam in Romuli faece sententiam. Quid verius quam in iudicium venire, qui ob rem iudicandam pecuniam acceperit? Censuit hoc Cato, adsensit senatus; equites curiae bellum, non mihi; nam ego dissensi. Quid impudentius publicanis renuntiantibus? fuit tamen retinendi ordinis causa faciunda iactura.

me, I fail to see: but they will certainly do the country good. Well! If I can make Caesar, who is now sailing gaily before the breeze, a better patriot too, shall I be doing so poor a service to the country? And, even if none were to envy me and all supported me, as they ought, still a remedy which cures the diseased parts of the State should be preferable to one which amputates them.

But as it is, when the knights, whom I once stationed on the Capitoline hill with you as their standard-bearer and leader, have deserted the Senate, and our great men think themselves in the seventh heaven, if they have bearded mullet in their fish-ponds that will feed from their hand, and don't care about anything else, surely you must allow that I have done my best, if I manage to take the will to do harm from those who have the power to do it. For our friend Cato is not more to you than to me: but still with the best of intentions and unimpeachable honesty at times he does harm to the country: for the opinions he delivers would be more in place in Plato's Republic than among the dregs of humanity collected by Romulus.^{[\[49\]](#)} That a man who accepts a bribe for the verdict he returns at a trial should be put on trial himself is as fair a principle as one could wish. Cato

Restitit et pervicit Cato. Itaque nunc consule in carcere incluso, saepe item seditione commota aspiravit nemo eorum, quorum ego concursu itemque ii consules, qui post me fuerunt, rem publicam defendere solebant. “Quid ergo? istos,” inquires, “mercede conductos habebimus?” Quid faciemus, si aliter non possumus? An libertinis atque etiam servis serviamus? Sed, ut tu ais, ὅλις σπουδῆς.

voted for it and won the House’s assent. Result, a war of the knights with the Senate, but not with me. I was against it. That the tax-collectors should repudiate their bargain was a most shameless proceeding. But we ought to have put up with the loss in order to keep their good-will. Cato resisted and carried the day. Result, though we’ve had a consul in prison, and frequent riots, not a breath of encouragement from one of those, who in my own consulship and that of my successors used to rally round us to defend the country. “Must we then bribe them for their support?” you will ask. What help is there, if we cannot get it otherwise? Are we to be slaves of freedmen and slaves? But, as you say, enough of the *grand sérieux*.

⁴⁹. Possibly “among the dregs of [the city] of Romulus”; but Plutarch, who translates it ἐν Ῥωμύλου ὑποστάθμῃ, (*Phoc.* 3), is against that rendering.

Favonius meam tribum tulit honestius quam suam, Luccei perdidit. Accusavit Nasicam inhoneste ac modeste tamen. Dixit ita, ut Rhodi videretur molis potius quam Moloni operam dedisse. Mihi, quod defendissem, leviter susceperat. Nunc tamen petit iterum rei publicae causa. Lucceius quid agat, scribam ad te, cum Caesarem videro, qui aderit biduo. Quod Sicyonii te laedunt, Catoni et eius aemulatori

Favonius carried my tribe with even more credit than his own, but lost that of Lucceius. His accusation of Nasica was nothing to be proud of; however he conducted it very moderately. He spoke so badly that one would think he devoted more time at Rhodes to grinding in the mills than at Molo’s lectures. I got into his bad books for undertaking the defence; however he is standing again now on public grounds. How

attribuis Servilio. Quid? ea plaga nonne ad multos bonos viros pertinet? Sed, si ita placuit, laudemus, deinde in discessionibus soli relinquamur.

Amalthea mea te exspectat et indiget tui. Tusculanum et Pompeianum valde me delectant, nisi quod me, illum ipsum vindicem aeris alieni, aere non Corinthio, sed hoc circumforaneo obruerunt. In Gallia speramus esse otium. Prognostica mea cum oratiunculis prope diem exspecta et tamen, quid cogites de adventu tuo, scribe ad nos. Nam mihi Pomponia nuntiarum iussit te mense Quintili Romae fore. Id a tuis litteris, quas ad me de censu tuo miseras, discrepabat.

Paetus, ut antea ad te scripsi, omnes libros, quos frater suus reliquisset, mihi donavit. Hoc illius munus in tua diligentia positum est. Si me amas, cura, ut conserventur et ad me perferantur; hoc mihi nihil potest esse gratius. Et cum Graecostum vero

Lucceius is getting on I will write and tell you, when I have seen Caesar, who will be here in a couple of days' time. The wrong the Sicyonians have done you, you attribute to Cato and his imitator Servilius. But does not the blow affect many good citizens? However, if it so pleases them, let us acquiesce, and be utterly deserted at the next question put to the vote.

My Amalthea is waiting and longing for you. I am delighted with my places at Tusculum and Pompeii, except that, champion of creditors as I am, they have overwhelmed me not so much with Corinthian bronze as with debts in the common copper coin of the realm. We hope things have settled down in Gaul. Expect my Prognostics^[50] and my bits of speeches very shortly: but for all that write and tell me your plans about coming. Pomponia has sent a message that you will be in Rome in July: but that disagrees with the letter you sent to me about placing your name on the census list.

Paetus, as I have already mentioned, has given me the books left him by his brother: but this gift depends on your kind services. As you love me, see that they are preserved and brought to me. You could do me no greater favour: and I should like the

diligenter Latinos ut conserves
velim. Tuum esse hoc munusculum
putabo. Ad Octavium dedi litteras;
cum ipso nihil eram locutus; neque
enim ista tua negotia provincialia
esse putabam neque te in
tocullionibus habebam. Sed scripsi,
ut debui, diligenter.

Latin books kept as well as the
Greek. I shall count them a present
from yourself. I have written to
Octavius, but not spoken to him
about it: for I did not know that your
business extended to the provinces,
nor did I count you among the
Shylocks. But I have written as
punctiliously as duty bade.

II

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. ad villam m.
Dec., ut videtur, a.
694*

Cura,
amabo te,
Ciceronem

nostrum. Ei nos συννοσεῖν videmur. Πελληναίων in manibus tenebam et hercule magnum acervum Dicaearchi mihi ante pedes exstruxeram. O magnum hominem, et unde multo plura didiceris quam de Procilio! Κορινθίων et Ἀθηναίων puto me Romae habere. Mihi crede, si leges haec, dices^[51]: mirabilis vir est. Ἡρώδης, si homo esset, eum potius legeret quam unam litteram scriberet. Qui me epistula petivit, ad te, ut video, comminus accessit. Coniurasse malletm quam restitisse coniurationi, si illum mihi audiendum putassem. De Iolio^[52] sanus non es; de vino laudo.

Sed heus tu, ecquid vides Kalendas venire, Antonium non venire? iudices cogi? Nam ita ad me mittunt, Nigidium minari in contione se iudicem, qui non adfuerit, compellaturum. Velim tamen, si quid est, de

⁵¹. crede, si leges haec, dices *Boot*: credes leges haec doceo *Z*: hredes lege hec doceo *M*.

II

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*At his country house,
Dec. (?), B.C. 60*

Look well after my little namesake. I am ill with him by sympathy. I have in hand my treatise on the constitution of Pellene, and you should see the huge heap of Dicaearchus that I have piled at my feet. What a great man! You could learn a lot more from him than from Procilius. I believe I have got his works on the constitutions of Corinth and Athens at Rome: and you may take my word for it that, if you read them, you will exclaim "The man is a wonder." If Herodes had any sense in him, he would spend his time reading him and never write a single letter of the alphabet. He has attacked me by post, and you, as I see, in person. I would far rather have joined in the conspiracy than opposed it, if I had thought I should have to pay for it by listening to him. As regards the darnel, you must be losing your senses: but about the wine I quite agree with you.

But, I say, have you noticed the Kalends are coming, and there is no

[52](#). The MSS. read Lollo; but lolio, the reading of the ed. Jensoniana (Venice, 1470) is supported by Reid with a reference to Pliny H.N. xxii, 160, where lolium is recommended for gout.

Antoni adventu quod audieris, scribas ad me et, quoniam huc non venis, cenes apud nos utique pridie Kal. Cave aliter facias. Cura, ut valeas.

Antonius? Though the jury is being empanelled,—at least they tell me so, and that Nigidius is threatening in a public meeting to serve a summons on any juror who does not attend. If you

should happen to get any news of Antonius' coming, please let me know: and, as you won't come here, dine with me anyhow on the 29th at my town house. Be sure you do; and take care of yourself.

III

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. ad villam m. Dec.
a. 694*

Primum,
ut opinor,
εὐαγγέλια. Valerius absolutus est
Hortensio defendente. Id iudicium
Auli filio condonatum putabatur; et
Iphicratem^[53] suspicor, ut scribis,
lascivum fuisse. Etenim mihi caligae
eius et fasciae cretatae non
placebant. Quid sit, sciemus, cum
veneris.

Fenestrarum angustias quod
reprehendis, scito te Κύρου παιδείαν
reprehendere. Nam, cum ego idem
istuc dicerem, Cyrus aiebat
viridariorum διαφάσεις latis
luminibus non tam esse suaves;
etenim ἔστω ὄψις μὲν ἢ α, τὸ δὲ
ὀρώμενον β, γ, ἀκτῖνες δὲ δ καὶ ε.
Vides enim cetera. Nam, si κατ'
εἰδώλων ἐμπτώσεις videremus, valde
laborarent εἰδῶλα in angustiis. Nunc
fit lepide illa ἔκχυσις radiorum.
Cetera si reprehenderis, non feres
tacitum, nisi si quid erit eius modi,
quod sine sumptu corrigi possit.

⁵³. Epicrates MSS.: Iphicrates Tyrrell.

III

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*At his country house,
Dec. (?), B.C. 60*

First a trifle please for good news.
Valerius has been acquitted, with
Hortensius as his advocate. The
verdict is generally thought to be a
concession to Aulus' son; and I
expect Iphicrates^[54] has been up to
some tricks, as you suggest. I didn't
like the look of his military boots
and puttees. We shall know what it
was, when you arrive.

In finding fault with the
narrowness of my windows, let me
tell you, you are finding fault with
the Education of Cyrus^[55]: for, when
I made the same remark to Cyrus, he
said that the view of gardens was not
so pleasant, if the windows were
broad. For, let *a* be the point of
vision, and *b, c* the object, and *d, e*
the rays,—you see what follows. If
our sight resulted from the impact of
images,^[56] the images would be
horribly squeezed in the narrow
space: but, as it is, the emission of
rays goes on merrily. If you have any
other faults to find, you will find me
ready with an answer, unless they are

such as can be put to rights without expense.

[54](#). Obviously a nickname for Pompey, and, in view of the next sentence, the name of Iphicrates, who invented a military boot, seems more likely than Epicrates, which would mean “our influential friend.”

[55](#). A play on the title of Xenophon’s book the *Cyropaedia* and the name of Cicero’s architect.

[56](#). Democritus and the Epicureans held that sight resulted from the incidence of images cast by external things upon the eyes. The view supported by Cicero, that it resulted from rays sent out from the eyes, was that held by Plato.

Venio nunc ad mensem Ianuarium et ad ὑπόστασιν nostram ac πολιτείαν, in qua Σωκρατικῶς εἰς ἐκότερον, sed tamen ad extremum, ut illi solebant, τὴν ἀρέσκουσάν. Est res sane magni consilii; nam aut fortiter resistendum est legi agrariae, in quo est quaedam dimicatio, sed plena laudis, aut quiescendum, quod est non dissimile atque ire in Solonium aut Antium, aut etiam adiuvandum, quod a me aiunt Caesarem sic exspectare, ut non dubitet. Nam fuit apud me Cornelius, hunc dico Balbum, Caesaris familiarem. Is adfirmabat illum omnibus in rebus meo et Pompei consilio usurum daturumque operam, ut cum Pompeio Crassum coniungeret. Hic sunt haec, coniunctio mihi summa cum Pompeio, si placet, etiam cum Caesare, reditus in gratiam cum

Now I come to January and my political attitude; and I shall follow the fashion of the Socratic schools in giving both sides of the question, ending, however, as they do, with the one which I prefer. It really is a point that requires much consideration. For either I have got to resist the agrarian measure strongly, which would mean something of a fight, though I should gain prestige by it; or I must hold my peace, which is equivalent to retiring to Solonium or Antium; or else I must assist the measure, and that is what they say Caesar expects me to do beyond a doubt. For Cornelius paid me a visit—I mean Balbus, Caesar’s great friend. He assured me that Caesar will take my own and Pompey’s opinion on everything, and that he will make an effort to reconcile Pompey and Crassus. On this side of

inimicis, pax cum multitudine,
senectutis otium. Sed me κατακλείς
mea illa commovet, quae est in libro
tertio:

“Interea cursus, quos prima a parte iuventae
Quosque adeo consul virtute animoque petisti,
Hos retine atque auge famam laudesque
bonorum.”

Haec mihi cum in eo libro, in quo
multa sunt scripta ἀριστοκρατικῶς,
Calliope ipsa praescripserit, non
opinor esse dubitandum, quin
semper nobis videatur

εἷς οἰωνὸς ἄριστος ἀμύνεσθαι περὶ πάτρης.

Sed haec ambulationibus
Compitaliciis reservemus. Tu pridie
Compitalia memento. Balneum
calfieri iubebo. Et Pomponiam
Terentia rogat; matrem

adiungemus. Θεοφράστου περὶ
φιλοτιμίας adfer mihi de libris Quinti
fratris.

the sheet may be placed an intimate
connection with Pompey and, if I
like, with Caesar too, reconciliation
with my enemies, peace with the
populace, and ease in my old age.
But my blood is still stirred by the
finale I laid down for myself in the
3rd book of my poem:^[57]

“Meantime the course you chose in youth’s first
spring
And held to, heart and soul, ’mid civic strife
Keep still, with growing fame and good report.”

Since Calliope herself dictated
those verses to me in a book full of
passages in lordly vein, I ought not
to have the least hesitation in holding
“no omen, better than to right one’s
country’s wrongs.”

Iliad xii, 243

But this point must be reserved for
our strolls at the Compitalia. Do you
remember the day before the festival.
I will order the bath to be heated,
and Terentia is going to invite
Pomponia. We will make

⁵⁷. On his consulship.

your mother one of the party.
Bring me from my brother Quintus’
library Theophrastus’ “Hints for
office-seekers.”

IV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Antium. Aprili a.
695*

Fecisti
mihi

pergratum, quod Serapionis librum ad me misisti; ex quo quidem ego, quod inter nos liceat dicere, millesimam partem vix intellego. Pro eo tibi praesentem pecuniam solvi imperavi, ne tu expensum muneribus ferres. Sed, quoniam nummorum mentio facta est, amabo te, cura, ut cum Titinio, quoquo modo poteris, transigas. Si in eo, quod ostenderat, non stat, mihi maxime placet ea, quae male empta sunt, reddi, si voluntate Pomponiae fieri poterit; si ne id quidem, nummi potius reddantur, quam ullus sit scrupulus. Valde hoc velim, antequam proficiscare, amanter, ut soles, diligenterque conficias.

Clodius ergo, ut ais, ad Tigranem! Velim Scepsii condicione; sed facile patior. Accommodatius enim nobis est ad liberam legationem tempus illud, cum et Quintus noster iam, ut speramus, in otio consederit, et, iste sacerdos Bonae deae cuius modi futurus sit, scierimus. Interea quidem cum Musis nos delectabimus

IV

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

I
am

Antium, April, B.C. 59

much obliged to you for sending me Serapio's book, though between you and me I hardly understand a thousandth part of it. I have given orders for you to be paid ready money for it, to prevent your entering it among presentation copies. Since I am mentioning money matters, please settle up with Titinius as best you can. If he won't stand by his agreement, the best plan, so far as I can see, will be to return the goods for which he made a bad bargain, if Pomponia will consent to that course: if even that won't work, then give him his money back rather than have a fuss. I should be very glad if you would finish the business before you leave, with your usual kindness and carefulness.

So Clodius is going to Tigranes you say! I wish it were on the same terms as that Scepsian.^[58] But I don't envy him. It will be a much more convenient time for me to get a free travelling pass, when my brother

Quintus has settled down in peace, as I hope he will, and when I know the intentions of that priest of Bona Dea.^[59] Meantime I shall settle down to the enjoyment of the Muses with resignation, indeed

^{58.} Metrodorus of Scepsus was sent by Mithridates to urge Tigranes to wage war with Rome, but privately spoke against it. He was therefore put to death by Mithridates.

^{59.} Clodius, on account of his intrusion into the mysteries of Bona Dea.

animo aequo, immo vero etiam gaudenti ac libenti, neque mihi umquam veniet in mentem Crasso invidere neque paenitere, quod a me ipse non desciverim.

De geographia dabo operam ut tibi satis faciam; sed nihil certi polliceor. Magnum opus est, sed tamen, ut iubes, curabo, ut huius peregrinationis aliquod tibi opus exstet. Tu quicquid indagaris de re publica, et maxime quos consules futuros putes, facito ut sciam. Tametsi minus sum curiosus; statui enim nihil iam de re publica cogitare.

Terentiae saltum perspeximus. Quid quaeris? praeter quercum Dodonaeam nihil desideramus, quo minus Epirum ipsam possidere videamur. Nos circiter Kal. aut in Formiano erimus aut in Pompeiano. Tu, si in Formiano non erimus, si nos amas, in Pompeianum venito. Id et

with hearty good-will and delight, for it will never enter my head to envy Crassus, or to repent of not having turned traitor to myself.

For the geography I will endeavour to satisfy you, but I won't make any definite promise. It is a big piece of work: still I will do as I am told, and see to it that this little tour is not entirely unproductive for you. Let me have any political news you may worm out, especially who you think are likely to be consuls. However, I am not very anxious. I have made up my mind to forget politics for the time.

I have had a good look at Terentia's woodlands, and can only say, that, if there was a Dodonaeian oak there, I should feel as though I possessed the whole of Epirus. About the first of the month I shall be either in my place at Formiae, or at Pompeii. If I am not at Formiae, as

nobis erit periucundum et tibi non sane devium. De muro imperavi Philotimo ne impediret, quo minus id fieret, quod tibi videretur. Tu censeo tamen adhibeas Vettium. His temporibus tam dubia vita optimi cuiusque magni aestimo unius aestatis fructum palaestrae Palatinae, sed ita tamen, ut nihil minus velim quam Pomponiam et puerum versari in timore ruinae.

you love me, come to Pompeii. I shall be delighted to see you, and it won't be far out of your way. With regard to the wall, I have given orders to Philotimus to let you do anything you like: but I think you ought to call in Vettius. In these days, when every honest man's life hangs in the balance, I set high store by the enjoyment of my Palatine palaestra for a summer, but not to the extent of wishing Pomponia and her boy to live in terror of a tottering ruin.

V

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Anti m. Apr. a.
695*

Cupio
equidem et
iam pridem cupio Alexandream
reliquamque Aegyptum visere et
simul ab hac hominum satietate
nostri discedere et cum aliquo

desiderio reverti; sed hoc tempore
et his mittentibus

αἰδέομαι Τρῶας καὶ Τρωάδας ἐλκεσιπέλους.

Quid enim nostri optimates, si qui
reliqui sunt, loquentur? an me aliquo
praemio de sententia esse deductum?

Πουλυδάμας μοι πρῶτος ἐλεγχείην ἀναθήσει,

Cato ille noster, qui mihi unus est
pro centum milibus. Quid vero
historiae de nobis ad annos D C
praedicarint? Quas quidem ego
multo magis vereor quam eorum
hominum, qui hodie vivunt,
rumusculos. Sed, opinor, excipiamus
et exspectemus. Si enim deferetur,
erit quaedam nostra potestas, et tum
deliberabimus. Etiam hercule est in
non accipiendo non nulla gloria.

V

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Antium, April, B.C. 59

I
am
eager, and have long been eager to
pay a visit to Alexandria and the rest
of Egypt, and also to get away from
here, where people are sick of seeing
me, and return when they miss me a
little: but

considering the circumstances,
and the people who are sending me.

Iliad vi, 442

“I fear the men and long-gowned dames of Troy.”

What will our conservative friends
say, if there are any of them left?
That I have been bribed out of my
opinions?

Iliad xxii, 100

“The first to chide will be Polydamas,”

that friend of ours, Cato, who
alone outweighs a hundred thousand
in my eyes. What would history be
saying of me six hundred years
hence? And that is a thing I fear
much more than the petty gossip of
those who are alive to-day. But I
suppose I can only lie low and see
what turns up. If an offer is made to

Quare, si quid Θεοφάνης tecum forte contulerit, ne omnino repudiaris.

De istis rebus exspecto tuas litteras, quid Arrius narret, quo animo se destitutum ferat, et qui consules parentur, utrum, ut populi sermo, Pompeius et Crassus an, ut mihi scribitur, cum Gabinio Servius Sulpicius, et num quae novae leges et num quid novi omnino, et, quoniam Nepos proficiscitur, cuinam auguratus deferatur; quo quidem uno ego ab istis capi possum. Videte vilitatem^[60] meam. Sed quid ego haec, quae cupio deponere et toto animo atque omni cura φιλοσοφεῖν? Sic, inquam, in animo est; vellem ab initio, nunc vero, quoniam, quae putavi esse praeclara,

⁶⁰. vilitatem *Meuntz*: civitatem *M*: vitam *Z*.

expertus sum quam essent inania, cum omnibus Musis rationem habere cogito. Tu tamen de Curtio ad me rescribe certius, et nunc quis in eius locum paretur, et quid de P. Clodio fiat, et omnia, quem ad modum

me, the decision will to some extent rest in my own hands, and then I will consider the question. Upon my word there is some little glory even in refusing: so, if Theophanes should happen to consult you, don't decline point blank.

This is what I am hoping to hear from you in your letter:—what Arrius has to say for himself, and how he takes Caesar's desertion of him, whether popular report is right in speaking of Pompey and Crassus as the favourites for the consulship, or a correspondent of mine who mentions Gabinius and Servius Sulpicius, whether there are any new laws or any news at all, and to whom the augurship will be offered, now that Nepos is going away. That is the only bait with which they could catch me. You see how cheap I am going. But this is a forbidden subject. I mean to forget it, and devote myself heart and soul to philosophy. That, I assure you, is my intention; and I only wish I had always practised it. Now that I have sampled the vanity of what I once thought

glory, I am thinking of confining my attention exclusively to the Muses. For all that you must post me up in news of Curtius and who will succeed to his position, and what is happening about P. Clodius. Take

polliceris, ἐπὶ σχολῇς scribe, et, quo
die Roma te exiturum putes, velim
ad me scribas, ut certiores te
faciam, quibus in locis futurus sim,
epistulamque statim des de iis rebus,
de quibus ad te scripsi. Valde enim
exspecto tuas litteras.

your time, and write fully about
things in general, as you promise.
Please let me know on what day you
are leaving Rome, so that I can tell
you where I shall be: and let me have
a letter at once on the points I have
mentioned, for I look forward to
your letters very eagerly.

VI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Anti m. Apr. a.
695*

Quod tibi
superioribus
litteris promiseram, fore ut opus
exstaret huius peregrinationis, nihil
iam magno opere confirmo; sic enim
sum complexus otium, ut ab eo
divelli non queam. Itaque aut libris
me delecto, quorum habeo Anti
festivam copiam, aut fluctus numero
(nam ad lacertas captandas
tempestates non sunt idoneae); a
scribendo prorsus abhorret animus.
Etenim γεωγραφικά, quae
constitueram, magnum opus est. Ita
valde Eratosthenes, quem mihi
proposueram, a Serapione et ab
Hipparcho reprehenditur. Quid
censes, si Tyrannio accesserit? Et
hercule sunt res difficiles ad
explicandum et ὁμοειδεῖς nec tam
possunt ἀνθηρογραφεῖσθαι, quam
videbantur, et, quod caput est, mihi
quaevis satis iusta causa cessandi est,
qui etiam dubitem, an hic Anti
considam et hoc tempus omne
consumam, ubi quidem ego malletm
duumvirum

VI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Antium April B.C. 59

I
am
not so certain now about fulfilling
the promises I made in former letters
to produce some work in this tour:
for I have fallen so in love with
idleness, that I can't tear myself from
it. So I either enjoy myself with my
books, of which I have a jolly good
lot at Antium, or else count the
waves: the rough weather won't
allow me to catch shads. At writing
my soul rebels utterly. The
geographical work I had planned is a
big undertaking. Eratosthenes, whom
I had taken as my authority, is
severely criticized by Serapion and
Hipparchus; and, if I take Tyrannio's
views too, there is no telling what
the result would be. Besides the
subject is confoundedly hard to
explain and monotonous, nor does it
give one as many opportunities for
flowers of fancy as I imagined:
besides—and this is the chief point
—I find any excuse for idleness
good enough. I am even debating
settling down at Antium, and
spending the rest of my life here: and

I really wish I had been a magistrate here

quam Romae fuisse. Tu vero sapientior Buthroti domum parasti. Sed, mihi crede, proxima est illi municipio haec Antiatium civitas. Esse locum tam prope Romam, ubi multi sint, qui Vatinius numquam viderint, ubi nemo sit praeter me, qui quemquam ex viginti viris vivum et salvum velit, ubi me interpellat nemo, diligant omnes! Hic, hic nimirum πολιτευτέον; nam istuc non solum non licet, sed etiam taedet. Itaque ἀνέκδοτα, quae tibi uni legamus, Theopompio genere aut etiam asperiore multo pangentur. Neque aliud iam quicquam πολιτεύομαι nisi odisse improbos et id ipsum nullo cum stomacho, sed potius cum aliqua scribendi voluptate.

Sed ut ad rem, scripsi ad quaestores urbanos de Quinti fratris negotio. Vide, quid narrent, ecquae spes sit denarii, an cistophoro Pompeiano iaceamus. Praeterea de muro statue quid faciendum sit. Aliud quid? Etiam. Quando te proficisci istinc putes, fac ut sciam.

rather than in Rome. You have been wiser in your generation and made a home for yourself at Buthrotum: but you may take my word for it that this township of Antium runs your borough very close. To think of there being a place so near Rome, where there are lots of people who have never seen Vatinius, where there is not a single soul save myself who cares whether any of our new commissioners are alive or dead, where no one intrudes upon me, though every one is fond of me. This, this is the very place for me to play the politician: for there in Rome, besides being shut out of politics, I am sick of them. So I will compose a private memoir, which I will read only to you, in the style of Theopompus, or even a still bitterer vein. My only policy now is hatred of the radicals: and that without rancour, indeed with some pleasure in expressing it.

But to return to business, I have written to the city quaestors about my brother Quintus' affairs. See what they have to say, and whether there is any hope of our getting current coin, or whether we must put up with Pompey's pice.^[61] Also decide what is to be done with the wall. Is there anything else I meant

to say? Yes. Let me know when you think of going away.

[61](#). The *cistophorus* was an Asiatic coin, of which Pompey had deposited a large quantity in the treasury. Apparently there was some idea of using them for paying Quintus during his proconsulship.

VII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Anti m. Apr. a.
695*

De
geographia

etiam atque etiam deliberabimus. Orationes autem a me duas postulas; quarum alteram non libebat mihi scribere, quia abscideram,^[62] alteram, ne laudarem eum, quem non amabam. Sed id quoque videbimus. Denique aliquid exstabit, ne tibi plane cessasse videamur.

De Publio quae ad me scribis sane mihi iucunda sunt, eaque etiam velim omnibus vestigiis indagata ad me adferas, cum venies, et interea scribas, si quid intelleges aut suspicabere, et maxime de legatione quid sit acturus. Equidem, antequam tuas legi litteras, hominem^[63] ire cupiebam, non mehercule ut differrem cum eo vadimonium (nam mira sum alacritate ad litigandum), sed videbatur mihi, si quid esset in eo popolare, quod plebeius factus esset, id amissurus. “Quid enim? ad plebem transisti, ut Tigranem ires salutatum? Narra mihi, reges Armenii patricos resalutare non solent?” Quid quaeris? acueram me ad exagitandam hanc eius legationem. Quam si ille contemnit,

VII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

I
will

Antium, April, B.C. 59

I give the geography further consideration. As to the two speeches you ask for, one I did not want to write down, because I had broken off in the middle, the other, because I had no desire to praise a man whom I did not like. But that too I will see about. Something shall appear anyhow, to convince you that I have not idled all my time away.

I am highly delighted with the news about Publius, please investigate all the details thoroughly, and bring a full account with you when you come. Meantime, if you pick up any hints, or draw any inferences, write to me, especially as to what he is going to do about the embassy. For my part, before I read your letter, I wished the man would go, not, I assure you, through any desire to postpone his impeachment—for I am extraordinarily anxious to conduct the case—but because I thought that he would lose any popularity he had gained by turning plebeian. “Why did you transfer yourself to the plebs? Was it to pay a

et si, ut scribis, bilem id commovet et latoribus et auspicibus legis curiatae, spectaculum egregium. Hercule, verum ut loquamur, subcontumeliose tractatur noster Publius, primum qui, cum

[62.](#) quia abscideram *most editors*: qui absciram *M*.

[63.](#) hominem *Lambinus*, in hominem *M, R, I*.

domi Caesaris quandam unus vir fuerit, nunc ne in viginti quidem esse potuerit; deinde alia legatio dicta erat, alia data est. Illa opima ad exigendas pecunias Druso, ut opinor, Pisaurensi an epuloni Vatinio reservatur; haecieiuna tabellarii legatio datur ei, cuius tribunatus ad istorum tempora reservatur. Incende hominem, amabo te, quod potes. Una spes est salutis istorum inter ipsos dissensio; cuius ego quaedam initia sensi ex Curione. Iam vero Arrius consulatum sibi ereptum fremit; Megabocchus et haec sanguinaria iuventus inimicissima est. Accedat vero, accedat etiam ista rixa auguratus. Spero me praeclaras de istis rebus epistulas ad te saepe missurum.

Sed illud quid sit, scire cupio, quod iacis obscure iam etiam ex ipsis

visit to Tigranes? Pray tell me: don't the kings of Armenia return the visit of a patrician?" As you see, I had sharpened my wits up to rally him on the subject of his embassy. But if he rejects it with scorn, and, as you say, thereby rouses the indignation of the proposers and augurs of the bill of adoption, it will be a grand sight. To speak the honest truth, you know, our friend Publius is being treated with very scant courtesy. In the first place, though he was once the only man in

Caesar's house, now he has not a footing even among twenty; and in the second place, one embassy is talked of, and another is given to him. That fat post for levying money is reserved for Drusus of Pisaurum, I suppose, or for the gourmand Vatinus, while this barren messenger's job is given to him, and his tribunate too has to wait their convenience. Fire the fellow's resentment please, as much as you can. My one hope of safety lies in their mutual disagreement: and from Curio I gather that there is a hint of such a thing. Arrius is beginning to rage at being robbed of his consulship: Megabocchus and the rest of that bloodthirsty band of youths are at daggers drawn with them. And God grant there may come a dispute about this augurship on the top. I hope I shall have

quinque viris loqui quosdam. Quidnam id est? Si est enim aliquid, plus est boni, quam putaram. Atque haec sic velim existimes non me abs te κατὰ τὸ πρακτικὸν quaerere, quod gestiat animus aliquid agere in re publica. Iam pridem gubernare me taedebat, etiam cum licebat; nunc vero cum cogar exire de navi non abiectis, sed ereptis gubernaculis, cupio istorum naufragia ex terra intueri, cupio, ut ait tuus amicus Sophocles,

κἄν ὑπὸ στέγῃ
πυκνῆς ἀκούειν ψακάδος εὐδούσῃ φρενί.

De muro quid opus sit, videbis.
Castricianum

mendum nos corrigemus, et tamen ad me Quintus HS CCICCC ICSC scripserat, nunc^[64] ad sororem tuam HS XXX. Terentia tibi salutem dicit. Cicero tibi mandat, ut Aristodemo idem de se respondeas, quod de fratre suo, sororis tuae filio, respondisti. De Ἀμαλθείᾳ quod me

occasion to send you some of my very best letters and plenty of them on these topics.

But I am anxious to know the meaning of that dark hint of yours, that even some of the board of five commissioners are speaking their minds. What on earth can it be? If there really is anything in it, things are in a better way than I thought. Please don't imagine that I ask the question with a view to action, because my soul is yearning to take part in politics. I have long been sick of holding the helm, even when I was allowed to do so: and now, when I have been marooned and the helm torn from my grasp without waiting for me to surrender it, my only desire is to watch their shipwreck from the dry land. I could wish, as your friend Sophocles says,

“In peaceful slumber sunk
To hear the pattering raindrops on the roof.”

About the wall you will see what is necessary. I

will set the mistake about Castricius right; and yet Quintus wrote about £130^[65] to me, though now to your sister he makes it nearly £260.^[66] Terentia sends her love; and my little boy commissions you to give Aristodemus the same answer for him as you gave for his cousin, your sister's son. I won't forget your

admones, non neglegemus. Cura, ut reminder about your Amalthea. Take
valeas. care of yourself.

VIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Anti medio m.
Apr. a. 695*

Epistula

m cum a te

avide exspectarem ad vesperum, ut soleo, ecce tibi nuntius pueros venisse Roma! Voco, quaero, ecquid litterarum. Negant. “Quid ais?” inquam, “nihilne a Pomponio?” Perterriti voce et vultu confessi sunt se accepisse, sed excidisse in via. Quid quaeris? permolesti tuli; nulla enim abs te per hos dies epistula inanis aliqua re utili et suavi venerat. Nunc, si quid in ea epistula, quam ante diem XVI Kal. Maias dedisti, fuit historia dignum, scribe quam primum, ne ignoremus; sin nihil praeter iocationem, redde id ipsum.

Et scito Curionem adulescentem venisse ad me salutatum. Valde eius sermo de Publio cum tuis litteris congruebat; ipse vero mirandum in modum “reges odisse superbos.” Peraeque narrabat incensam

[64](#). non M.

VIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Antium, April, B.C. 59

When I was looking forward eagerly to a letter of yours towards evening, as usual, lo and behold a message that some slaves had come from Rome. I called them, and inquired if they had any letters. “No,” they said. “What’s that,” said I, “nothing from Pomponius?” Frightened to death by my voice and look they confessed they had been given one, but it had been lost on the way. As you may suppose, I was wild with annoyance. For every letter you have sent me these last few days has contained something of importance or entertainment. So, if there was anything worth saying in the letter of the 15th of April, write at once and let me know it: if there was nothing but nonsense, you owe me a repetition of it.

Let me tell you that young Curio has come and paid his respects to me: and what he said about Publius agreed very closely with your letter. It is astonishing too how he “holds

proud kings in hate,” and he tells me that the younger generation in

[65](#). 15,000 sesterces.

[66](#). 30,000 sesterces.

esse iuventutem neque ferre haec posse. Bene habemus. Nos, si in his spes est, opinor, aliud agamus. Ego me do historiae. Quamquam licet me Saufeium putes esse, nihil me est inertius.

Sed cognosce itinera nostra, ut statuas, ubi nos visurus sis. In Formianum volumus venire Parilibus; inde, quoniam putas praetermittendum nobis esse hoc tempore Cratera illum delicatum, Kal. Maiis de Formiano proficiscemur, ut Anti simus a. d. v Nonas Maias. Ludi enim Anti futuri sunt a IIII ad pr. Nonas Maias. Eos Tullia spectare vult. Inde cogito in Tusculanum, deinde Arpinum, Romam ad Kal. Iunias. Te aut in Formiano aut Anti aut in Tusculano cura ut videamus. Epistulam superiorem restitue nobis et adpinge aliquid novi.

general holds equally strong views, and cannot put up with the present state of affairs. We are all right. If we can put our trust in them, we need not trouble ourselves, so far as I can see. I am devoting myself to history. But, though you think me as energetic as Saufeius, I am the laziest mortal alive.

But get clear about my journeys, so that you may settle where you will see me. I am intending to get to my place at Formiae on the feast of Pales; and then, since you think I ought not to stop at the delightful Crater^{[67](#)} on this occasion, I shall leave Formiae on the 1st of May, so as to reach Antium on the 3rd. There are games at Antium from the 4th to the 6th of May, and Tullia wants to see them. Then I am thinking of going to Tusculum, and from there to Arpinum, reaching Rome on the 1st of June. Be sure you pay me a visit either at Formiae or at Antium, or at my place at Tusculum. Reproduce your former letter for me, and add something new to it.

IX

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Anti medio m.
Apr. a. 695*

Subito

cum mihi

dixisset Caecilius quaestor puerum se Romam mittere, haec scripsi raptim, ut tuos elicerem mirificos cum Publio dialogos cum eos, de quibus scribis, tum illum, quem abdis et ais longum esse, quae ad ea responderis, perscribere; illum vero, qui nondum habitus est, quem illa βοῶπις, cum e Solonio redierit, ad te est relatura. Sic velim putes, nihil hoc posse mihi esse iucundius. Si vero, quae

de me pacta sunt, ea non servantur, in caelo sum, ut sciat hic nosier Hierosolymarius traductor ad plebem, quam bonam meis putissimis orationibus gratiam rettulerit. Quarum exspecta divinam παλινῳδίαν. Etenim, quantum coniectura auguramur, si erit nebulo iste cum his dynastis in gratia, non

IX

CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.

Antium, April, B.C. 59

Caecilius

the quaestor having suddenly told me that he was sending a man to Rome, I write this note in haste to extract from you all your wonderful dialogues with Publius, those you mention in your note, and the one you keep dark, saying that your answers were too long to write; and besides the one which has not yet been held, but which that Juno^[68] is going to report to you, when she returns from Solonium. Pray believe me when I say there is nothing that would please me more. If the compact about

⁶⁷. The bay of Naples, where Cicero's Pompeian villa was.

⁶⁸. Clodia.

me is not kept, I am in the seventh heaven with delight at thinking how that Jerusalemite plebeian-monger will learn what a pretty return he has made for all my choicest panegyrics: and you may expect recantation of eclipsing brilliancy; for, so far as I can see, if that good-for-nothing is in favour with our sovereigns, he will

modo de cynico consulari, sed ne de istis quidem piscinarum Tritonibus poterit se iactare. Non enim poterimus ulla esse invidia spoliati opibus et illa senatoria potentia. Sin autem ab iis dissentiet, erit absurdum in nos invehi. Verum tamen invehatur.

Festive, mihi crede, et minore sonitu, quam putaram. orbis hic in re publica est conversus; citius omnino, quam potuit, idque^[69] culpa Catonis, sed rursus improbitate istorum, qui auspicia, qui Aeliam legem. qui Iuniam et Liciniam, qui Caeciliam et Didiam neglexerunt, qui omnia remedia rei publicae effuderunt, qui regna quasi praedia tetrarchis, qui immanes pecunias paucis dederunt. Video iam, quo invidia transeat et ubi sit habitatura. Nihil me existimaris neque usu neque a Theophrasto didicisse, nisi brevi tempore desiderari nostra illa tempora videris. Etenim, si fuit invidiosa senatus potentia, cum ed non ad populum, sed ad tres homines immoderatos redacta sit, quid iam censes fore? Proinde isti licet faciant, quos

⁶⁹. idque *Wesenberg*: id *M*.

have to give up crowing over the “ex-consul with a cynic’s tongue” and those “Tritons of the fish-ponds” together: for there will be nothing to envy me for, when I have been robbed of my power and my influence in the Senate. If on the other hand he quarrels with them, then any attack on me would be absurd. However let him attack, if he likes.

Upon my word the wheel of State has turned round gaily and with less noise than I had expected: more quickly to be sure than it might have done. That is Cato’s fault, but it is still more through the villainy of those who have disregarded auspices and the Aelian law, the Iunian and Licinian law and the Caecilian and Didian law, who have thrown out of the window all the physic for the State, who have given kingdoms to tetrarchs as though they were farms and immense sums of money to one or two people. I can see already which way jealousy is tending and where it will come home to roost. Count me too big a dunce to have learned anything by experience or from Theophrastus, if you do not see very shortly men mourning for the days of my government. For if the power of the Senate was unpopular, you can imagine what things will be like now, when the power has been transferred not to the people, but to

volent, consules, tribunos pl.,
denique etiam Vatini strumam
sacerdotii διβάφῳ vestiant, videbis
breui tempore magnos non modo
eos, qui nihil titubarunt, sed etiam
illum ipsum, qui peccavit, Catonem.
Nam nos quidem, si per istum tuum
sodalem Publium licebit,
σοφιστεύειν cogitamus, si ille cogit,
tum^[70] dumtaxat nos defendere, et,
quod est proprium artis huius,
ἐπαγγέλλομαι

ἄνδρ' ἀπαμύνεσθαι, ὅτε τις πρότερος χαλεπήνῃ.

Patria propitia sit. Habet a nobis,
etiamsi non plus, quam debitum est;
plus certe, quam postulatum est.
Male vehi malo alio gubernante
quam tam ingratis vectoribus bene
gubernare. Sed haec coram
commodius.

Nunc audi, quod quaeris. Antium
me ex Formiano recipere cogito a. d.
v Nonas Maias; Antio volo Nonis
Maiis proficisci in Tusculanum. Sed,
cum e Formiano rediero (ibi esse
usque ad pr. K. Maias volo), faciam
statim te certiolem. Terentia tibi
salutem, καὶ Κικέρων ὁ μικρὸς
ἀσπάζεται Τίτον Ἀθηναῖον.

three unbridled men. So let them
make anyone they like consuls and
tribunes,

let them cloak Vatinius' wen with
the double-dyed purple gown of the
augur, you will see very soon not
only those who have made no slip,
but even Cato himself for all his
mistakes exalted, to the skies. As for
me, I am thinking of playing the
sophist, if your comrade Publius will
allow me: I shall defend myself only
if he compels me. Using the ordinary
trick of the trade, I shall put up a
notice that I am ready to

Iliad xxiv, 369

Give blow for blow, if any rouse me first.

If only the country will be on my
side. Certainly it has had from me
more than it ever asked for, if not
more than I owe to it. I would rather
have a bad passage with another at
the helm than steer safely myself for
such ungrateful passengers. But of
this we can talk better when we
meet.

Now listen to my answer to your
question. I am thinking of betaking
myself to Antium from Formiae on
May the 3rd: and I hope to start from
Antium for Tusculum on May the
7th. But, as soon as I have returned
from Formiae—and I intend to stay
there till the last of April—I will
send you definite news. Terentia

sends her love, and little Cicero his
greeting to Titus the Athenian.

X

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

Scr. in Appi Foro XII
K. Apr. a. 695

Volo
ames meam

constantiam. Ludos Anti spectare
non placet; est enim ὑποσόλοιον,
cum velim vitare omnium deliciarum
suspicionem, repente ἀναφαίνεσθαι
non solum delicate, sed etiam inepte
peregrinantem.

[70](#). cogit, tum *Orelli*: cogitat tantum *M*.

X

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

I
hop
e

*Appi Forum, March
21, B.C. 59*

you will admire my consistency. I have decided not to see the games at Antium. For it would be rather noticeably inconsistent at a time when I am trying to avoid the suspicion of taking a pleasure trip, suddenly to appear in the character of one travelling not only for pleasure, but for very

Quare usque ad Nonas Maias te in Formiano exspectabo. Nunc fac ut sciam, quo die te visuri simus. Ab Appi Foro hora quarta. Dederam aliam paulo ante a Tribus Tabernis.

foolish pleasure too. So I shall wait for you till the 7th of May at Formiae. Now let me know what day I shall see you. From Appi Forum at 10 o'clock. I sent another letter a little earlier from the Three Taverns.

XI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Formiano m.
Apr. a. 695*

Narro
tibi, plane
relegatus mihi videor, posteaquam in
Formiano sum. Dies enim nullus
erat, Anti cum essem, quo die non
melius scirem, Romae quid ageretur,
quam ii, qui erant Romae. Etenim
litterae tuae, non solum quid Romae,
sed etiam quid in re publica, neque
solum quid fieret, verum etiam quid
futurum esset, indicabant. Nunc, nisi
si quid ex praetereunte viatore
exceptum est, scire nihil possumus.
Quare, quamquam iam te ipsum
exspecto, tamen isti puero, quem ad
me statim iussi recurrere, da
ponderosam aliquam epistulam
plenam omnium non modo actorum,
sed etiam opinionum tuarum, ac
diem, quo Roma sis exiturus, cura ut
sciam. Nos in Formiano esse
volumus usque ad prid. Nonas
Maias. Eo si ante eam diem non
veneris, Romae te fortasse videbo;
nam Arpinum quid ego te invitem?

Τρηχεῖ, ἀλλ' ἀγαθὴ κουροτρόφος, οὐτ' ἄρ'
ἔγωγε
ἥς γαίης δύναμαι γλυκερώτερον ἄλλο ιδέσθαι.

Haec igitur. Cura, ut valeas.

XI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Formiae, April, B.C.
59*

I
ass
ure
you I feel an absolute exile since I
have been at Formiae. There never
was a day when I was at Antium that
I was not better up in the news of
Rome than those who were living
there. The fact is your letters used to
set before me not only the city news,
but all the political news, and not
only what was happening, but what
was going to happen too. Now I
can't get to know anything, unless I
pick up chance news from a passing
traveller. So, although I am
expecting you here very soon, give
this man of mine, who is under
orders to return at once, a bulky
missive, full of news of all that has
happened and what you think about
it: and don't forget to say what day
you are leaving Rome. I intend to
stay at Formiae till the 6th of May. If
you can't get here before that date,
perhaps I shall see you at Rome, for
I can hardly invite you to Arpinum.

Odyssey ix. 27

My rugged native land, good nurse for men;
None other would mine eyes so gladly see.

That is all then. Take care of
yourself.

XII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Tribus Tabernis
XIII K. Mai. a. 695*

Negent
illi Publium

plebeium factum esse? Hoc vero regnum est et ferri nullo pacto potest. Emmittat ad me Publius, qui obsignent; iurabo Gnaeum nostrum, collegam Balbi, Anti mihi narrasse se in auspicio fuisse.

O suaves epistulas tuas uno tempore mihi datas duas! Quibus εὐαγγέλια quae reddam, nescio; deberi quidem plane fateor. Sed vide συγκύρημα. Emerseram commodum ex Antiati in Appiam ad Tris Tabernas ipsis Cerialibus, cum in me incurrit Roma veniens Curio meus. Ibidem ilico puer abs te cum epistulis. Ille ex me, nihilne audissem novi. Ego negare. "Publius," inquit, "tribunatum pl. petit." "Quid ais?" "Et inimicissimus quidem Caesaris, et ut omnia," inquit, "ista rescindat." "Quid Caesar?" inquam. "Negat se quicquam de illius adoptione tulisse." Deinde suum, Memmi, Metelli Nepotis exprompsit odium. Complexus iuvenem dimisi properans ad epistulas. Ubi sunt, qui aiunt "ζώσης φωνῆς"? quanto magis

XII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Tres Tabernae, Apr.
18, B.C. 59*

So they deny that Publius has been made a plebeian, do they? This is certainly sheer tyranny and not to be borne. Let Publius send some one to witness my affidavit. I will take my oath that my friend Gnaeus, Balbus' colleague, told me at Antium that he had himself assisted at taking the auspices.

Fancy two such delightful letters of yours being delivered at one and the same time! I don't know how to pay you back for your good news, though I candidly confess my debt. Here's a coincidence. I had just taken the turn off the road to Antium on to the Appian Way at the Three Taverns on the very day of the Cerealia, when my friend Curio met me, fresh from Rome: and at the very same moment your man with a letter. Curio inquired whether I hadn't heard the news. "No," said I. "Publius is standing for the tribuneship," says he. "You don't say so!" "And he is at deadly enmity with Caesar," he replies, "and wants to annul all those laws of his." "And

vidi ex tuis litteris quam ex illius sermone, quid ageretur, de ruminatone cotidiana, de cogitatione Publi, de lituis βοώπιδος, de signifero Athenione, de litteris missis ad Gnaeum, de

what is Caesar doing?” I inquired. “He is denying that he ever proposed Clodius’ adoption.” Then he emptied the vials of his own wrath and that of Memmius and Metellus Nepos. I embraced the youth and said good-bye, being in a hurry to get to your letters. What a lot of nonsense is talked about “viva vox”? Why, I learned a dozen times as much about affairs from your letter as from his talk—the daily chit-chat, the designs of Publius, Juno’s war-cries, how Athenio^[71] is raising the standard, his letter

⁷¹. Juno = Clodia, while it is probably Sex. Clodius who is referred to as *Athenio*. Athenio was one of the leaders in the insurrection of slaves in Sicily 103–101 B.C.

Theophanis Memmique sermone; quantam porro mihi exspectationem dedisti convivii istius ἀσελγοῦς! Sum in curiositate ὀξύπεινος, sed tamen facile patior te id ad me συμπόσιον non scribere; praesentem audire malo.

Quod me, ut scribam aliquid, hortaris, crescit mihi quidem materies, ut dicis, sed tota res etiam nunc fluctuat, κατ’ ὀπώρην τρύξ. Quae si desederit, magis erunt iam liquata,^[72] quae scribam. Quae si statim a me ferre non potueris, primus habebis tamen et aliquamdiu solus. Dicaearchum recte amas; luculentus homo est et civis haud paulo melior quam isti nostri

to Gnaeus, the conversation with Theophanes and Memmius: and you have made me wild with inquisitiveness about that “fast” dinner. My curiosity is insatiable: but I have no grievance at your omitting to write an account of the dinner. I would much rather hear it by word of mouth.

As for your exhortations to write something, my material certainly is increasing, as you say; but everything is still in a state of ferment, like must in autumn. When things have settled down, my writing will be more clarified. Though you may not get anything from me at once, you shall be the first to have it

ἀδικαίαρχοι; Litteras scripsi hora
decima Cerialibus, statim ut tuas
legeram, sed eas eram daturus, ut
putaram, postridie ei, qui mihi
primus obviam venisset. Terentia
delectata est tuis litteris; impertit tibi
multam salutem, καὶ Κικέρων ὁ
φιλόσοφος τὸν πολιτικὸν Τίτον
ἀσπάζεται.

however, and no one else for a long
time. You are right in admiring
Dicaearchus. He is a splendid fellow
and a far better patriot than any of
these great men of ours to whom his
name would certainly not apply.^[73] I
write this on the day of the Cerealia
at four o'clock, as soon as I read
yours: but I am thinking of giving it
to the first person I meet to-morrow.
Terentia is delighted with your
letters. She sends you her warmest
greetings, and Cicero in his new rôle
of philosopher salutes Titus the
politician.

XIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Formiano m.
Apr. circ. a. d. VIII K.
Mai. a. 695*

Facinus
indignum!
epistulam

αὐθωρεὶ tibi a Tribus Tabernis
rescriptam ad tuas suavissimas
epistulas neminem reddidisse! At
scito eum fasciculum, quo illam
conieceram, domum eo ipso die
latum esse, quo ego dederam, et ad
me in Formianum relatum esse.
Itaque tibi tuam epistulam iussi
referri, ex qua intellegeres, quam
mihi tum illae gratae fuissent.
Romae

⁷². iudicata MSS.; liquata Orelli; iam liquata
Kayser.

quod scribis sileri, ita putabam; at
hercule in agris non siletur, nec iam
ipsi agri regnum vestrum ferre
possunt. Si vero in hanc Τηλέπουλον
veneris Λαιστρυγονίην, Formias
dico, qui fremitus hominum! quam
irati animi? quanto in odio noster
amicus Magnus! cuius cognomen
una cum Crassi Divitis cognomine
consenescit. Credas mihi velim,
neminem adhuc offendi, qui haec
tam lente, quam ego fero, ferret.
Quare, mihi crede, φιλοσοφῶμεν.
Iuratus tibi possum dicere nihil esse

XIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Formiae, circa April
23, B.C. 59*

What a shame! The letter I wrote
on the spur of the moment at the
Three Taverns in answer to your
delightful notes never reached you!
The reason was that the packet in
which I had put it was taken to my
town house the same day, and
brought back to me at Formiae. So I
have had the letter sent back to show
you how pleased I was with yours.

⁷³. Cicero puns on the name Dicaearchus (=“just ruler”).

Your news that the uproar has died
down in Rome does not surprise me:
but I can assure you it has not died
down in the country, and the very
country cannot endure that
despotism you endure. If you come
to this “Laestrygonia of the far
gates,”—Formiae I mean—you will
find the Odyssey x. 81
people raging with indignation, and
our friend Magnus—a name which is
now growing as obsolete as Crassus’
surname Dives—held in the deepest
abhorrence. You may not believe me,

tanti. Tu si litteras ad Sicyonios habes, advola in Formianum, unde nos pridie Nonas Maias cogitamus. but I have not met anyone here who takes the matter as coolly as myself. So follow my advice and let us stick to philosophy. I can take my oath there is nothing like it. If you have a letter to send to the Sicyonians, hasten to Formiae. I am thinking of leaving on the 6th of May.

XIV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Formiano inter
XI et III K. Mai. a.
695*

Quantam
tu mihi
moves

exspectationem de sermone Bibuli,
quantam de colloquio βοώπιδος,
quantam etiam de illo delicato
convivio! Proinde ita fac venias ut ad
sitientes aures. Quamquam nihil est
iam, quod magis timendum nobis
putem, quam ne ille noster
Sampsiceramus, cum se omnium
sermonibus sentiet vapulare, et cum
has actiones εὐαντρέπτους videbit,
ruere incipiat. Ego autem usque eo
sum enervatus, ut hoc otio, quo nunc
tabescimus, malim ἐντυραννεῖσθαι
quam cum optima spe dimicare.

De pangendo quod me crebro
adhortaris, fieri nihil potest.
Basilicam habeo, non villam,
frequentia Formianorum

atque imparem basilica tribui
Aemiliae.^[74] Sed omitto vulgus; post
horam quartam molesti ceteri non
sunt. C. Arrius proximus est vicinus,

XIV

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Formiae, between
April 20 and 28, B.C.
59*

You have aroused the liveliest
curiosity in me as to your talk with
Bibulus and your conversation with
Juno, and about that “fast” dinner
too. So remember my ears are
thirsting for news, and come quickly.
However, the thing I am most afraid
of at the present moment is that our
friend the Pasha may run amuck as
soon as he realizes that every one is
railing at him and laying it on to
him, and that these new measures are
quite easy to upset. For myself,
however, I have grown so slack that I
should prefer to waste my life in my
present ease under a despotism than
to take part in the struggle however
bright the prospect of success. As for
the writing, for which you so
incessantly clamour, it is impossible.
My house is so crowded with the
townsfolk that it is a

public hall rather than a private
house: and too small at that for the
Aemilian tribe. But—to omit the
common herd, for others don’t

immo ille quidem iam contubernalis, qui etiam se idcirco Romam ire negat, ut hic mecum totos dies philosophetur. Ecce ex altera parte Sebosus, ille Catuli familiaris. Quo me vertam? Statim mehercule Arpinum irem, ni te in Formiano commodissime exspectari viderem dumtaxat ad pr. Nonas Maias; vides enim, quibus hominibus aures sint deditae meae. O occasionem mirificam, si qui nunc, dum hi apud me sunt, emere de me fundum Formianum velit! Et tamen illud probem: “Magnum quid aggrediamur et multae cogitationis atque otii”? Sed tamen satis fiet a nobis, neque parcetur labori.

bother me after ten o'clock—C. Arrius is my next door neighbour, or rather he lives with me, declaring that he has forborne to go to Rome, expressly for the purpose of spending his whole day philosophizing with me here. Then on the other side there is Sebosus, Catulus' intimate friend. Which way can I turn? Upon my word I would go to Arpinum straight away, if I did not see that Formiae is the most convenient place to wait for your visit: but only up to the 6th of May, for you see what bores my ears are condemned to endure. Now's the time to bid for my Formian estate, while these people are pestering me. And in spite of this am I to make good my promise “Let me attempt something great, requiring much thought and leisure”? Still I will satisfy you and not spare my labour.

XV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Formiano inter
XI et III K. Mai a. 695*

Ut scribis, ita video non minus incerta in re publica quam in epistula tua, sed tamen ista ipsa me varietas sermonum opinionumque delectat. Romae enim videor esse, cum tuas litteras lego, et, ut fit in tantis rebus, modo hoc, modo illud audire. Illud tamen explicare non possum, quidnam invenire possit nullo recusante ad facultatem agrariam. Bibuli autem ista magnitudo animi in comitiorum dilatione quid habet nisi ipsius iudicium sine ulla correctione rei

^{74.} ad quam partem basilicae tribum Aemiliam M: the text follows Boot's emendation.

publicae? Nimirum in Publio spes est. Fiat, fiat tribunus pl., si nihil aliud, ut eo citius tu ex Epiro revertare; nam, ut illo tu careas, non video posse fieri, praesertim si mecum aliquid volet disputare. Sed id quidem non dubium est, quin, si quid erit eius modi, sis advolaturus. Verum, ut hoc non sit, tamen, sive

XV

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Formiae, between
April 20 and 28, B.C.
59*

I full y real ize that, as you say, your letter only reflects the general uncertainty of public affairs: but still that very variety of talk and opinion has its charm: for I feel as though I was at Rome, when I read your letter, and was hearing first one thing and then another, as one does on questions of importance. But what I can't make out is how Caesar can possibly find any solution of the land question which will not meet with opposition. As to Bibulus' firmness in impeding the comitia, it amounts to nothing but an expression of his opinion and does not improve

the position of affairs at all. Upon my word our only hope rests in Publius. Let him by all means become tribune; if for no other reason, to make you return all the sooner from Epirus. For I don't see how you can possibly keep away from him, especially if he should choose to quarrel with me. But of

ruet sive eriget^[75] rem publicam, praeclarum spectaculum mihi propono, modo te consessore spectare liceat.

Cum haec maxime scriberem, ecce tibi Sebosus! Nondum plane ingemueram, “salve,” inquit Arrius. Hoc est Roma decedere! Quos ego homines effugi cum in hos incidi! Ego vero

“In montes patrios et ad incunabula nostra”

pergam. Denique, si solus non potuero, cum rusticis potius quam cum his perurbanis, ita tamen, ut, quoniam tu certi nihil scribis, in Formiano tibi praestoler usque ad III Nonas Maias.

Terentiae pergrata est adsiduitas tua et diligentia in controversia Mulviana. Nescit omnino te communem causam defendere eorum, qui agros publicos possideant; sed tamen tu aliquid publicanis pendis, haec etiam id recusat. Ea tibi igitur et Κικέρων, ἀριστοκρατικώτατος παῖς, salutem dicunt.

⁷⁵. sive eriget *Corradus*: get CZ: ΔΣ. omit the word.

course I have no doubt that you would fly to my side, if anything of the kind were to happen. But, even if this does not happen, I am looking forward to a sight worth seeing, whether he runs amuck or saves the state, if I can watch it with you sitting by my side.

Just as I was writing these words, in comes Sebosus: and I had hardly fetched a sigh, when there was Arrius saying “Good day.” This is going out of town! Is it escaping from society to run into people like this? I shall certainly be off to “My native hills, the cradle of my youth.” To put it shortly, if I can’t be alone, I would rather be with countryfolk than with these ultra-city men. However, as you send no definite date, I will wait for you at Formiae till the 5th of May.

Terentia is much gratified by the attention and care you have bestowed on her dispute with Mulvius. She has not the least idea that you are supporting the common cause of all the owners of public land. However you do pay something to the tax-collectors; while she refuses to pay a penny. Accordingly she and my boy, a most conservative lad, send their respects.

XVI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Formiano in.
m. Maio a. 695*

Cenato
mihi et iam

dormitanti pridie K. Maias epistula est illa reddita, in qua de agro Campano scribis. Quid quaeris? primo ita me pupugit, ut somnum mihi ademerit, sed id cogitatione magis quam molestia; cogitanti autem haec fere succurrebant. Primum ex eo, quod superioribus litteris scripseras, ex familiari te illius audisse prolatum iri aliquid, quod nemo improbaret, maius aliquid timueram. Hoc mihi eius modi non videbatur. Deinde, ut me egomet consoler, omnis exspectatio largitionis agrariae in agrum Campanum videtur esse derivata, qui ager, ut dena iugera sint, non amplius hominum quinque milia potest sustinere; reliqua omnis multitudo ab illis abalienetur necesse est. Praeterea si ulla res est, quae bonorum animos, quos iam video esse commotos, vehementius possit incendere, haec certe est et eo magis, quod portoriis Italiae sublati, agro Campano diviso quod vectigal superest domesticum praeter vicensimam? quae mihi videtur una contiuncula clamore pedisequorum

XVI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Formiae, May, B.C. 59

As I was taking a nap after dinner on the last of April, your letter about the Campanian land arrived. Well, at first it startled me so that it banished all desire to sleep, though it was thought rather than uneasiness that kept me awake. The result of my cogitations was something of this sort. First, when you said in your last letter you had heard from a great friend of Caesar's that some proposal was going to be made to which no one could object, I had feared some sweeping measure; but this I don't consider anything of the kind. Secondly—and that is some consolation to me—all hope of agrarian distribution seems to have been diverted to the Campanian land. Supposing that the allotments are about 6 acres apiece, that land will not hold more than 5,000 people; so they have to offend all the rest of the masses. Besides, if anything is calculated to arouse a fiercer pitch of indignation in the minds of the conservatives, who are obviously getting roused already, this is the very thing that will; all the more so

nostrorum esse peritura. Gnaeus quidem noster iam plane quid cogitet nescio;

φυσᾷ γὰρ οὐ σμικροῖσιν αὐλίσκοις ἔτι,
ἀλλ' ἀγρίαις φύσαισι φορβειᾷς ἄτερ.

qui quidem etiam istuc adduci potuerit. Nam adhuc

because there won't be any home tax left except the 5 per cent.,^[76] now that the customs duties have been abolished, if the Campanian land is distributed: and that, I fancy, it would take only one petty harangue assisted by the cheers of our lacqueys to abolish. What on earth our friend Gnaeus is thinking of in letting himself be carried so far, I cannot tell:

He blows no more on slender pipe of reed,
But fierce unmodulated trumpet-blasts.

⁷⁶. On manumitted slaves.

haec ἐσοφίζετο, se leges Caesaris probare, actiones ipsum praestare debere; agrariam legem sibi placuisse, potuerit intercedi necne, nihil ad se pertinere; de rege Alexandrino placuisse sibi aliquando confici, Bibulus de caelo tum servasset necne, sibi quaerendum non fuisse; de publicanis voluisse se illi ordini commodare, quid futurum fuerit, si Bibulus tum in forum descendisset, se divinare non potuisse. Nunc vero, Sampsicerame, quid dices? vectigal te nobis in monte Antilibano constituisse, agri Campani abstulisse? Quid? hoc quem ad modum obtinebis? "Oppressos vos," inquit, "tenebo exercitu Caesaris." Non mehercule me tu quidem tam isto exercitu quam ingratis animis eorum hominum, qui

For up to now he has chopped logic about the matter, saying that he approved of Caesar's laws, but it was for Caesar to see to their passing: that the agrarian law was sound enough to his mind, but whether it could be vetoed by a tribune or not did not matter to him: he thought it was high time the question was settled with the king of Alexandria: whether Bibulus had been watching for omens or not at that particular moment was no business of his: as for the tax-gatherers, they were a class that he wished to oblige: what was going to happen, if Bibulus came down to the forum on that occasion, he could not have prophesied. But now what has the Pasha got to say for himself? That he imposed a tax on Antilibanus and

appellantur boni, qui mihi non mode praemiorum, sed ne sermonum quidem umquam fructum ullum aut gratiam rettulerunt. Quodsi in eam me partem incitarem, profecto iam aliquam reperirem resistendi viam. Nunc prorsus hoc statui, ut, quoniam tanta controversia est Dicaearcho, familiari tuo, cum Theophrasto, amico meo, ut ille tuus τὸν πρακτικὸν βίον longe omnibus anteponat, hic autem τὸν θεωρητικόν, utrique a me mos gestus esse videatur. Puto enim me Dicaearcho adfatim satis fecisse; respicio nunc ad hanc familiam, quae mihi non modo, ut requiescam, permittit, sed reprehendit, quia non semper quierim. Quare incumbamus, o noster Tite, ad illa praeclara studia et

took it off the Campanian land? Well, I don't see how he will make it good. "I will keep you in check with Caesar's army," he says. No, not me at least; that army will not restrain me so much as the ungrateful minds of the so-called constitutionalists, who have not repaid my services even by thanks, much less by more substantial rewards. But, if I were really to rouse myself to energy against that party, I would certainly find some means of resisting them. As it is, since there is such an endless controversy between your intimate Dicaearchus and my friend Theophrastus, Dicaearchus giving the preference to a practical life, Theophrastus to a contemplative, I have set my mind on making it clear that I have humoured them both. I take it I have fully satisfied Dicaearchus: now I am turning my eye to the other school, which not only gives me permission to take my ease now, but blames me for ever having done anything else. So, my dear Titus, let me throw myself heart and soul into those excellent studies,

eo, unde discedere non oportuit, aliquando revertamur.

Quod de Quinti fratris epistula scribis, ad me quoque fuit πρόσθε λέων, ὅπιθεν δὲ—^[77]quid dicam, nescio; nam ita deplorat primis versibus mansionem suam, ut

and at length seek the home that I ought never to have left.

As for your complaints about my brother Quintus' letter, to me, too, it seemed "a lion before, behind"—heaven knows what. For the groans in the first lines about his long

quemvis movere possit, ita rursus remittit, ut me roget, ut annales suos emendem et edam. Illud tamen, quod scribis, animadvertas velim de portorio circumvectionis; ait se de consilii sententia rem ad senatum reiecissee. Nondum videlicet meas litteras legerat, quibus ad eum re consulta et explorata perscripseram non deberi. Velim, si qui Graeci iam Romam ex Asia de ea causa venerunt, videas et, si tibi videbitur, iis demonstres, quid ego de ea re sentiam. Si possum discedere, ne causa optima in senatu pereat, ego satis faciam publicanis; εἰ δὲ μή (vere tecum loquar), in hac re malo universae Asiae et negotiatoribus; nam eorum quoque vehementer interest. Hoc ego sentio valde nobis opus esse. Sed tu id videbis. Quaestores autem, quaeso, num etiam de cistophoro dubitant? Nam, si aliud nihil erit, cum erimus omnia experti, ego ne illud quidem contemnam, quod extremum est. Te in Arpinati videbimus et hospitio agresti accipiemus, quoniam maritimum hoc contempsisti.

[77](#). Iliad vi, 181, ending δράκων, μέσση δὲ χίμαιρα.

absence would touch anybody's heart: then afterwards he calms down sufficiently to ask me to touch up and edit his journal. Please pay some attention to the point you mention about the dues on goods transferred from port to port. He says he referred it to the Senate by the advice of his assessors. Evidently he had not read my letter, in which I told him after careful consideration and research that no tax was legally due. If any Greeks have come from Asia to Rome about it, please see them, and, if you think fit, tell them my opinion. If I can recant, I will do as the tax collectors wish, rather than see the good cause worsted in the House: but, if not, I candidly confess I prefer the interests of the whole of Asia and the merchants, for I feel it is really a matter of great importance to them. I think, however, it is a case of necessity for us. But you will see to it. Are the quaestors, then, still debating about the currency? If there is no escape from it in spite of all our efforts, I shouldn't turn up my nose at the Asiatic coins as the last resource. I shall see you at Arpinum, and give you a country welcome, since you have despised this at the seaside.

XVII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Formiano in m.
Mai. a. 695*

Prorsus,
ut scribis,

ita sentio, turbatur Sampsicramus. Nihil est, quod non timendum sit; ὁμολογουμένως τυραννίδα συσκευάζεται. Quid enim ista repentina adfinitatis coniunctio, quid ager Campanus, quid effusio pecuniae significant? Quae si essent extrema, tamen esset nimium mali, sed ea natura rei est, ut haec extrema esse non possint. Quid enim? eos haec ipsa per se delectare possunt? Numquam huc venissent, nisi ad alias res pestiferas aditus sibi compararent. Verum, ut scribis, haec in Arpinati a. d. VI circiter Idus Maias non deflebimus, ne et opera et oleum philologiae nostrae perierit; sed conferemus tranquillo animo. Di immortales neque tam me εὐελπιστία consolatur ut antea quam ἀδιαφορία, qua nulla in re tam utor quam in hac civili et publica. Quin etiam, quod est subinane in nobis et non ἀφιλόδοξον (bellum est enim sua vitia nosse), id adficitur quadam delectatione. Solebat enim me pungere, ne Sampsicrami merita in patriam ad annos sescentos maiora viderentur quam nostra. Hac quidem

cura certe iam vacuus sum; iacet enim ille sic, ut πτώσις^[78] Curiana stare videatur. Sed haec coram. Tu tamen videris mihi Romae fore ad nostrum adventum, quod sane facile patiar, si tuo commodo fieri possit; sin, ut scribis, ita venies, velim ex Theophane

⁷⁸. πτώσις *Bosius*: phocis *codd.*

XVII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

I

agr

Formiae, May, B.C. 59

ee entirely with what you say in your letter. The Pasha is running amuck. We may anticipate anything: he is quite clearly setting up a tyranny. What else is the meaning of this sudden marriage-contract,^[79] of the proposals about the Campanian land, of this reckless expenditure of money? If that were the end of it, it would be disastrous enough: but the nature of the case makes it impossible that this should be the end. These things in themselves cannot possibly give them any pleasure: and they would never have taken this step except as the first to other pernicious acts. But, as you say, we will discuss these questions rationally at Arpinum about the 10th of May, and not prove all the labour and the midnight oil we have spent on our studies wasted by weeping over them. Heaven help us! I derive consolation not so much from hope, as I did formerly, as from a spirit of indifference, which I call to my service especially in civic and political matters. Nay more, the little

strain of vanity and thirst for fame that there is in me—it is a good thing to recognize one’s own faults—even experiences a pleasurable sensation. For the thought that the Pasha’s services to the country might in the dim future be reckoned higher than mine, used to prick me to the heart: but now I rest quite easy on that score. He has fallen so low that the fallen Curius in comparison seems to stand erect. But of this when we meet. It seems now as though you will be at Rome when I arrive: for which I shall not be at all sorry, if it is

[79](#). Of Pompey with Caesar’s daughter.

expiscere, quonam in me animo sit Arabarches. Quaeres scilicet κατὰ τὸ κηδεμονικὸν et ad me ab eo quasi ὑποθήκας adferes, quem ad modum me geram. Aliquid ex eius sermone poterimus περὶ τῶν ὅλων suspicari.

convenient to you. But if you come to see me, as you promise in your note, I wish you would fish out of Theophanes how the Sheikh is disposed to me. You will of course use your usual care in inquiring, and will deliver to me a kind of Whole Duty by which to regulate my conduct. From his conversation we shall be able to get an inkling of the entire situation.

XVIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae m. Iun.
aut in. Quint. a. 695*

Accepi
aliquot

epistulas tuas; ex quibus intellexi, quam suspenso animo et sollicito scire avenes, quid esset novi. Tenemur undique neque iam, quo minus serviamus, recusamus, sed mortem et eiectionem quasi maiora timemus, quae multo sunt minora. Atque hic status, quasi^[80] una voce omnium gemitur neque verbo cuiusquam sublevatur. Σκοπὸς est, ut suspicor, illis, qui tenent, nullam cuiquam largitionem relinquere. Unus loquitur et palam adversatur adulescens Curio. Huic plausus maximi, consalutatio forensis perhonorifica, signa praeterea benevolentiae permulta a bonis impertiuntur. Fufium clamoribus et conviciis et sibilis consecretantur. His ex rebus non spes, sed dolor est maior, cum videas civitatis voluntatem solutam, virtutem alligatam. Ac, ne forte quaeras κατὰ λεπτὸν de singulis rebus, universa res eo est deducta, spes ut nulla sit aliquando non modo privatos, verum etiam magistratus liberos fore. Hac tamen in oppressione sermo in circulis dumtaxat

XVIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Rome, June or July,
B.C. 59*

I
hav
e

received several letters of yours, and from them I see with what tense anxiety you are looking forward to news. We are hemmed in on every side; yet we do not rebel at servitude, fearing death and exile as though they were greater evils, whereas they are really far lesser evils. Yes, that is the position, and though every one groans about it, not a voice is raised to relieve it. The object, I presume, of those who hold the reins is to leave nothing for anyone else to give away. One man only opens his mouth and opposes them publicly, and that is young Curio. The loyal party cheers him loudly, greets him in the forum with the highest respect, and shows its good-will to him in many other ways, while Fufius is pursued with shouts and jeers and hisses. But this raises not one's hope so much as one's disgust at seeing the people's will so free and their courage so enslaved. And, not to enter into details with you, affairs

et in conviviis est liberior quam fuit. Vincere incipit timorem dolor, sed ita, ut omnia sint plenissima desperationis. Habet etiam Campana lex execrationem candidatorum, si mentionem in contione fecerint, quo aliter ager possideatur atque ut ex legibus Iuliis. Non dubitant iurare ceteri; Laterensis existimatur laute fecisse, quod tribunatum pl. petere destitit, ne iuraret.

Sed de re publica non libet plura scribere. Displiceo mihi nec sine summo scribo dolore. Me tueor ut oppressis omnibus non demisse, ut tantis rebus gestis parum fortiter. A Caesare valde liberaliter invitor in legationem illam, sibi ut sim legatus, atque etiam libera legatio voti causa datur. Sed haec et praesidii apud pudorem Pulchelli non habet satis et a fratris adventu me ablegat, illa et munitior est et non impedit, quo minus adsim, cum velim. Hanc ego teneo, sed usurum me non puto, neque tamen scit quisquam. Non lubet fugere, aveo pugnare. Magna sunt hominum studia. Sed nihil adfirmo; tu hoc silebis.

have come to such a pass that there is no hope of ever again having free magistrates, let alone a free people. But in the midst of this tyranny speech is freer than ever, at any rate in clubs and over our

cups. Disgust is beginning to conquer fear, though it still leaves the blankest despair everywhere. The Campanian law goes so far as to impose upon candidates a formula of execration upon themselves if they propose any different occupation of the land to that laid down by the Julian laws, to be used by them in their speech as candidates. The others showed no compunction in taking the oath: but Laterensis is thought a hero because he threw up his candidature for the tribunate rather than take it.

I have no heart to write more about politics. I am disgusted with myself and it is agony to me to write. I stand my ground without losing self-respect considering the universal servility, but with less courage than I could wish considering my past record. Caesar most liberally invites me to take a place on his personal staff: and I even have an offer of a free travelling pass nominally to fulfil a vow.^[81] But it is hardly safe to trust to that Beauty's delicacy to that extent. Besides it would mean that I should not be here for my brother's

De Statio manu misso et non
nullis aliis rebus angor equidem, sed
iam prorsus occallui. Tu vellem

return. The other post is much safer,
and does not prevent me from being
here when I wish. The free pass I
have, but I don't think I shall use it.
No one knows of it however. I don't
want to run away; I long to fight. I
have plenty of ardent admirers. But I
won't take my oath on anything, and
please don't mention what I've said.

I am much distressed about the
manumission of Statius and some
other things, but I've become thick-
skinned by now. I wish you were
here, I long for

[81](#). The *libera legatio* was a pseudo-
embassy at state expense, granted to senators
who wished to pay a vow, receive an inheritance,
or exact a debt.

ego vel cuperem adesses; nec mihi
consilium nec consolatio deesset.
Sed ita te para, ut, si inclaro,
advoles.

it. I should no longer feel the lack
of advice or consolation. However,
hold yourself ready to come quickly,
if I call for you.

XIX

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae m. Quint.
a. 695*

Multa me
sollicitant et
ex rei publicae tanto motu et ex iis
periculis, quae mihi ipsi intenduntur
et sescenta sunt; sed mihi nihil est
molestius quam Statium manu
missum:

“Nec meum imperium, ac mitto imperium non
simultatem meam
Revereri saltem!”

Nec, quid faciam, scio, neque
tantum est in re, quantus est sermo.
Ego autem ne irasci possum quidem
iis, quos valde amo; tantum doleo ac
mirifice quidem. Cetera in magnis
rebus. Minae Clodi contentionesque,
quae mihi proponuntur, modice me
tangunt; etenim vel subire eas videor
mihi summa cum dignitate vel
declinare nulla cum molestia posse.
Dices fortasse: “Dignitatis ἄλις
tamquam δρυός, saluti, si me amas,
consule.” Me miserum! cur non
ades? nihil profecto te praeteriret.
Ego fortasse τυφλώττω et nimium τῷ
καλῷ προσπέπονθα. Scito nihil
umquam fuisse tam infame, tam
turpe, tam peraeque omnibus
generibus, ordinibus, aetatibus
offensum quam hunc statum, qui

XIX

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Rome, July, B.C. 59

I
have
e many causes for anxiety, both from
the troubled state of the constitution
and from the innumerable personal
dangers which threaten me. But
nothing annoys me more than
Statius’ manumission:

Terence, Phorm. 232

That my authority—nay, I let that be—
That my displeasure should be counted nought!

But what I am to do, I don’t know;
and the matter is more talk than
anything. I can never be angry with
those I really love: I can only feel
sorrow, and very deep sorrow too.
My other cares are for important
matters. Clodius’ threats and the
struggle I have to face do not affect
me much: for I think I can face the
music with dignity or avoid the
danger without unpleasantness.
Perhaps you will say: “Hang dignity.
It’s prehistoric.^[82] For mercy’s sake
look after your safety,” Alas! Why
aren’t you here? You would notice
everything: while I perhaps am
blinded by my passion for high
ideals. Nothing was ever so

nunc est, magis mehercule, quam
vellem, non modo quam putarem.
Populares isti iam etiam

scandalous, so disgraceful, and so
objectionable to every rank and class
of men young or old as this present
state of affairs, far more so than I
expected, nay upon my soul it is
more so than I could wish. The
popular party have taught even the

[82](#). Lit. “enough of the oak,” a proverb
alluding to a supposed acorn diet in the days
before the use of corn was discovered.

modestos homines sibilare
docuerunt. Bibulus in caelo est, nec,
quare, scio, sed ita laudatur, quasi

moderate men to hiss. Bibulus is
exalted to the sky, though I don’t
know why. However he is as much
bepraised as though

“Unus homo nobis cunctando restituit rem.”

“His wise delay alone did save the state.”[\[83\]](#)

Pompeius, nostri amores, quod
mihi summo dolori est, ipse se
adflixit. Neminem tenent voluntate;
ne metu necesse sit iis uti, vereor.
Ego autem neque pugno cum illa
causa propter illam amicitiam neque
approbo, ne omnia improbem, quae
antea gessi; utor via. Populi sensus
maxime theatro et spectaculis
perspectus est; nam gladiatoribus
qua dominus qua advocati sibilis
conscissi; ludis Apollinaribus
Diphilus tragoedus in nostrum
Pompeium petulanter invectus est:

To my infinite sorrow, my pet,
Pompey, has shattered his own
reputation. They have no hold on
anyone by affection: and I am afraid
they may find it necessary to try the
effect of fear. I do not quarrel with
them on account of my friendship for
him, though I refrain from showing
approval not to stultify all my
previous actions. I keep to the high-
road. The popular feeling can be
seen best in the theatre and at public
exhibitions. For at the gladiatorial
show both the leader[\[84\]](#) and his
associates were overwhelmed with
hisses: at the games in honour of
Apollo the actor Diphilus made an
impertinent attack on Pompey, “By
our misfortunes thou art Great,”
which was encored again and again.

“Nostra miseria tu es magnus—”

miliens coactus est dicere;

“Eandem virtutem istam veniet tempus cum
graviter gemes”

totius theatri clamore dixit
itemque cetera. Nam et eius modi
sunt ii versus, uti in tempus ab
inimico Pompei scripti esse
videantur:

“Si neque leges neque mores cogunt—,”

et cetera magno cum fremitu et
clamore sunt dicta. Caesar cum
venisset mortuo plausu, Curio filius
est insecutus. Huic ita plausum est,
ut salva re publica Pompeio plaudi
solebat. Tulit Caesar graviter.
Litterae Capuam ad Pompeium
volare dicebantur. Inimici

“A time will come when thou wilt
rue that might” he declaimed amid
the cheers of the whole audience,
and so on with the rest. For indeed
the verses do look as though they
had been written for the occasion by
an enemy of Pompey: “If neither law
nor custom can constrain,” etc. was
received with a tremendous uproar
and outcry. At Caesar’s entry the
applause dwindled away; but young
Curio who followed was applauded
as Pompey used to be when the
constitution was still sound. Caesar
was much annoyed: and it is said a
letter flew post haste to Pompey at
Capua.

[83](#). So Ennius speaking of Q. Fabius
Maximus.

[84](#). Probably Pompey, Caesar being the
chief of the *socii*, though some take it to refer to
Gabinus, who gave the show, or to Caesar.

erant equitibus, qui Curioni
stantes plauserant, hostes omnibus;
Rosciae legi, etiam frumentariae
minitabantur. Sane res erat
perturbata. Equidem malueram, quod
erat susceptum ab illis, silentio
transiri, sed vereor, ne non liceat.
Non ferunt homines, quod videtur
esse tamen ferendum; sed est iam
una vox omnium magis odio firmata
quam praesidio.

Noster autem Publius mihi
minitatur, inimicus est. Impendit
negotium, ad quod tu scilicet

They are annoyed with the knights
who stood up and clapped Curio, and
their hand is against every man’s.
They are threatening the Roscian law
and even the corn law. Things are in
a most disturbed condition. I used to
think it would be best silently to
ignore their doings, but I am afraid
that will be impossible. The public
cannot put up with things, and yet it
looks as though they would have to
put up with them. The whole people
speak now with one voice, but the
unanimity has no foundation but
common hate.

advolabis. Videor mihi nostrum illum consularem exercitum bonorum omnium, etiam satis bonorum habere firmissimum. Pompeius significat studium erga me non mediocre; idem adfirmat verbum de me illum non esse facturum; in quo non me ille fallit, sed ipse fallitur. Cosconio mortuo sum in eius locum invitatus. Id erat vocari in locum mortui. Nihil me turpius apud homines fuisset neque vero ad istam ipsam ἀσφάλειαν quicquam alienius. Sunt enim illi apud bonos invidiosi, ego apud improbos meam retinuissem invidiam, alienam adsumpsissem. Caesar me sibi vult esse legatum. Honestior declinatio haec periculi; sed ego hoc non repudio. Quid ergo est? pugnare malo. Nihil tamen certi. Iterum dico “utinam adesses!” Sed tamen, si erit necesse, arcessemus

Anyhow our friend Publius is threatening me and making hostile advances: there is trouble ahead, and you must fly to the rescue. I think I have at my back the same firm bodyguard of all the sound men and even the moderately sound, as I had in my consulship. The affection Pompey shows me is more than ordinary. He declares Clodius will not say a word against me: but there he is deceiving himself not me. I have been asked to fill Cosconius' place^[85] now he is dead. That would be stepping into a dead man's shoes, with a vengeance! I should disgrace myself utterly in the world's eyes: and nothing could be more opposed to the state of safety you keep talking of. For that board is unpopular with the loyal party, and so I should keep my unpopularity with the disloyal and take up another's burden too. Caesar wants me to go as his lieutenant. That would be a more honourable way of getting out of danger. But I don't want to shirk it, for the very good reason that I prefer fighting. However nothing is settled, I repeat, I wish you were here. However,

⁸⁵. As one of the twenty commissioners for the distribution of public land.

Quid aliud? quid? Hoc opinor. Certi sumus perisse omnia; quid enim ἀκκιζόμεθα tam diu?

if it is necessary. I will send for you. Anything else? One thing, I think: I am sure the country is lost. It

Sed haec scripsi properans et is no use mincing matters^[86] any
mehercule timide. Posthac ad te aut, longer.
si perfidelem habebo, cui dem,
scribam plane omnia, aut, si obscure
scribam, tu tamen intelleges. In iis
epistulis me Laelium, te Furium
faciam; cetera erunt ἐν αἰνιγμοῖς. Hic
Caecilium colimus et observamus
diligenter. Edicta Bibuli audio ad te
missa. Iis ardet dolore et ira noster
Pompeius.

However I have written this in a
hurry, and, I may say, in a fright too.
Some time I will give you a clear
account, if I find a very trusty
messenger; or, if I veil my meaning,
you will manage to understand it. In
these letters I will call myself
Laelius and you Furius: and convey
the rest in riddles. Here I am
cultivating Caecilius and paying him
elaborate attention. I hear Bibulus'
edicts have been sent to you.
Pompey is blazing with wrath and
indignation at them.

XX

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae m. Quint.
a. 695*

Anicato,
ut te velle I
intellexeram, nullo loco defui. hav
Numestium ex litteris tuis studiose
scriptis libenter in amicitiam recepi.
Caecilium, quibus rebus possum,
tueor diligenter. Varro satis facit
nobis. Pompeius amat nos carosque
habet. “Credis?” inquires. Credo;
prorsus mihi persuadet; sed, quia
volgo pragmatici homines omnibus
historiis, praeceptis, versibus
denique cavere iubent et vetant
credere, alterum facio, ut caveam,
alterum, ut non credam, facere non
possum. Clodius adhuc mihi
denuntiat periculum. Pompeius
adfirmat non esse periculum, adiurat;
addit etiam se prius occisum iri ab eo
quam me violatum iri. Tractatur

XX

CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.

Rome, July, B.C. 59

I
e done all I could for Anicatus,
knowing you wanted me to do so,
and have willingly adopted
Numestius as a friend on the strength
of the earnest recommendation in
your letter. To Caecilius I take care
to pay every suitable attention. Varro
is as good as I can expect; and
Pompey shows me friendship and
affection. Can I believe him, you
ask. I do believe him; he quite
convinces me. But since men of the
world are always advising one in
their histories and precepts and even
in their verses to beware and
forbidding one to believe, I do the
one and beware, but to the other—
not to believe—I cannot persuade
myself. Clodius is still threatening
me with danger, while Pompey
asserts that there is no danger. He
swears it, adding even that he will
not see me injured if it costs him his
life. The point is under

[86](#). Lit. “to be coy,” or “to coquet.”

negotiation: as soon as any certain
conclusion is reached, I will write to

res. Simul et quid erit certi, scribam ad te. Si erit pugnandum, arcessam ad societatem laboris; si quies dabitur, ab Amalthea te non commovebo.

De re publica breviter ad te scribam; iam enim, charta ipsa ne nos prodat, pertimesco. Itaque posthac, si erunt mihi plura ad te scribenda, ἀλληγορίαις obscurabo. Nunc quidem novo quodam morbo civitas moritur, ut, cum omnes ea, quae sunt acta, improbent, querantur, doleant, varietas nulla in re sit, aperteque loquantur et iam clare gemant, tamen medicina nulla adferatur. Neque enim resisti sine internecone posse arbitramur nec videmus, qui finis cedendi praeter exitium futurus sit. Bibulus hominum admiratione et benevolentia in caelo est; edicta eius et contiones describunt et legunt. Novo quodam genere in summam gloriam venit. Populare nunc nihil tam est quam odium popularium. Haec quo sint eruptura, timeo; sed, si dispicere quid coepero, scribam ad te apertius. Tu, si me amas tantum, quantum profecto amas, expeditus facito ut sis, si inclaro, ut accurras; sed do operam et dabo, ne sit necesse. Quod scripseram me tibi ut^[87] Furio scripturum, nihil necesse est tuum nomen mutare; me faciam Laelium et te Atticum neque utar meo chirographo neque signo, si

you. If I have to fight, I will summon you to share my labour: but if I am left in peace, I will not rout you out of your Amalthea.

Political matters I shall only touch on briefly: for I am beginning to be afraid that the very paper may betray me. So in future, if I have to write in fuller detail to you, I shall hide my meaning under covert language. Now the State is dying of a new disease. The measures that have been passed cause universal discontent and grumbling and indignation: there is no disagreement on the point and people are now venting their opinion and their disapproval openly and loudly, yet no remedy is applied. Resistance seems impossible without bloodshed: nor can we see any other end to concession except destruction. Bibulus is exalted to the skies amid universal admiration and popularity. His edicts and speeches are copied out and read. He has attained the height of glory in quite a novel way. Nothing is so popular now as hatred of the popular party. I have my fears about the issue of all this. But I will write more clearly, if I get any definite views. Do you, if your affection for me is as real as I know it to be, hold yourself ready to run to my call, when it comes. But I am doing my best, and will continue to do it, to prevent any necessity. I said I would call you Furius in my letters,

modo erunt eius modi litterae, quas in alienum incidere nolim.

[87](#). me tibi ut *Wesenberg*: et *M*.

Diodotus mortuus est; reliquit nobis HS fortasse centiens. Comitia Bibulus cum Archilochio edicto in ante diem xv Kal. Novembr. distulit. A Vibio libros accepi. Poeta ineptus et tamen scit nihil, sed est non inutilis. Describe et remitto.

but there is no need to alter your name. I will call myself Laelius and you Atticus, and I won't use my own handwriting or seal, at any rate if the letters are such that I should not like them to fall into a stranger's hands.

Diodotus is dead: he left me about £88,000.^{[\[88\]](#)} Bibulus has written a scathing edict putting off the elections till the 18th of October. I have received the books from Vibius: he^{[\[89\]](#)} is a wretched poet, and indeed has nothing in him; still he is of some use to me. I am going to copy the work out and send it back.

XXI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae post VIII
K. Sext., ante XV K.
Nov. a. 695*

De re publica quid ego tibi subtiliter? Tota periit atque hoc est miserior, quam reliquisti, quod tum videbatur eius modi dominatio civitatem oppressisse, quae iucunda esset multitudini, bonis autem ita molesta, ut tamen sine pernicie, nunc repente tanto in odio est omnibus, ut, quorsus eruptura sit, horreamus. Nam iracundiam atque intemperantiam illorum sumus experti, qui Catoni irati omnia perdiderunt, sed ita lenibus uti videbantur venenis, ut posse videremur sine dolore interire; nunc vero sibilis volgi, sermonibus honestorum, fremitu Italiae vereor ne exarserint. Equidem sperabam, ut saepe etiam loqui tecum solebam, sic orbem rei publicae esse conversum, ut vix

XXI

CICERO TO ATTICUS; GREETING.

*Rome, between July
25 and Oct. 18, B.C.
59*

To enter into details about politics would be superfluous. The whole country has gone to rack and ruin: and affairs are in one respect worse than when you left. Then it looked as though we were oppressed with a tyranny which was popular with the lower classes, and, though annoying to the upper, still comparatively harmless: but now it has become suddenly so universally detested that I tremble for the issue. For we have had an experience of the wrath and recklessness of the Triumvirs, and in their indignation with Cato, they have ruined the state. The poisons they used seemed to be so slow that I thought we could die painlessly. But now I am afraid they have been roused to energy by the hisses of the crowd, the talk of the loyalists, and the murmurs of Italy. I had hopes, as I used often to say to you, that the wheel of state had turned so smoothly that we could

[88](#). 10,000,000 sesterces. But it seems too large a sum for Diodotus, a stoic who lived in Cicero's house for some time, to have left. Tyrrell therefore suggests *centum*, i.e. 100,000 sesterces, about £880.

[89](#). Not Vibius himself, but Alexander of Ephesus, author of a *Cosmographia*; cf. Att. II, 22, 7.

sonitum audire, vix impressam orbitam videre possemus; et fuisset ita, si homines transitum tempestatis exspectare potuissent. Sed, cum diu occulte suspirassent, postea iam gemere, ad extremum vero loqui omnes et clamare coeperunt. Itaque ille amicus noster insolens infamiae, semper in laude versatus, circumfluens gloria, deformatus corpore, fractus animo, quo se conferat, nescit; progressum praecipitem, inconstantem reditum videt; bonos inimicos habet, improbos ipsos non amicos.

Ac vide mollitiem animi. Non tenui lacrimas; cum illum a. d. VIII Kal. Sextiles vidi de edictis Bibuli contionantem. Qui antea solitus esset iactare se magnificentissime illo in loco summo cum amore populi, cunctis faventibus, ut ille tum humilis, ut demissus erat, ut ipse etiam sibi, non iis solum, qui aderant, displicebat! O spectaculum uni Crasso iucundum, ceteris non item! Nam, quia deciderat ex astris, lapsus quam progressus potius videbatur, et, ut Apelles, si Venerem, aut Protogenes, si Ialysum illum

scarcely catch the sound of its motion, and scarcely see the track of its path: and that is what would have happened, if people could only have waited for the storm to pass. But for a while they stifled their sighs; then they began to groan aloud; and finally all set about airing their grievances at the top of their voices. And so our friend, being unused to unpopularity, and having always lived in an atmosphere of flattery and glory, disfigured in person and broken in spirit, does not know what to do with himself: he sees that to advance is dangerous, to retreat a confession of weakness: the respectable parties are his enemies, the very riff-raff not his friends.

Yet see how soft-hearted I am. I could not restrain my tears, when I saw him on the 25th of July delivering a speech on the subject of the edicts of Bibulus. He used to carry himself with such a lofty bearing, enjoying unbounded popularity and universal respect: and now, how humble he was, how cast down, and what discontent he aroused in himself as well as in his

suum caeno oblitum videret, magnum, credo, acciperet dolorem, sic ego hunc omnibus a me pictum et politum artis coloribus subito deformatum non sine magno dolore vidi. Quamquam nemo putabat propter Clodianum negotium me illi amicum esse debere, tamen tantus fuit amor, ut exauriri nulla posset

hearers! What a sight! Crassus may have enjoyed it, but no one else. For seeing that he had fallen from the stars, one could not but attribute his swift descent to accident rather than to voluntary motion. And, just as Apelles or Protogenes, if they had seen their Venus or Ialysus smeared with mud, would, I imagine, have been cut to the heart, so I myself could not but feel poignant grief at seeing the idol on whose adornment I had lavished all the colours of my art suddenly disfigured. For though no one looked on it as my duty to retain my friendship with him after the Clodian affair, my affection for him was such that no slight could extinguish

iniuria. Itaque Archilochia in illum edicta Bibuli populo ita sunt iucunda, ut eum locum, ubi proponuntur, prae multitudine eorum, qui legunt, transire nequeamus, ipsi ita acerba, ut tabescat dolore, mihi mehercule molesta, quod et eum, quem semper dilexi, nimis excruciant, et timeo, tam vehemens vir tamque acer in ferro et tam insuetus contumeliae ne omni animi impetu dolori et iracundiae pareat.

Bibuli qui sit exitus futurus, nescio. Ut nunc res se habet, admirabili gloria est. Qui cum comitia in mensem Octobrem

it. The result, is that now Bibulus' scathing^[90] edicts against him are so popular, that one can't pass the place where they are posted up for the crowd of people reading them. Pompey finds them so distressing that he is wasting away with grief; and I myself am much annoyed with them, partly because they cause so much pain to a man whom I have always loved, and partly for fear that being so impulsive and ready to draw the sword, as well as so unused to abuse, he may give full reins to his indignation and wrath.

I don't know what will be the end of Bibulus. As things stand at present

distulisset, quod solet ea res populi voluntatem offendere, putarat Caesar oratione sua posse impelli contionem, ut iret ad Bibulum; multa cum seditiosissime diceret, vocem exprimere non potuit. Quid quaeris? sentiunt se nullam ullius partis voluntatem tenere. Eo magis vis nobis est timenda.

Clodius inimicus est nobis. Pompeius confirmat eum nihil esse facturum contra me. Mihi periculosum est credere, ad resistendum me paro. Studia spero me summa habiturum omnium ordinum. Te cum ego desidero, tum vero res ad tempus illud vocat. Plurimum consilii, animi, praesidii denique mihi, si te ad tempus videro, accesserit. Varro mihi satis facit. Pompeius loquitur divinitus. Spero nos aut certe cum summa gloria aut etiam sine molestia discessuros. Tu quid agas, quem ad modum te oblectes, quid cum Sicyoniis egeris, ut sciam, cura.

his reputation is extraordinarily high. When he put off the elections till October, which generally annoys the populace, Caesar thought he could induce the people by a speech to attack Bibulus: but in spite of all his seditious talk, he could not ring a word out of anybody. In short they feel that they have lost the good-will of all parties: and so violent action on their part is all the more to be feared.

Clodius is hostile to me. Pompey assures me he will do nothing against me: but I am afraid to trust him and am getting ready for resistance. I hope I shall have very strong support from all classes. For your presence I have a longing myself and circumstances call for it to meet the crisis. If I see you in time, I shall feel it a great accession to my policy, my courage and my safety. Varro is very obliging; and Pompey talks like an angel. I hope that in the end I shall either be certain of a glorious victory, or even escape unmolested. Let me know what you are doing, how you are enjoying yourself, and what has happened as regards the Sicyonians.

[90](#). Archilochus was a Greek poet of Paros, who wrote scathing iambic verses.

XXII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae post VIII
K. Sext., ante XV K.
Nov. a. 695*

Quam
vellem
Romae!

Mansisses profecto, si haec fore putassemus. Nam Pulchellum nostrum facillime teneremus aut certe, quid esset facturus, scire possemus. Nunc se res sic habet. Volitat, furit; nihil habet certi, multis denuntiat, quod fors obtulerit, id acturus videtur; cum videt, quo sit in odio status hic rerum, in eos, qui haec egerunt, impetum facturus videtur; cum autem rursus opes eorum et vim et exercitus recordatur, convertit se in bonos, nobis autem ipsis tum vim, tum iudicium minatur. Cum hoc Pompeius egit et, ut ad me ipse referebat (alium enim habeo neminem testem), vehementer egit, cum diceret in summa se perfidiae et sceleris infamia fore, si mihi periculum crearetur ab eo, quem ipse armasset, cum plebeium fieri passus esset. Fidem recepissem sibi et ipsum et Appium de me. Hanc si ille non servaret, ita laturum, ut omnes intellexerent nihil sibi antiquius amicitia nostra fuisse. Haec et in eam sententiam cum multa dixisset,

XXII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Rome, between July
25 and October 18,
B.C. 59*

How I wish you were in town! You would certainly have stayed, if we had thought this was going to happen. For then we could have easily kept that little Beauty in order or at any rate should have known what he was going to do. As it is he flits about in a frenzy and doesn't know what he is doing; he threatens lots of people, but will probably do whatever turns up. When he sees the general abhorrence of the present state of affairs he seems to meditate an attack on the authors of it; but when he remembers the armed force behind them, he turns his wrath against the loyalists. As for me, he threatens me now with brute force, and now with a prosecution. Pompey spoke to him about it, and according to his own account—for he is the only witness I have—he remonstrated strongly with him, saying that he would become a byword for treachery and underhandedness, if my life were threatened by one whose weapons he

aiebat illum primo sane diu multa
contra, ad extremum autem

himself had forged by acquiescing in
his transference to the plebs: that
both he and Appius had pledged their
word for me: and that, unless
Clodius respected their promise, he
would be so annoyed that he would
make it plain to the world that he
prized my friendship beyond
everything. He declared that after he
had said this and much more to the
same effect, Clodius at first persisted
in arguing the point at length, but
finally gave way and

manus dedisse et adfirmasse nihil
se contra eius voluntatem esse
facturum. Sed postea tamen ille non
destitit de nobis asperrime loqui.
Quodsi non faceret, tamen ei nihil
crederemus atque omnia, sicut
facimus, pararemus.

promised he would not do
anything to offend him. Since then,
however, he has not ceased to speak
very unpleasantly about me: but,
even if he did not, I should not
believe him and should continue the
preparations which I am making.

Nunc ita nos gerimus, ut in dies
singulos et studia in nos hominum et
opes nostrae augeantur; rem
publicam nulla ex parte attingimus,
in causis atque in illa opera nostra
forensi summa industria versamur;
quod egregie non modo iis, qui
utuntur opera, sed etiam in vulgus
gratum esse sentimus. Domus
celebratur, occurritur, renovatur
memoria consulatus, studia
significantur; in eam spem
adducimur, ut nobis ea contentio;
quae impendet, interdum non
fugienda videatur.

At the present time I am managing
things so that my popularity and the
strength of my position increases
daily. Politics I am not touching at
all, but am busily engaged in the law
courts and in my other forensic
work: and thereby I find I win
extraordinary favour not only with
those who enjoy my services, but
with the people in general too. My
house is thronged with folk;
processions meet me; the days of my
consulship are recalled; friendships
are not disguised: and my hopes are
so raised that I often think there is no

Nunc mihi et consiliis opus est tuis et amore et fide. Quare advola. Expedita mihi erunt omnia, si te habebo. Multa per Varronem nostrum agi possunt, quae te urgente erunt firmiora, multa ab ipso Publio elici, multa cognosci, quae tibi occulta esse non poterunt, multa etiam—sed absurdum est singula explicare, cum ego requiram te ad omnia. Unum illud tibi persuadeas velim, omnia mihi fore explicata, si te videro; sed totum est in eo, si ante, quam ille ineat magistratum. Puto Pompeium Crasso urgente, si tu aderis, qui per βοῶπιν ex ipso intellegere possis, qua fide ab illis agatur; nos aut sine molestia aut certe

sine errore futuros. Precibus nostris et cohortatione non indiges; quid mea voluntas, quid tempus, quid rei magnitudo postulet, intellegis.

De re publica nihil habeo ad te scribere nisi summum odium omnium hominum in eos, qui tenent omnia. Mutationis tamen spes nulla. Sed, quod facile sentias, taedet

reason for me to shrink from the struggle which threatens.

What I want now is your advice and your affection and loyalty: so fly to me. It will simplify everything, if I have you with me. Varro can render me many services, but they would be far surer if you were here to support them: a great deal of information can be extracted from Publius himself, and a great deal found out, which could not possibly be kept from your ears: besides a great deal more—but it is absurd to specify details, when I want you for everything. The one point I want you to grasp is that the mere sight of you would simplify everything for me; but it all depends on your coming before he enters on his office. I think that, though Crassus is egging on Pompey, if you were here and could find out from the enemy through Juno how far the great men are to be trusted, I should either escape molestation altogether or at any rate I should no longer be

in a fog. There is no need of prayers and exhortations between you and me: you know what I wish and what the gravity of the occasion demands.

I have no political news except that the present masters of the world have the world's hatred: and yet there is no hope of a change. But, as you can easily imagine, Pompey is

ipsum Pompeium vehementerque paenitet. Non provideo satis, quem exitum futurum putem; sed certe videntur haec aliquo eruptura.

Libros Alexandri, neglegentis hominis et non boni poetae, sed tamen non inutilis, tibi remisi. Numerium Numestium libenter accepi in amicitiam et hominem gravem et prudentem et dignum tua commendatione cognovi.

disgusted and heartily sick of it all. I can't see what the end of it will be, but I am pretty sure there will be an explosion of some sort.

I have sent back the works of Alexander, who is a careless writer and not much of a poet: still there is some use in him. Numerius Numestius I have admitted to my friendship with pleasure and find he has plenty of sober good sense and is quite worthy of your recommendation.

XXIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae ante XV
K. Nov. a. 695*

Numqua
m ante I
arbitror te epistulam meam legisse don
nisi mea manu scriptam. Ex eo 't
colligere poteris, quanta occupatione think you ever before read a letter of
distinear. Nam, cum vacui temporis mine which I had not written myself.
nihil haberem, et cum recreandae That will show you how I am
voculae causa necesse esset mihi plagued to death by business. As I
ambulare, haec dictavi ambulans. haven't a moment to spare, and must
Primum igitur illud te scire volo, take some exercise to refresh my
Sampsiceramum, nostrum amicum, poor voice, I am dictating this as I
vehementer sui status paenitere walk.
restituique in eum locum cupere, ex
quo decidit, doloremque suum
impertire nobis et medicinam
interdum aperte quaerere, quam ego
possum invenire nullam; deinde
omnes illius partis auctores ac socios
nullo adversario consenescere,
consensionem universorum

nec voluntatis nec sermonis
maio rem umquam fuisse.

Nos autem (nam id te scire cupere
certo scio) publicis consiliis nullis
intersumus totesque nos ad forensem

XXIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Rome, before Oct. 18,
B.C. 59*

I
don
't
think you ever before read a letter of
mine which I had not written myself.
That will show you how I am
plagued to death by business. As I
haven't a moment to spare, and must
take some exercise to refresh my
poor voice, I am dictating this as I
walk.

Well, the first thing I have to tell
you, is that our friend the Pasha is
heartily sick of his position and
wants to be restored to the place
from which he fell. He confides his
sorrows to me, and at times openly
looks for a remedy; but for the life of
me I cannot find any. Secondly, the
whole of that party, both the
principals and their followers, are
losing their strength, though no one
opposes them; and there

never was a greater unanimity of
sentiment or of the popular
expression of it than there is now.

As for me—for I am sure you
want to hear about myself—I take no
part in public deliberations and

operam laboremque contulimus. Ex quo, quod facile intellegi possit, in multa commemoratione earum rerum, quas gessimus, desiderioque versamur. Sed βοῶπιδος nostrae consanguineus non mediocres terrores iacit atque denuntiat et Sampsicramo negat, ceteris prae se fert et ostentat. Quam ob rem, si me amas tantum, quantum profecto amas, si dormis, expergiscere, si stas, ingredi, si ingredieris, curre, si curris, advola. Credibile non est, quantum ego in consiliis et prudentia tua, quodque maximum est, quantum in amore et fide ponam. Magnitudo rei longam orationem fortasse desiderat, coniunctio vero nostrorum animorum brevitate contenta est. Permagni nostra interest te, si comitiis non potueris, at declarato illo esse Romae. Cura, ut valeas.

devote myself entirely to my law-court practice, which arouses, as you can easily conceive, many a memory of my past achievements and much regret for them. But our dear Juno's brother is venting most alarming threats and, though he denies them to the Pasha, he openly parades them to others. So, if your affection is as real as I know it is, wake up, if you are sleeping, start moving, if you are standing still, run, if you are moving, and fly, if you are running. I set greater store than you can possibly believe by your advice and your wisdom, and, what is still more, by your love and your loyalty. The importance of the theme would perhaps demand a long disquisition; but our hearts are so united that a word is enough. It is of the highest importance to me that you should be in Rome after the elections, if you can't get here before them. Take care of yourself.

XXIV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae ante XV
K. Nov. a. 695*

Quas
Numestio

litteras dedi, sic te iis evocabam, ut nihil acrius neque incitatus fieri posset. Ad illam celeritatem adde etiam, si quid potes. Ac ne sis perturbatus (novi enim te et non ignoro, “quam sit amor omnis sollicitus atque anxius”)—sed res est, ut

spero, non tam exitu molesta quam aditu. Vettius ille, ille noster index, Caesari, ut perspicimus, pollicitus est sese curaturum, ut in aliquam suspicionem facinoris Curio filius adduceretur. Itaque insinuavit in familiaritatem adolescentis et cum eo, ut res indicat, saepe congressus rem in eum locum deduxit, ut diceret sibi certum esse cum suis servis in Pompeium impetum facere eumque occidere. Hoc Curio ad patrem detulit, ille ad Pompeium. Res delata ad senatum est. Introductus Vettius

XXIV

CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.

*Rome, before Oct. 18,
B.C. 59*

I
n the
letter I gave to Numestius I made a most urgent and pressing appeal to you to come. To the speed I then enjoined add something, if you possibly can. And don't be alarmed (for I know you and don't forget that to love “It is to be all made of sighs and tears”^[91]): the matter I hope is one that will

⁹¹. *quam ... anxius* seems to be a quotation from some drama; and Jeans happily translates by this verse from Shakespeare's *As you like it*.

not be so troublesome at the end as at the beginning. That fellow Vettius, my famous informer, promised Caesar, so far as we can see, that he would get some criminal suspicion thrown on young Curio. So he wormed his way into intimacy with the young man and after meeting him often, as events prove, he went so far as to declare that he was determined to make an attack on Pompey with the assistance of his slaves, and to slay him. Curio told his father of this, and he told

primo negabat se umquam cum Curione constitisse, neque id sane diu; nam statim fidem publicam postulavit. Reclamatum est. Tum exposuit manum fuisse iuventutis duce Curione, in qua Paulus initio fuisset et Q. Caepio hic Brutus et Lentulus, flaminis filius, conscio patre; postea C. Septimium, scribam Bibuli, pugionem sibi a Bibulo attulisse. Quod totum irrisum est, Vettio pugionem defuisse, nisi ei consul dedisset, eoque magis id eiectum est, quod a. d. III Idus Mai. Bibulus Pompeium fecerat certiozem, ut caveret insidias; in quo ei Pompeius gratias egerat.

Introductus Curio filius dixit ad ea, quae Vettius dixerat, maximeque in eo tum quidem Vettius est reprehensus, quod dixerat id fuisse adulescentium consilium, ut in foro gladiatoribus Gabini Pompeium adorirentur; in eo principem Paulum fuisse, quem constabat eo tempore in Macedonia fuisse. Fit senatus

Pompey. The affair was reported to the Senate. Vettius was summoned before them and at first denied that he had ever had an appointment with Curio. However he did not stick to that tale long; but at once claimed the privilege of king's evidence. Amid cries of "no," he began to explain that there had been a confederacy of the younger men under the leadership of Curio, to which Paulus at first belonged and Q. Caepio, Brutus I mean, and Lentulus, the flamen's son, with his father's consent; and then that C. Septimius, Bibulus' secretary, had brought him a dagger from Bibulus. The idea of Vettius not having a dagger, unless the consul gave him one, and the rest of it, was too much for anybody's gravity: and the charge was scouted the more because Bibulus had warned Pompey on the 13th of May to be on his guard against plots; and Pompey had thanked him for the advice.

Young Curio was brought in and repelled Vettius' assertions: and the point for which Vettius was especially jumped on was saying that the young men's intention was to attack Pompey in the forum at the gladiatorial show which Gabinius gave, and that Paulus was to be the leader, when it was well known that he was in Macedonia at the time. The House decreed

consultum, ut Vettius, quod confessus esset se cum telo fuisse, in vincula coniceretur; qui emisisset, eum contra rem publicam esse facturum. Res erat in ea opinione, ut putarent id esse actum, ut Vettius in foro cum pugione et item servi eius comprehenderentur cum telis, deinde ille se diceret indicaturum. Idque ita factum esset, nisi Curiones rem ante ad Pompeium detulissent. Tum senatus consultum in contione recitatum est. Postero autem die Caesar, is qui olim, praetor cum esset, Q. Catulum ex inferiore loco iusserat dicere, Vettium in rostra produxit eumque in eo loco constituit, quo Bibulo consuli adspirare non liceret. Hic ille omnia, quae voluit de re publica, dixit, et qui illuc factus institutusque venisset, primum Caepionem de oratione sua sustulit, quem in senatu acerrime nominarat, ut appareret noctem et nocturnam deprecationem intercessisse. Deinde, quos in senatu ne tenuissima quidem suspicione attigerat, eos nominavit, L. Lucillum, a quo solitum esse ad se mitti C. Fannium, illum qui in P. Clodium subscripserat, L. Domitium, cuius domum constitutam fuisse, unde eruptio fieret. Me non nominavit, sed dixit consularem disertum vicinum consulis sibi dixisse Aham Servilium aliquem aut Brutum opus esse reperiri.

that Vettius should be committed on his own confession of having carried a weapon; and that it should be high treason to release him. The view most generally held is that it was a put up job: Vettius was to be discovered in the forum with a dagger and his slaves round him with weapons, and then he was to turn king's evidence: and it would have come off, if the Curios had not reported the matter to Pompey. Then the senatorial decree was read aloud to an assembly. On the next day, however, Caesar, the man who as praetor some years ago had bidden Q. Catulus speak from the floor, brought Vettius out on the rostra, and set him in a place which was beyond Bibulus' aspiration, though a consul. Here he said anything he liked about public affairs; and, as he had come ready primed and tutored, he omitted all mention of Caepio, though he had named him most emphatically in the House: so it was obvious that a night and a nocturnal appeal had intervened. Then he mentioned people on whom he had not cast the slightest suspicion in the House,—L. Lucillus, who, he said, generally used to send to him C. Fannius, the man who once supported a prosecution of P. Clodius, and L. Domitius, whose house was to be the basis of operations. My name he did not mention, but he said that an

Addidit ad extremum, cum iam dimissa contione revocatus a Vatinius fuisset, se audisse a Curione his de rebus conscium esse Pisonem, generum meum, et M. Laterensem.

Nunc reus erat apud Crassum Divitem Vettius de vi et, cum esset damnatus, erat indicium postulaturus.

eloquent ex-consul, a neighbour of the consul, had remarked to him that we stood in need of a Servilius Ahala or a Brutus. He added at the end, when he had been called back by Vatinius after the assembly was dismissed, that he had heard from Curio that Piso, my son-in-law, was in the plot, and M. Laterensis too.

Now Vettius is on trial for violence before Crassus Dives, and, when he is condemned, he will claim to turn

Quod si impetrasset, iudicia fore videbantur. Ea nos, utpote qui nihil contemnere soleremus, non pertimescebamus. Hominum quidem summa erga nos studia significabantur; sed prorsus vitae taedet; ita sunt omnia omnium miseriarum plenissima. Modo caedem timueramus quam oratio fortissimi senis, Q. Considi, discusserat: ea, ea, inquam, quam^[92] cotidie timere potueramus, subito exorta est. Quid quaeris? nihil me infortunatius, nihil fortunatius est Catulo cum splendore vitae tum mortis tempore. Nos tamen in his miseriis erecto animo et minime perturbato sumus honestissimeque et dignitatem et auctoritatem nostram magna cura tuemur.

Pompeius de Clodio iubet nos esse sine cura et summam in nos benevolentiam omni oratione

king's evidence. If he is successful there may very well be some prosecutions. Of that—though to be sure I never despise anything—I'm not much afraid. Everybody is showing me the greatest kindness; but I am sick of life; the whole world is so thoroughly out of joint. Just lately we were afraid of a massacre, but it was averted by a speech of that gallant old man Q. Considius: and now the disaster of which we had been in daily fear has suddenly happened. In fact, nothing could be more deplorable than my situation, nothing more enviable than that of Catulus, considering his glorious life and his timely end. However, I keep up my heart in spite of my miseries, and don't show the white feather, and, with an exercise of caution, I maintain my position and authority with honour.

significat. Te habere consiliorum auctorem, sollicitudinum socium, omni in cogitatione coniunctum cupio. Quare, ut Numestio mandavi, tecum ut ageret, item atque eo, si potest, acrius, te rogo, ut plane ad nos advoles. Respiraro, si te videro.

Pompey tells me to have no fear of Clodius, and shows me the greatest good-will whenever he speaks. I am longing to have you to advise my actions, to be the partner of my anxieties, to share my every thought. So I have commissioned Numestius to plead with you, and now add, if possible, even more urgent prayers of my own, that you literally fly to me. I shall breathe again when I see you.

XXV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae ante K.
Nov. a. 695*

Cum
aliquem

apud te laudaro tuorum familiarium, volam illum scire ex te me id fecisse, ut nuper me scis scripsisse ad te de Varronis erga me officio, te ad me rescripsisse eam rem summae tibi voluptati esse. Sed ego malletm ad illum scripsisses mihi illum

[92](#). ea inquam *M*¹; eam quam *M*²; ea, ea inquam, quam *Tyrrell*.

satis facere, non quo faceret, sed ut faceret; mirabiliter enim moratus est, sicut nosti, ἐλικτὰ καὶ οὐδέν— Sed nos tenemus praeceptum illud τὰς τῶν κρατούντων—. At hercule alter tuus familiaris, Hortalus, quam plena manu, quam ingenue, quam ornate nostras laudes in astra sustulit, cum de Flacci praetura et de illo tempore Allobrogum diceret! Sic habeto, nec amantius nec honorificentius nec copiosius potuisse dici. Ei te hoc scribere a me tibi esse missum sane volo. Sed quid tu scribas? quem iam ego venire atque adesse arbitror; ita enim egi tecum superioribus litteris. Valde te

XXV

CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.

*Rome, before Nov. 1,
B.C. 59*

When I write to you praising any of your friends, I wish you would let them know I have done so. For example, I mentioned in a letter lately Varro's kindness to me, and you answered that you were delighted to hear it. But I had much rather you had written to him saying he was doing all I wished—not

that he was, but to make him do it. For, as you know, he is an odd creature, "all tortuous thoughts and no—".^[93] But I hold to the maxim, "A great man's follies."^[94] However, your other friend, Hortalus, most certainly lauded me to the skies in the most liberal, open-hearted and elaborate manner, when he was delivering a speech on Flaccus' praetorship and that incident of the Allobroges. You may take my word for it that he could not have expressed himself in more affectionate and laudatory terms, nor more fully. I should much like you to write and tell him that I sent you

exspecto, valde desidero neque ego magis, quam ipsa res et tempus poscit.

His de negotiis quid scribam ad te nisi idem quod saepe? re publica nihil desperatius, iis, quorum opera, nihil maiore odio. Nos, ut opinio et spes et coniectura nostra fert, firmissima benevolentia hominum muniti sumus. Quare advola; aut expedies nos omni molestia aut eris particeps. Ideo sum brevior, quod, ut spero, coram brevi tempore conferre, quae volumus, licebit. Cura, ut valeas.

word of it. But I hope you won't have to write, and are now on your way and quite close after the appeals in my former letter. I am eagerly looking out for you, and in sore need of you: and circumstances and the times call for you as much as I do.

On these affairs I have nothing new to say: the country is in the most desperate position possible, and nothing could exceed the unpopularity of those who are responsible for it. I myself, as I think, hope and imagine, am safeguarded by the staunchest support. So hasten your coming: you will either relieve all my cares or share them with me. If I am rather brief, it is because I hope that I may soon be able to discuss anything I wish with you face to face. Take care of yourself.

[93](#). Euripides, And. 448, ἑλικτὰ κούδ' ἐν ὕγιές ἀλλὰ πᾶν περίξ φρονοῦντες: "Thinking tortuous thoughts, naught honest, but all roundabout."

[94](#). Euripides, Phoen. 393, τὰς τῶν κρατούντων ἀμαθίας φέρειν χρεῶν. "One needs must bear the follies of those in power."

**M. TULLI CICERONIS
EPISTULARUM AD
ATTICUM
LIBER TERTIUS**

I

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in itinere in. m.
Apr. a. 696*

Cum
antea

maxime nostra interesse arbitrabar te esse nobiscum, tum vero, ut legi rogationem, intellexi ad iter id, quod constitui, nihil mihi optatius cadere posse, quam ut tu me quam primum consequerere, ut, cum ex Italia profecti essemus, sive per Epirum iter esset faciendum, tuo tuorumque praesidio uteremur, sive aliud quid agendum esset, certum consilium de tua sententia capere possemus. Quam ob rem te oro, des operam, ut me statim consequare. Facilius potes, quoniam de provincia Macedonia perlata lex est. Pluribus verbis tecum agerem, nisi pro me apud te res ipsa loqueretur.

**CICERO'S LETTERS
TO ATTICUS
BOOK III**

II

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in itinere VI Id.
Apr. a. 696*

Itineris
nostri causa
fuit, quod non habebam locum, ubi
pro meo iure diutius esse possem
quam in fundo Siccae, praesertim
nondum rogatione correcta, et simul
intellegebam ex eo loco, si te
haberem, posse me Brundisium
referre, sine te autem non esse nobis
illas partes tenendas propter
Autronium. Nunc, ut ad te antea
scripsi, si ad nos veneris, consilium
totius rei capiemus. Iter esse
molestum scio, sed tota calamitas
omnes molestias habet. Plura
scribere non possum; ita sum animo
perculso et abiecto. Cura, ut valeas.
Data VI Idus Apriles Narib. Luc.

I

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*On a journey, Apr.,
B.C. 58*

I
had
been
n thinking that it would be of the
greatest service to me to have you
with me, but when I read the bill,^[95] I
saw at once that the most desirable
thing in view of the journey I have
undertaken would be that you should
join me as soon as possible. Then I
should have the benefit of your own
and your friends' protection, if I
passed through Epirus, after leaving
Italy; and, if I chose any other
course, I could lay down fixed plans
on your advice. So please be quick
and join me. You can the more easily
do so as the bill about the province
of Macedonia has been passed. I
would say more, if facts themselves
did not speak for me with you.

II

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*On a journey, Apr. 8,
B.C. 58*

The reason why I moved was that there was nowhere where I could remain unmolested except on Sicca's estate, especially as the bill has not been emended. Besides I noticed that I could get back to Brundisium from there, if I had you with me. Without you I could not stay in those districts on account of Autronius. Now, as I said in my last letter, if you will come, I can take your advice on the whole matter. I know the journey is an annoyance: but the whole of this miserable business is full of annoyances. I can't write any more, I am so down-hearted and wretched. Take care of yourself. April 8, Nares in Lucania.

[95](#). Clodius' bill interdicting from fire and water anyone who had put to death a Roman citizen uncondemned.

III

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in itinere circ.
Non. Apr. a. 696*

Utinam
illum diem
videam, cum tibi agam gratias, quod
me vivere coegisti! adhuc quidem
valde me paenitet. Sed te oro, ut ad
me Vibonem statim venias, quo ego
multis de causis converti iter meum.
Sed, eo si veneris, de toto itinere ac
fuga mea consilium capere potero. Si
id non feceris, mirabor; sed confido
te esse facturum.

III

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*On a journey about
Apr. 5, B.C. 58*

Pray God that the day may come
when I shall be able to thank you for
compelling me to go on living. At
present I am heartily sorry for it.
Please come to me at once at Vibo.
For several reasons I've made my
way thither. If you come, I shall be
able to lay plans for my whole
journey in exile. If you do not, I shall
be surprised: but I trust you will.

IV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in itinere inter
Vibonem et
Brundisium Id. Apr. a.
696*

Miseriae
nostrae
potius velim
quam

inconstantiae tribuas, quod a Vibone, quo te arcessebamus, subito discessimus. Allata est enim nobis rogatio de perniciē mea; in qua quod correctum esse audieramus, erat eius modi, ut mihi ultra quadringenta milia liceret esse, illo pervenire non liceret. Statim iter Brundisium versus contuli ante diem rogationis, ne et Sicca, apud quem eram, periret, et quod Melitae esse non licebat. Nunc tu propera, ut nos consequare, si modo recipiemur. Adhuc invitamur benigne, sed, quod superest, timemus. Me, mi Pomponi, valde paenitet vivere; qua in re apud me tu plurimum valuisti. Sed haec coram. Fac modo, ut venias.

IV

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Between Vibo and
Brundisium Apr. 13,
B.C. 58*

Please attribute my sudden departure from Vibo after asking you to join me there to my misery rather than to caprice. I received a copy of the bill for my destruction, and found that the alteration of which I had heard, took the form of banishment beyond four hundred miles. Since I could not go where I wished, I went straight to Brundisium before the bill was passed; for fear of involving my host Sicca in my destruction and because I am not permitted to stay at Malta. Now make haste and join me; if I can find anyone to take me in. At present I receive kind invitations: but I fear the future. I indeed, Pomponius, am heartily sick of life: and it is mainly for your sake that I consented to live. But of this when we meet. Please do come.

V

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Thuriis IIII Id.
Apr., ut videtur, a. 696*

Terentia
tibi et saepe
et maximas agit gratias. Id est mihi
gratissimum. Ego vivo miserrimus et
maximo dolore conficior. Ad te quid
scribam, nescio. Si enim es Romae,
iam me adsequi non potes, sin es in
via, cum eris me adsecutus, coram
agemus, quae erunt agenda. Tantum
te oro, ut, quoniam me ipsum semper
amasti, ut nunc eodem amore sis;
ego enim idem sum. Inimici mei mea
mihi, non me ipsum ademerunt.
Cura, ut valeas.

Data IIII Idus April. Thurii.

V

CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.

*Thurii, Apr. 10 (?),
B.C. 58*

Terentia
continually
expresses the deepest gratitude to
you: and I am very glad of it. My life
is one long misery and I am crushed
with the weight of my sorrows. What
to write I don't know. If you are in
Rome, you will be too late to catch
me: but, if you are already on the
way, we will discuss all that has to
be discussed, when you join me. One
thing only I beg of you, since you
have always loved me for myself, to
preserve your affection for me. I am
still the same. My enemies have
robbed me of all I had; but they have
not robbed me of myself. Take care
of your health.

At Thurium, April 10.

VI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Tarentino XIV
K. Mai. a. 696*

Non fuerat mihi
dubium, quin te Tarenti aut Brundisi
visurus essem, idque ad multa
pertinuit, in eis, et ut in Epiro
consisteremus et de reliquis rebus
tuo consilio uteremur. Quoniam id
non contigit, erit hoc quoque in
magno numero nostrorum malorum.
Nobis iter est in Asiam, maxime
Cyzicum. Meos tibi commendo. Me
vix misereque sustento.

Data XIII K. Maias de Tarentino.

VI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Tarentum, Apr. 17,
B.C. 58*

I
qui te
expected to see you at Tarentum or
Brundisium, and it was important
that I should for many reasons,
among others for my stay in Epirus
and for the advantage of your advice
in other matters. That it did not
happen I shall count among my
many other misfortunes. I am
starting for Asia, for Cyzicus in
particular. I entrust my dear ones to
you. It is with difficulty that I
prolong my miserable existence.

From the neighbourhood of
Tarentum, April 17.

VII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Brundisi pr. K.
Mai. a. 696*

Brundisiu
m veni a. d.
XIII Kal. Maias. Eo die pueri tui mihi
a te litteras reddiderunt, et alii pueri
post diem tertium eius diei alias
litteras attulerunt. Quod me rogas et
hortaris, ut apud te in Epiro sim,
voluntas tua mihi valde grata est et
minime nova. Esset consilium mihi
quidem optatum, si liceret ibi omne
tempus consumere; odi enim
celebritatem, fugio homines, lucem
aspicere vix possum, esset mihi ista
solitudo, praesertim tam familiari in
loco, non amara; sed, itineris causa
ut deverterer, primum est devium,
deinde ab Autronio et ceteris
quadridui, deinde sine te. Nam
castellum munitum habitanti mihi
prodesset, transeunti non est
necessarium. Quod si auderem,
Athenas peterem. Sane ita cadebat,
ut vellem. Nunc et nostri hostes ibi
sunt, et te non habemus et veremur
ne interpretentur illud quoque
oppidum ab Italia non satis abesse,
nec scribis quam ad diem te
exspectemus.

Quod me ad vitam vocas, unum
efficis, ut a me manus absteineam,

VII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Brundisium, Apr. 29,
B.C. 58*

I
arri
ved

at Brundisium on April 17, and on
the same day your men delivered a
letter from you. The next day but one
some others brought me another
letter. I am very grateful for your
kind invitation to stay at your place
in Epirus, though I expected it. It is a
plan, which would have just suited
me, if I could have stayed there all
the time. I hate a crowd, I shun my
fellow-men, I can hardly bear to look
upon the light: so the solitude there,
especially as I am so at home there,
would have been far from
unpleasant. But for stopping on the
route it is too far out of the way:
moreover I should be only four days'
march from Autronius and the rest,
moreover you would not be there
yourself. Yes, a fortified place would
be useful to me if I were settling
there, but it is unnecessary, when I
am merely passing. If I dared, I
should make for Athens; and things
were turning out right for it: but now
my enemies are there, you have not
joined me, and I am afraid that town

alterum non potes, ut me non nostri consilii vitaeque paeniteat. Quid enim est, quod me retineat, praesertim si spes ea non est quae nos proficiscentes prosequatur? Non faciam ut enumerem miseras omnes, in quas incidi per summam iniuriam et scelus non tam inimicorum meorum

quam invidorum, ne et meum maerorem exagitem et te in eundem luctum vocem; hoc adfirmo, neminem umquam tanta calamitate esse adfectum, nemini mortem magis optandam fuisse. Cuius oppetendae tempus honestissimum praetermissum est; reliqua tempora sunt non iam ad medicinam, sed ad finem doloris.

De re publica video te colligere omnia quae putes aliquam spem mihi posse adferre mutandarum rerum. Quae quamquam exigua sunt, tamen, quoniam placet, expectemus. Tu nihilo minus, si properaris, nos consequere; nam aut accedemus in Epirum aut tarde per Candaviam ibimus. Dubitationem autem de Epiro non inconstantia nostra adferebat, sed quod de fratre, ubi

too may not be counted far enough away from Italy. Nor have you let me know when I may expect you.

Your pleas to me not to think of suicide have one result that I refrain from laying violent hands on myself; but you cannot make me cease to regret our decision and my existence. What is there for me to live for, especially if I have lost even that hope I had when I set out? I will forbear to mention all the miseries into which I have fallen through the villainous machinations not so much of my enemies, as of

those who envy me, for fear of arousing my grief again, and provoking you to share it by sympathy. But this I will say, that no one has ever suffered such a misfortune, and no one ever had more right to wish for death. But I have missed the time when I could have died with honour. At any other time death will only end my pain, not heal it.

I notice you collect everything which you think can raise any hopes in me of a change in affairs. That “everything” is very little: still, since you so decide, I will await the issue. Though you have not started, you will catch me yet, if you hurry. I shall either go to Epirus, or proceed slowly through Candavia. My hesitation about Epirus does not

eum visuri essemus, nesciebamus; arise from my changefulness, but quem quidem ego nec quo modo from doubts as to where I shall see visurus nec ut dimissurus sim, scio. my brother. I don't know where I Id est maximum et miserrimum shall see him, nor how I shall tear mearum omnium miseriarum. Ego et myself from him. That is the chief saepius ad te et plura scriberem, nisi and most pitiful of all my miseries. I mihi dolor meus cum omnes partes would write to you oftener and mentis tum maxime huius generis fuller, if grief had not robbed me of facultatem ademisset. Videre te all my wits and especially of that cupio. Cura ut valeas. particular faculty. I long to see you.

Data pr. Kal. Mai. Brundisii.

Take care of yourself.

At Brundisium, April 29.

VIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

Scr. Thessalonicae IV
K. Iun. a. 696

Brundisio

[\[96\]](#)

proficiscens scripseram ad te, quas ob causas in Epirum non essemus profecti, quod et Achaia prope esset plena audacissimorum inimicorum et exitus difficiles haberet, cum inde proficisceremur. Accessit, cum Dyrrachi essemus, ut duo nuntii adferrentur, unus classe fratrem Epheso Athenas, alter

[96.](#) Brundisio added by Graevius.

pedibus per Macedoniam venire. Itaque illi obviam misimus Athenas, ut inde Thessalonicam veniret. Ipsi processimus et Thessalonicam a. d. x Kal. Iunias venimus, neque de illius itinere quicquam certi habebamus nisi eum ab Epheso ante aliquanto profectum. Nunc, istic quid agatur, magno opere timeo; quamquam tu altera epistula scribis Idibus Maiis audire te fore ut acrius postularetur, altera iam esse mitiora. Sed haec est pridie data quam illa, quo conturber magis. Itaque cum meus me maeror

VIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Thessalonica, May
29, B.C. 58

As I was setting out from Brundisium, I wrote to you, explaining why I could not go to Epirus, because it is close to Achaia which is full of my most virulent enemies, and it is a hard place to get out of, when I want to start. My decision was confirmed by the receipt of two messages at Dyrrachium, one saying that my brother was coming by sea from Ephesus to

Athens, the other that he was coming by land through Macedonia. So I sent a note to catch him at Athens, asking him to come on to Thessalonica, and I myself set off and arrived at Thessalonica on the 23rd of May. The only certain news about him, that I have had, is that he started a short time ago from Ephesus. Now I am in great anxiety to know what is happening at Rome. It is true that in one letter dated May 15 you say you have heard that Quintus will be rigorously called in

cotidianus lacerat et conficit, tum vero haec addita cura vix mihi vitam reliquam facit. Sed et navigatio perdifficilis fuit, et ille, incertus ubi ego essem, fortasse alium cursum petivit. Nam Phaetho libertus eum non vidit. Vento reiectus ab Illo in Macedoniam Pellae mihi praesto fuit. Reliqua quam mihi timenda sint video, nec quid scribam habeo et omnia timeo, nec tam miserum est quicquam, quod non in nostram fortunam cadere videatur. Equidem adhuc miser in maximis meis aerumnis et luctibus hoc metu adiecto maneo Thessalonicae suspensus nec audeo quicquam.

Nunc ad ea, quae scripsisti. Tryphonem Caecilium non vidi. Sermonem tuum et Pompei cognovi ex tuis litteris. Motum in re publica non tantum ego impendere video, quantum tu aut vides aut ad me consolandum adfers. Tigrane enim neglecto sublata sunt omnia. Varroni me iubes agere gratias. Faciam; item Hypsaeo. Quod suades, ne longius discedamus,

question, and in another that things are calming down: but the latter is dated a day before the former, to increase my perplexity. So, what between my own personal grief, which racks and tortures me daily, and this additional anxiety, I have hardly any life left in me. But the passage was very bad and perhaps, not knowing where I was, he took some other direction. My freedman Phaetho has seen nothing of him. Phaetho was driven back by wind from Ilium to Macedonia and came to me at Pella. I see how threatening the future is, though I have not the heart to write. I am afraid of everything: there is no misfortune that does not seem to fall to my lot. I am still staying in suspense at Thessalonica, with this new fear added to the woes and sorrows that oppress me; and I do not dare to make a move of any kind.

Now for the things you mention in your letter. Caecilius Trypho I have not seen. Of your talk with Pompey I have heard from your letter. I cannot see such signs of a political change as you either see or invent to comfort me: for, if they take no notice of the Tigranes episode, all hope is lost. You bid me pay my thanks to Varro. I will, and to Hypsaeus too. I think I will follow your advice not to go any

dum acta mensis Maii ad nos perferantur, puto me ita esse facturum, sed, ubi, nondum statui; atque ita perturbato sum animo de Quinto, ut nihil queam statuere, sed tamen statim te faciam certiolem.

Ex epistularum mearum inconstantia puto te mentis meae motum videre, qui, etsi incredibili et singulari calamitate adflictus sum, tamen non tam est ex miseria quam ex culpa nostrae recordatione commotus. Cuius enim scelere impulsus ac proditi sumus, iam profecto vides, atque utinam iam ante vidisses neque totum animum tuum errori mecum simul dedisses! Quare, cum me adflictum et confectum luctu audies, existimato me stultitiae meae poenam ferre gravius quam eventui, quod ei crediderim, quem esse nefarium non putarim. Me et meorum malorum memoria et metus de fratre in scribendo impedit. Tu ista omnia vide et governa. Terentia tibi maximas gratias agit. Litterarum exemplum, quas ad Pompeium scripsi, misi tibi.

Data IIII Kal. Iunias Thessalonicae.

further away, until I receive the parliamentary news for May. But where to stop I have not yet made up my mind; and I am so anxious about Quintus, that I can't make up my mind to anything. But I will soon let you know.

From these rambling notes of mine, you can see the perturbed state of my wits. Yet, though I have been crushed by an incredible and unparalleled misfortune, it is not so much my misery as the remembrance of my own mistake that affects me. For now surely you see whose treachery egged me on and betrayed me. Would to heaven you had seen it before, and had not let a mistake dominate your mind as I did. So when you hear that I am crushed and overwhelmed with grief, be assured that the sense of my folly in trusting one, whose treachery I had not suspected, is a heavier penalty than all the consequences. The thought of my misfortunes and my fears for my brother prevent me from writing. Keep your eye on events and your hand at the helm. Terentia expresses the deepest gratitude to you. I have sent you a copy of the letter I wrote to Pompey.

At Thessalonica, May 29.

IX

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Thessalonicae Id.
Iun. a. 696*

Quintus
frater cum
ex Asia discessisset ante Kal. Maias
et Athenas venisset Idibus, valde fuit
ei properandum, ne quid absens
acciperet calamitatis, si quis forte
fuisset, qui contentus nostris malis
non esset. Itaque eum malui
properare Romam quam ad me
venire et simul (dicam enim, quod
verum est, ex quo

magnitudinem miseriarum
mearum perspicere possis) animum
inducere non potui, ut aut illum
amantissimum mei, mollissimo
animo tanto in maerore aspicerem
aut meas miseras luctu adflictus^[97]
et perditam fortunam illi offerrem
aut ab illo aspici paterer. Atque etiam
illud timebam, quod profecto
accidisset, ne a me digredi non
posset. Versabatur mihi tempus illud
ante oculos, cum ille aut lictores
dimitteret aut vi avelleretur ex
complexu meo. Huius acerbitalis
eventum altera acerbitate non
videndi fratris vitavi. In hunc me

IX

CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.

*Thessalonica, June
13, B.C. 58*

My brother Quintus left Asia at
the end of April and reached Athens
on May the 15th: and he had to
hurry, for fear anything disastrous
might happen in his absence, if there
were anyone who was not yet
contented with the measure of our
woes. So I preferred him to hurry on
to Rome rather than to come to me:
and besides—I will confess the

truth and it will show you the
depth of my misery—I could not
bear in my great distress to look on
one so devoted to me and so tender-
hearted, nor could I thrust upon him
the misery of my affliction and my
fallen fortune, or suffer him to see
me. Besides I was afraid of what
would have been sure to happen—
that he would not be able to part
from me. The picture of the moment
when he would have had to dismiss
his lictors or to be torn by force from
my arms was ever before me. The
bitterness of parting I have avoided
by the bitterness of not seeing my

casum vos vivendi auctores impulistis. Itaque mei peccati luo poenas. Quamquam me tuae litterae sustentant, ex quibus, quantum tu ipse speres, facile perspicio; quae quidem tamen aliquid habebant solacii, antequam eo venisti a Pompeio, “Nunc Hortensium allice et eius modi viros.” Obsecro, mi Pomponi, nondum perspicias, quorum opera, quorum insidiis, quorum scelere perierimus? Sed tecum haec omnia coram agemus; tantum dico, quod scire te puto, nos non inimici, sed invidi perdiderunt. Nunc, si ita sunt, quae speras, sustinebimus nos et spe, qua iubes, nitentur; sin, ut mihi videntur, infirma sunt, quod optimo tempore facere non licuit, minus idoneo fiet.

Terentia tibi saepe agit gratias. Mihi etiam unum de malis in metu est, fratris miseri negotium; quod si sciam cuius modi sit, sciam, quid agendum mihi sit.

[97](#). *adflictus Reid; adflictas MSS.*

brother. That is the kind of dilemma into which you who are responsible for my survival have forced me; and so I have to pay the penalty for my mistake. Your letter however cheers me, though I can easily see from it how little hope you have yourself. Still it offered some little consolation till you passed from your mention of Pompey to the passage: “Now try to win over Hortensius and such people.” In heaven’s name, my dear Pomponius, have you not yet grasped, whose agency, whose villainy and whose treachery have ruined me? But that I will discuss when I meet you. Now I will only say, what you must surely know, that it is not so much my enemies as my enviers who have ruined me. If there is any real foundation for your hopes, I will bear up and rely on the hope you suggest. But if, as seems probable to me, your hopes are ill-founded, then I will do now what you would not let me do before, though the time is far less appropriate.

Terentia often expresses her gratitude to you. The thing I most fear among all my misfortunes is my poor brother’s business: if I knew the exact state of affairs, I might know what to do about it. I am

Me etiam nunc istorum
beneficiorum et litterarum

following your advice and still staying at Thessalonica in hope of

exspectatio, ut tibi placet, the advantages you mention and of
Thessalonicae tenet. Si quid erit novi letters. When I get some news, I
allatum, sciam, de reliquo quid shall be able to shape my course of
agendum sit. Tu si, ut scribis, Kal. action. If you started from Rome on
Iuniis Roma profectus es, prope the first of June, as you say, I shall
diem nos videbis. Litteras, quas ad very soon see you. I have sent you
Pompeium scripsi, tibi misi. the letter I wrote to Pompey.

Data Id. Iun. Thessalonicae.

Thessalonica, 13 June.

X

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Thessalonicae
XIV K. Quint. a. 696*

Acta quae
essent usque
ad VIII Kal. Iunias, cognovi ex tuis
litteris; reliqua exspectabam, ut tibi
placebat, Thessalonicae. Quibus
adlatis facilius statuere potero, ubi
sim. Nam, si erit causa, si quid
agetur, si spem videro, aut ibidem
opperiar aut me ad te conferam; sin,
ut tu scribis, ista evanuerint, aliquid
aliud videbimus. Omnino adhuc nihil
mihi significatis nisi discordiam
istorum; quae tamen inter eos de
omnibus potius rebus est quam de
me. Itaque, quid ea mihi prosit,
nescio, sed tamen, quoad me vos
sperare vultis, vobis obtemperabo.
Nam, quod me tam saepe et tam
vehementer obiurgas et animo
infirmo esse dicis, quaeso, ecquod
tantum malum est, quod in mea
calamitate non sit? ecquis umquam
tam ex amplo statu, tam in bona
causa, tantis facultatibus ingenii,
consilii, gratiae, tantis praesidiis
bonorum omnium concidit? Possum
oblivisci, qui fuerim, non sentire, qui
sim, quo caream honore, qua gloria,
quibus liberis, quibus fortunis, quo
fratre? Quem ego, ut novum

X

**CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.**

*Thessalonica, June
17. B.C. 58*

Your letter has posted me up in
political news to May 25: and I am
awaiting the course of events at
Thessalonica, as you suggest. When
I hear more, I shall know where to
be. For if there is any excuse, if
anything is being done, if I see a ray
of hope, I shall either wait here or
pay you a visit: but if, as you say in
your letter, those hopes have
vanished into air I shall look for
something else. At present you do
not give me the least hint of anything
except the disagreement of those
friends of yours: and they are
quarrelling about anything rather
than me, so I do not see what good it
will do me. But, as long as you wish
me to hope, I will bow to your
wishes. You frequently reproach me
strongly for weak-heartedness: but I
should like to know if I have been
spared any hardship in my
misfortune. Did anyone ever fall
from such a high estate in such a
good cause, especially when he was
so well endowed with genius and

calamitatis genus attendas, cum pluris facerem quam me

good sense, so popular and so strongly supported by all honest men? Can I forget what I was? Can I help feeling what I am? Can I help missing my honour and fame, my children, my fortune and my brother? That is a fresh misfortune for you to contemplate.

ipsum semperque fecissem, vitavi ne viderem, ne aut illius luctum squaloremque aspicerem aut me, quem ille florentissimum reliquerat, perditum illi adflictumque offerrem. Mitto cetera intolerabilia; etenim fletu impediior. Hic utrum tandem sum accusandus, quod doleo, an quod commisi, ut haec aut non retinerem, quod facile fuisset, nisi intra parietes meos de mea pernicie consilia inirentur, aut certe vivus non amitterem?

Haec eo scripsi, ut potius relevares me, quod facis, quam ut castigatione aut obiurgatione dignum putares, eoque ad te minus multa scribo, quod et maerore impediior et, quod exspectem istinc, magis habeo, quam quod ipse scribam. Quae si erunt allata, faciam te consilii nostri certiore. Tu, ut adhuc fecisti, quam plurimis de rebus ad me velim scribas, ut prorsus ne quid ignorem.

Data XIII Kal. Quintiles Thessalonicae.

I have avoided seeing my brother, though I love him and always have loved him better than myself, for fear that I should see him in his grief and misery, or that I, from whom he had parted in the height of prosperity, should present myself to him in ruin and humiliation. Of other things too hard to bear, I will say nothing: my tears prevent me. And what pray is it that calls for reproof? My grief, or my sin in not retaining my position,—which would have been easy enough, if there had not been a conspiracy for my ruin within my own walls,—or that I should not have lost it without losing life too?

My object in wanting thus is to call for your ready sympathy, instead of seeming to deserve your reproaches and reproofs, and the reason why I write less than usual is partly that my sorrow prevents me, and partly that I have more reason to expect news from you than to write to you. When I get your news, I will give you a clearer idea of my plans. Please continue to write fully about

things as you have at present, that no detail may escape me.

Thessalonica, 17 June.

XI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

Scr. Thessalonicae IV
K. Quint. a. 696

Me et
tuae litterae
et quidam boni nuntii, non optimis
tamen auctoribus, et exspectatio
vestrarum litterarum, et quod tibi ita
placuerat, adhuc Thessalonicae
tenebat. Si accepero litteras, quas
exspecto, si spes erit ea, quae
rumoribus adferebatur, ad te me
conferam; si non erit faciam te
certiorem, quid

XI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Thessalonica, June
27, B.C. 58*

At present I am kept at Thessalonica by your letter and by some good news, which however has not the best authority. Besides I am waiting for your note, and you expressed your desire that I should stay here. As soon as I receive the note I am waiting for, I will come to you, if the hope, which has reached me by rumour, is confirmed. If not, I will let you know my movements. Please continue to

egerim. Tu me, ut facis, opera, consilio, gratia iuva; consolari iam desine, obiurgare vero noli; quod cum facis, ut ego tuum amorem et dolorem desidero! Quem ita adfectum mea aerumna esse arbitror, ut te ipsum consolari nemo possit. Quintum fratrem optimum humanissimumque sustenta. Ad me obsecro te ut omnia certa perscribas.

Data IIII Kal. Quintiles.

exert your energy, your wits and your influence on my behalf. I don't ask for encouragement: but please don't find fault with me; for when you do that, I feel as though I had lost your affection and your sympathy, though I am sure you take my misfortune so to heart, that you yourself are inconsolable. Lend a helping hand to Quintus, the best and kindest of brothers, and for mercy's sake let me have all the definite news there is.

June 27.

XII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Thessalonicae
XVI Kal. Sext. a. 696*

Tu
quidem

sedulo argumentaris, quid sit sperandum et maxime per senatum, idemque caput rogationis proponi scribis, quare in senatu dici nihil liceat. Itaque siletur. Hic tu me accusas, quod me adflictem, cum ita sim adflictus ut nemo umquam, quod tute intellegis. Spem ostendis secundum comitia. Quae ista est eodem tribuno pl. et inimico consule designato? Percussisti autem me etiam de oratione prolata. Cui vulneri, ut scribis, medere, si quid potes. Scripsi equidem olim ei iratus, quod ille prior scripserat, sed ita compresseram, ut numquam emanaturam putarem. Quo modo exciderit, nescio. Sed, quia numquam accidit, ut cum eo verbo uno concertarem, et quia scripta mihi videtur neglegentius quam ceterae, puto posse probari non esse meam. Id, si

XII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Thessalonica, July 17,
B.C. 58*

You lay great stress on the hopes I may entertain, especially of action on the part of the Senate; yet at the same time you write that the clause forbidding any mention of my case in the House is being posted up. So no one opens his mouth. Then you accuse me of distressing myself, though, as you know quite well, I have more reason for distress than ever mortal had. You hold out hopes to me on the results of the elections. What hope is there, if the same tribune is re-elected and a consul elect is my enemy? Your news too that my speech^[98] has been published is a blow to me. Heal the wound, if possible, as you propose. In my indignation I paid him back in his own coin: but I had suppressed it so carefully, that I thought it would never leak out. How it has, I can't imagine. But since it so happens that I have never said a word against him, and this appears to me to be more carelessly written than my other speeches, I should think it could be

passed off as some one else's work.
If you think my case is not

[98](#). A speech against Curio, not extant.

putas me posse sanari, cures
velim; sin plane perii, minus laboro.

Ego etiam nunc eodem in loco
iaceo sine sermone ullo, sine
cogitatione ulla. Licet tibi, ut scribis,
significaram, ut ad me venires,
dudum tamen^[99] intellego te istic
prodesse, hic ne verbo quidem levare
me posse. Non queo plura scribere,
nec est, quod scribam; vestra magis
exspecto.

Data XVI Kal. Sextiles
Thessalonicae.

hopeless, please give your
attention to the matter; but if I am
past praying for, then I don't much
mind about it.

I am still lying dormant at the
same place, and neither speak nor
think. Though, as you say, I did
suggest that you should come to me,
I see now that you are useful to me
where you are, while here you could
not find even a word of comfort to
lighten my sorrows. I cannot write
more, nor have I anything to say.
Therefore, I am all the more anxious
for your news.

Thessalonica, July 17.

XIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Thessalonicae
Non. Sext. a. 696*

Quod ad

te

scripseram me in Epiro futurum, posteaquam extenuari spem nostram et evanescere vidi, mutavi consilium nec me Thessalonica commovi, ubi esse statueram, quoad aliquid ad me de eo scriberes, quod proximis litteris scripseras, fore uti secundum comitia aliquid de nobis in senatu ageretur; id tibi Pompeium dixisse. Qua de re, quoniam comitia habita sunt, tuque nihil ad me scribis, proinde habebo, ac si scripsisses nihil esse, meque temporis non longinqui spe ductum esse non^[100] moleste feram. Quem autem motum te videre scripseras, qui nobis utilis fore videretur, eum nuntiant, qui veniunt, nullum fore. In tribunis pl. designatis reliqua spes est. Quam si exspectaro, non erit, quod putes me causae meae, voluntati meorum defuisse.

⁹⁹. dudum tamen *Koch*; si donatum ut *M*.

¹⁰⁰. non added by *Tyrrell*.

XIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Thessalonica, Aug. 5,
B.C. 58*

I

change

d my mind about the proposed journey to Epirus when I saw my hope growing less and less and finally vanishing, and have not moved from Thessalonica, where I proposed to stay till you should send me some news of what you mentioned on Pompey's authority in your last letter, that my case might come before the House after the elections. And so, now the elections are over and I get no news from you, I shall take that as equivalent to your writing and saying that nothing has come of it, nor shall I regret that the hope which buoyed me up has not lasted long. As for the movement that appeared to be in my favour, which you said you foresaw, new arrivals here assure me that it won't come off. The only hope left is in the tribunes elect: and if I wait till that is settled, you will have no right to regard me as a traitor to my own cause and to my friends' wishes.

Quod me saepe accusas, cur hunc meum casum tam graviter feram, debes ignoscere, cum ita me adflictum videas, ut neminem umquam nec videris nec audieris. Nam, quod scribis te audire me etiam mentis errore ex dolore adfici, mihi vero mens integra est. Atque utinam tam in periculo fuisset! cum ego iis, quibus meam salutem carissimam esse arbitrabar, inimicissimis crudelissimisque usus sum; qui, ut me paulum inclinari timore viderunt, sic impulerunt, ut omni suo scelere et perfidia abuterentur ad exitium meum. Nunc, quoniam est Cyzicum nobis eundum, quo rarius ad me litterae perferentur, hoc velim diligentius omnia, quae putaris me scire opus esse, perscribas. Quintum fratrem meum fac diligas; quem ego miser si incolumem relinquo, non me totum perisse arbitror.

Data Nonis Sextilibus.

Instead of blaming me so often for taking my troubles so seriously, you ought to pardon me, as you see that my afflictions surpass all that you have ever seen or heard of. You say you have heard that my mind is becoming unhinged with grief: my mind is sound enough. Would that it had been as sound in the hour of danger, when I found those my cruelest enemies who I thought had my salvation most at heart. As soon as they saw I had lost my balance a little through fear, they used all their malice and treachery to thrust me to my doom. Now that I have to go to Cyzicus, where your letters will reach me less frequently, please be all the more careful to give me a thorough account of everything you think I ought to know. Be a good friend to my brother Quintus, for, if I leave him unharmed by my fall, I shall not regard myself as utterly overwhelmed.

August 5.

XIV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

Scr. Thessalonicae XII
K. Sext. a. 696

Ex tuis
litteris

plenus sum exspectatione de Pompeio, quidnam de nobis velit aut ostendat. Comitia enim credo esse habita; quibus absolutis scribis illi placuisse agi de nobis. Si tibi stultus esse videor, qui sperem, facio tuo iussu, et scio te me iis epistulis potius et meas spes solitum esse remorari. Nunc velim mihi plane perscribas, quid videas. Scio nos nostris multis peccatis in hanc aerumnam incidisse. Ea si qui casus aliqua ex parte correxerit, minus moleste feremus nos vixisse et adhuc vivere.

Ego propter viae celebritatem et cotidianam exspectationem rerum novarum non commovi me adhuc Thessalonica. Sed iam extrudimur non a Plancio (nam is quidem retinet), verum ab ipso loco minime apposito ad tolerandam in tanto luctu

XIV

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Thessalonica, July 21,
B.C. 58

Your letter has filled me with hopes of Pompey's intentions or professed intentions as regards me. For I think the elections have been held, and it is when they are over you say he has decided to have my affair brought forward. If you think me foolish for hoping, I only do what you bid me to do, and I know your letters generally are more inclined to restrain me and my hopes than to encourage them. Now please tell me plainly and fully what you see. I know it is through many faults of my own that I have fallen into this misery: and if fate mends my faults even partially, I shall be less disgusted both with my past and my present existence.

The amount of traffic on the roads and the daily expectation of a change of government have prevented me from leaving Thessalonica at present. But now I am forced to quit, not by Plancius—who wants me to stop—but by the nature of the place, which

calamitatem. In Epirum ideo, ut scripseram, non ii, quod subito mihi universi nuntii venerant et litterae, quare nihil esset necesse quam proxime Italiam esse. Hinc, si aliquid a comitiis audierimus, nos in Asiam convertemus; neque adhuc stabat quo potissimum, sed scies.

Data XII Sextiles Thessalonicae.

is not at all suitable to help one to bear such distress and misfortune. I did not go to Epirus as I said I should, since all the news and all the letters that have reached me lately have shown me that there was no necessity to remain very near Italy. If I get any important news from the scene of the elections, I shall betake myself to Asia, when I leave here. Where exactly, is not yet fixed: but I will let you know.

Thessalonica, July 21.

XV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Thessalonicae
XIV K. Sept. a. 696*

Accepi
Idibus

Sextilibus quattuor epistulas a te missas, unam, qua me obiurgas et rogas, ut sim firmior, alteram, qua Crassi libertum ais tibi de mea sollicitudine macieque narrasse, tertiam, qua demonstras acta in senatu, quartam de eo, quod a Varrone scribis tibi esse confirmatum de voluntate Pompei. Ad primam tibi hoc scribo, me ita dolere, ut non modo a mente non deserar, sed id ipsum doleam, me tam firma mente ubi utar et quibuscum non habere. Nam, si tu me uno non sine maerore cares, quid me censes, qui et te et omnibus? et, si tu incolumis me requiris, quo modo a me ipsam incolumitatem desiderari putas? Nolo commemorare, quibus rebus

sim spoliatus, non solum quia non ignoras, sed etiam ne rescindam ipse dolorem meum; hoc confirmo, neque

XV

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Thessalonica, Aug.
17, B.C. 58*

On August 13 I received four letters from you,—one in terms of reproof, urging me to firmness, another telling me of Crassus' freedman's account of my careworn appearance, a third relating the doings in the House, and a fourth containing Varro's confirmation of your opinion as to Pompey's wishes. My answer to the first is that though I am distressed, it has not unhinged my mind: nay, I am even distressed that, though my mind is so sound, I have neither place nor opportunity for using it. For, if you feel the loss of a single friend like myself, what do you suppose my feelings are, when I have lost you and every one else? And if you, on whom no ban of outlawry has fallen, miss my presence, you can imagine the aching void outlawry leaves in me. I will not mention all that I

have lost,—you know it well enough, and it would only open my wound again. But this I do assert that

tantis bonis esse privatum quemquam neque in tantas miserias incidisse. Dies autem non modo non levat luctum hunc, sed etiam auget. Nam ceteri dolores mitigantur vetustate, hic non potest non et sensu praesentis miseriae et recordatione praeteritae vitae cotidie augeri. Desidero enim non mea solum neque meos, sed me ipsum. Quid enim sum? Sed non faciam, ut aut tuum animum angam querelis aut meis vulneribus saepius manus adferam.

Nam, quod purgas eos, quos ego mihi scripsi invidisse, et in eis Catonem, ego vero tantum illum puto ab isto scelere afuisse, ut maxime doleam plus apud me simulationem aliorum quam istius fidem valuisse. Ceteros quos purgas, debent mihi probati esse, tibi si sunt. Sed haec sero agimus.

Crassi libertum nihil puto sincere locutum. In senatu rem probe scribis actam. Sed quid Curio? an illam orationem non legit? quae unde sit prolata, nescio. Sed Axius eiusdem diei scribens ad me acta non ita laudat Curionem. At potest ille aliquid praetermittere, tu, nisi quod erat, profecto non scripsisti. Varronis sermo facit expectationem Caesaris. Atque utinam ipse Varro incumbat in causam! quod profecto cum sua sponte tum te instante faciet.

no one has ever lost so much and no one has ever fallen into such a depth of misery. Time too, instead of lightening my grief, can but add to it: for other sorrows lose their sting as time passes, but my sorrow can but grow daily, as I feel my present misery and think on my past happiness. I mourn the loss not only of my wealth and my friends but of my old self. For what am I now? But I will not wring your soul with my complaints nor keep fingering my sore.

You write in defence of those who, I said, envied me and among them Cato. Of him I have not the least suspicion: indeed I am sorry that the false friendship of others had more weight with me than his loyalty. As to the others I suppose I should acquit them if you do. But it is too late to matter now.

I don't think Crassus' freedman meant what he said. You say things went well in the House. But what about Curio? Hasn't he read that speech? Goodness knows how it got published. Axius however, writing on the same day an account of the meeting, has less to say for Curio. Still he might well miss something, while you would certainly not have written what was not true. Varro's talk with you gives me hopes of Caesar. I only wish Varro himself would throw his weight into my

Ego, si me aliquando vestri et patriae compotem fortuna fecerit, certe efficiam, ut maxime laetere unus ex omnibus amicis, meaque officia et studia, quae parum antea luxerunt (fatendum est enim), sic

exsequar, ut me aequae tibi ac fratri et liberis nostris restitutum putes. Si quid in te peccavi ac potius quoniam peccavi, ignosce; in me enim ipsum peccavi vehementius. Neque haec eo scribo, quo te non meo casu maximo dolore esse adfectum sciam, sed profecto, si, quantum me amas et amasti, tantum amare deberes ac debuisses, numquam esses passus me, quo tu abundabas, egere consilio nec esses passus mihi persuaderi utile nobis esse legem de collegiis perferri. Sed tu tantum lacrimas praebuisti dolori meo, quod erat amoris, tamquam ipse ego; quod meritis meis perfectum potuit, ut dies et noctes, quid mihi faciendum esset, cogitares, id abs te meo, non tuo scelere praetermissum est. Quodsi non modo tu, sed quisquam fuisset, qui me Pompei minus liberali responso perterritum a turpissimo consilio revocaret, quod unus tu facere maxime potuisti, aut occubuissem honeste, aut victores

cause; and I think he will with a little pressing from you, if not of his own accord.

If ever I have the fortune to see you and my country again, I will not fail to give you more cause for joy at my recall than all my other friends: and, though I must confess that up to now my friendly attentions have not been as conspicuous as they

should have been, I will be so persistent with them, that you shall feel that I have been restored to you quite as much as to my brother and children. If ever I have wronged you or rather for the wrongs that I have done you, forgive me. I have wronged myself far more deeply. I do not write this in ignorance of your great grief at my misfortune, but because, if I had earned a right to all the affection you lavish and have lavished on me, you would never have suffered me to stand in need of that sound common sense of yours, and you would not have let me be persuaded that it was to my interest to let the bill about the guilds^[101] be passed. But you, like myself, only gave your tears to my distress, as a tribute of affection: and it was my fault, not yours, that you did not devote day and night to pondering on the course I should take, as you might have done, if my claims on you had been stronger. If you or

hodie viveremus. Hic mihi ignosces; me enim ipsum multo magis accuso, deinde te quasi me alterum et simul meae culpa socium quaero. Ac, si restitutor, etiam minus videbimur deliquisse abs teque certe, quoniam nullo nostro, tuo ipsius beneficio diligemur.

anyone had dissuaded me from the disgraceful resolve I formed in my alarm at Pompey's ungenerous reply, —and you were the person best qualified to do so—I should either have died with honour, or should to-day be living in triumph. You will pardon what I have said. I am blaming myself far more than you, and you only as my second self, and because I want a companion in my guilt. If I am restored, our common guilt will seem far less, and you, at any rate, will hold me dear for services rendered, not received, by you.

[101](#). The *Collegia* were guilds for social, mercantile, or religious purposes. A decree had declared some of them illegal in 64 B.C.; but this was counteracted by a bill passed by Clodius in 58 B.C. The result was many new guilds were formed, which he used for political purposes.

Quod te cum Culleone scribis de privilegio locutum, est aliquid, sed multo est melius abrogari. Si enim nemo impedit, sic est firmitus; sin erit, qui ferri non sinat, idem senatus consulto intercedet. Nec quicquam aliud opus est abrogari; nam prior lex nos nihil laedebat. Quam si, ut est promulgata, laudare voluissemus, aut, ut erat negligenda, negligere, nocere omnino nobis non potuisset. Hic mihi primum meum consilium defuit, sed etiam obfuit. Caeci, caeci, inquam, fuimus in vestitu mutando, in populo rogando, quod, nisi

You mention talking to Culleo about this bill being directed against an individual.^{[\[102\]](#)} There is something in that point: but it is much better to have it repealed. If no one vetoes it, it is by far the surest course. If on the other hand anyone is opposed to it, he will veto the Senate's decree too. There is no necessity to repeal anything else as well: the former law did not touch me. If we had had the sense to support it when it was brought forward, or to take no notice of it, which was all it deserved, it never would have done us any harm.

nominatim mecum agi coeptum esset, fieri perniciosum fuit. Sed pergo praeterita, verum tamen ob hanc causam, ut, si quid agatur, legem illam, in qua popularia multa sunt, ne tangatis. Verum est stultum me praecipere, quid agatis aut quo modo. Utinam modo agatur aliquid! In quo ipso multa occultant tuae litterae, credo, ne vehementius desperatione perturber. Quid enim vides agi posse aut quo modo? per senatumne? At tute scripsisti ad me quoddam caput legis Clodium in curiae poste fixisse, NE REFERRI NEVE DICI LICERET. Quo modo igitur Domitius se dixit relaturum? quo modo autem iis, quos tu scribis, et de re dicentibus et, ut referretur,ulantibus Clodius tacuit? Ac,

It was then I first lost the use of my wits, or rather used them to my own destruction. It was blind, absolutely blind of us to put on mourning, to appeal to the crowd—a fatal thing to do before I was attacked personally. But I keep harping on what is over and done with. My point, however, is to urge you, when you do make a move, not to touch that law on account of its claims to popularity. But it is absurd of me to lay down what you should do or how. If only something could be done! And on that very point I am afraid your letters keep back a good deal, to save me from giving way to even deeper despair. What course of action do you suppose can be taken and how? Through the Senate? But you yourself have told me that a clause of Clodius' bill, forbidding any motion or reference to my case, has been posted up in the House. How then does Domitius propose to make a motion? And how is it that Clodius holds his tongue, when the men you mention talk about the case and ask for a motion? And, if you think

[102](#). A *privilegium* was a law passed for or against some particular person, which was expressly forbidden by the Twelve Tables.

si per populum, poteritne nisi de omnium tribunorum pl. sententia? Quid de bonis? quid de domo? poteritne restitui? aut, si non poterit,

of acting through the people, can it be managed without the consent of all the tribunes? What about my goods and chattels? What about my house? Will they be restored? If not,

egomet quo modo potero? Haec nisi vides expediri, quam in spem me vocas? sin autem spei nihil est, quae est mihi vita? Itaque exspecto Thessalonicae acta Kal. Sext., ex quibus statuam, in tuosne agros confugiam, ut neque videam homines, quos nolim, et te, ut scribis, videam et propius sim, si quid agatur, id quod intellexi cum tibi tum Quinto fratri placere, an abeam Cyzicum.

Nunc, Pomponi, quoniam nihil impertisti tuae prudentiae ad salutem meam, quod aut in me ipso satis esse consilii decreras aut te nihil plus mihi debere, quam ut praesto esses, quoniamque ego proditus, inductus, coniectus in fraudem omnia mea praesidia neglexi, totam Italiam mire erectam ad me defendendum destitui et reliqui, me, meos, mea tradidi inimicis inspectante et tacente te, qui, si non plus ingenio valebas quam ego, certe timebas minus, si potes, erige adflictos et in eo nos iuva; sin omnia sunt obstructa, id ipsum fac ut sciamus et nos aliquando aut obiurgare aut communiter consolari desine. Ego si tuam fidem accusarem, non me potissimum tuis

how can I be? If you don't see your way to managing that, what is it you want me to hope for? And, if there is nothing to hope for, what sort of life can I lead? Under these circumstances I am awaiting the gazette for August 1 at Thessalonica, before I make up my mind whether to take refuge on your estate, where I can avoid seeing those I don't want to see, and see you, as you point out in your letter, and be nearer at hand if any action is being taken, or whether I shall go to Cyzicus. I believe you and Quintus want me to keep at hand.

Now, Pomponius, you used none of your wisdom in saving me from ruin—either because you thought I had enough common sense myself, or because you thought you owed me nothing but the support of your presence: while I, basely betrayed and hurried to my ruin, threw down my arms and fled, deserting my country, though all Italy would have stood up and defended me with enthusiasm. You looked on in silence, while I betrayed myself, my family and my possessions, to my enemies, though, even if you had not more sense than I had, you certainly had less cause for panic. Now, if you can, raise me from my fall, and in that render me assistance. But, if all ways are blocked, let me know of the fact, and do not keep on either

reproaching me or offering us^[103] your sympathy. If I had any fault to find with your loyalty, I should not trust myself to your house in preference to all

¹⁰³. *Communiter* must apparently = me and my family. Some however read *comiter*.

tectis crederem; meam amentiam accuso, quod me a te tantum amari, quantum ego vellem, putavi. Quod si fuisset; fidem eandem, curam maiorem adhibuisses, me certe ad exitium praecipitantem retinuisses, istos labores, quos nunc in naufragiis nostris suscipis, non subisses. Quare fac, ut omnia ad me perspecta et explorata perscribas meque, ut facis, velis esse aliquem, quoniam, qui fui, et qui esse potui, iam esse non possum, et ut his litteris non te, sed me ipsum a me esse accusatum putes. Si qui erunt, quibus putes opus esse meo nomine litteras dari, velim conscribas curesque dandas.

Data XIII Kal. Sept.

others. It is my own folly in thinking that your affection for me was as great as I wished it to be, that I am finding fault with. If it had been so, you would not have shown more loyalty, but you would have taken more trouble, and you would certainly have prevented me from rushing to my fate, and would not have had all the trouble you are now taking to repair the shipwreck. So please let me know all that you can ascertain for certain, and continue to wish to see me a somebody again, even if I cannot regain the position I once held and might have held. I hope you won't think it is you and not myself I am blaming in this letter. If there is anyone to whom you think a letter ought to be sent in my name, please write one and see that it is sent.

August 17.

XVI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Thessalonicae XII
K. Sept. a. 696*

Totum
iter mihi
incertum facit expectatio litterarum
vestrarum Kal. Sextil. datarum.
Nam, si spes erit, Epirum, si minus,
Cyzicum aut aliud aliquid sequemur.
Tuae quidem litterae quo saepius a
me leguntur, hoc spem faciunt mihi
minorem; quae cum laetae sunt, tum
id, quod attulerunt ad spem,
infirmant, ut facile appareat te et
consolationi servire et veritati. Itaque
te rogo, plane ut ad me, quae scies,
ut erunt, quae putabis, ita scribas.

Data XII Kal.

XVI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Thessalonica, Aug.
19, B.C. 58*

I
am
wai
ting for your letters of the first of
August before I can decide at all
where I shall go. If there is any hope,
I shall go to Epirus: if not, I shall
make for Cyzicus, or take some
other direction. The more often I
read your letters, the less hope I
have: for, though they are cheerful,
they tone down any hope they raise,
so that one can easily see that your
allegiance wavers between
consolation of me and truth. I must
therefore beg you to report facts just
as they are, and what you really
think of them.

August 19.

XVII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Thessalonicae pr.
Non. Sept. a. 696*

De
Quinto

fratre nuntii nobis tristes nec varii venerant ex ante diem III Non. Iun. usque ad prid. Kal. Sept. Eo autem die Livineius, L. Reguli libertus, ad me a Regulo missus venit. Is omnino mentionem nullam factam esse nuntiavit, sed fuisse tamen sermonem de C. Clodi filio, isque mihi a Q. fratre litteras attulit. Sed postridie Sesti pueri venerunt, qui a te litteras attulerunt non tam exploratas a timore, quam sermo Livinei fuerat. Sane sum in meo infinito maerore sollicitus et eo magis, quod Appi quaestio est.

Cetera, quae ad me eisdem litteris scribis de nostra spe, intellego esse languidiora, quam alii ostendunt. Ego autem, quoniam non longe ab eo tempore absumus, in quo res diiudicabitur, aut ad te conferam me aut etiam nunc circum haec loca commorabor.

Scribit ad me frater omnia sua per te unum sustineri. Quid te aut horter, quod facis, aut agam gratias, quod non exspectas? Tantum velim fortuna det nobis potestatem, ut

XVII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Thessalonica, Sept. 4,
B.C. 58*

All the news I have had about my brother Quintus from June the 3rd to the end of August has been bad news without exception. But on the last of August Livineius, who had been sent by his former master, L. Regulus, came to me. He assured me that no notice whatever had been given of a prosecution though there was some talk of C. Clodius' son undertaking one: and he brought me letters from Quintus himself. But on the next day came some of Sestius' men, with some letters of yours which are not so positive and alarming as Livineius' conversation was. My own unending distress of course renders me anxious, all the more so, as Appius would preside at the trial.

From the rest of your remarks in the same letter as to my own chances, I infer that our hopes are fainter than others make out. But since it will not be long now before the matter is settled, I will either remove to your house or still stay somewhere round here.

incolumes amore nostro perfruamur. Tuas litteras semper maxime exspecto; in quibus cave vereare ne aut diligentia tua mihi molesta aut veritas acerba sit.

Data pr. Nonas Sept.

My brother writes that you alone are his support. I need not urge you to efforts, which you make of your own accord, nor will I offer my thanks, since you do not expect them. I only hope fate may allow us to enjoy our affection in safety. I am always looking eagerly for your letters: and please don't be afraid either of boring me with your minuteness or paining me by telling the truth.

September 4.

XVIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Thessalonicae
medio m. Sept. a. 696*

Exspectat
ionem nobis
non parvam attuleras, cum scripseras
Varronem tibi pro amicitia
confirmasse causam nostram
Pompeium certe suscepturum et,
simul a Caesare ei litterae, quas
exspectaret, remissae essent, actorem
etiam daturum. Utrum id nihil fuit,
an adversatae sunt Caesaris litterae,
an est aliquid in spe? Etiam illud
scripseras eundem “secundum
comitia” dixisse.

Fac, si vides, quantis in malis
iaceam, et si putas esse humanitatis
tuae, me fac de tota causa nostra
certiorem. Nam Quintus frater, homo
mirus, qui me tam valde amat, omnia
mittit spei plena metuens, credo,
defectionem animi mei; tuae autem
litterae sunt variae; neque enim me
desperare vis nec temere sperare.
Fac, obsecro te, ut omnia, quae
perspici a te possunt, sciamus.

XVIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Thessalonica, Sept.
B.C. 58*

You raised my hopes considerably
by writing that Varro had assured
you as a friend that Pompey was
going to take up my case, and that he
would appoint an agent as soon as he
had received a letter which he was
expecting from Caesar. Did it come
to nothing? Or was Caesar's letter
hostile? Or is there still room for
hope? You mentioned too that he
used the words “after the elections.”

Please do let me have full
information as to the state of my
case,—you know the anxiety I am in
and how kind it would be of you. For
my brother, a dear good fellow and
very fond of me, sends me nothing
but hopeful news, for fear, I suppose,
that I should entirely lose heart.
Whereas your letters vary in tone;
for your intention is neither to cast
me into despondency nor to raise
rash hopes in me. Pray do let me
know everything you may succeed in
discovering.

XIX

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Thessalonicae
XVI K. Oct. a. 696*

Quoad
eius modi

mihi litterae a vobis adferebantur, ut aliquid ex iis esset expectandum, spe et cupiditate Thessalonicae retentus sum; posteaquam omnis actio huius anni confecta nobis videbatur, in Asiam ire nolui, quod et celebritas mihi odio est, et, si fieret aliquid a novis magistratibus, abesse longe nolebam. Itaque in Epirum ad te statui me conferre, non quo

mea interesset loci natura, qui lucem omnino fugerem, sed et ad salutem lubentissime ex tuo portu proficiscar, et, si ea praecisa erit, nusquam facilius hanc miserrimam vitam vel sustentabo vel, quod multo est melius, abiecero. Ero cum paucis, multitudinem dimittam.

Me tuae litterae numquam in tantam spem adduxerunt quantam aliorum; ac tamen mea spes etiam tenuior semper fuit quam tuae litterae. Sed tamen, quoniam coeptum est agi, quoquo modo

XIX

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Thessalonica Sept. 15,
B.C. 58*

So long as your letters afforded me any ground for it, my hopes and my longings kept me at Thessalonica: but, as soon as I saw that all political business for this year had come to an end, I made up my mind not to go to Asia, because I cannot put up with society and I do not want to be far away in case the new magistrates should make a move. So I determined to go to your house in Epirus, not that the

features of the place make any difference to me now that I shun the light of day entirely, but I should like to sail back to freedom from a port of yours, and, if that hope is cut off, I could not find a better place either to drag on my miserable existence, or, what is preferable, to end it. I shall have few people about me, and shall get free from society.

Your letters never aroused my hopes as much as other people's: and yet my hopes were always fainter than your letters. However, since

coeptum est et quacumque de causa, non deseram neque optumi atque unici fratris miseras ac luctuosas preces, nec Sesti ceterorumque promissa, nec spem aerumnosissimae mulieris Terentiae, nec miserrimae mulieris Tulliolae obsecrationem et fideles litteras tuas. Mihi Epirus aut iter ad salutem dabit, aut quod scripsi supra.

Te oro et obsecro, T. Pomponi, si me omnibus amplissimis, carissimis iucundissimisque rebus perfidia hominum spoliatum, si me a meis consiliariis proditum et proiectum vides, si intellegis me coactum, ut ipse me et meos perderem, ut me tua misericordia iuves et Quintum fratrem, qui potest esse salvus, sustentens, Terentiam liberosque meos tueare, me, si putas te istic visurum, exspectes, si minus, invisas, si potes, mihi ex agro tuo tantum adsignes, quantum meo corpore occupari potest, et pueros ad me cum litteris quam primum et quam saepissime mittas.

Data XVI Kal. Octobres.

some kind of a move has been made in the matter, whatever kind it may be and whatsoever its cause, I will not disappoint either my dear and only brother's sad and touching entreaties, nor the promises of Sestius and others, nor the appeals of my wife in her deep affliction and my little Tullia in her misery, nor your own true-hearted letters. Epirus shall be my road back to freedom or to what I mentioned before.

I beg and beseech you, Pomponius, as you see how I have been robbed of my honours and of my dearest and fondest possessions by men's treachery, as you see how I was betrayed and cast aside by those on whose advice I relied, as you know how I was forced into betraying myself and my family, of your pity help me, and support my brother Quintus, who is not past salvation: guard Terentia and my children; as for me, wait for me in Rome, if you think there is any chance of seeing me there. If not, come to see me, if you can, and allot me of your land enough for my body to rest in; and send a man with letters as soon and as often as possible.

Sept. 15.

XX

**CICERO S. D. Q. CAECILIO
Q. F. POMPONIANO
ATTICO,**

*Scr. Thessalonicae IV
Non. Oct. a. 696*

quod
quidem ita
esse et avunculum tuum functum
esse officio vehementissime probo,
gaudere me tum dicam, si mihi hoc
verbo licebit uti. Me miserum! quam
omnia essent ex sententia, si nobis
animus, si consilium, si fides eorum,
quibus credidimus, non defuisset!
Quae colligere nolo, ne augeam
maerorem; sed tibi venire in mentem
certo scio, quae vita esset nostra,
quae suavitas, quae dignitas. Ad
quae recuperanda, per fortunas!
incumbe, ut facis, diemque natalem
reditus mei cura ut in tuis aedibus
amoenissimis agam tecum et cum
meis. Ego huic spei et exspectationi,
quae nobis proponitur maxima,
tamen volui praestolari apud te in
Epiro, sed ita ad me scribitur, ut
putem esse commodius non eisdem
in locis esse.

De domo et Curionis oratione, ut
scribis, ita est. In universa salute, si
ea modo nobis restituetur, inerunt
omnia; ex quibus nihil malo quam
domum. Sed tibi nihil mando

XX

**MY DEAR QUINTUS
CAECILIUS
POMPONIANUS ATTICUS,
SON OF QUINTUS,**

*Thessalonica, Oct. 4
B.C. 58.*

t
hat
this
name is now yours and that your
uncle has done his duty by you
meets with my heartiest approval; I
will reserve the phrase "I am glad"
for a time when circumstances may
permit of my using the word. Poor
devil that I am! Everything would be
going as right as possible with me, if
my own courage and judgement and
the loyalty of those in whom I
trusted had not failed me. But I will
not piece my misfortunes together,
for fear of increasing my misery. I
am sure you must recollect my
former life and its charm and dignity.
In the name of good luck and bad, do
not let the efforts you are making to
recover my position relax; and let me
celebrate the birthday of my return in
your delightful house with you and
my family. Though my hopes and
expectations of return have been
roused to the highest pitch, I still
thought of awaiting their fulfilment
at your house in Epirus: but from

nominatim, totum me tuo amori fideique commendo.

Quod te in tanta hereditate ab omni occupatione expedisti, valde mihi gratum est. Quod facultates

letters I infer it would be more convenient for me not to be in the same neighbourhood.

You are quite right about my house and Curio's speech. If only restoration is promised in general terms, everything else is comprised in that word: and of all things I am most anxious about my house. But I won't enter into details: I trust myself entirely to your affection and loyalty.

That you have freed yourself from all embarrassments in taking over your large inheritance is exceedingly pleasant news to me; and I fully realize

tuas ad meam salutem polliceris, ut omnibus rebus a te praeter ceteros iuver, id quantum sit praesidium, video intellegoque te multas partes meae salutis et suscipere et posse sustinere, neque, ut ita facias, rogandum esse. Quod me vetas quicquam suspicari accidisse ad animum tuum, quod secus a me erga te commissum aut praetermissum videretur, geram tibi morem et liberabor ista cura, tibi tamen eo plus debebo, quo tua in me humanitas fuerit excelsior quam in te mea. Velim, quid videas, quid intellegas, quid agatur, ad me scribas tuosque omnes ad nostram salutem adhortere.

Rogatio Sesti neque dignitatis satis habet nec cautionis. Nam et

nominatim ferri oportet et de bonis
diligentius scribi, et id animadvertas
velim. Data IIII Nonas Octobres
Thessalonicae.

XXI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

Scr. Thessalonicae V
K. Nov. a. 696

Triginta
dies erant

ipsi, cum has dabam litteras, per quos nullas a vobis acceperam. Mihi autem erat in animo iam, ut antea ad te scripsi, ire in Epirum et ibi omnem casum potissimum exspectare. Te oro, ut, si quid erit, quod perspicias quamcumque in partem, quam planissime ad me scribas et meo nomine, ut scribis, litteras, quibus putabis opus esse, ut des. Data v Kal. Novembres.

what an assistance to me is your promise to devote all your resources to my restoration, that I need not call on anyone else for help. I know too that you are taking on your shoulders several men's burdens on my behalf, and that you are quite capable of bearing them, and will not require asking to do so. You forbid me to imagine that it has ever entered your head that I have done what I ought not or left undone what I ought to have done in my dealings with you—well, I will humour you and free my heart from that anxiety, but I shall count myself still deeper in your debt, because your kindness to me has far exceeded mine to you. Please send me news of everything you see or gather and of all that is being done; and urge all your friends to support my return.

Sestius' bill does not pay sufficient regard to dignity or caution. The proposal should mention me by name, and contain a carefully worded clause about my property. Please pay attention to that point.

Thessalonica, Oct. 4.

XXI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

I
t is
just

Thessalonica, Oct. 28,
B.C. 58

thirty days from the date of this letter since I had any news from you. My intentions are, as I have said before, to go to Epirus, and to await my fate there rather than anywhere else. I must beg you to inform me quite openly of anything you notice, whether for good or for bad, and, as you suggest, to send letters in my name to every one to whom you think it necessary.

October 28.

XXII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. partim
Thessalonicae, partim
Dyrrachi VI K. Dec.
a. 696*

Etsi
diligenter ad
me Quintus
frater et

Piso, quae essent acta, scripserant, tamen vellem tua te occupatio non impedisset, quo minus, ut consuesti, ad me, quid ageretur, et quid intellegeres, perscriberes. Me adhuc Plancius liberalitate sua retinet iam aliquotiens conatum ire in Epirum. Spes homini est iniecta non eadem quae mihi, posse nos una decedere; quam rem sibi magno honori sperat fore. Sed iam, cum adventare milites dicentur, faciendum nobis erit, ut ab eo discedamus. Quod cum faciemus, ad te statim mittemus, ut scias, ubi simus. Lentulus suo in nos officio, quod et re et promissis et litteris declarat, spem nobis non nullam adfert Pompei voluntatis; saepe enim tu ad me scripsisti eum totum esse in illius potestate. De Metello scripsit ad me frater quantum speraret profectum esse per te. Mi Pomponi, pugna, ut tecum et cum meis mihi liceat vivere, et scribe ad me omnia. Premor luctu, desiderio cum omnium rerum tum meorum, qui mihi me

XXII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Partly at
Thessalonica, partly
at Dyrrachium, Nov.
25, B.C. 58*

Though my brother Quintus and Piso have sent me careful accounts of what has been done, I am sorry you were too busy to write your usual full description of events and of your surmises. Plancius' kindness keeps me here still, though I have several times tried to go to Epirus. He is inspired with a hope, which I do not share, that we may return together: which he hopes would redound to his honour. But now, as soon as news arrives of the approach of the soldiers, I shall have to make an effort to leave him. When I do, I will send word to you at once and let you know where I am. The courtesy which Lentulus shows in his actions, his promises and his letters, gives me some hope of Pompey's good will: for you have often mentioned that he would do anything for him. With Metellus, my brother tells me, you have had as much success as he hoped. My dear Pomponius, fight hard for me to be allowed to live

cariores semper fuerunt. Cura, ut valeas.

Ego quod, per Thessaliam si irem in Epirum, perdiu nihil eram auditurus, et quod mei studiosos habeo Dyrrachinos, ad eos perrexī, cum illa superiora Thessalonicae scripsissem. Inde cum ad te me convertam, faciam, ut scias, tuque ad me velim omnia quam diligentissime, cuicuiusmodi sunt, scribas. Ego iam aut rem aut ne spem quidem exspecto.

Data VI Kal. Decembr. Dyrrachi.

with you and with my family; and send me all the news. I am bowed down with grief through my longing for all my dear ones, who have always been dearer to me than myself. Take care of yourself.

Knowing that I should be a very long time without any news, if I went to Epirus through Thessaly, and that the people of Dyrrachium were warm friends of mine, I have come to them, after writing the first part of this letter at Thessalonica. As soon as I leave here and go to your house, I will let you know; and please write me every detail of whatsoever kind. Now I look either for the fulfilment of my hopes or for blank despair.

Dyrrachium, Nov 25.

XXIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Dyrrachi pr. K.
Dec. a. 696*

A. d. v
Kal.

Decembr. tres epistulas a te accepi, unam datam a. d. VIII Kal. Novembres, in qua me hortaris, ut forti animo mensem Ianuarium exspectem, eaque, quae ad spem putas pertinere de Lentuli studio, de Metelli voluntate, de tota Pompei ratione, perscribis. In altera epistula praeter consuetudinem tuam diem non adscribis, sed satis significas tempus; lege enim ab octo tribunis pl. promulgata scribis te eas litteras eo ipso die dedisse, id est a. d. IIII Kal. Novembres, et, quid putes utilitatis eam promulgationem attulisse, perscribis. In quo si iam nostra salus cum hac lege desperata erit, velim pro tuo in me amore hanc inanem meam diligentiam miserabilem potius quam ineptam putes, sin est aliquid spei, des operam, ut maiore diligentia posthac a nostris magistratibus defendamur. Nam ea veterum tribunorum pl. rogatio tria capita habuit, unum de reditu meo scriptum incaute; nihil enim restituitur praeter civitatem et ordinem, quod mihi pro meo casu satis est; sed, quae cavenda fuerint et

XXIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Dyrrachium, Nov. 29,
B.C. 58*

On the 26th of November I received three letters from you. In one of them, posted on the 25th of October, you exhort me to keep up my courage and wait for January, and you give a full list of all the hopeful signs, Lentulus' zeal for my cause, Metellus' good will and Pompey's policy. One of the others is undated, which is unlike you; but you give a clear clue to the time, for you say you were writing it on the very day that the bill was published by the eight tribunes, that is to say the 29th of October: and you state the advantages you think have resulted from the publication of the law. If my restoration and this law together are long past praying for, I hope your affection will make you regard the trouble I am taking about it with pity rather than amusement. But, if there is still some hope, please see to it that our new magistrates set up a more careful case. For the old tribunes' bill had three sections, and the one about my return was carelessly worded; it does

quo modo, te non fugit. Alterum caput est tralatitium de impunitate, SI QUID CONTRA ALIAS LEGES EIVS LEGIS ERGO FACTVM SIT.

Tertium caput, mi Pomponi, quo consilio et a quo sit inculcatum, vide. Scis enim Clodium sanxisse, ut vix aut ut omnino non posset nec per senatum nec per populum infirmari sua lex. Sed vides numquam

not provide for the restitution of anything but my citizenship and my position. In my fallen fortunes that is enough for me, but you cannot fail to see what ought to have been stipulated and how. The second clause is the usual form of indemnity: "If in virtue of this law there be any breach of other laws," etc.

But it is the third clause, Pomponius, to which I would call your attention. What is its object, and who put it in? You know that Clodius had so provided that it was almost, if not quite impossible for either the Senate or the people to annul his law;

esse observatas sanctiones earum legum, quae abrogarentur. Nam, si id esset, nulla fere abrogari posset; neque enim ulla est, quae non ipsa se saepiat difficultate abrogationis. Sed, cum lex abrogatur, illud ipsum abrogatur, quo modo eam abrogari oporteat. Hoc cum et re vera ita sit, et cum semper ita habitum observatumque sit, octo nostri tribuni pl. caput posuerunt hoc: SI QUID IN HAC ROGATIONE SCRIPTVM EST, QVOD PER LEGES PLEBISVE SCITA, hoc est quod per legem Clodiam, PROMVLGARE, ABROGARE, DEROGARE, OBROGARE SINE FRAVDE SVA NON LICEAT, NON LICVERIT, QVODVE EI, QVI PROMVLGAVIT, ABROGAVIT, DEROGAVIT,

but, you see, the imprecations^{[\[105\]](#)} attached to laws which are repealed are never regarded, otherwise hardly any law ever would be repealed; for there never is a law which did not hedge itself in with obstacles against its repeal. But, when a law is repealed, the provisions against repeal are repealed likewise. Though this is the case, and always has been in theory and in practice, our eight tribunes have thought fit to insert a clause: "If there be anything contained in this bill, which by law or popular decree," that is by Clodius' law, "cannot now or hereafter be brought forward, whether by way of proposal, repeal,

OBROGAVIT, OB EAM REM POENAE
MVLTA EVE SIT, E. H. L. N. R. Atque hoc
in illis tribunis pl. non laedebat; lege
enim collegii sui non tenebantur.
Quo maior est suspicio malitiae
alicuius, cum id, quod ad ipsos nihil
pertinebat, erat autem contra me,
scripserunt, ut novi tribuni pl., si
essent timidiores, multo magis sibi
eo capite utendum putarent. Neque
id a Clodio praetermissum est; dixit
enim in contione a. d. III Nonas
Novembres hoc capite designates
tribunis pl. praescriptum esse, quid
liceret. Tamen in lege nulla esse eius
modi caput te non fallit, quod si opus
esset, omnes in abrogando uterentur.
Ut Ninnium aut ceteros fugerit,
investiges velim, et quis attulerit, et
quare octo tribuni pl. ad senatum de
me referre non dubitarint, scilicet^[104]
quod observandum illud caput non

¹⁰⁴. scilicet *Lallemand*; sive *MSS*.

putabant, eidem in abrogando tam
cauti fuerint, ut id metuerent, soluti
cum essent, quod ne iis quidem, qui

amendment or modification, without
penalty, or without involving the
author of the proposal or amendment
in a penalty or fine, no such proposal
is made in this law.” And yet these
tribunes did not run any risks; as a
law made by one of their own body
was not binding on them. That
increases my suspicion that there is
some trickery about it, as they have
inserted a clause which does not
apply to themselves, but is against
my interest; and as a result the new
tribunes, if they should happen to be
rather timid, would suppose that
clause still more indispensable. Nor
did Clodius overlook the point: for in
the meeting on November the third
he said that this clause defined the
powers of the tribunes elect. Yet you
know quite well that no such clause
is ever inserted in a law: and, if it
were necessary, everybody would
use it when repealing a law. Please
try to find out how this clause
escaped the notice of Ninnius and
the rest, also who inserted it, and
why the eight tribunes, after showing
no hesitation about bringing my case
before the House—which proves
they did not think

¹⁰⁵. Against anyone who should seek to
repeal the law.

that section need be taken
seriously—yet when it came to
repealing the law, became so

lege tenentur, est curandum. Id caput sane nolim novos tribunos pl. ferre; sed perferant modo quidlibet; uno capite, quo revocabor, modo res conficiatur, ero contentus. Iam dudum pudet tam multa scribere; vereor enim, ne re iam desperata legas, ut haec mea diligentia miserabilis tibi, aliis irridenda videatur. Sed, si est aliquid in spe, vide legem, quam T. Fadio scripsit Visellius. Ea mihi perplacet; nam Sesti nostri, quam tu tibi probari scribis, mihi non placet.

Tertia est epistula pridie Idus Novembr. data, in qua exponis prudenter et diligenter, quae sint, quae rem distinere videantur, de Crasso, de Pompeio, de ceteris. Quare oro te, ut, si qua spes erit posse studiis bonorum, auctoritate, multitudine comparata rem confici, des operam, ut uno impetu perfringantur, in eam rem incumbas ceterosque excites. Sin, ut ego perspicio cum tua coniectura tum etiam mea, spei nihil est, oro obtestorque te, ut Quintum fratrem ames, quem ego miserum misere perdidici, neve quid eum patiari gravius consulere de se, quam expediat sororis tuae filio, meum Ciceronem, cui nihil misello relinquo praeter invidiam et ignominiam nominis mei, tueare, quoad poteris, Terentiam, unam omnium

cautious that they feared a rule, which even those who are bound by the law do not regard, though they themselves were not bound by it. That clause I would rather the new tribunes did not propose; but do let them pass something—anything. I shall be quite contented with a single clause of recall, if only the matter can be settled. For some time past I have been ashamed of writing such long letters. For by the time you read this I am afraid that there may be no hope left, and that all my trouble may serve only to make you pity and others laugh. But, if there is any hope left, look at the bill which Visellius has drawn up for Fadius: it takes my fancy very much, whereas our friend Sestius' proposal, which you say has your approval, does not please me at all.

The third letter is dated November 12, and in it you go through the reasons which you think are causing delay in my case, thoughtfully and carefully, mentioning Crassus, Pompey and the rest. Now, if there is the least chance of getting the matter settled by the good offices and authority of the conservatives and by getting a large mass of supporters, for heaven's sake try to break the barrier down at a rush: devote yourself to it and incite others to join. But if, as I infer from your guesses as well as mine, there is no

hope left, then I beg and pray you to cherish my poor brother Quintus, whom I have involved in my own ruin, and not to let him pursue any rash course which would endanger your sister's son. Watch over my poor little boy, to whom I leave nothing but the hatred and the disgrace of my name, so far as you can, and support Terentia with your kindness in her

aerumnosissimam, sustentas tuis officiis. Ego in Epirum proficiscar, cum primorum dierum nuntios excepero. Tu ad me velim proximis litteris, ut se initia dederint, perscribas.

Data pridie Kal. Decembr.

unparalleled misfortune. I shall start for Epirus as soon as I have news about the first few days of the new tribunate. Please let me know in your next letter how the beginning has turned out.

November 29.

XXIV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Dyrrachi IV Id.
Dec. a. 696*

Antea,
cum ad me
scripsissetis vestro consensu
consulum provincias ornatas esse,
etsi verebar, quorsum id casurum
esset, tamen sperabam vos aliquid
aliquando vidisse prudentius; postea
quam mihi et dictum est et scriptum
vehementer consilium vestrum
reprehendi, sum graviter commotus,
quod illa ipsa spes exigua, quae erat,
videretur esse sublata. Nam, si
tribuni pl. nobis suscensent, quae
potest spes esse? Ac videntur iure
suscensere, cum et expertes consilii
fuerint ei, qui causam nostram
susceperant, et nostra concessione
omnem vim sui iuris amiserint,
praesertim cum ita dicant, se nostra
causa voluisse suam potestatem esse
de consulibus ornandis, non ut eos
impedirent, sed ut ad nostram
causam adiungerent; nunc, si
consules a nobis alieniores esse
velint, posse id libere facere; sin
velint nostra causa, nihil posse se
invitis. Nam, quod scribis, pi ita
vobis placuisset,

XXIV

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Dyrrachium, Dec. 10,
B.C. 58*

When you wrote to me some time ago that the estimates for the consular provinces^[106] were passed with your consent, I hoped you saw some good reason or other for that course, though I was afraid of the result: but now that I have been told by word of mouth and by letter that your policy was severely criticized, I am much disturbed at seeing the faint hope I had apparently taken from me. For, if the tribunes are annoyed with us, what hope is left? And they seem to me to have every reason for annoyance, when they were left out of the plan, though they had espoused my cause, and by our concession they have lost all use of their just right, especially as they assert that it was for my sake they wished to exercise their powers in fitting out the consuls, with a view not to oppose them but to attach them to my cause. But now if the consuls choose to stand aloof from me, they are perfectly free to do so, while, if they take my part, they can

do nothing against the tribunes' will.
As for your writing that, if you had

[106](#). *Ornare consules* or *provincias* is the phrase used of the arrangement of the number of troops, the staff, and the amount of money to be granted to each consul, when going he went to his province. It generally took place after they came into office; but for some reason it had been arranged earlier on this occasion.

illos hoc idem per populum adsecuturos fuisse, invitis tribunis pl. fieri nullo modo potuit. Ita vereor ne et studia tribunorum amiserimus et, si studia maneant, vinclum illud adiungendorum consulum amissum sit.

Accedit aliud non parvum incommodum, quod gravis illa opinio, ut quidem ad nos perferebatur, senatum nihil decernere, antequam de nobis actum esset, amissa est, praesertim in ea causa, quae non modo necessaria non fuit, sed etiam inusitata ac nova (neque enim umquam arbitror ornatas esse provincias designatorum), ut, cum in hoc illa constantia, quae erat mea causa suscepta, imminuta sit, nihil iam possit non decerni. Iis, ad quos relatum est, amicis placuisse non mirum est; erat enim difficile reperire, qui contra tanta commoda duorum consulum palam sententiam diceret. Fuit omnino difficile non obsequi vel amicissimo homini Lentulo, vel Metello, qui simultatem

not assented, they would have got their way all the same through the people, that could never have happened, if the tribunes opposed it. So I am afraid that I have lost the tribunes' favour, and that, if it is still retained, the bond which should have united the consuls with them has been lost.

There is another considerable disadvantage too. There was a strong opinion, or so at least it was reported to me, that the Senate would not pass any measure until my case was settled. That is now lost, and in a case where there was no necessity whatever; indeed the proceeding was unusual and unprecedented. For I do not think the estimates for the provinces were ever passed before the consuls entered on their office. The result is that, now that the firm resolution formed in favour of my case has been broken for this one occasion, there is no reason why any decree should not be passed. I don't wonder that those friends to whom the question was referred agreed to

humanissime deponeret; sed vereor, ne hos tamen tenere potuerimus, tribunos pl. amiserimus. Haec res quem ad modum ceciderit, et tota res quo loco sit, velim ad me scribas et ita, ut instituisti. Nam ista veritas, etiamsi iucunda non est, mihi tamen grata est.

Data IIII Id. Decembr.

it: it would of course have been difficult to find anyone who would openly oppose a measure so favourable to the two consuls. It would have been very difficult too not to oblige so good a friend as Lentulus, or Metellus, considering his kindness in laying aside his quarrel with me. But I am afraid that, while we could have retained their friendship in any case, we have thrown away that of the tribunes. Please write and tell me what the result has been, and how my whole case stands, as freely as you have before. For, however unpleasant the truth may be, I am grateful for it.

December 10.

XXV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Dyrrachi m. Dec.
a. 696, post IV Id.,
ante II K. Ian.*

Post tuum
a me
discessum

litterae mihi Roma allatae sunt, ex quibus perspicio nobis in hac calamitate tabescendum esse. Neque enim (sed bonam in partem accipies), si ulla spes salutis nostrae subesset, tu pro tuo amore in me hoc tempore discessisses. Sed, ne ingrati aut ne omnia velle nobiscum una interire videamur, hoc omitto; illud abs te peto des operam, id quod mihi adfirmasti, ut te ante Kalendas Ianuarias ubicumque erimus, sistas.

XXV

CICERO TO ATTICUS; GREETING.

*Dyrrachium, between
Dec. 10 and 29, B.C.
58*

After your departure from me I received a letter from Rome, from which I can see that I shall have to waste away in my present misery. For (you must take it in good part) if there had been any hopes of my salvation, I am sure your affection would not have permitted you to go away at such a time. But about that I will say no more, lest I appear ungrateful and seem to want to involve the whole world in my ruin. One thing I do beg of you; keep your promise to present yourself, wherever I am, before the New Year.

XXVI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Dyrrachi m.
Ianuario a. 697*

Litterae
mihi a

Quinto fratre cum senatus consulto, quod de me est factum, allatae sunt. Mihi in animo est legum lationem exspectare, et, si obtrectabitur, utar auctoritate senatus et potius vita quam patria carebo. Tu, quaeso, festina ad nos venire.

XXVI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Dyrrachium, Jan.,
B.C. 57*

A letter from my brother Quintus has come, containing the decree which the Senate passed about me. I am thinking of waiting till the bill is brought forward; and then, if it meets with opposition, I will avail myself of the Senate's expressed opinion, preferring to be deprived of my life rather than of my native land. Please make haste and come to me.

XXVII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Dyrrachi ex. m.
Ian. a. 697*

Ex tuis
litteris et ex
re ipsa nos funditus perisse video. Te
oro, ut, quibus in rebus tui mei
indigebunt, nostris miseriis ne desis.
Ego te, ut scribis, cito videbo.

XXVII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Dyrrachium, Jan.,
B.C. 57*

Your letter shows me that I am
ruined beyond redemption; the facts
speak for themselves. I implore you
to stand by us in our misfortune, and
not to let my family want for your
assistance in anything. As you say, I
myself shall see you soon.

**M. TULLI CICERONIS
EPISTULARUM AD
ATTICUM
LIBER QUARTUS**

I

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae med. m.
Sept. a. 697*

Cum
primum

Romam veni, fuitque cui recte ad te litteras darem, nihil prius faciendum mihi putavi, quam ut tibi absenti de reditu nostro gratularer. Cognoram enim, ut vere scribam, te in consiliis mihi dandis nec fortiozem nee prudentiozem quam me ipsum nec etiam pro praeterita mea in te observantia^[107] nimium in custodia salutis meae diligentem, eundemque te, qui primis temporibus erroris nostri aut potius furoris particeps et falsi timoris socius fuisses, acerbissime discidium nostrum tulisse, plurimumque operae, studii, diligentiae, laboris ad conficiendum reditum meum contulisse. Itaque hoc tibi vere adfirmo, in maxima laetitia et exoptatissima gratulatione unum ad cumulandum gaudium conspectum aut potius complexum mihi tuum defuisse. Quem semel nactus si umquam dimisero ac nisi etiam praetermissos fructus tuae suavitatis praeteriti temporis omnes exegero, profecto hac restitutione fortunae me ipse non satis dignum iudicabo.

CICERO'S LETTERS TO ATTICUS BOOK IV

Nos adhuc, in nostro statu quod difficillime recuperari posse arbitrati sumus, splendorem nostrum illum forensem et in senatu auctoritatem et apud viros bonos gratiam, magis, quam optamus, consecuti sumus; in re autem familiari, quae quem ad modum

[107](#). propter (or propterea) meam in te observantiam. MSS. Corrected by Bosius.

I

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Rome, Sept., B.C. 57

As soon as I reached Rome and there was anyone to whom I could safely entrust a letter to you, my first thought was to write and thank you for my return, since you are not here to receive my thanks. For I grasped, to tell you the truth, that though in the advice you gave me you showed yourself no wiser and no braver than myself, and indeed, considering my past attentions to you, you were none too energetic in defence of my honour, still, though at first you shared my mistake or rather my madness and my unnecessary fright, it was you who took my exile most to heart and contributed most energy, zeal and perseverance in bringing about my return. And so I can assure you that in the midst of great rejoicing and the most gratifying congratulations, one thing was lacking to fill the cup of my happiness, the sight of you or rather your embrace. When once I have obtained that, I shall certainly think myself undeserving of this renewal of good fortune, if ever I let you go

again, and if I do not exact to the full all arrears in the enjoyment of your pleasant society.

As regards my political position, I have attained what I thought would be the hardest thing to recover—my distinction at the Bar, my authority in the House and more popularity with the sound party than I desire. But you know how my private property has been crippled, dissipated, plundered. I

fracta, dissipata, direpta sit, non ignoras, valde laboramus tuarumque non tam facultatum, quas ego nostras esse iudico, quam consiliorum ad colligendas et constituendas reliquias nostras indigemus.

Nunc, etsi omnia ant scripta esse a tuis arbitror aut etiam nuntiis ac rumore perlata, tamen ea scribam brevi, quae te puto potissimum ex meis litteris velle cognoscere. Pr. Nonas Sextiles Dyrrachio sum profectus ipso illo die, quo lex est lata de nobis. Brundisium veni Nonis Sextilibus. Ibi mihi Tulliola mea fuit praesto, natali suo ipso die, qui casu idem natalis erat et Brundisinae coloniae et tuae vicinae Salutis; quae res animadversa a multitudine summa Brundisinorum gratulatione celebrata est. Ante diem VI Idus Sextiles cognovi, cum Brundisi essem, litteris Quinti mirifico studio omnium aetatum atque ordinum,

am in great difficulties with it and stand in need not so much of your means, which I know I can look upon as my own, as of your advice to gather the fragments together and arrange matters.

Now, though I suppose you have had all the news from your family or from messengers and rumour, I will give you a short account of everything I think you would rather learn from my letters. On the 4th of August, the very day the law about me was proposed, I started from Dyrrachium, and arrived at Brundisium on the 5th. There my little Tullia was waiting for me, on her own birthday, which; as it happened, was the commemoration day of Brundisium and of the temple of Safety near your house too. The coincidence was noticed and the people of Brundisium held great celebrations. On the 8th of August,

incredibili concursu Italiae legem comitiis centuriatis esse perlatam. Inde a Brundisinis honestissimis ornatus, iter ita feci, ut undique ad me cum gratulatione legati convenerint. Ad urbem ita veni, ut nemo ullius ordinis homo nomenclatori notus fuerit, qui mihi obviam non venerit, praeter eos inimicos, quibus id ipsum, se inimicos esse, non liceret aut dissimulare aut negare. Cum venissem ad portam Capenam, gradus templorum ab infima plebe completi erant. A qua plausu maximo cum esset mihi gratulatio significata, similis et frequentia et plausus me usque ad Capitolium celebravit, in foroque et in ipso Capitolio miranda multitudo fuit.

while I was still at Brundisium, I heard from Quintus that the law had been passed in the Comitia Centuriata with extraordinary enthusiasm of all ages and ranks in Italy who had flocked to Rome in thousands. Then I started on my journey amid the rejoicings of all the loyal folk of Brundisium, and was met everywhere by deputations offering congratulations. When I came near the city, there was not a soul of any class known to my attendant,^[108] who did not come to meet me, except those enemies who could neither hide nor deny their enmity. When I reached the Capenan Gate, the steps of the temples were thronged with the populace. Their joy was exhibited in loud applause: a similar crowd accompanied me with like applause to the Capitol, and in the Forum and on the very Capitol there was an extraordinary gathering.

^{108.} A *nomenclator* attended canvassers and others to tell them the names of persons they met.

Postridie in senatu, qui fuit dies Nonarum Septembr., senatui gratias egimus. Eo biduo cum esset annonae summa caritas, et homines ad theatrum primo, deinde ad senatum concurrissent, impulsu Clodi mea opera frumenti inopiam esse clamarent, cum per eos dies senatus de annona haberetur, et ad eius procuracionem sermone non solum

Next day, on the 5th of September, I returned thanks to the Senate^[110] in the House. On those two days bread was very dear and crowds ran first to the theatre and then to the House, crying out at Clodius' instigation that the dearth of corn was my fault. On the same days there were meetings of the House about the corn supply and Pompey was called upon by

plebis, verum etiam bonorum Pompeius vocaretur, idque ipse cuperet, multitudoque a me nominatim, ut id decernerem, postularet, feci et accurate sententiam dixi. Cum abessent consulares, quod tuto se negarent posse sententiam dicere, praeter Messallam et Afranium, factum est senatus consultum in meam sententiam, ut cum Pompeio ageretur, ut eam rem susciperet, lexque ferretur. Quo senatus consulto recitato cum more hoc insulso et novo populus^[109] plausum meo nomine recitando dedisset, habui contionem. Omnes magistratus praesentes praeter unum praetorem et duos tribunes pl. dederunt. Postridie senatus frequens et omnes consulares nihil Pompeio postulanti negarunt. Ille legatos quindecim cum postularet, me principem nominavit et ad omnia me alterum se fore dixit. Legem consules conscripserunt, qua Pompeio per quinquennium omnis potestas rei frumentariae toto orbe terrarum daretur, alteram Messius, qui omnis pecuniae dat potestatem et adiungit classem et exercitum et maius imperium in provinciis, quam sit eorum, qui eas obtineant. Illa nostra lex consularis nunc modesta videtur, haec

¹⁰⁹. populus added by Boot.

poor and rich alike to take the matter in hand. He was more than willing; and the people asked me by name to propose it: so I delivered my opinion carefully. As the ex-consuls, except Messalla and Afranius, were absent, thinking it was not safe to record a vote, a decree was passed in accordance with my proposal that Pompey should be appealed to take the matter in hand and a law should be passed. When this bill was read out, the people received the mention of my name with applause after the new silly fashion: and I delivered an harangue, with the permission of all the magistrates present, except one praetor and two tribunes. On the next day there was a full House and all the ex-consuls were willing to grant Pompey anything. He asked for a committee of fifteen, naming me at the head of them and saying that I should count as his second self in everything. The consuls drew up a law giving Pompey the direction of the whole corn supply in the world for five years: Messius another granting him the control of the treasury, and adding an army and a fleet and higher powers than those of the local officials in the provinces. The law we ex-consuls proposed is regarded now as quite moderate, this

¹¹⁰. This the *Oratio cum senatui gratias egit*, and a few lines lower down he refers to

another extant speech, the *Oratio cum populo gratias egit*.

Messi non ferenda. Pompeius illam velle se dicit, familiares hanc. Consulares duce Favonio fremunt; nos tacemus et eo magis, quod de domo nostra nihil adhuc pontifices responderunt. Qui si sustulerint religionem, aream praeclaram habebimus; superficiem consules ex senatus consulto aestimabunt; sin aliter, demolientur, suo nomine locabunt, rem totam aestimabunt.

Ita sunt res nostrae,

“Ut in secundis fluxae, ut in advorsis bonae.”

In re familiari valde sumus, ut scis, perturbati. Praeterea sunt quaedam domestica, quae litteris non committo. Quintum fratrem insigni pietate, virtute, fide praeditum sic amo, ut debeo. Te exspecto et oro, ut matures venire eoque animo venias, ut me tuo consilio egere non sinas. Alterius vitae quoddam initium ordimur. Iam quidam, qui nos absentes defenderunt, incipiunt praesentibus occulte irasci, aperte invidere. Vehementer te requirimus.

of Messius as perfectly intolerable. Pompey says he prefers the former; his friends that he prefers the latter. Favonius is leading the consular party who rebel against it, while I hold my peace, especially as the pontifices at present have given no answer about my house. If they annul the consecration, I shall have a splendid site. The consuls will value the building according to the decree of the Senate; if not, they will pull it down, lease it out in their own name, and reckon up the whole cost.

So my affairs are

“For happy though but ill, for ill not worst.”^[111]

My monetary affairs, as you know, are in an awful muddle: and there are some private matters which I won’t commit to writing. I am devoted to my brother Quintus as his extraordinary affection, virtue and loyalty deserve. I am looking forward to your coming and beg you to come soon, and to come resolved to give me the full benefit of your advice. I am standing at the threshold of a new life. Already those who took my part in my exile are beginning to feel annoyance at my presence, though they disguise it, and to envy me without even taking the trouble to disguise that. I really stand in urgent need of you.

II

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae in. m. Oct.
a. 697*

Si forte
rarius tibi a
me quam a ceteris litterae redduntur,
peto a te, ut id non modo
neglegentiae meae, sed ne
occupationi quidem tribuas; quae etsi

summa est, tamen nulla esse
potest tanta, ut interrumpat iter
amoris nostri et officii mei. Nam, ut
veni Romam, iterum nunc sum
certior factus esse cui darem litteras;
itaque has alteras dedi.

Prioribus tibi declaravi, adventus
noster qualis fuisset, et quis esset
status, atque omnes res nostrae quem
ad modum essent,

“Ut in secundis fluxae, ut in advorsis bonae.”

Post illas datas litteras secuta est
summa contentio de domo. Diximus
apud pontifices pr. Kal. Octobres.
Acta res est accurate a nobis, et, si
umquam in dicendo fuimus aliquid,
aut etiam si numquam alias fuimus,
tum profecto doloris magnitudo vim

II

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Rome, Oct., B.C. 57

I
f I
am a less regular correspondent than
others, please do not lay it to my
carelessness or to my business
either; for, though I am
extraordinarily

[111](#). Shuckburgh aptly borrows this line
from Milton, *P.L.*, II, 224.

busy, no press of work could be
sufficient to break the course of our
affection or of my duty to you. Since
I have come to Rome, this is the
second time that I have heard of a
messenger, and so this is the second
letter I send.

In my former I described the sort
of return I had, my position and the
state of all my affairs:

“For happy though but ill, for ill not worst.”

After I sent that letter, there
followed a great fight about my
house. I delivered a speech^{[\[112\]](#)} before
the pontifices on the 29th of
September. I bestowed great pains on
the matter, and, if ever I had any
oratorical ability, or even if I never

quandam nobis dicendi dedit. Itaque oratio iuventuti nostrae deberi non potest; quam tibi, etiamsi non desideras, tamen mittam cito. Cum pontifices decreissent ita, SI NEQVE POPVLI IVSSV NEQVE PLEBIS SCITV IS, QVI SE DEDICASSE DICERET, NOMINATIM EI REI PRAEFECTVS ESSET NEQVE POPVLI IVSSV AVT PLEBIS SCITU ID FACERE IVSSVS ESSET, VIDERI POSSE SINE RELIGIONE EAM PARTEM AREAE MIHI RESTITVI, mihi facta statim est gratulatio; nemo enim dubitabat, quin domus nobis esset adiudicata: cum subito ille in contionem escendit, quam Appius ei dedit. Nuntiat iam populo pontifices secundum se decrevisse, me autem vi conari in possessionem venire; hortatur, ut se et Appium sequantur et suam Libertatem vi defendant. Hic cum etiam illi infirmi partim admirarentur, partim irriderent hominis amentiam, ego statueram illuc non accedere, nisi

had before, on that occasion at any rate, my great indignation lent some vigour to my style. So its publication is a debt which I must not leave unpaid to the rising generation: and to you I will send it very soon, whether you want it or not. The pontifices decreed that “if the party alleging that he had dedicated had not been appointed by name either by order of the people or vote of the plebs, and if he had not been commanded to do so, either by order of the people or by vote of the plebs then it appeared that that part of the site might be restored to me without sacrilege,” I was congratulated at once, everybody thinking that the house had been adjudged to me. But all of a sudden up gets a man to speak, at Appius’ invitation, and announces that the pontifices have decided in his favour and I am trying to take possession by force: he exhorts them to follow him and Appius and defend their shrine of Liberty. Thereupon, though even those pliable persons were partly lost in wonder and partly laughing at the man’s folly, I determined

[112](#). *De domo sua ad pontifices.*

cum consules ex senatus consulto porticum Catuli restituendam locassent. Kal. Octobr. habetur senatus frequens. Adhibentur omnes pontifices, qui erant senatores. A

not to go near the place until the consuls by decree of the Senate had given out the contract for restoring the porch of Catulus. On the first of October there was a full meeting of

quibus Marcellinus, qui erat cupidissimus mei, sententiam primus rogatus quaesivit, quid essent in decernendo secuti. Tum M. Lucullus de omnium collegarum sententia respondit religionis iudices pontifices fuisse, legis esse senatum; se et collegas suos de religione statuisset, in senatu de lege statuturos cum senatu. Itaque suo quisque horum loco sententiam rogatus multa secundum causam nostram disputavit. Cum ad Clodium ventum est, cupiit diem consumere, neque ei finis est factus, sed tamen, cum horas tres fere dixisset, odio et strepitu senatus coactus est aliquando perorare. Cum fieret senatus consultum in sententiam Marcellini omnibus praeter unum adsentientibus, Serranus intercessit. De intercessione statim ambo consules referre coeperunt. Cum sententiae gravissimae dicerentur, senatui placere mihi domum restitui, porticum Catuli locari, auctoritatem ordinis ab omnibus magistratibus defendi, si quae vis esset facta, senatum existimaturum eius opera factum esse, qui senatus consulto intercessisset, Serranus pertimuit, et Cornicinus ad suam veterem fabulam rediit; abiecta toga se ad generi pedes abiecit. Ille noctem sibi postulavit. Non concedebant, reminiscebantur enim Kal. Ianuar. Vix

the Senate. All the pontifices who were senators were summoned: and Marcellinus, a strong partisan of mine, being called upon first for his opinion, asked them what was the purport of their decree. Then M. Lucullus speaking for all his colleagues answered, that the pontifices had to decide points of religion and the Senate points of law: he and his colleagues had settled the religious point and now in the Senate they would join the other senators in settling the legal point. Accordingly as each of them was called upon in his turn, he delivered a long speech in my favour. When it came to Clodius, he wanted to waste the whole day and spoke on endlessly, but at last, after speaking for nearly three hours, he was forced by the indignant outcry of the Senate to wind up his speech. A decree was passed in accordance with Marcellinus' proposal with only one dissentient voice: and then Serranus put his veto on it. Both consuls at once referred the veto to the Senate, and many resolute speeches were delivered: "that the Senate approved of the restitution of my house," "that a contract should be drawn up for the portico of Catulus," "that the Senate's resolution should be supported by all the magistrates," "that if any violence occurred, the Senate would hold him responsible

who had vetoed its decree.” Serranus showed the white feather and Cornicinus played the same old farce: he threw off his toga and flung himself at his son-in-law’s feet. Serranus demanded a night to think it over. They would not grant it, remembering the first of January. At last with my

tamen tibi de mea voluntate concessum est. Postridie senatus consultum factum est id, quod ad te misi. Deinde consules porticum Catuli restituendam locarunt; illam porticum redemptores statim sunt demoliti libentissimis omnibus. Nobis superficiem aedium consules de consilii sententia aestimarunt sestertio viciens, cetera valde inliberaliter, Tusculanam villam quingentis milibus, Formianum HS ducentis quinquaginta milibus. Quae aestimatio non modo vehementer ab optimo quoque, sed etiam a plebe reprehenditur. Dices: ‘Quid igitur causae fuit?’ Dicunt illi quidem pudorem meum, quod neque negarim neque vehementius postularim; sed non est id: nam hoc quidem etiam profuisset. Verum iidem, mi T. Pomponi, iidem, inquam, illi, quos ne tu quidem ignoras, qui mihi pinnae inciderant, nolunt easdem renasci. Sed, ut spero, iam renascuntur. Tu modo ad nos veni; quod vereor ne tardius

consent the concession was unwillingly made. On the next day the decree which I send was passed. Then the consuls gave out the contract for the restoration of the portico of Catulus; and the contractors immediately pulled down that portico of his to everybody’s satisfaction. The consuls valued my house at nearly £18,000^[113] at their assessor’s advice: and the other things very stingily—my Tusculan villa at £4,400 and my Formian at £2,200.^[114] This estimate was violently decried not only by all the conservative party, but by the people too. If you ask me the reason, they say it was my bashfulness, as I did not refuse or make pressing demands. But that is not the reason; for that in itself would have counted for me. But the fact is, my dear Pomponius, those very same men—you know quite well who I mean—who cut my wings, do not wish them to grow again. But I hope they are growing. Do you only come to me.

interventu Varronis tui nostrique facias.

Quoniam, acta quae sint, habes, de reliqua nostra cogitatione cognosce. Ego me a Pompeio legari ita sum passus, ut nulla re impedirer. Quod nisi vellem mihi esset integrum, ut, si comitia censorum proximi consules haberent, petere possem, votivam legationem sumpsissem prope omnium fanorum, lucorum; sic enim nostrae rationes utilitatis meae postulabant. Sed volui meam potestatem esse vel petendi vel ineunte

But I fear you may be delayed by the visit of your and my friend Varro.

There you have all that has happened. Now you shall dip into my thoughts. I have let myself be appointed legate to Pompey with a reservation that it should not hamper me at all. If I did not want to have a free hand to stand for the censorship, if the next consuls hold a censorial election, I would have taken a votive commission^[115] to nearly any shrines or groves. For that was what suited my idea of my interests best. But I wanted to be free either to stand for election or to quit the city at the beginning of summer and meanwhile I thought it good policy

¹¹³. 2,000,000 sesterces.

¹¹⁴. 500,000 and 250,000 sesterces.

¹¹⁵. Cf. p. ¹⁶³ footnote.

aestate exeundi et interea me esse in oculis civium de me optime meritorum non alienum putavi.

Ac forensium quidem rerum haec nostra consilia sunt, domesticarum autem valde impedita. Domus aedificatur, scis, quo sumptu, qua molestia; reficitur Formianum, quod ego nec relinquere possum nec videre; Tusculanum proscripsi; suburbano facile careo. Amicorum benignitas exhausta est in ea re, quae nihil habuit praeter dedecus, quod sensisti tu absens, nos^[116] praesentes;

to keep myself before the eyes of the citizens who have treated me well.

As regards public affairs those are my plans: but my private affairs are in a horrible muddle. My house is being built and you know the expense and the bother it entails: my Formian villa is being restored, though I cannot bring myself either to abandon it or to look at it. My house at Tusculum I have put up for sale: I can easily do without a suburban residence. My friends'

quorum studiis ego et copiis, si esset
per meos defensores licitum, facile
essem omnia consecutus. Quo in
genere nunc vehementer laboratur.
Cetera, quae me sollicitant,
μυστικώτερα sunt. Amamur a fratre
et a filia. Te exspectamus.

benevolence has been exhausted in
what has brought nothing but
dishonour: this you saw, though you
were absent, and so do I who am on
the spot: and I might have obtained
all I wanted easily from their efforts
and their wealth, if my champions
had allowed it. In this respect I am
now in sore straits. My other
anxieties may not be rashly
mentioned. My brother and daughter
are devoted to me. I am looking
forward to your coming.

III

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae VIII K.
Dec. a. 697*

Avere te
certo scio I
cum scire, quid hic agatur, tum ea a
me scire, non quo certiora sint ea,
quae in oculis omnium geruntur, si a
me scribantur, quam cum ab aliis aut
scribantur tibi aut nuntientur, sed ut
perspicias ex meis litteris, quo animo
ea feram, quae geruntur, et qui sit
hoc tempore aut mentis meae sensus
aut omnino vitae status.

Armatis hominibus ante diem
tertium Nonas Novembres expulsi
sunt fabri de area nostra, disturbata
porticus Catuli, quae ex senatus
consulto consulum

[116](#). nos added by Madvig.

locatione reficiebatur et ad tectum
paene pervenerat, Quinti fratris
domus primo fracta coniectu
lapidum ex area nostra, deinde
inflammata iussu Clodi inspectante
urbe coniectis ignibus, magna
querela et gemitu non dicam
bonorum, qui nescio an nulli sint,
sed plane hominum omnium. Ille

III

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Rome, Nov. 23, B.C. 57

I
am
sure you are wanting to know what
is going on here and to know it from
me too, not that there is any more
certainty about events which take
place before the eyes of the whole
world, if I write to you about them,
than if others either write or tell you
of them: but that you may see from
my letters how I am taking events
and what are my feelings and my
general state of existence.

On the 3rd of November the
workmen were driven out of my
building-ground by armed assault:
the porch of Catulus, which was
being repaired on a contract made by
the consuls in accordance with a
decree of

the Senate, and had nearly got as
high as the roof, was knocked down:
my brother Quintus' house was first
smashed by a discharge of stones
from my plot, and then set on fire
under Clodius' orders by firebrands
hurled before the eyes of the whole
city, amidst the groans and growls—
I will not say of the loyal party,

demens ruere, post hunc vero furorem nihil nisi caedem inimicorum cogitare, viciatim ambire, servis aperte spem libertatis ostendere. Etenim antea, cum iudicium nolebat, habebat ille quidem difficilem manifestamque causam, sed tamen causam; poterat infitiri, poterat in alios derivare, poterat etiam aliquid iure factum defendere; post has ruinas, incendia, rapinas desertus a suis vix iam Decimum designatorem, vix Gellium retinet, servorum consiliis utitur, videt, si omnes, quos vult, palam occiderit, nihilo suam causam difficiliorem, quam adhuc sit, in iudicio futuram. Itaque ante diem tertium Idus Novembres, cum Sacra via descenderem, insecutus est me cum suis. Clamor, lapides, fustes, gladii, haec improvisa omnia. Discessimus in vestibulum Tetti Damionis. Qui erant mecum, facile operas aditu prohibuerunt. Ipse occidi potuit, sed ego diaeta curare incipio, chirurgiae taedet. Ille omnium vocibus cum se non ad iudicium, sed ad supplicium praesens trudi videret, omnes Catilinas

which seems to have vanished out of existence—but simply of every human creature. He was rushing about in a frenzy, thinking of nothing but the slaughter of his enemies after this mad freak, and canvassing the city quarter by quarter, openly promising liberation to slaves. Before this, when he was trying to shirk his trial, he had a case hard indeed to support and obviously wrongful, but still it was a case: he could deny things, he could put the blame on others, he could even plead that he had the right on his side in some respects. But after this wreckage, arson and pillage, his own supporters have left him in the lurch and he hardly has a hold now even on Decimus the marshal, or Gellius: he has to take slaves into his confidence and sees, that if he openly commits all the murders he wishes to commit, his case before the court will not be one whit worse than it is now. So, on the 11th of November, as I was going down the Sacred Way, he followed me with his gang. There were shouts, stones, clubs, swords, all without a moment's warning. We stepped aside into Tettius Damio's hall: and those who were with me easily prevented his roughs from entering. He might have been killed himself: but I have got tired of surgery and am beginning a regime cure. He realized

Acidinos postea reddidit. Nam Milonis domum, eam quae est in Cermalus, pr. Idus Novembr. expugnare et incendere ita conatus est, ut palam hora quinta cum scutis homines eductis gladiis, alios cum accensis facibus adduxerit. Ipse domum P. Sullae pro castris sibi ad eam impugnationem sumpserat. Tum ex Anniana Milonis domo Q. Flaccus eduxit viros acris; occidit homines ex omni latrocinio Clodiano notissimos, ipsum cupivit, sed ille se in interiora^[117] aedium Sullae. Exin senatus postridie Idus. Domi Clodius. Egregius Marcellinus, omnes acres. Metellus calumnia dicendi tempus exemit adiuvante Appio, etiam hercule familiari tuo, de cuius constantia virtute tuae verissimae litterae. Sestius furere. Ille postea, si comitia sua non fierent, urbi minari. Milo, proposita Marcellini sententia, quam ille de scripto ita dixerat, ut totam nostram causam areae, incendiorum, periculi mei iudicio complecteretur eaque omnia comitiis anteferebat, proscripsit se per omnes dies comitiales de caelo servaturum.

that there was a universal outcry not for his prosecution but for his execution, and has since behaved in such a way that a Catiline looks ultraconservative

beside him. For on the 12th of November he attempted to storm and burn Milo's house—the one on the Cermalus—openly bringing men with shields and drawn swords and others with lighted torches to the spot at eleven o'clock in the morning. His own headquarters during the assault were P. Sulla's house. Then Q. Flaccus led forth a gallant band from Milo's family house and slew the most notorious of Clodius' troop of ruffians. He wanted to slay Clodius himself: but he was skulking in the recesses of Sulla's house. There followed a meeting of the Senate on the 14th: Clodius stayed at home: Marcellinus behaved splendidly: and everybody was enthusiastic. Metellus with the assistance of Appius and, mark you, your great friend^[118] of whose constancy you sent me such a veracious account, tried the ruse of talking the time away. Sestius was furious, Clodius afterwards vowed vengeance on the city, if his election did not take place. Marcellinus posted up his resolution which he had in writing when he delivered it—it provided that my entire case should be included in the trial, the

Contiones turbulentae Metelli, temerariae Appi, furiosissimae Publi. Haec tamen summa, nisi Milo in campo obnuntiasset, comitia futura. Ante diem XII Kal. Decembr. Milo ante mediam noctem cum magna manu in campum venit. Clodius, cum haberet

[117.](#) in interiora Orelli: ex interiorem M.

fugitivorum delectas copias, in campum ire non est ausus. Milo permansit ad meridiem mirifica hominum laetitia summa cum gloria. Contentio fratrum trium turpis, fracta vis, contemptus furor. Metellus tamen postulat, ut sibi postero die in foro obnuntietur; nihil esse, quod in campum nocte veniretur; se hora prima in comitio fore. Itaque ante diem XI Kal. in comitium Milo de nocte venit. Metellus cum prima luce furtim in campum itineribus prope deviis currebat: adsequitur inter lucos hominem Milo, obnuntiat. Ille se recepit magno et turpi Q. Flacci convicio. Ante diem X Kal. nundinae. Contio biduo nulla.

attack on my building ground, the arson and the assault on my person, and that all these should precede the election—and Milo gave notice that he intended to watch the sky for omens on all the election days.

Disorderly meetings were held by Metellus, wild meetings by Appius and raging mad meetings by Publius. But the end of it all was that the elections would have taken place, if Milo had not reported evil omens in the Campus Martius. On the 19th of November Milo took up his position in the Campus before midnight with a large force; while Clodius in spite of

[118.](#) Hortensius.

his picked gangs of runaway slaves did not venture to show himself. Milo to the huge delight of everybody and to his own great credit stayed there till midday: and the three brethren's struggle ended in disgrace, their strength broken and their mad pride humbled. Metellus; however, demands that the prohibition should be repeated in the forum on the next day. There was no necessity, he said, for Milo to come to the Campus at night; he would be in the Comitium at six in the morning. So on the 20th Milo went to the Comitium in the early hours of the morning. At daybreak Metellus came sneaking into the Campus by

Ante diem VIII Kal. haec ego scribebam hora noctis nona. Milo campum iam tenebat. Marcellus candidatus ita stertebat, ut ego vicinus audirem. Clodi vestibulum vacuum sane mihi nuntiabatur: pauci pannosi linea lanterna. Meo consilio omnia illi fieri querebantur ignari quantum in illo heroe esset animi, quantum etiam consilii. Miranda virtus est. Nova quaedam divina mitto; sed haec summa est. Comitia fore non arbitror; reum Publium, nisi ante occisus erit, fore a Milone puto; si se in turba ei iam^[119] obtulerit, occisum iri ab ipso Milone video. Non dubitat facere, prae se fert; casum illum nostrum non extimescit. Numquam enim cuiusquam

^{119.} se in turba ei iam *Klotz*: se uti turbae iam *NCZb*: si sentitur veiam *M*.

invidi et perfidi consilio est usus, nec inertis nobili crediturus.

Nos animo dumtaxat vigemus, etiam magis, quam cum florebamur, re familiari comminuti sumus. Quinti

something like byepaths. Milo catches the fellow up “between the groves”^[120] and serves his notice: and he retired amid loud jeers and insults from Q. Flaccus. The 21st was a market-day, and for two days there were no meetings.

It is now three o’clock on the morning of the 23rd as I am writing. Milo has already taken possession of the Campus. Marcellus, the candidate, is snoring loud enough for me to hear him next door. I have just had news that Clodius’ hall is utterly deserted, save for a few rag and bob tails with a canvas lantern. His side are complaining that I am at the bottom of it all: but they little know the courage and wisdom of that hero. His valour is marvellous. I can’t stop to mention some of his new strokes of genius. But this is the upshot: I believe the elections will not be held, and Milo will bring Publius before the bar, unless he kills him first. If he gives him a chance in a riot, I can see Milo will kill him with his own hands. He has got no scruples

^{120.} A spot between the Capitol and the Campus Martius, where Romulus founded his Asylum.

about it and avows his intentions, undeterred by my downfall: for he has never followed the advice of a jealous and treacherous friend, nor trusted in a weak aristocrat.

fratris tamen liberalitati pro So far as my mind is concerned, I
facultatibus nostris, ne omnino am as strong as ever I was even in
exhaustus essem, illo recusante my most palmy days, if not stronger;
subsidiis amicorum respondemus. but my circumstances are straitened.
Quid consilii de omni nostro statu My brother Quintus' liberality I shall
capiamus, te absente nescimus. repay, in spite of his protests, as the
Quare adpropera. state of my finances compels me—
by the aid of friends, so as not
entirely to beggar myself. What
general course of action to adopt I
cannot make up my mind without
your assistance; so make haste.

IV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae III K.
Febr. a. 698*

Periucun
dus mihi
Cincius fuit ante diem III Kal. Febr.
ante lucem; dixit enim mihi te esse
in Italia seseque ad te pueros mittere.
Quos sine meis litteris ire nolui, non
quo haberem, quod tibi, praesertim
iam prope praesenti, scriberem, sed
ut hoc ipsum significarem, mihi
tuum adventum suavissimum
exspectatissimumque esse. Quare
advola ad nos eo animo, ut nos ames,
te amari scias. Cetera coram agemus.
Haec properantes scripsimus. Quo
die venies; utique cum tuis apud me
eris.

IV

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Rome, Jan. 28, B.C. 56

I
wa
s charmed by Cincius' visit on the
28th of Rome. January before
daybreak: for he told me you were in
Italy and he was sending some men
to you. I did not like them to go
without a letter from me—not that I
had anything to write, especially
when you are so near, but that I
might express my delight at your
arrival and how I have longed for it.
So fly to me with the assurance that
your love for me is fully
reciprocated. The rest we will
discuss when we meet. I am writing
in haste. The day you arrive, mind,
you and your party are to accept my
hospitality.

IVa

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Antiati m. Apr.
aut Mai. a. 698*

Perbelle
feceris, si ad
nos veneris. Offendes designationem
Tyrannionis mirificam in librorum
meorum bibliotheca, quorum
reliquiae multo meliores sunt, quam
putaram. Et velim mihi mittas de tuis

librariolis duos aliquos, quibus
Tyrannic utatur glutinatoribus, ad
cetera administris, usque imperes, ut
sumant membranulam, ex qua
indices fiant, quos vos Graeci, ut
opinor, σιλλύβους appellatis. Sed
haec, si tibi erit commodum. Ipse
vero utique fac venias, si potes in his
locis adhaerescere et Piliam
adducere. Ita enim et aequum est et
cupit Tullia. Medius fidius ne tu
emisti λόχον^[121] praeclarum.
Gladiatores audio pugnare mirifice.
Si locare voluisses, duobus his
muneribus liber esses.^[122] Sed haec
posterius. Tu fac venias et de
librariis, si me amas, diligenter.

IVa

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Antium, Apr. or May,
B.C. 56*

I
sha
ll
be delighted if you can pay me a
visit. You will be surprised at
Tyrannio's excellent arrangement in
my library. What is left of it is much
better than I expected: still I should
be glad if you would

send me two of your library slaves
for Tyrannio to employ to glue pages
together and assist in general, and
would tell them to get some bits of
parchment to make title-pieces,
which I think you Greeks call
"sillybi." That is only if it is
convenient to you. In any case mind
you come yourself, if you can stick
in such a place, and bring Pilia with
you. For that is only right and Tullia
wishes her to come. My word! you
have bought a fine troop. I hear your
gladiators are fighting splendidly. If
you had cared to let them out, you
would have cleared your expenses
on these two shows. But of that later.
Be sure you come, and, as you love
me, remember the library slaves.

V

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Antiati m. Apr.
aut Mai. a. 698*

Ain tu?
an me

existimas ab ullo malle mea legi
probarique quam a te? Cur igitur
cuiquam misi prius? Urgebar ab eo,
ad quem misi, et non habebam
exemplar. Quid? Etiam (dudum enim
circumrodo, quod devorandum est)
subturpicula mihi videbatur esse
παλινῳδία. Sed valeant recta, vera,
honesta consilia. Non est credibile,
quae sit perfidia in istis principibus,
ut volunt esse et ut essent, si
quicquam haberent fidei. Senseram,
noram inductus, relictus, proiectus
ab iis. Tamen hoc eram animo, ut
cum iis in re publica consentirem.
Idem erant qui fuerant. Vix
aliquando te auctore resipui. Dices
ea te monuisse, suasisse, quae
facere, non etiam ut scriberem.
Ego mehercule mihi necessitatem
volui

[121.](#) λόχον *Bosius*; locum *M*; ludum *Ernesti*.

[122.](#) liber esses *Pius*; liberasses *M*.

imponere huius novae
coniunctionis, ne qua mihi liceret

V

CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.

*Antium, Apr. or May,
B.C. 56*

Come now, do you really imagine
I prefer my things to be read and
criticized by anyone but you? Then
why did I send them to anyone else
first? The man I sent them to was
very pressing and I had not a copy.
Anything else? Well, yes—though I
keep mouthing the pill instead of
swallowing it—I was a bit ashamed
of my palinode. But good-bye to
honesty, straightforwardness and
uprightness! You would hardly
believe the treachery of our leaders,
as they want to be and would be, if
they had any honour. I knew full
well how they had taken me in,
abandoned me and cast me off. Still I
resolved to stick to them in politics.
But they have proved the same as
ever: and at last I have come to my
senses under your guidance. You will
say your advice applied exclusively
to my actions and did not include
writing too. The fact is, I

wanted to tie myself down to this
new alliance so as to leave myself no

labi ad illos, qui etiam tum, cum misereri mei debent, non desinunt invidere. Sed tamen modici fuimus ὑποθέσει, ut scripsi. Erimus uberiores, si et ille libenter accipiet, et ii subringentur, qui villam me moleste ferunt habere, quae Catuli fuerat, a Vettio emisse non cogitant; qui domum negant oportuisse me aedificare, vendere aiunt oportuisse. Sed quid ad hoc, si, quibus sententiis dixi, quod et ipsi probarent, laetati sunt tamen me contra Pompei voluntatem dixisse? Finis sit. Quoniam, qui nihil possunt, ii me nolunt amare, demus operam, ut ab iis, qui possunt, diligamur. Dices: “Vellem iam pridem.” Scio te voluisse et me asinum germanum fuisse. Sed iam tempus est me ipsum a me amari, quando ab illis nullo modo possum.

Domum meam quod crebro invisit est mihi valde gratum. Viaticum Crassipes praeripit. Tu “de via recta in hortos.” Videtur commodius ad te: postridie scilicet; quid enim tua? Sed viderimus. Bibliothecam mihi tui pinxerunt constructione et sillybis. Eos velim laudes.

chance of slipping back to those who do not cease to envy me, even when they ought to pity me. However, I was quite moderate in my treatment of the subject, as I have said. I will let myself go more, if he takes it well, and those make wry faces who are annoyed to see me occupy a villa which used to belong to Catulus, forgetting that I bought it from Vettius; and who declare I ought not to have built a house, but ought to have sold the site. That however is nothing compared with their unholy joy, when the very speeches I delivered in support of their views were alienating me from Pompey. Let us have an end of it. Since those who have no influence refuse me their affection, I may as well try to win that of those who have some influence. You will say you wish I had before. I know you wished it, and I was a downright ass. But now is the time to show affection for myself, since I cannot get any from them anyhow.

I am very grateful to you for going to see my house so often. Crassipes is swallowing all my travelling money. You say I must go straight to your country house. It seems to me more convenient to go to your town house, and on the next day, it can't make any difference to you. But we shall see. Your men have beautified my library by binding the books and

affixing title-slips. Please thank
them,

VI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in villa m. Apr.
aut Mai. a. 698*

De
Lentulo

scilicet sic fero, ut debeo. Virum
bonum et magnum hominem et in
summa magnitudine animi multa
humanitate temperatum perdidimus
nosque

VI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*At his country house,
Apr. or May, B.C. 56*

The news about Lentulus I feel of course as I ought: we have lost a good man and a fine fellow, and one who combined a remarkable strength of character with great courtesy. Still I find some consolation,

malo solacio, sed non nullo tamen, consolamur, quod ipsius vicem minime dolemus, non ut Saufeius et vestri, sed mehercule quia sic amabat patriam, ut mihi aliquo deorum beneficio videatur ex eius incendio esse ereptus. Nam quid foedius nostra vita, praecipue mea? Nam tu quidem, etsi es natura πολιτικός, tamen nullam habes propriam servitutem, communi frueris nomine^[123]; ego vero, qui, si loquor de re publica, quod oportet, insanus, si, quod opus est, servus existimor, si taceo, oppressus et captus, quo dolore esse debeo? Quo sum scilicet, hoc etiam acriore, quod ne dolere quidem possum, ut non ingratus videar. Quid, si cessare libeat et in otii portum confugere? Nequiquam.

though a poor one, in the thought that I need not grieve for him—not for the same reason as Saufeius and your Epicurean friends, but because he was so true a patriot that it seems as though a merciful providence had snatched him from his country's fiery ruin. For what could be more shameful than the life we are all leading, especially myself? You, in spite of a political bent, have avoided wearing any special yoke; but you share the universal bondage. But think of the sufferings I undergo, when I am taken for a lunatic, if I say what I ought about the State, for a slave, if I say what expediency dictates, and for a cowed and helpless bondsman, if I hold my tongue. I suffer as you may suppose,

Immo etiam in bellum et in castra. Ergo erimus ὅπαδοί, qui ταγοὶ esse noluimus? Sic faciendum est, tibi enim ipsi (cui utinam semper paruissem!) sic video placere. Reliquum iam^[124] est

Σπάρταν ἔλαχες, ταύταν κόσμει.

Non mehercule possum et Philoxeno ignosco, qui reduci in carcerem maluit. Verum tamen id ipsum mecum in his locis commentor, ut ista improbem, idque tu, cum una erimus, confirmabis.

A te litteras crebro ad me scribi video, sed omnes uno tempore accepi. Quae res etiam auxit dolorem

¹²³. frueris nomine *Pius*; fueris nonne *M*.

¹²⁴. reliquum iam *Orelli*; reliquia *M*.

meum. Casu enim trinas ante legeram, quibus meliuscule Lentulo esse scriptum erat. Ecce quartae fulmen! Sed ille, ut scripsi, non miser, nos vero ferrei.

with the added bitterness that I cannot show my grief without seeming ungrateful. Well! why shouldn't I take a rest, and flee to the haven of retirement? I haven't the chance. Then be it war and camp. And so I must be a subaltern, after refusing to be a captain. So be it. That I see is your opinion, and I wish I had always followed your advice. Hobson's choice^[125] is all that is left to me. But upon my soul I can't stomach it, and have a fellow feeling for Philoxenus, who preferred to go back to his prison.^[126] However, I am spending my time here devising a way of confounding their policy, and when we meet you will strengthen my purpose.

I see your letters were written at several times, but I received them all together, and that increased

¹²⁵. Lit. "Sparta has fallen to your lot, do it credit," a phrase denoting that one has no choice. Cf. p. ⁹⁵.

¹²⁶. Philoxenus of Cythera, a dithyrambic poet, was condemned to the quarries for criticizing the literary compositions of Dionysius of Syracuse. He was given a chance of freedom, if he altered his opinion; but preferred to return to the quarries.

my sorrow; for, as it happened, I first read the three in which you said Lentulus was a little better; and then, lo and behold, a thunderbolt in the fourth. Still, as I said, he is out of

Quod me admones, ut scribam illa Hortensiana, in alia incidi non immemor istius mandati tui; sed mehercule in incipiendo refugi, ne, qui videor stulte illius amici intemperiem non tulisse, rursus stulte iniuriam illius faciam inlustrem, si quid scripsero, et simul ne βαθύτης mea, quae in agendo apparuit, in scribendo sit occultior, et aliquid satisfactio levitatis habere videatur. Sed viderimus; tu modo quam saepissime ad me aliquid. Epistulam, Lucceio nunc quam misi, qua, meas res ut scribat, rogo, fac ut ab eo sumas (valde bella est) eumque, ut adproperet, adhorteris et, quod mihi se ita facturum rescripsit, agas gratias, domum nostram, quoad poteris, invisas, Vestorio aliquid significes. Valde enim est in me liberalis.

misery, while we live on in an Iron Age.^[127]

I have not forgotten your advice to write that attack on Hortensius, though I have drifted into other things. But upon my word, I jibbed at the very beginning. I look foolish enough for not submitting to his conduct, outrageous though it was, from a friend, and, if I were to write about it, I fear I should enhance my folly by advertising his insult, while at the same time the self-restraint which I showed in my actions might not be so apparent in writing, and this way of taking satisfaction might seem rather weak. But we will see. Be sure you send me a line as often as you can, and take care you get from Lucceius the letter I sent asking him to write my biography. It is a very pretty bit of writing. Urge him to be quick about it, and give him my thanks for his answer undertaking it. Have a look at my house as often as possible. Say something to Vestorius: he is behaving most liberally to me.

VII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Arpinati m.
Apr. aut Mai. a. 698*

Nihil
εὐκαιρότερο

v epistula tua, quae me sollicitum de Quinto nostro, puero optimo, valde levavit. Venerat horis duabus ante Chaerippus; mera monstra nuntiarat. De Apollonio quod scribis, qui illi di irati! homini Graeco, qui conturbat atque idem putat sibi

licere quod equitibus Romanis.
Nam Terentius suo iure. De Metello

Odyssey xxii, 412

οὐχ ὅσῃ φθιμένοισιν,

sed tamen multis annis civis nemo erat mortuus qui quidem.... Tibi nummi meo periculo sint. Quid enim vereris quemcumque^[128] heredem fecit, nisi Publium fecit. Verum fecit non improbiorem, quam fuit ipse.^[129] Quare in hoc thecam nummariam non retexeris, in aliis eris cautior.

Mea mandata de domo curabis,
praesidia locabis, Milonem

VII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Arpinum, Apr or May,
B.C. 56*

Nothing could be more à propos than your letter, which has relieved me about the dear child Quintus very greatly. Chaerippus had come two hours earlier with the wildest tales. As to your news about Apollonius, confound him! A Greek to go bankrupt and

¹²⁷. *Ferrei*, according to Kayser, contains an allusion to Hesiod's Iron Age: but others take it as simply "callous."

think he has the same privilege as a Roman knight! For of course Terentius was within his rights. As to Metellus "de mortuis nil nisi bonum," still for years no citizen has died who——For your money I will go bail. Why should you fear, whoever he has appointed his heir, unless it were Publius? However, he has chosen an heir no worse than himself: so you won't have to open your coffers over this business, and you will be more careful another time.

admonebis. Arpinatium fremitus est
incredibilis de Laterio. Quid quaeris?
equidem dolui;

Odyssey i, 271

ὁ δὲ οὐκ ἐμπάζετο μύθων.

Quod superest; etiam puerum
Ciceronem curabis et amabis; ut
facis.

You will attend to my instructions
about the house, hire some guards
and give Milo a hint. There is a
tremendous outcry here at Arpinum
about Laterium.^[131] Of course I am
much distressed about it: but “little
he recked my rede.” For the rest,
look after little Quintus with the
affection you always show towards
him.

VIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Anti m. Apr. aut
Mai. a. 698*

Multa me
in epistula
tua delectarunt, sed nihil magis quam
patina tyrotarichi. Nam de
raudusculo quod scribis,

μήπω μέγ' εἴπης, πρὶν τελευτήσαντ' ἴδης.

Aedificati tibi in agris nihil
reperio. In oppido est quiddam, de
quo est dubium, sitne venale, ac
proximum quidem nostris aedibus.
Hoc scito, Antium Buthrotum esse
Romae, ut Corcyrae illud tuum.
Nihil quietius, nihil alsius, nihil
amoenius.

Εἴη μοι οὗτος φίλος οἶκος.^[130]

^{128.} quemcumque editors: quaecunque M.

^{129.} improbiorem quam Müller: improbe
(corr. to improbi) quemquam M. The reading of
the whole passage from qui quidem is very
uncertain.

^{130.} Εἴη—οἶκος Peerlkamp: ΕΙΜΗΙΧΤΩ
ΦΙΛΟC ΚΟC M.

Postea vero quam Tyrannio mihi
libros disposuit, mens addita videtur
meis aedibus. Qua quidem in re
mirifica opera Dionysi et Menophili
tui fuit. Nihil venustius quam illa tua

VIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Antium, Apr. or May,
B.C. 56*

Your letter contained many
delightful passages, but nothing to
beat the “plate of red herrings.” For
as to what you say about the little
debt, “don’t holloa till you are out of
the wood.”^[132]

I can’t find anything like a country
house for you. In the town there is
something, and quite close to me too,
but it is not certain if it is for sale.
Let me tell you that Antium is the
Buthrotum of Rome, and just what
your Buthrotum is to Corcyra.
Nothing could be quieter or fresher
or prettier: “this be my own

^{131.} An estate of Q. Cicero in Arpinum. He
seems to have diverted a watercourse to the
annoyance of his neighbours.

^{132.} Lit. “Do not boast till you see your
enemy dead.” From a lost play of Sophocles.

sweet home.” Since Tyrannio has
arranged my books, the house seems
to have acquired a soul: and your
Dionysius and Menophilus were of
extraordinary service. Nothing could
be more charming than those

pegmata, postquam mi sillybis^[133] bookcases of yours now that the
libros illustrarunt. Vale. Et scribas ad books are adorned with title-slips.
me velim de gladiatoribus, sed ita, Farewell. Please let me know about
bene si rem gerunt; non quaero, male the gladiators: but only if they are
si se gessere. behaving well; if not, I don't want to
know.

VIIIa
CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. auctumno anni
698*

Apenas
vix

discesserat, cum epistula. Quid ais? Putasne fore ut legem non ferat? Dic, oro te, clarius; vix enim mihi exaudisse videor. Verum statim fac ut sciam, si modo tibi est commodum. Ludis quidem quoniam dies est additus, eo etiam melius hic eum diem cum Dionysio conteremus.

De Trebonio prorsus tibi adsentior.
De Domitio

σύκω, μὰ τὴν Δήμητρα, σῦκον οὐδὲ ἐν
οὕτως ὅμοιον γέγονεν,

quam est ista περίστασις nostrae, vel quod ab isdem, vel quod praeter opinionem, vel quod viri boni nusquam; unum dissimile, quod huic merito. Nam de ipso casu nescio an illud melius. Quid enim hoc miserius, quam eum, qui tot annos, quot habet, designatus consul fuerit, fieri consulem non posse, praesertim cum aut solus aut certe non plus quam cum altero petat? Si vero id est, quod nescio an sit, ut non minus longas iam in codicillorum fastis futurorum consulum paginulas habeat quam factorum,

VIIIa

**CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.**

Autumn, B.C. 56

Apenas had hardly gone when your letter came. Really? Do you think he won't propose his law? Pray speak a little more clearly, I hardly think I caught your meaning. But let me know at once, if you possibly can. Well, as they have given an extra day to the games, I shall be all the better contented to spend that day here with Dionysius.

About Trebonius I heartily agree with you. As for Domitius, his *dénouement* was as like mine as two peas; the same persons had a hand in it, it was equally unexpected, and the conservative party deserted us both. There is only one point of difference: he deserved his fate. Perhaps my fall was the less hard to bear. For what could be more humiliating than for one, who all his life long has looked forward to the consulship as his birth-right, to fail to obtain it—and that too when there is no one or at most only one other candidate standing against him? But, if it is true that our friend^[134] has in his

[133](#). *mi sillybis editors: misit M: sit tibi NP: sit tibae Zl.*

quid illo miserius nisi res publica, in qua ne speratur quidem melius quicquam?

De Natta ex tuis primum scivi litteris; oderam hominem. De poëmate quod quaeris, quid, si cupiat effugere? quid? sinas? De Fabio Lusco quod eram exorsus, homo peramans semper nostri fuit nec mihi umquam odio. Satis enim acutus et permodestus ac bonae frugi. Eum, quia non videbam, abesse putabam: audiui ex Gavio hoc Firmano Romae esse hominem et fuisse adsidium. Percussit animum. Dices: “Tantulane causa?” Permulta ad me detulerat non dubia de Firmanis fratribus. Quid sit, quod se a me removet, si modo removet, ignoro.

De eo, quod me mones, ut et πολιτικῶς me geram et τὴν ἑξω^{[135](#)} γραμμὴν teneam, ita faciam. Sed opus est maiore prudentia. Quam a te, ut soleo, petam. Tu velim ex Fabio, si quem habes aditum, odorere et istum convivam tuum degustes et ad me de his rebus et de omnibus cotidie scribas. Ubi nihil erit, quod scribas, id ipsum scribito. Cura ut valeas.

note-books as many pages of names of future consuls as of past, then

[134](#). Pompey.

Domitius has only one rival in his misfortunes—the country which has given up even hoping for better days.

Your letter was the first to give me information about Natta: I could never abide the man. You ask about my poem. Well, what if it wants to take wing? Will you let it? I had begun to mention Fabius Lusco: he was always a great admirer of mine, and I never disliked him, for he was intelligent enough and very worthy and unassuming. As I had not seen him for a long time, I thought he was away: but I hear from this fellow Gavius of Firmum that the man is in Rome and has been here all along. It struck me as odd. You will say it is an insignificant trifle. But he had told me a good many things, of which there was no doubt, about those brothers from Firmum: and what has made him shun me, if he has shunned me, I cannot imagine.

Your advice to act diplomatically and not to steer too close to the wind^{[136](#)} I will follow: but I shall want more than my own stock of wisdom; so, as usual, I shall draw on you. Please scent out anything you can from Fabius, if you can get at him, and suck that guest of yours dry, and write to me every day about

these points and anything else. When you have nothing to write, write and say so. Look after yourself.

IX

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Neapoli IV K.
Mai. a. 699*

Sane
velim scire,
num censum impediunt tribuni
diebus vitiandis (est enim hic rumor)
totaque de censura quid agant, quid
cogitent. Nos hic cum

[135](#). ἔξω Manutius: εἰ M.

IX

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

I
sho
uld

Naples, Apr. 27, B.C.
55

much like to know whether the tribunes are hindering the census by declaring days void—for there is a rumour to that effect—and what is happening about the census in general and what people are

[136](#). Lit. “Keep the outside course” in a chariot race.

Pompeio fuimus. Multa mecum de re publica sane sibi displicens, ut loquebatur (sic est enim in hoc homine dicendum), Syriam spernens, Hispaniam iactans, hic quoque, ut loquebatur; et, opinor, usquequaque, de hoc cum dicemus, sit hoc quasi καὶ τόδε Φωκυλίδου. Tibi etiam gratias agebat, quod signa componenda suscepisses; in nos vero suavissime hercule est effusus. Venit etiam ad me in Cumanum a se. Nihil minus velle mihi visus est quam Messallam consulatum petere. De quo ipso si quid scis, velim scire.

Quod Luceio scribis te nostram gloriam commendaturum, et

thinking. I met Pompey here; and he told me a lot of political news. He was very dissatisfied with himself, as he said—for that is a necessary proviso in his case. Of Syria he expressed a very low opinion, while he runs down^{[137](#)} Spain—with the same proviso “as he said,” which I think must be inserted everywhere when he is mentioned, like the tag “this too is by Phocylides.” To you he expressed his thanks for undertaking the arrangement of the statues, and he laid himself out to be most uncommonly pleasant to me. He even came to visit me in my house at Cumae. The last thing he seemed to wish was that Messalla

aedificium nostrum quod crebro
invisis, gratum. Quintus frater ad me
scripsit se, quoniam Ciceronem
suavissimum tecum haberes, ad te
Nonis Maiis venturum. Ego me de
Cumano movi ante diem v Kal.
Maias. Eo die Neapoli apud Paetum.
Ante diem iiii Kal. Maias iens in
Pompeianum bene mane haec
scripsi.

should stand for the consulship: and
if you have any information on that
point, I should like to know it.

I am most grateful to you for
saying that you will recommend me
as a subject for a panegyric to
Luceius and for your frequent visits
to my house. My brother Quintus has
written that he will pay you a visit on
the 7th of May since you have his
dear child with you. I left my villa at
Cumae on the 26th of April, spent
that night with Paetus at Naples, and
am writing this very early in the
morning of the 27th on my way to
my place at Pompeii.

X

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Cumano IX K.
Mai. a. 699*

Puteolis
magnus est
rumor Ptolomaeum esse in regno. Si
quid habes certius, velim scire. Ego
hic pascor bibliotheca Fausti.
Fortasse tu putabas his

rebus Puteolanis et Lucrinensibus.
Ne ista quidem desunt. Sed
mehercule a ceteris oblectationibus
deseror et voluptatibus propter rem
publicam. Sic litteris sustentor et
recreor maloque in illa tua sedecula,
quam habes sub imagine Aristotelis,
sedere quam in istorum sella curuli
tecumque apud te ambulare quam
cum eo, quocum video esse
ambulandum. Sed de illa
ambulatione fors viderit, aut si qui
est, qui curet, deus; nostram
ambulationem et Laconicum eaque,
quae Cyrea sint, velim, quod poterit,
invisas et urgeas Philotimum, ut
properet, ut possim tibi aliquid in eo
genere respondere, Pompeius in
Cumanum Parilibus venit. Misit ad

X

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Cumae, Apr. 22, B.C.
55*

Puteoli is full of the report that
Ptolemy is restored. If you have
more definite news, I should like to
know it. Here I am feasting on
Faustus'

[137](#). Following Manutius and Tyrrell. Others
however translate *iactans* as "extolling."

library. Perhaps you thought it was
on the attractions of Puteoli and the
Lucrine lakes. Well, I have them too.
But upon my word the more I am
deprived of other enjoyments and
pleasures on account of the state of
politics, the more support and
recreation do I find in literature. And
I would rather be in that niche of
yours under Aristotle's statue than in
their curule chair, and take a walk
with you at home than have the
company which I see will be with
me on my path. But my path I leave
to fate or god; if there be any god
that looks after these things. Please
have a look at my garden path and
my Spartan bath and the other things
which are in Cyrus' province, when

me statim qui salutem nuntiaret. Ad
eum postridie mane vadebam, cum
haec scripsi.

you can, and urge Philotimus to
make haste, so that I may have
something in that line to match
yours. Pompey came to his place at
Cumae on the Parilia: and at once
sent a man to me with his
compliments. I am going to call on
him on the morning following, as
soon as I have written this letter.

XI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Cumano ex. m.
Mai. a. 699*

Delectaru

nt me I

epistulae tuae, quas accepi uno tempore duas ante diem v Kal. Perge reliqua. Gestio scire ista omnia. Etiam illud cuius modi sit, velim perspicias; potes a Demetrio. Dixit mihi Pompeius Crassum a se in Albano exspectari ante diem iii Kal.; is cum venisset, Romam eum^[138] et se statim venturos, ut rationes cum publicanis putarent. Quaesivi, gladiatoribusne. Respondit, antequam inducerentur. Id cuius modi sit, aut nunc, si scies, aut cum is Romam venerit, ad me mittas velim.

^[138]. eum added by Lehmann.

Nos hic voramus litteras cum homine mirifico (ita mehercule sentio) Dionysio, qui te omnesque vos salutat.

Οὐδὲν γλυκύτερον ἢ πάντ' εἰδέναι. Quare ut homini curioso ita perscribe ad me, quid primus dies, quid secundus, quid censores, quid Appius, quid illa populi Appuleia; denique etiam, quid a te fiat, ad me

XI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Cumae, May, B.C. 55

I was delighted with your two letters which I received together on the 26th. Go on with the story. I am longing to hear the whole of it. I should also like you to look into the meaning of this: you can find out from Demetrius. Pompey told me he was expecting Crassus at his house at Alba on the 27th: and as soon as he arrived they were going to Rome together to settle accounts with the tax-gatherers. I asked, "During the show of gladiators?" And he answered, "Before it begins," Please let me know what this means, either at once, if you know, or when he gets to Rome.

I am devouring literature here with that extraordinary person—for upon my soul I really think he is extraordinary—Dionysius, who sends his respects to you and all your family.

"Than universal knowing nought more sweet." So satisfy my curiosity by describing to me all about the first and second days of the show,

velim scribas. Non enim, ut vere loquamur, tam rebus novis quam tuis litteris delector.

Ego mecum praeter Dionysium eduxi neminem, nec metuo tamen, ne mihi sermo desit: ita ab isto puero^[139] delector. Tu Luceio nostrum librum dabis. Demetri Magnetis tibi mitto, statim ut sit, qui a te mihi epistulam referat.

the censors, Appius, and that unsexed Appuleius^[140] of the populace: and finally please let me know what you are doing yourself. For to tell you the truth your letters are as exciting to me as a revolution.

I did not bring anyone away with me except Dionysius; yet I have no fear of feeling the lack of conversation: I find the youth so entertaining. You will give my book to Luceius. I am sending you one by Demetrius of Magnesia, so that there may be a messenger handy to bring back your answer at once.

XII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

Scr. m. Mai. a. 699

Egnatius

Romae est. Sed ego cum eo de re Halimeti vehementer Anti egi. Graviter se acturum cum Aquilio confirmavit. Videbis ergo hominem, si voles. Macroni vix videor praesto esse posse; Idibus enim auctionem Larini video et biduum praeterea. Id tu, quoniam Macronem tanti facis, ignoscas mihi velim. Sed, si me diligis, postridie Kal. cena apud me cum Pilia. Prorsus id facies. Kalendis cogito in hortis Crassipedis quasi in deversorio cenare. Facio fraudem senatus consulto. Inde domum cenatus, ut sim mane

¹³⁹. ita ab isto puero *Madvig*: abs te opere *codd.*

praesto Miloni. Ibi te igitur videbo et permanebo.^[142] Domus te nostra tota salutatur.

XII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

May, B.C. 55

Egnatius is at Rome: but I pleaded Halimetus' cause strongly with him at Antium. He assured me he would speak seriously to Aquilius. You can look him up, if you like. I hardly think I can keep the appointment with Macro: for I see that the auction at Larinum is on the 15th and the two following days. Pray forgive me, since you think so highly of Macro. But as you love me, dine with me on the 2nd, and bring Pilia with you. You absolutely must. On the 1st I am thinking of dining in Crassipes' gardens in lieu of an inn; and so I cheat the senatorial decree.^[141] From there I shall proceed home

¹⁴⁰. Clodius, compared with Appuleius Saturninus.

¹⁴¹. Compelling senators to attend meetings, if in Rome.

after dinner, so as to keep my appointment with Milo in the morning. There then I shall see you, and I will wait till you come. My whole family sends its respects.

XIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Tusculano m.
Nov. post XVII K.
Dec. a. 699*

Nos in
Tusculanum I
venisse a. d. see
you
xvii Kal. Dec video te scire. Ibi
Dionysius nobis praesto fuit Romae
a. d. xiiii Kal. volumus esse. Quid
dico "volumus"? immo vero
cogimur. Milonis nuptiae.
Comitiorum non nulla opinio est.
Ego, ut sit rata,^[143] afuisse me in
altercationibus, quas in senatu factas
audio fero non moleste. Nam aut
defendissem, quod non placeret, aut
defuissem, cui non oporteret. Sed
mehercule velim res istas et
praesentem statum rei publicae, et
quo animo consules ferant hunc
σκυλμόν, scribas ad me quantum
pote. Valde sum ὀξύπεινος, et, si
quaeris, omnia mihi sunt suspecta.
Crassum quidem nostrum minore
dignitate aiunt profectum paludatum
quam olim aequalem eius L. Paulum,
item iterum consulem. O hominem
nequam! De libris oratoriis factum
est a me diligenter. Diu multumque
in manibus fuerunt. Describas licet.
Illud etiam te rogo, τὴν παροῦσαν
κατάστασιν τυπωδῶς, ne istuc
hospes veniam.

XIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Tusculum, after Nov.
14, B.C. 55*

I
see
you
know of my arrival at my Tusculum
villa on the 14th of November. There
I was met by Dionysius. I want to be
back in Rome on the 17th. When I
say want, I mean I have to be in
town for Milo's wedding. There is
some idea of an election. Even if it
has come off, I am not at all sorry to
have missed the disputes which I
hear have taken place in the Senate.
For I should either have had to give
my support against my conscience,
or neglect my bounden duty. But I
hope to goodness you will write me
as full a description as possible of
that affair and of the present state of
politics and tell me how the consuls
are taking all this pother. I am
ravenous for news, and, to tell you
the truth, I suspect everything. They
say our friend Crassus made a less
dignified start^[144] in his uniform than
L. Paulus of old, who rivalled him in
age and in his two consulships. What
a poor thing he is! I have been
working hard at the books on

[142](#). *permanebo Gurlitt: promonebo MSS.*

[143](#). *Ego, ut sit rata Crat. Bosius: ergo et si irata M.*

oratory: and have had them on hand a long time and done a lot to them: you can have them copied. Again I beg you to send me a sketch of the present situation, that I may not feel an utter stranger when I get back.

[144](#). For Syria.

XIV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Cumano m.
Mai. post VI Id. a.
700*

Vestorius
noster me
per litteras

fecit certiore te Roma a. d. VI Idus
Maías putari profectum esse tardius,
quam dixeras, quod minus valuisses.
Si iam melius vales, vehementer
gaudeo. Velim domum ad te scribas,
ut mihi tui libri pateant non secus, ac
si ipse adesses, cum ceteri tum
Varronis. Est enim mihi utendum
quibusdam rebus ex his libris ad eos,
quos in manibus habeo; quos, ut
spero, tibi valde probabo. Tu velim,
si quid forte novi habes, maxime a
Quinto fratre, deinde a C. Caesare, et
si quid forte de comitiis, de re
publica (soles enim tu haec festive
odorari), scribas ad me; si nihil
habebis, tamen scribas aliquid.
Numquam enim mihi tua epistula aut
intempestiva aut loquax visa est.
Maxime autem rogo, rebus tuis
totoque itinere ex sententia confecto
nos quam primum revisas.
Dionysium iube salvere. Cura, ut
valeas.

XIV

CICERO TO ATTICUS GREETING.

*Cumae, after May 10,
B.C. 54*

Our friend Vestorius has informed me by letter that you are believed to have left Rome on the 10th of May, later than you said you would, because you had not been quite well. I sincerely hope you are better now. Would you please write home telling them to give me the run of your books, more especially of Varro, just as though you were there? I shall have to use some passages from those books for the works I have in hand, which I hope will meet with your hearty approval. I should be glad if you would let me know, if you happen to have any news, from my brother Quintus particularly, or from C. Caesar, or anything about the elections and politics—you generally have a pretty scent for such things. If you have no news, write something anyhow: for no letter of yours ever seemed ill-timed or long-winded to me. But above all pray come back as soon as possible, when your business and your tour are completed to your satisfaction. Give

my regards to Dionysius. Take care
of yourself.

XV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae VI K.
Sext. a. 700*

De
Eutychide

gratum, qui vetere praenomine, novo
nomine T. erit Caecilius, ut est ex me
et ex te iunctus Dionysius M.
Pomponius. Valde mehercule mihi
gratum est Eutychidem tuam erga me
benivolentiam

XV

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

I

am

Rome, July 27, B.C. 54

glad to hear about Eutychides. Taking your old name and your new surname, he will be T. Caecilius, just as Dionysius has become M. Pomponius by a combination of yours and mine. It is really a great pleasure to me that Eutychides should know that his freedom is a favour granted on my

cognosse et^[145] suam illam in meo dolore συμπάθειαν neque tum mihi obscuram neque post ingratam fuisse.

Iter Asiaticum tuum puto tibi suscipiendum fuisse; numquam enim tu sine iustissima causa tam longe a tot tuis et hominibus et rebus carissimis et suavissimis abesse voluisses. Sed humanitatem tuam amoremque in tuos reditus celeritas declarabit. Sed vereor, ne lepore suo detineat diutius rhetor^[146] Clodius et homo pereruditus, ut aiunt, et nunc quidem deditus Graecis litteris Pituanus. Sed, si vis homo esse, recipe te ad nos, ad quod tempus

account, and that his sympathy with me in my sorrow was not lost on me at the time nor forgotten afterwards.

I suppose your journey to Asia is inevitable; for you would never want to put such a distance between yourself and all your nearest and dearest friends and possessions without very good reason. But you will show your consideration and your love for your friends by the quickness with which you return. I am however afraid the attractions of the rhetorician Clodius and the reputed deep learning of Pituanus, who just now is devoted to Greek literature, may keep you from

confirmasti. Cum illis tamen, cum salvi venerint, Romae vivere licebit.

Avere te scribis accipere aliquid a me litterarum. Dedi ac multis quidem de rebus ἡμερολογεῶν perscripta omnia; sed, ut conicio, quoniam mihi non videris in Epiro diu fuisse, redditas tibi non arbitror. Genus autem mearum ad te quidem litterarum eius modi fere est, ut non libeat cuiquam dare, nisi de quo exploratum sit tibi eum redditurum.

Nunc Romanas res accipe. A. d. IIII Nonas Quintiles Sufenas et Cato absoluti, Procilius condemnatus. Ex quo intellectum est τρισαρειοπαγίτας ambitum, comitia, interregnum, maiestatem, totam denique rem publicam flocci non facere: debemus patrem familias domi suae occidere nolle, neque tamen id ipsum abunde; nam absolverunt XXII, condemnarunt XXVIII. Publius sane diserto epilogo criminans mentes iudicum commoverat. Hortalus in ea causa fuit,

[145](#). et added by Bücheler.

[146](#). rhetor *Bosius*: praetor *M*¹: p *M*².

cuius modi solet. Nos verbum nullum; verita est enim pusilla, quae nunc laborat, ne animum Publi

returning. But, if you would prove yourself a good man and true, find your way back to us by the date you promised. You can live with them when they get safely to Rome.

You say you are longing for a line of some sort from me. I have written a letter full of news, with everything described as in a diary, but I suppose it was never delivered, as you don't seem to have stopped long in Epirus. Besides my letters are generally not of a kind that I like to give to anyone, unless I can be sure he will deliver them to you.

Now I will tell you the news of the town. On the 4th of July Sufenas and Cato were acquitted, Procilius condemned. That shows us that our lights of the law care not a straw for bribery, elections, a political deadlock, treason or the country in general. They prefer one not to murder a father of a family in his own home; but even that preference has no overwhelming majority in its favour: for 22 voted for acquittal against 28 for condemnation. Publius no doubt had awakened the sympathy of the jury by his eloquent peroration for the prosecution. Hortalus was retained and behaved as usual. I did not utter

a word: for my little girl, who is ill, was afraid I might offend Publius. After all this the people of

offenderem. His rebus actis Reatini me ad sua Τέμπη duxerunt; ut agerem causam contra Interamnates apud consulem et decem legatos, quod lacus Velinus a M'. Curio emissus interciso monte in Nar defluit; ex quo est illa siccata et umida tamen modice Rosia. Vixi cum Axio; qui etiam me ad Septem aquas duxit.

Redii Romam Fontei causa a. d. vii Idus Quinct. Veni spectatum primum magno et aequabili plausu. Sed hoc ne curaris. Ego ineptus, qui scripserim. Deinde Antiphonti operam. Is erat ante manu missus quam productus. Ne diutius pendeas, palmam tulit; sed nihil tam pusillum, nihil tam sine voce, nihil tam.... Verum haec tu tecum habeto. In Andromacha tamen maior fuit quam Astyanax, in ceteris parem habuit neminem. Quaeris nunc de Arbuscula. Valde placuit. Ludi magnifici et grati; venatio in aliud tempus dilata.

Sequere nunc me in campum. Ardet ambitus; σῆμα δέ τοι ἐρέω. Iliad xxiii, 326 Faenus ex triente Idibus Quinctilibus factum erat bessibus. Dices: "Istuc quidem non moleste fero." O virum! o civem! Memmii Caesaris omnes opes confirmant. Cum eo Domitium consules iunxerunt, qua pactione, epistulae committere non audeo, Pompeius fremit, queritur, Scauro

Reate took me to their "banks and braes" to plead their cause against the Interamnates before the consul and ten commissioners, because the Veline lake, drained by the channel cut by M'. Curius through the mountain,^[147] flowed into the Nar. By this means the famous Rosia has been dried up, though it is still moderately damp. I stayed with Axius, who took me for a visit to the Seven Waters too.

For Fonteius' sake I returned to Rome on the 9th of July. I went to the theatre and was greeted with loud and unbroken applause—but don't bother about that: I am a fool to mention it. Then I gave my attention to Antiphon. He was granted his freedom before he appeared: and, not to keep you in suspense, he won his laurels. But there never was such a little weakling with so little voice and so.... But keep that to yourself. However in the Andromache he was taller than Astyanax: among the rest there was no one of his size. You want to know next about Arbuscula: she pleased me very much. The games were magnificent and much liked. The wild beast hunt was put off till later.

Now follow me to the election field. There is an outburst of bribery. More by token, the rate of interest has risen from 4 per cent to 8 per cent since the 15th of July. You will

say: “Well, I can put up with that at any rate.” And you call yourself a man and a patriot! Memmius is supported by all Caesar’s influence. The consuls have coupled him with Domitius in an agreement which I dare not commit to paper. Pompey is raging and growling and backing

[147](#). The passage to the waterfall of Terni, opened in 290 B.C.

studet, sed, utrum fronte an mente, dubitatur. Ἐξοχή in nullo est; pecunia omnium dignitatem exaequat. Messalla languet, non quo aut animus desit aut amici, sed coitio consulum et Pompeius obsunt. Ea comitia puto fore ut ducantur. Tribunicii candidati iurarunt se arbitrio Catonis petitueros. Apud eum HS quingena deposuerunt, ut, qui a Catone damnatus esset, id perderet et competitoribus tribueretur.

Haec ego pridie scribebam, quam comitia fore putabantur. Sed ad te, quinto Kal. Sextil. si facta erunt, et tabellarius non erit profectus, tota comitia perscribam. Quae si, ut putantur, gratuita fuerint, plus unus Cato potuerit quam omnes leges^{[148](#)} omnesque iudices. Messius defendebatur a nobis de legatione revocatus; nam eum Caesari legarat Appius. Servilius edixit, ut adesset. Tribus habet Pomptinam, Velinam, Maeciam. Pugnatur acriter; agitur tamen satis. Deinde me expedit ad

Scaurus; but whether ostensibly or in earnest is more than one can say. None of them is romping ahead: money levels all their ranks. Messalla is not in the running, not that his heart or his friends have failed him, but the coalition of the consuls and Pompey are both against him. I think the elections will have to be postponed. The candidates for the tribunate have taken an oath to submit their conduct to Cato’s approval, and have deposited £4,400^{[149](#)} with him on the condition that any one of them who is condemned by Cato shall lose it and it shall be given to his rivals.

I am writing this the day before the elections are expected to come off. But on the 28th I will give you a full account of them, if they have taken place and the messenger has not started. If they really are conducted without bribery, which people think will be the case, then Cato alone will have done more than

Drusum, inde ad Scaurum. Parantur orationibus indices gloriosi. Fortasse accedent etiam consules designati. In quibus si Scaurus non fuerit, in hoc iudicio valde laborabit.

Ex Quinti fratris litteris suspicor iam eum esse in Britannia. Suspense animo exspecto, quid agat. Illud quidem sumus adepti, quod multis et magnis

[148](#). omnes leges *added by Wesenberg*.

indiciis possumus iudicare, nos Caesari et carissimos et iucundissimos esse. Dionysium velim salvere iubeas et eum roges et hortere, ut quam primum veniat, ut possit Ciceronem meum atque etiam me ipsum erudire.

all the laws and all the law courts can do. I am acting for Messius, who has been recalled from his office. Appius had given him a commission on Caesar's staff: but Servilius issued a warrant requiring his presence. The tribes he has to face are the Pomptine, Veline and Maecian. It is a sharp struggle, however it is getting on fairly well. Then I have to get ready for Drusus and after that for Scaurus. These will make grand titles for my speeches. I may even have the names of the consuls elect to add to the list; and, if Scaurus is not one of them, he will find himself in serious difficulties in this trial.

From my brother Quintus' letters I suspect he is now in Britain, and I am very anxious to know how he is getting on. One point I have certainly gained:

[149](#). 500,000 sesterces.

Caesar has given many strong proofs which assure me of his esteem and affection. Please pay my compliments to Dionysius, and beg and urge him to come as soon as possible and undertake the instruction of my son and of myself too.

XVI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae ex. m. Iun
aut in. Quint. a. 700*

Occupati
onum

mearum vel hoc signum erit, quod epistula librarii manu est. De epistularum frequentia te nihil accuso, sed pleraeque tantum modo mihi nuntiabant, ubi esses: quod erant abs te, vel etiam significabant recte esse. Quo in genere maxime delectarunt duae fere eodem tempore abs te Buthroto datae. Scire enim volebam te commode navigasse. Sed haec epistularum frequentia non tam ubertate sua quam crebritate delectavit. Illa fuit gravis et plena rerum, quam mihi M. Paccius, hospes tuus, reddidit. Ad eam rescribam igitur et hoc quidem primum. Paccio ratione et verbis et re ostendi, quid tua commendatio ponderis haberet. Itaque in intimis est meis, cum antea notus non fuisset.

Nunc pergam ad cetera. Varro, de quo ad me scribis, includetur in aliquem locum, si modo erit locus. Sed nosti genus dialogorum meorum. Ut in oratoriis, quos tu in caelum fers, non potuit mentio fieri cuiusquam ab iis, qui disputant, nisi

XVI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Rome, June or July,
B.C. 54*

The bare fact that my letter is by the hand of an amanuensis will show you how busy I am. I have nothing to grumble about as regards the frequency of your letters, but most of them merely told me where you were. That they were from you showed, too, that you were well. The two of this sort which gave me the most pleasure were those dated almost simultaneously from Buthrotum: for I was anxious to know whether you had a good crossing. But it is more the regularity of this constant supply of letters which has pleased me than the richness of their contents. The one that your guest M. Paccius delivered was of importance and full of matter: so I will answer that. The first thing is that I have shown Paccius, both by word and by deed, the weight a recommendation from you carries. Accordingly he is among my intimate friends now, though I did not know him before.

eius, qui illis notus aut auditus esset,
ita hanc ego, de re publica

Now for the rest. You mention Varro: I will try and get him in somewhere, if I can find a place. But you know the style of my Dialogues: just as in those *On the Orator*, which you laud to the skies, I could not let the interlocutors mention anyone except persons they had known or heard of, so here too in the dialogue *On the Republic* which I have begun, I

quam institui, disputationem in Africani personam et Philii et Laeli et Manili contuli. Adiunxi adulescentes Q. Tuberonem, P. Rutilium, duo Laeli generos, Scaevolam et Fannium. Itaque cogitabam, quoniam in singulis libris utor prohoemiis ut Aristoteles in iis, quos ἐξωτερικοὺς vocat, aliquid efficere, ut non sine causa istum appellarem; id quod intellego tibi placere. Utinam modo conata efficere possim! Rem enim, quod te non fugit, magnam complexus sum et gravem et plurimi otii, quo ego maxime egeo.

Quod in iis libris, quos laudas, personam desideras Scaevolae, non eam temere dimovi: sed fecit idem in πολιτεία deus ille noster Plato. Cum in Piraeum Socrates venisset ad Cephalum, locupletem et festivum senem, quoad primus ille sermo habetur, adest in disputando senex, deinde, cum ipse quoque

have put the discussion in the mouths of Africanus, Philus, Laelius and Manilius, adding the youths Q. Tubero, P. Rutilius and the two sons-in-law of Laelius, Scaevola and Fannius. So I am thinking of contriving some way of mentioning him appropriately—for that I think is what you want—in one of the introductions. I am giving an introduction to each book, as Aristotle does in the work he called the *Exoterics*. And I only hope I may manage to get him in. For as you fully comprehend, I have set my hand to a subject of wide range and of some difficulty, which requires much leisure; and that is precisely what I have not got.

While praising those books, you miss the character of Scaevola from the scene. It was not without good reason that I removed him. Our god Plato did the same in his *Republic*. When Socrates called on that

commodissime locutus esset, ad rem divinam dicit se velle discedere neque postea revertitur. Credo Platonem vix putasse satis consonum fore, si hominem id aetatis in tam longo sermone diutius retinisset. Multo ego magis hoc mihi cavendum putavi in Scaevola, qui et aetate et valetudine erat ea, qua eum esse meministi, et iis honoribus, ut vix satis decorum videretur eum plures dies esse in Crassi Tusculano. Et erat primi libri sermo non alienus a Scaevolae studiis, reliqui libri τεχνολογίαν habent, ut scis. Huic ioculatorem senem illum, ut noras, interesse sane nolui.

De re Piliae quod scribis, erit mihi curae. Etenim est luculenta res Aureliani, ut scribis, indiciis. Et in eo me etiam Tulliae meae venditabo. Vestorio non desum. Gratum enim tibi id esse intellego et, ut ille intellegat, curo. Sed scis, qui. Cum habeat duo faciles, nihil difficilior.

Nunc ad ea, quae quaeris de C. Catone. Lege Iunia et Licinia scis

wealthy and cheery old soul Cephalus in the Piraeus, the old man takes part in the discussion during the introductory conversation; but after a very neat speech, he pleads that he wants to go to a divine service, and does not come back again. I fancy Plato thought it would have been inartistic to keep a man of that age any longer in so lengthy a discussion. I thought there was still more reason to be careful in the case of Scaevola, who was at the age and in the state of health in which you must remember he was, and was crowned with such honours that it would hardly have been proper for him to spend several days with Crassus at his villa at Tusculum. Besides, the talk in the first book was not unconnected with Scaevola's pursuits: while the remaining books contained a technical discussion, as you know. In such I did not like the merry old man, you remember, to take a part.

In Pilia's business I will be sure to do what you suggest: for, as you say, the point is quite clear on Aurelianus' evidence. And it will give me a chance of glorifying myself in my Tullia's eyes. I am supporting Vestorius: for I see you regard it as a favour, and I make him see it too. But you know the kind of man he is: frightfully difficult to get

absolutum; Fufia ego tibi nuntio absolutum iri neque patronis suis tam libentibus quam accusatoribus. Is tamen et mecum et cum Milone in gratiam rediit. Drusus reus est factus a Lucretio. Iudicibus reiciendis dies est dictus^[150] a. d. v Non. Quinct. De Procilio rumores non boni, sed indicia nosti. Hirrus cum Domitio in gratia est. Senatus consultum, quod hi consules de provinciis fecerunt, QVICVMQVE POSTHAC—, non mihi videtur esse valiturum.

xvii, 2

De

Messalla quod quaeris, quid scribam, nescio. Numquam ego vidi tam pares candidatos. Messallae copias nosti. Scaurum Triarius reum fecit. Si quaeris, nulla est magno opere commota συμπάθεια, sed tamen habet aedilitas eius memoriam non ingratam, et est pondus apud rusticos in patris memoria. Reliqui duo plebei sic exaequantur, ut Domitius valeat amicis, adiuvetur tamen non nihil^[151] gratissimo munere, Memmius Caesaris commendetur militibus, Pompei Gallia nitatur. Quibus si non valuerit, putant fore aliquem,

¹⁵⁰. dies est dictus, *added by Madvig.*

¹⁵¹. nihil *added by Wesenberg.*

on with, even for two such easy-going people.

Now for your questions about C. Cato. You know he was acquitted under the Junian and Licinian law. The Fufian law will acquit him too, I assure you, and that as much to the relief of his accusers as of his supporters. However, he has made his peace with Milo and myself. Drusus is being prosecuted by Lucretius. The day for challenging the jury is fixed for the 3rd of July. About Procilius there are sinister rumours: but you know what juries are. Hirrus is on good terms with Domitius. The decree which these consuls have carried about the provinces, “whosoever henceforth,” etc., I do not think will have any effect.

I don’t know what to say to your question about Messalla: I have never seen candidates more evenly matched. You know Messalla’s support. Scaurus has been called into court by Triarius; without any great sympathy for him being aroused, if you want to know. However his aedileship recalls no unpleasant memories, and their remembrance of his father has some weight with the country voters. The other two plebeian candidates are about equal, as Domitius is strong in friends and his very popular gladiatorial exhibition will count for him too,

while Memmius is popular with Caesar's soldiers and relies on the support of Pompey's Gaul. If that does not avail him,

qui comitia in adventum Caesaris detrudat, Catone praesertim absoluto.

xvi, 15

Paccianae epistulae respondi. Nunc te obiurgari patere, si iure. Scribis enim in ea epistula, quam C. Decimius mihi reddidit Buthroto datam, in Asiam tibi eundum esse te arbitrari. Mihi mehercule nihil videbatur esse, in quo tantulum interesset utrum per procuratores ageres an per te ipsum, ut a tuis^[152] totiens et tam longe abesses. Sed haec mallet integra re tecum egissem, profecto enim aliquid egissem. Nunc reprimam susceptam obiurgationem. Utinam valeat ad celeritatem reditus tui!

Ego ad te propterea minus saepe scribo, quod certum non habeo, ubi sis aut ubi futurus sis; huic tamen nescio cui, quod videbatur isti te visurus esse, putavi dandas esse litteras. Tu, quoniam iturum te in Asiam esse putas, ad quae tempora te exspectemus, facias me certiozem velim, et de Eutychide quid egeris.

XVII [XVIII]

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae K. Oct. a.
700*

Puto te
existimare

me nunc oblitum consuetudinis et
instituti mei rarius ad te scribere,
quam solebam; sed, quoniam loca et
itinera tua nihil habere certi video,
neque in Epirum neque Athenas
neque in Asiam cuiquam nisi ad te
ipsum proficiscenti dedi litteras.
Neque enim sunt epistolae nostrae
eae quae si perlatae non sint, nihil ea
res nos offensura sit; quae tantum
habent mysteriorum, ut eas ne
librariis

[152](#). ut a tuis *Boot*: mutabis *M*.

it is thought some one will block the elections till Caesar's return, especially since Cato's acquittal.

There, I have answered the letter Paccius brought. Now you must let me scold you, if you deserve it. In the letter dated from Buthrotum which was delivered by C. Decimius, you say you think you will have to go to Asia. For the life of me I cannot see any reason why it should make the least little bit of difference whether you act by proxy or in person; nor why you should so often go to such out of the way places. But I wish I had tackled you about it before you had taken any steps: then I should certainly have had some influence. As it is, I will keep the rest of my scolding for another time. I only hope it may prevail on you to return quickly.

The reason why I write so seldom to you is that I do not know where you are or are going to be. But as there was some one or other who thought he might see you, I decided to give him this letter. Since you think of going to Asia, let me know when we may expect you back and what you have done about Eutychides.

XVII [XVIII]

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

I

sup

Rome, Oct. 1, B.C. 54

pose you think I have forgotten my old custom and rule and write less frequently than I used; but the fact is that I have not given letters to anyone going to Epirus or Athens or Asia, unless he was going expressly to you, because there was no certainty where you were or where you were going. For our letters are not such that it would do no harm to us, if they are not delivered. They are so full of

quidem fere committamus,
lepidum quid ne^[153] quo excidat.

Consules flagrant infamia, quod C. Memmius candidatus pactionem in senatu recitavit, quam ipse et suus competitor Domitius cum consulibus fecisset, uti ambo HS quadragena consulibus darent, si essent ipsi consules facti, nisi tres augures dedissent, qui se adfuisse dicerent, cum lex curiata ferretur, quae lata non esset, et duo consulares, qui se dicerent in ornandis provinciis consularibus scribendo adfuisse, cum omnino ne senatus quidem fuisset.

secrets that we cannot even trust an amanuensis as a rule, for fear of some jest leaking out.

The consuls' infamy has had a lurid light thrown on it owing to C. Memmius, one of the candidates, reading out in the Senate an agreement made by himself and his fellow-candidate Domitius with them. If they were elected to the consulship, they were both to give the consuls £350 each, if they did not produce three augurs who would depose that they were present at the carrying of a *lex curiata*—which had

Haec pactio non verbis, sed nominibus et perscriptionibus multorum tabulis cum esse facta diceretur, prolata a Memmio est nominibus inductis auctore Pompeio. Hic Appius erat idem. Nihil sane iacturae. Corruerat alter, et plane, inquam, iacebat. Memmius autem dirempta coitione invito Calvino plane refrixerat, et eo magis nunc xvi, 6 totus iacet, [\[154\]](#) quod iam intellegebamus enuntiationem illam Memmi valde Caesari displicere. Messalla noster et eius Domitius competitor liberalis in populo valde fuit. Nihil gratius. Certi erant consules. At senatus decrevit, ut tacitum iudicium ante comitia fieret ab iis consiliis, quae erant omnibus sortita, in singulos candidatos. Magnus timor candidatorum. Sed quidam iudices, in his Optimus,

[153.](#) quid ne *added by Tyrrell.*

[154.](#) totus iacet *Reid: cociace M.*

never been passed; and two ex-consuls who would depose to having been present at the drafting of a decree for the fitting out of the consular provinces—though there had never been any meeting of the Senate about it at all. As this compact was alleged not to be a mere verbal compact, but one properly drawn up with the sums promised on it, drafts on the bank, and many other documents, Memmius exhibited it, with all the items entered, [\[155\]](#) on the suggestion of Pompey. It was all the same to Appius: he had nothing to lose by it. The other has had a sad comedown, and I may say is quite done for. Memmius, however, having dissolved the coalition against Calvinus' will, has sunk out of mind, and his ruin is all the more irretrievable because we know now that his disclosure annoyed Caesar very much. Our friend Messalla and his fellow-competitor Domitius were very liberal to the people, and could not be more popular. They are certain of election. But the Senate has decreed that a trial with closed doors should be held before the elections, and each candidate's conduct inquired into by the panels chosen by lot for all of them. The candidates are in a great fright: but some of the jury—among

[155.](#) Or "cancelled."

Veiento, Rantius, tribunos pl. appellarunt, ne iniussu populi iudicarent. Res cedit; comitia dilata ex senatus consulto, dum lex de tacito iudicio ferretur. Venit legi dies. Terentius intercessit. Consules, qui illud levi brachio egissent, rem ad senatum detulerunt. Hic Abdera non tacente me. Dices: "Tamen tu non quiescis?" Ignosce, vix possum. Verum tamen quid tam ridiculum? Senatus decreverat, ne prius comitia haberentur, quam lex lata esset; si qui intercessisset, res integra referretur. Coepta ferri leviter, intercessum non invitis, res ad senatum. De ea re ita censuerunt, comitia primo quoque tempore haberi esse e re publica.

xvi, 7

Scaurus, qui erat paucis diebus illis absolutus, cum ego partem eius ornatissime defendissem, obnuntiationibus per Scaevolam interpositis singulis diebus usque ad pr. Kal. Octobr., quo ego haec die scripsi, sublatis populo tributim domi suae satis fecerat. Sed tamen, etsi uberior liberalitas huius, gratior esse videbatur eorum, qui occuparant. Cuperem vultum videre tuum, cum haec legeres; nam profecto spem habes nullam haec negotia multarum nundinarum fore. Sed senatus hodie fuerat futurus, id est Kal. Octobribus; iam enim luciscit. Ibi loquetur praeter

them Opimus, Veiento, and Rantius—have appealed to the tribunes to prevent their being called upon to serve without the sanction of the people. The affair is going on. A senatorial decree postponed the elections until an enactment about the trial with closed doors was carried. The day for that enactment came, and Terentius vetoed it. The consuls, who were taking the matter very coolly, referred the point to the Senate. Thereupon there was Bedlam, and I contributed my share of noise. You will say: "Can you never hold your tongue?" Forgive me: I hardly can. But could anything be more ridiculous? The Senate had passed a decree that the elections should not be held before that enactment was passed: if it was vetoed, then the matter should be brought forward again. The law was brought forward casually; it was vetoed to the satisfaction of the proposers; the matter was referred to the Senate: and they decided that it was to the interest of the State that the elections should be held as soon as possible.

Scaurus, who was acquitted in the last few days, after a most elaborate speech from me in his defence, gave the requisite donations to the people tribe by tribe at his own house, since all the days up to the last of September, on which I am writing,

had been rendered impossible for the elections by ill omens announced by Scaevola. But though his liberality exceeded theirs, those who came first won the most popularity. I should like to see your face as you read this. For of course you have no hope that the business will be protracted over many weeks. But there is going to be a meeting of the Senate on the first of October, to-day, for the day is already breaking. There no one will speak boldly except Antius and

Antium et Favonium libere nemo; nam Cato aegrotat. De me nihil timueris, sed tamen promitto nihil.

vi, 8

Quid quaeris aliud? Iudicia, credo. Drusus, Scaurus non fecisse videntur. Tres candidati fore rei putabantur, Domitius a Memmio, Messalla a Q. Pompeio Rufo, Scaurus a Triario aut a L. Caesare. "Quid poteris," inquires, "pro iis dicere?" Ne vivam, si scio; in illis quidem tribus libris, quos tu dilaudas, nihil reperio.

xvi, 13

Cognosce cetera. Ex fratris litteris incredibilia quaedam de Caesaris in me amore cognovi, eaque sunt ipsius Caesaris uberrimis litteris confirmata. Britannici belli exitus expectatur; constat enim aditus insulae esse muratos^[156] mirificis molibus. Etiam illud iam cognitum est, neque argenti

Favonius: Cato is ill. You need not be afraid for me, but I won't promise anything.

What else do you want to know? Oh! the trials, I suppose. Drusus and Scaurus are thought to be innocent. Three candidates will probably be prosecuted, Domitius by Memmius, Messalla by Q. Pompeius Rufus, Scaurus by Triarius or L. Caesar. What shall I be able to find to say for them, you will ask. May I die, if I know. Certainly I find no suggestions in those three books you praise so highly.

Here is the other news. From my brother's letters I hear that Caesar shows signs of extraordinary affection for me, and this is confirmed by a very cordial letter from Caesar himself. The result of the war in Britain is looked forward

scripulum esse ullum in illa insula neque ullam spem praedae nisi ex mancipiis; ex quibus nullos puto te litteris aut musicis eruditos exspectare.

xvi, 14

Paulus in medio foro basilicam iam paene refecit isdem antiquis columnis; illam autem, quam locavit, facit magnificentissimam. Quid quaeris? nihil gratius illo monumento; nihil gloriosius. Itaque Caesaris amici, me dico et Oppium, dirumparis licet, in monumentum illud, quod tu tollere laudibus solebas, ut forum laxaremus et usque ad atrium Libertatis explicaremus, contempsimus sexcenties HS; cum privatis

[156](#). *muratos Junius, Tyrrell: miratos M: munitos E.*

non poterat transigi minore pecunia. Efficiemus rem gloriosissimam; nam in campo Martio saepta tributis comitiis marmorea sumus et tecta facturi eaque cingemus excelsa porticu, ut mille passuum conficiatur. Simul adiungetur huic operi villa etiam

to with anxiety. For it is proved that the approach to the island is guarded with astonishing masses of rock, and it has been ascertained too that there is not a scrap of silver in the island, nor any hope of booty except from slaves; but I don't fancy you will find any with literary or musical talents among them.

Paulus has almost reached the roof of his colonnade in the Forum. He has used the same old columns, but has executed most magnificently the part he put out on contract. It goes without saying that a monument like that will win for him more popularity and glory than anything. And so we friends of Caesar—myself and Oppius I mean, though you may explode with wrath at my confession—have thought nothing of spending half a million of money^[157] for that public work of which you used to speak so enthusiastically, the extension of the Forum and continuation of it as far as the Hall of Liberty. We could not

[157](#). 60,000,000 sesterces.

satisfy the private owners with less; but we will make it a most magnificent affair. In the Campus Martius we are going to make polling-barriers of marble for the tribal assemblies, roof them over, and surround them with a lofty colonnade a mile in circumference.

publica. Dices: "Quid mihi hoc monumentum proderit?" At quid id laboramus? Habes res Romanas. Non enim te puto de lustris, quod iam desperatum est, aut de iudiciis, quae lege Coctia fiant, quaerere.

And at the same time we shall join this to the Villa Publica. You will ask "What advantage shall I derive from the work?" But we need not go into that now. That is all the public news. For I don't suppose you will want to hear about the lustration which is given up in despair, or about the trials which are taking place in accordance with the Coctian law.

XVIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

xvi, 9

*Scr. Romae ex. m.
Oct. a. 700*

... Nunc

ut
opinionem

habeas rerum, ferendum est. Quaeris, ego me ut gesserim. Constanter et libere. “Quid? ille,” inquires, “ut ferebat?” Humaniter meaeque dignitatis, quoad mihi satis factum esset, habendam sibi rationem putabat. Quo modo ergo absolutus? Omnino γοργεῖα γυμνά.^[158] Accusatorum incredibilis infantia, id est L. Lentuli L. f., quem fremunt omnes praevaricatum, deinde Pompei mira contentio, iudicum sordes. Ac tamen XXXII condemnarunt, XXXVIII absolverunt. Iudicia reliqua impendent. Nondum xvi, 10 est plane expeditus. Dices: “Tu ergo haec quo modo fers?” Belle mehercule et in eo me valde amo. Amisimus, mi Pomponi, omnem

^{158.} γοργεῖα γυμνά *Bosius:*
ΠΟΡΠΑΠΥΜΝΑ Μ.

XVIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Rome, Oct., B.C. 54

So now, to give you my opinion on affairs, we have got to put up with them. You want to know how I behaved. With firmness and boldness. You will ask how Pompey took things. Quite kindly, evidently thinking he must consider my dignity until satisfaction had been paid to me. How did Gabinius come to be acquitted then? It was simply a puppet show: the behaviour of the accusers—that is to say of L. Lentulus, the younger, who is being universally accused of collusion—was incredibly infantile: Pompey exerted his influence energetically: and the jury were a rotten lot. Still 32 voted for condemnation and 38 for acquittal. Other trials are hanging over his head: he is not out of the wood yet. You will say: “How then do you take it?” Quite coolly, upon my word, and I congratulate myself thereon. The State, my dear Pomponius, has lost not only its sap and blood,

non modo sucum ac sanguinem, sed etiam colorem et speciem pristinam civitatis. Nulla est res publica, quae delectet, in qua acquiescam. “Idne igitur,” inquires; “facile fers?” Id ipsum; recorder enim, quam bella paulisper nobis gubernantibus civitas fuerit, quae mihi gratia relata sit. Nullus dolor me angit unum omnia posse; dirumpuntur ii, qui me aliquid posse doluerunt. Multa mihi dant solacia, nec tamen ego de meo statu demigro, quaeque vita maxime est ad naturam, ad eam me refero, ad litteras et studia nostra. Dicendi laborem delectatione oratoria consolor; domus me et rura nostra delectant; non recordor, unde ceciderim, sed unde surrexerim. Fratrem mecum et te si habebo, per me isti pedibus trahantur; vobis ἐμφιλοσοφῆσαι possum. Locus ille animi nostri, stomachus ubi habitabat olim, concalluit; privata modo et domestica nos delectant. Miram securitatem videbis; cuius plurimae mehercule partes sunt in tuo reditu; nemo enim in terris est mihi tam consentientibus sensibus.

xvi, 11

Sed accipe alia. Res fluit ad interregnum, et est non nullus odor dictaturae, sermo quidem multus; qui etiam Gabinium apud timidos iudices adiuvit. Candidati consulares omnes rei ambitus. Accedit etiam Gabinius;

but even all its old colour and outward semblance. There is in fact no Republic to give one a feeling of joy and peace. “And is that what you find so comfortable?” you may ask. That is the very thing. For I remember its glory during the little while when I directed it, and the return that was paid me. It does not cost me a pang to see one man omnipotent: but those who were annoyed at my small power are bursting with indignation. There are many things which bring consolation to me without my stirring from my original position; and I am returning to the life which suits my nature best, to literature and my studies. For the labour of pleading I console myself by my delight in oratory. I find pleasure in my town house and my country houses. I think not of the height from which I have fallen, but of the depths from which I have risen. If I have but my brother and you with me, they may be hanged drawn and quartered for all I care: I can study philosophy with you. That part of my soul which used to harbour wrath has lost its power of feeling. Now only my private and personal affairs interest me. You will find me in a wonderfully peaceful state of mind, and upon my word your return is a great factor in my peace: for there is no one in the

quem P. Sulla non dubitans, quin foris esset, postularat contra dicente et nihil obtinente

world whose spirit so harmonizes with my own.

But now I will tell you the other news. Things are drifting towards an interregnum: and a dictatorship is in the air. There is a great deal of talk about it, which helped Gabinius with timid jurors. All the candidates for the consulship are accused of bribery. Gabinius is with them too. P. Sulla applied for the prosecution of him, suspecting that he would be too out of pocket to bribe a jury. Torquatus applied too

Torquato. Sed omnes absolventur, nec posthac quisquam damnabitur, nisi qui hominem Occident. Hoc tamen agitur severius, itaque indicia calent. M. Fulvius Nobilior condemnatus est; multi alii urbani ne respondent quidem.

xvi, 12

Quid

aliud novi? Etiam. Absolute Gabinio stomachantes alii iudices hora post Antiochum Gabinium nescio quem e Sopolidis pictoribus libertum, accensum Gabini, lege Papia condemnarunt. Itaque dixit statim resp. lege maiestatis ΟΥΣΟΙΜΠΙΣΑΜΑΦΙΗΙ. Pomptinus vult a. d. IIII Non. Novembr. triumphare. Huic obviam Cato et Servilius praetores ad portam et Q. Mucius tribunus. Negant enim latum de imperio, et est latum hercule insulse. Sed erit cum Pomptino

but did not obtain it. But they will all be acquitted, and in future no one will be condemned except for homicide. That charge is being severely dealt with and so informers are busy. M. Fulvius Nobilior has been condemned: and a number of others are polite enough not even to answer the charge.

Any other news? Yes. An hour after the acquittal of Gabinius another jury in indignation condemned some one called Antiochus Gabinius, out of Sopolis' studio, a freedman and attendant of Gabinius, under the Papian law. He at once said "So the State will not acquit me of treason as it did you."^[159]

Pomptinus wants to celebrate his triumph on the 2nd of November. He is openly opposed by the praetors

Appius consul. Cato tamen adfirmat se vivo illum non triumphaturum. Id ego puto ut multa eiusdem ad nihil recasurum. Appius sine lege suo sumptu in Ciliciam cogitat.

xvii, 3

A Quinto fratre et a Caesare accepi a. d. viii Kal. Nov. litteras datas a litoribus Britanniae proximis a. d. vi Kal. Octobr. Confecta Britannia, obsidibus acceptis, nulla praeda, imperata tamen pecunia exercitum ex Britannia reportabant. Q. Pilius erat iam ad Caesarem profectus. Tu, si aut amor in te est nostri ac tuorum aut ulla veritas, aut etiam si sapis ac frui

tuis commodis cogitas, adventare et prope adesse iam debes. Non mehercule aequo animo te careo; te autem quid mirum, qui Dionysium tanto opere desiderem? Quem quidem abs te, cum dies venerit, et

Cato and Servilius and the tribune Q. Mucius, who declare that no authority was ever given for a triumph: and it certainly was given in the most absurd manner. However Pomptinus will have the consul Appius on his side. Cato declares he shall never triumph as long as he lives. I fancy it will all come to nothing like most similar affairs. Appius is thinking of going to Cilicia without authority and at his own expense.

On the 24th of October I received a letter from my brother Quintus and from Caesar, dated from the nearest point on the coast of Britain on the 25th of September. Britain is settled, hostages taken, no booty, but a tribute imposed; and they are bringing back the army from the place. Q. Pilius was just on his way to Caesar. If you have any affection for me and your family, if any trust can be put in your word, nay, if you have any sense and want to enjoy your

[159](#). The Greek words here are corrupt. The translation follows Schuckburgh's emendation οὐ σοί κεν ἄρ' ἴσά μ' ἀφείη.

blessings, you ought to be on your way home and very close at hand too. Upon my word, I cannot endure your absence. And what wonder that I want you, when I miss Dionysius so much? Him both I and little

ego et Cicero meus flagitabit. Abs te Marcus shall demand from you at the
proximas litteras habebam Epheso a. proper time. The last letter I had
d. v Idus Sextil. datas. from you was posted from Ephesus
on the 9th of August.

XIX [XVII]

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Romae ex. m.
Nov. a. 700*

O
exspectatas

mihi tuas litteras! o gratum
adventum! o constantiam promissi et
fidem miram! o navigationem
amandam! quam mehercule ego
valde timebam recordans superioris
tuae transmissionis δέπρεις. Sed, nisi
fallor, citius te, quam scribis, videbo.
Credo enim te putasse tuas mulieres
in Apulia esse. Quod cum secus erit,
quid te Apulia moretur? Num
Vestorio dandi sunt dies et ille
Latinus ἄττικισμὸς ex intervallo
regustandus? Quin tu huc advolas et
invisis illius nostrae rei publicae
germanae imaginem.^[160] Disputavi
de nummis ante comitia tributim uno
xviii, 3 loco divisis
palam, inde absolutum Gabinium:
remp. in^[161] dictaturam ruere^[162]
iustitio et omnium rerum licentia.
Perspice aequitatem animi mei et
lauda meam^[163] contemptionem
Seleucianae provinciae et mehercule
cum Caesare suavissimam
coniunctionem (haec enim me una
ex hoc naufragio tabula delectat); qui
quidem

XIX [XVII]

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Rome, Nov., B.C. 54

How I have longed for this letter!
And how glad I am to hear of your
arrival! You have kept your promise
with marvellous exactitude and
fidelity. What a charming voyage!
Of that I was really very much
afraid, remembering the fur-coats of
your former crossing. But, unless I
am mistaken, I shall see you earlier
than you say. I fancy you think your
ladies are still in Apulia. That is not
the case, so there will be nothing to
keep you there. You surely wont
throw days away on Vestorius and
have another taste of his Latin Greek
after all this interval. Fly hither
rather, and visit the remains of what
was once our genuine Republic. I
have discussed the open bribery of
the people tribe by tribe before the
elections, and the consequent
acquittal of Gabinius. Things are
tending to a dictatorship, what with
the deadlock and the general licence.
Observe my placidity and praise my
contempt for the Seleucinian
province,^[164] and my really delightful
association with Caesar. That is the

[160.](#) imaginem added by Wesenberg.
disputavi *Madvig*: putavi *MSS*.

[161.](#) remp. in added by *Madvig*.

[162.](#) ruere *Madvig*: frueri *M*.

[163.](#) lauda meam *Boot*: ludum et *M*.

Quintum meum tuumque, di boni!
quem ad modum tractat honore,
dignitate, gratia! non secus ac si ego
essem imperator. Hiberna legionis
eligendi optio delata commodum, ut
ad me Quintus scribit. Hunc tu non
ames? quem igitur istorum?

Sed heus tu! scripseramne tibi me
esse legatum Pompeio et extra
urbem quidem fore ex Idibus
Ianuariis? Visum est hoc mihi ad
multa quadrare. Sed quid plura?
Coram, opinor, reliqua, ut tu tamen
aliquid exspectes. Dionysio
plurimam salutem; cui quidem ego
non modo servavi, sed etiam
aedificavi locum. Quid quaeris? ad
summam laetitiam meam, quam ex
tuo reditu capio, magnus illius
adventus cumulus accedit. Quo die
ad me venies, fac ut, si me amas,
apud me cum tuis maneas.

one plank left in this shipwreck to
delight my eyes. Heavens! how he
does load

[164.](#) The whole of this passage is very
doubtful, and the reference in *Seleucianae*
provinciae is unknown.

your and my Quintus with
honours and dignities and favours!
Just as though I were a commander-
in-chief. The choice of any of the
army winter-quarters has just been
given him, as Quintus writes me. If
one does not fall in love with such a
man, which of the others could one
fall in love with?

By the bye, had I told you I am on
Pompey's staff, and from the 13th of
January shall not be in Rome? It
seemed to me to square with a good
many things. I need not say more. I
think I will leave the rest till we meet
to give you something to look
forward to. My best respects to
Dionysius. I have not merely kept a
place for him; I have built one. In
fact his coming will add a finishing
stroke to the great joy I shall find in
your return. The day you arrive, I
must insist on you and your
company staying with me.

**M. TULLI CICERONIS
EPISTULARUM AD
ATTICUM
LIBER QUINTUS**

I

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Menturnis III aut
prid. Non. Mai. a. 703*

Ego vero et tuum in discessu vidi animum et meo sum ipse testis. Quo magis erit tibi videndum, ne quid novi decernatur, ut hoc nostrum desiderium ne plus sit annum. De Annio Saturnino curasti probe. De satis dando vero te rogo, quoad eris Romae, tu ut satis des. Et sunt aliquot satisfationes secundum mancipium veluti Mennianorum praediorum vel Atilianorum. De Oppio factum est, ut volui, et maxime quod DCCC aperuisti. Quae quidem ego utique vel versura facta solvi volo, ne extrema exactio nostrorum nominum exspectetur.

Nunc venio ad transversum illum extremae epistulae tuae versiculum, in quo me admones de sorore. Quae res se sic habet. Ut veni in Arpinas, cum ad me frater venisset, in primis nobis sermo isque multus de te fuit. Ex quo ego veni ad ea, quae fueramus ego et tu inter nos de sorore in Tusculano locuti. Nihil tam vidi mite, nihil tam placatum, quam tum meus frater erat in sororem tuam, ut, etiam si qua

CICERO'S LETTERS TO ATTICUS BOOK V

I

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Menturnae, May 5 or
6, B.C. 51*

Yes, I did see your feelings when we parted, and to my own I can testify. That is an additional reason why you should take care that no new decrees are passed, to prevent this painful separation from lasting more than one year. You have taken the right steps with Annius Saturninus. As to the guarantee, please give it yourself, while you are in town. There are some proofs of ownership, for instance those for Mennius' or rather Atilius' estate. You have done exactly what I wanted in Oppius' case, especially in putting the £7,000^[165] to his credit. I must have that paid off without waiting till I've got in all my arrears, even if I have to get into the hands of the Jews^[166] over it.

Now I come to the line you wrote crosswise at the end of your letter, in which you give me a word of advice about your sister. The facts of the case are that when I reached Arpinum and my brother had come, the first thing we did was to have a

long talk about you. After that I brought the talk round to the discussion you and I had about your sister at Tusculum. My brother's behaviour then to your sister was gentleness and kindness itself. If there ever was any quarrel about

[165](#). 800,000 sesterces.

[166](#). *Versuram facere* = to borrow money to pay off a previous loan.

fuerat ex ratione sumptus offensio, non appareret. Ille sic dies. Postridie ex Arpinati profecti sumus. Ut in Arcano Quintus maneret, dies fecit, ego Aquini, sed prandimus in Arcano. Nosti hunc fundum. Quo ut venimus, humanissime Quintus "Pomponia" inquit, "tu invita mulieres, ego arcivero viros." Nihil potuit, mihi quidem ut visum est, dulcius idque cum verbis tum etiam animo ac vultu. At illa audientibus nobis "Ego ipsa sum" inquit "hic hospita," id autem ex eo, ut opinor, quod antecesserat Statius, ut prandium nobis videret. Tum Quintus "En" inquit mihi "haec ego patior cotidie." Dices: "Quid, quaeso, istuc erat?" Magnum; itaque me ipsum commoverat; sic absurde et aspere verbis vultuque responderat. Dissimulavi dolens. Discubuimus omnes praeter illam, cui tamen Quintus de mensa misit. Illa reiecit. Quid multa? nihil meo fratre lenius, nihil asperius tua sorore

expense, there were no signs of it. So passed that day. On the next day we started from Arpinum. A festival caused Quintus to stop at Arcanum, while I went on to Aquinum: but we lunched together at Arcanum. You know his place there. Well, when we reached it, Quintus said most politely, "Pomponia, you invite the ladies, I will ask the men." Nothing, so far as I could see, could have been more gentle than his words or his intention or his expression. But before us all she answered "I'm only a stranger here"; just because Statius had been sent on in front to get dinner ready for us, I suppose. Says Quintus to me: "There you are. That's what I have to put up with every day." You may say there surely was not much in that. But there was a good deal: indeed she upset me myself; she answered with such uncalled for acrimony in word and look. I concealed my annoyance. We all took our places except her: but

mihi visum est; et multa praetereo, quae tum mihi maiori stomacho quam ipsi Quinto fuerunt. Ego inde Aquinum. Quintus in Arcano remansit et Aquinum ad me postridie mane venit mihiq[ue] narravit nee secum illam dormire voluisse et, cum discessura esset, fuisse eius modi, qualem ego vidissem. Quid quaeris? vel ipsi hoc dicas licet, humanitatem ei meo iudicio illo die defuisse.

Haec ad te scripsi fortasse pluribus, quam necesse fuit, ut videres tuas quoque esse partes instituendi et monendi. Reliquum est, ut, antequam proficiscare, mandata nostra, exhaurias, scribas ad me omnia, Pomptinum

extrudas, cum profectus eris, cures, ut sciam, sic habeas, nihil mehercule te mihi nec carius esse nec suavius. A. Torquatum amantissime dimisi Menturnis, optimum virum; cui me ad te scripsisse aliquid in sermone significes velim.

Quintus sent her something from the table, which she refused. In a word, it seemed to me that my brother was as good-tempered and your sister as cross as could be, and I have omitted a lot of things that aroused my wrath more than Quintus'. Then I went on to Aquinum. Quintus stayed at Arcanum, and came to me the next morning, and told me that she would not sleep with him and, when she was leaving, she was as cross as when I saw her. In fact, I don't care if you tell her herself, that to my mind she behaved with a lack of courtesy that day.

I have said perhaps more than necessary about it to show you that it is your turn to do a little instructing and advising too. It only remains for you to fulfil all my commissions before you start, and send me an account of all of them, to rout Pomptinus out,

and, when you have left, to let me know, believing that there is nothing I hold dearer than yourself, nothing that gives me more delight. I bade that good fellow, A. Torquatus, a most affectionate farewell at Menturnae. I should like you to tell him I mentioned him in a letter.

II

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Pompeiano VI
Id. Mai. a. 703*

A. d. VI
Idus Maias,
cum has dabam litteras, ex
Pompeiano proficiscebar, ut eo die
manerem in Trebulano apud
Pontium. Deinde cogitabam sine ulla
mora iusta itinera facere. In Cumano
cum essem, venit ad me, quod mihi
pergratum fuit, noster Hortensius;
cui deposcenti mea mandata cetera
universe mandavi, illud proprie, ne
pateretur, quantum esset in ipso;
prorogari nobis provincias. In quo
eum tu velim confirmes gratumque
mihi fecisse dicas, quod et venerit ad
me et hoc mihi, praetereaue si quid
opus esset, promiserit. Confirmavi
ad eam causam etiam Furnium
nostrum, quem ad annum tribunum
pl. videbam fore. Habuimus in
Cumano quasi pusillam Romam.
Tanta erat in his locis multitudo; cum
interim Rufio noster, quod se a
Vestorio observari videbat,
strategemate hominem percussit;
nam ad me non accessit. Itane? cum
Hortensius veniret et infirmus et tam
longe et Hortensius, cum maxima
praeterea multitudo, ille non venit?
Non, inquam. "Non vidisti igitur
hominem?" inquires. Qui potui non

II

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Pompeii, May 10, B.C.
51*

On the 10th of May, the date of
this letter, I set out from my villa at
Pompeii, to spend the day with
Pontius in his villa at Trebula.
Thereafter I mean to do my day's
journey regularly without delay.
While I was in my villa at Cumae,
our friend Hortensius paid me a very
welcome visit. He asked if I had any
commissions, and I gave him
commissions in general, and in
particular to prevent to the best of
his ability extension of my term of
office in my province. Please keep
him up to it, and tell him that I was
much gratified at his visit, and at his
promises on that particular point and
of any other assistance I might need.
I have bound our friend Furnius,
who, I see, will be tribune next year,
to help me in the same matter. My
villa at Cumae was a miniature
Rome; there were such a lot of
people in the neighbourhood. In the
middle of it all our friend Rufio,
seeing that Vestorius was on his
tracks, baffled the man by a ruse; for

videre, cum per emporium
Puteolanorum iter

he did not come to me. You may be surprised that he did not come, seeing that Hortensius came, who is ill, lives afar off and is a great man, and crowds of other people came as well. I repeat he did not come. You may infer I did not see him. How could I fail to see him when I travelled

facerem? In quo illum agentem aliquid, credo, salutavi, post etiam iussi valere, cum me exiens e sua villa, numquid vellem, rogasset. Hunc hominem parum gratum quisquam putet aut non in eo ipso laudandum, quod audiri non laborarit? Sed redeo ad illud.

Noli putare mihi aliam consolationem esse huius ingentis molestiae, nisi quod spero non longiorem annua fore. Hoc me ita velle multi non credunt ex consuetudine aliorum; tu, qui scis, omnem diligentiam adhibebis tum scilicet, cum id agi debebit, cum ex Epiro redieris. De re publica scribas ad me velim, si quid erit, quod odorere. Nondum enim satis huc erat allatum, quo modo Caesar ferret de auctoritate perscripta, eratque rumor de Transpadanis eos iussos IIII viros creare. Quod si ita est, magnos motus timeo. Sed aliquid ex Pompeio sciam.

through the market of Puteoli? He was busy about something there I fancy, when I greeted him. On a subsequent occasion, I bade him a brief good-bye, when he came out of his villa and asked if I had any commands. Is one to reckon such a man ungrateful, or does he not rather deserve praise for not striving to get audience? But I return to my former point.

Pray don't imagine that I have any consolation for this tremendous nuisance beyond a hope that my office will not outlast a year. A number of people do not believe in this wish of mine, judging me by others. You, who know my mind, will please use every effort, I mean when the time comes for action, on your return from Epirus. Please write me on state politics, and tell me any secrets you may scent out. For at present we have no sufficient news as to how Caesar takes the recorded opinion of the Senate on his case, and there was a report too that the

III

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Trebulano V Id.
Mai. a. 703*

A. d. VI
Idus Maias

veni in Trebulanum ad Pontium. Ibi
mihi tuae litterae binae redditae sunt
tertio abs te die. Eodem autem
exiens e Pompeiano

Transpadani were ordered to create a
board of four municipal officers.^[167]

If that is the case, I fear great
disturbance: but I shall learn some
news from Pompey.

III

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Trebula, May 11, B.C.

51

On the 10th of May I came to Pontius' villa at Trebula. There two letters from you were delivered to me on the third day after leaving your hands. On that same day, as I was quitting my place at Pompeii,

[167](#). Caesar wished to give Transpadane Gaul the full *civitas*; in which case they would become a *municipium* and elect a yearly board of *quattuorviri*, instead of *duoviri*.

Philotimo dederam ad te litteras; nec vero nunc erat sane, quod scriberem. Qui de re publica rumores, scribe, quaeso; in oppidis enim summum video timorem, sed multa inania. Quid de his cogites et quando, scire velim. Ad quas litteras tibi rescribi velis, nescio. Nullas enim adhuc acceperam, praeter quae mihi binae simul in Trebulano redditae sunt; quarum alterae edictum P. Lentuli habebant (erant autem Nonis Maiis datae), alterae rescriptae ad meas Menturnenses. Quani vereor, ne quid fuerit σπουδαιότερον in iis, quas non

I gave Philotimus a letter to you: nor have I at present any news. I beg you write me what reports there are on the political situation. In the country towns I notice there is much panic: but a great deal is nonsense. Please let me know your opinion about this and the date of the impending crisis. I do not know to which of your letters you ask for a reply. I have received no letter so far, except the two which were handed me together at my villa in Trebula. One of these contained the edict of P. Lentulus, and was dated the 7th of May: the other was a reply to my letter from Menturnae. I fear there

accepi, quibus rescribi vis! Apud
Lentulum ponam te in gratia.

Dionysius nobis cordi est. Nicanor
tuus operam mihi dat egregiam. Iam
deest, quod scribam, et lucet.
Beneventi cogitabam hodie. Nostra
continentia et diligentia esse satis^[168]
faciemus satis.

A Pontio ex Trebulano a. d. v Idus
Maías.

may have been some matter more
important in a letter I did not receive,
to which you ask for a reply. I will
put you in Lentulus' good graces.

Dionysius is my bosom friend.
Your Nicanor does me excellent
service. I have no more to say, and
day is breaking. I think of going to
Beneventum to-day. My continence
and diligence shall satisfy....

From the house of Pontius at
Trebulæ, May 11.

IV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Beneventi IV Id
Mai. a. 703*

Beneventum veni a. d. v Idus Maias. Ibi accepi eas litteras, quas tu superioribus litteris significaveras te dedisse, ad quas ego eo ipso die dederam ex Trebulano a Pontio. Ac binas quidem tuas Beneventi accepi, quarum alteras Funisulanus multo mane mihi dedit, alteras scriba Tullius. Gratissima est mihi tua cura de illo meo primo et maximo mandato; sed tua profectio spem meam debilitat. Ac de illo illuc

[168](#). *The text here is corrupt.*

quidem labor,^[169] non quo—, sed inopia cogimur eo contenti esse. De illo altero, quem scribis tibi visum esse non alienum, vereor, adduci ut nostra possit, et tu ais δυσδιάγνωστον esse. Equidem sum facilis, sed tu aberis, et me absente res habebit mei rationem?^[170] Nam posset aliquid, si utervis nostrum adesset, agente Servilia Servio fieri

IV

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Beneventum May 12,
B.C. 51*

I reached Beneventum on the 11th of May. There I received the note which you said in your last letter had been despatched. I answered that letter on the day I received it from Pontius' villa at Trebula. And indeed two letters of yours reached me at Beneventum, one of them handed to me by Funisulanus in the early morning, and the other by my secretary Tullius. I am very grateful to you for your trouble about my first and most important commission. But your departure from Rome lessens my

hope. As regards the man you mention, I am slipping into your view, not that—but for want of a better we are compelled to be satisfied with him. As for the other man who, you say, appears a not unlikely candidate, I fear my daughter could not be persuaded, and, as you add, there is not a pin to choose between them. For myself I am reasonable; but you will be away,

probabile. Nunc, si iam res placeat, agendi tamen viam non video.

Nunc venio ad eam epistulam, quam accepi a Tullio. De Marcello fecisti diligenter. Igitur, senatus consultum si erit factum, scribes ad me; si minus, rem tamen conficies; mihi enim attribui oportebit, item Bibulo. Sed non dubito, quin senatus consultum expeditum sit, in quo praesertim sit compendium populi. De Torquato probe. De Masone et Ligure, cum venerint. De illo, quod Chaerippus (quoniam hic quoque πρόσνευσιν sustulisti), o provincia! etiamne hic mihi curandus est? curandus autem hactenus, ne quid ad senatum “consule!” aut “numera!” Nam de ceteris—sed tamen commode, quod cum Scrofa. De Pomptino recte scribis. Est enim ita, ut, si ante Kal. Iunias Brundisi futurus sit, minus urguendi fuerint M. Anneius et L. Tullius. Quae de Sicinio audisti, ea mihi probantur, modo ne illa exceptio in aliquem incurrat bene de nobis meritum. Sed considerabimus., rem enim probo. De

[169](#). de illo, illuc quidem labor *Kayser*: me ille illud quod labat *Z^hN*: me ille illud *M* with a marginal variant me illud quidem labat.

[170](#). res habebis mirationem *M*. The text is *Tyrrell's emendation*. Many others have been made, e.g. *Palmer's* res haerebit. Habebis mei rationem.

and will any account be taken of me in my absence? For, if either of us were on the spot, a good face might be put on the matter with Servius through the agency of Servilia. Now, even if it were a thing I favoured, I see no way of bringing it to pass.

Now I come to that letter which I received from Tullius. You have been very energetic about Marcellus: so, if a decree should be passed, please inform me: but, if not, try to carry the matter through: a grant ought to be made to me and to Bibulus. But I am confident that the decree will be passed especially as it saves the people's pocket. That is fine about Torquatus. As for Maso and Ligur, we can wait till they come. As to Chaerippus' request, since you have given me no tip on the matter—hang the province! Must I trouble about him too? Well, I must take enough trouble to prevent any debate on the matter or count out in the House. As for others—however you do well to have spoken with Scrofa. As to Pomptinus you are right. It comes to this, if Pomptinus will be at Brundisium before June, M. Anneius and L. Tullius need not hurry out of Rome. As to your news from Sicinius, I am satisfied, provided this restriction does not apply to anyone who has obliged me. But I will think it over,

as the plan pleases me. I will let you know

nostro itinere quod statuero, de quinque praefectis quid Pompeius factururus sit, cum ex ipso cognoro, faciam, ut scias. De Oppio bene curasti, quod ei de DCCC exposuisti, idque, quoniam Philotimum habes, perfice et cognosce rationem et, ut agam amplius, si me amas, priusquam proficiscaris, effice. Magna me cura levaris.

Habes ad omnia. Etsi paene praeterii chartam tibi deesse. Mea captio est, si quidem eius inopia minus multa ad me scribis. Tu vero aufer ducentos; etsi meam in eo parsimoniam huius paginae contractio significat. Dumtaxat rumores, vel etiam si qua certa habes de Caesare, exspecto. Litteras et aliis et Pomptino de omnibus rebus diligenter dabis.

what course I have determined to adopt as regards my route, and also as to Pompey's policy about the five prefects,^[171] when I have heard from him. As for Oppius you have done well to explain to him the matter of the £7,000.^[172] Please arrange the business since Philotimus is with you. Examine the account and, to go further in my request, if you love me, settle the debt before you leave town. You will relieve me of great anxiety.

I have replied to all your points. But your want of paper I had almost forgotten. It is my loss, if for lack of it your letter is shorter. Take a couple of hundred sheets,^[173] though the shortness of this page betokens my stinginess in paper. In return I look for information and gossip and any certain news of Caesar. You will write a letter to Pomptinus, as well as others, about everything.

V

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Venusiae Id. Mai.
a. 703*

Plane deest, quod scribam; nam, nec quod mandem, habeo (nihil enim praetermissum est), nec quod narrem (novi enim nihil), nec iocandi locus est; ita me multa sollicitant. Tantum tamen scito, Idibus Maiis nos Venusia mane proficiscentes has dedisse. Eo autem die credo aliquid actum in senatu. Sequantur igitur nos tuae litterae, quibus non modo res

V

CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.

*Venusia, May 15, B.C.
51*

I have absolutely nothing to write about. Having forgotten nothing I have no commission for you. Having no news, I have nothing to relate. And this is no place for jests considering the number of my cares. Still you must know that I despatched this letter setting out from Venusia on the morning of the 15th of May. I believe something has been done in the Senate to-day. So send a letter after

[171](#). Five new prefects were to be appointed in each of the Spains.

[172](#). 800,000 sesterces.

[173](#). Understanding *chartas*, which is used by the older Latin authors as a masculine noun, cf. Nonius 196, 17. Others however understand *sestertios*.

omnes, sed etiam rumores cognoscamus. Eas accipiemus Brundisi; ibi enim Pomptinum ad eam diem, quam tu scripsisti, exspectare consilium est. Nos Tarenti quos cum Pompeio διαλόγους de re publica habuerimus, ad te

me, giving not only all the facts but the gossip too. I shall get it at Brundisium. For it is there that I intend to await Pomptinus up to the date that you have mentioned. I will write you of the *causeries* I had with Pompey at Tarentum about politics.

perscribemus. Etsi id ipsum scire cupio, quod ad tempus recte ad te scribere possim, id est quam diu Romae futurus sis, ut aut, quo dem posthac litteras, sciam, aut ne dem frustra. Sed, antequam proficiscare, utique explicatum sit illud HS. XX et DCCC. Hoc velim in maximis rebus et maxime necessariis habeas, ut, quod auctore te velle coepi, adiutore adsequar.

Although there is one thing I want to know, up to what time I can safely write to you at Rome, that is how long you will be in town, so that I may have your address after your removal and may not send letters in vain. Before you go, settle the business of the £180 and the £7,000. ^[174] Please count it most important and most necessary, that with your help I may achieve, what I began to wish for at your instance.

VI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Tarenti XIV K.
Iun. a. 703*

Tarentum
veni a. d. xv
Kal. Iunias. Quod Pomptinum
statueram exspectare,
commodissimum duxi dies eos,
quoad ille veniret, cum Pompeio
consumere eoque magis, quod ei
gratum esse id videbam, qui etiam a
me petierit, ut secum et apud se
essem cotidie. Quod concessi
libenter. Multos enim eius praeclaros
de re publica sermones accipiam,
instruar etiam consiliis idoneis ad
hoc nostrum negotium.

Sed ad te brevior iam in scribendo
incipio fieri dubitans, Romaene sis
an iam profectus. Quod tamen quoad
ignorabo, scribam aliquid potius
quam committam, ut, tibi cum
possint reddi a me litterae, non
reddantur. Nee tamen iam habeo,
quod aut mandem tibi aut narrem.
Mandavi omnia; quae quidem tu,

VI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Tarentum, May 19,
B.C. 51*

I
ca me
to Tarentum on the 18th of May. As I
had decided to await Pomptinus, I
thought it most convenient to spend
the days before his arrival with
Pompey, the more so because I saw
it pleased him. Indeed he begged me
to see him and to be at his house
every day; and I am glad to give him
my company. I shall have some
grand conversations with him about
the political situation, and shall get
useful advice on this business of
mine.

I am beginning to send you shorter
letters, as I do not know whether you
are in Rome, or have now started on
your journey. However, so long as I
am ignorant of your whereabouts, I
will write you a line rather than run
the risk of not sending you a letter,
when a letter from me can reach you.
I have no commission for you and
nothing to say. I have given

[174](#). 20,000 and 800,000 sesterces.

ut polliceris, exhausties. Narrabo, cum aliquid habebo novi. Illud tamen non desinam, dum adesse te putabo, de Caesaris nomine rogare ut confectum relinquant. Avide exspecto tuas litteras et maxime, ut norim tempus profectionis tuae.

you all my commissions, and please execute them as you promise. I will send you any fresh news, when I have it. One matter I shall not cease to request so long as I think you are in town,—that you will leave my debt to Caesar settled. I await eagerly a letter from you, especially that I may know the date of your leaving Rome.

VII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Tarenti XIII K.
Iun. a. 703*

Cotidie
vel potius in
dies singulos breviores litteras ad te
mitto; cotidie enim magis suspicor te
in Epirum iam profectum. Sed
tamen, ut mandatum scias me
curasse, quo de ante, ait se Pompeius
quinos praefectos delaturum novos
vacationis iudiciariae causa. Ego
cum triduum cum Pompeio et apud
Pompeium fuissem, proficiscebar
Brundisium a. d. XIII Kal. Iunias.
Civem illum egregium relinquebam
et ad haec, quae timentur,
propulsanda paratissimum. Tuas
litteras exspectabo, cum ut, quid
agas, tum ut, ubi sis, sciam.

VII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Tarentum, May 20,
B.C. 51*

Daily, or rather more and more
every day, I send you shorter letters:
for daily I suspect more than ever
that you have started for Epirus.
However, to inform you that I have
taken in hand your previous
commission:—Pompey says that he
will appoint five new prefects,
exempting them from serving on
juries. For myself, after spending
three days with Pompey at his house,
I am setting out for Brundisium on
the 20th of May. I am leaving behind
me a noble citizen, well-prepared to
ward off the dangers we fear. I shall
await your letters to inform me of
your actions and whereabouts.

VIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Brundisi IV aut
III Non. Iun. a. 703*

Me et
incommoda
valetudo, e qua iam emerseram,
utpote cum sine febris laborassem, et
Pomptini exspectatio, de quo adhuc
ne rumor quidem venerat, tenebat
duodecimum iam diem Brundisi; sed
cursum exspectabamus. Tu, si modo
es Romae (vix enim puto), sin es,
hoc vehementer animadvertas velim.

Roma acceperam litteras Milonem
meum queri per litteras iniuriam
meam, quod Philotimus socius esset
in bonis suis. Id ego ita fieri volui de
C. Duroni sententia, quem et
amicissimum Miloni perspexeram et
talem virum, qualem tu iudicas,
cognoram. Eius autem consilium
meumque hoc fuerat, primum ut in
potestate nostra esset res, ne illum
malus emptor alienus mancipiis,
quae permulta secum habet,
spoliaret, deinde ut Faustae, cui
cautum ille esse voluisset, ratum
esset. Erat etiam illud, ut ipsi nos, si

VIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Brundisium, June 2 or
3, B.C. 51*

Tiresome indisposition, from
which I have recovered, as there was
no fever with my ailment, and also
my awaiting Pomptinus, of whom so
far no news has reached me, have
detained me now twelve days at
Brundisium: but I am looking for an
opportunity to sail. I scarcely
imagine that you are in town; but, if
you are, please give your closest
attention to

the following. I have received a
letter from Rome, saying that my
friend Milo writes complaining of
ill-treatment from me, for allowing
Philotimus to have a hand in the
purchase of his property. I acted on
the advice of C. Duronius, a man
whom I saw to be most friendly to
Milo, and just such a person as you
suppose him to be. His plan and
mine was this, firstly, to keep a hold
over Milo's property for fear some
hard bargainer, a stranger to us,
should rob him of his slaves, of
whom a great number were with

quid servari posset, quam facillime servaremus. Nunc rem totam perspicias velim; nobis enim scribuntur saepe maiora. Si ille queritur, si scribit ad amicos, si idem Fausta vult, Philotimus, ut ego ei coram dixeram, mihique ille receperat, ne sit invito Milone in bonis. Nihil nobis fuerat tanti. Sin haec leviora sunt, tu iudicabis. Loquere cum Duronio. Scripsi etiam ad Camillum, ad Lamiam eoque magis, quod non confidebam Romae te esse. Summa erit haec. Statues, ut ex fide, fama reque mea videbitur.

him; and secondly, that the settlement he intended to make on Fausta should be respected. There was the further intention, that we ourselves should have the readiest means of saving anything that could be saved. Now please review the whole matter, for letters to me often exaggerate. If Milo complains and writes to his friends, and, if Fausta wishes, as I told Philotimus and as he agreed, I would not have him purchase the property against Milo's wish. Nothing would compensate for offending Milo. You will judge if the matter has been exaggerated. Please consult Duronius. I have written also to Camillus and to Lamia, among other reasons because I do not feel sure you are in town. To sum up, in deciding be careful of my honour, reputation and interests.

IX

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Acti XVII K.
Quint. a. 703*

Actium
venimus a. I
d. xvii Kal. Quinctiles, cum quidem rea
et Corcyrae et Sybotis muneribus che
tuis, quae et Araus et meus amicus
Eutychides opipare et
φιλοπροσηνέστατα nobis
congresserant, epulati essemus

Saliarem in modum. Actio
maluimus iter facere pedibus, qui
incommodissime navigassemus, et
Leucata[m] flectere molestum
videbatur, actuariis autem minutis
Patras accedere sine impedimentis
non satis visum est decorum. Ego, ut
saepe tu me currentem hortatus es,
cotidie meditor, praecipio meis,
faciam denique, ut summa modestia
et summa abstinentia munus hoc
extraordinarium traducamus. Parthus
velim quiescat, et fortuna nos iuvet,
nostra praestabimus.

Tu, quaeso, quid agas, ubi quoque
tempore futurus sis, quales res
nostras Romae reliqueris, maxime de
XX et DCCC cura ut sciamus. Id
unis diligenter litteris datis, quae ad
me utique perferantur, consequere.

IX

CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.

*Actium, June 14. B.C.
51*

d Actium on the 14th of June, after
feasting like an alderman both at
Corcyra and the Sybota islands,
thanks to your gifts which Araus and
my good friend Eutychides heaped
on me with lavish

kindness. From Actium I preferred
to travel by land, in view of the
wretched passage we had and the
danger of rounding Leucatas. It did
not seem to me quite dignified to go
ashore at Patrae in small boats
without my baggage. I will really
take care to fulfil this unusual office
of mine with all propriety and
honesty, as you have often urged me,
nothing loth; and daily I bethink me
of your advice and impress it on my
staff. Please God the Parthians keep
quiet and fortune favour me, I will
answer for myself.

I beg that you will let me know
what you are doing, your movements
from time to time, how you left my
business at Rome, particularly in the
matter of the £180 and the £7,000.

Illud tamen, quoniam nunc abes, cum id non agitur, aderis autem ad tempus, ut mihi rescripsti, memento curare per te et per omnes nostros, in primis per Hortensium, ut annus noster maneat suo statu, ne quid novi decernatur. Hoc tibi ita mando, ut dubitem, an etiam te rogem, ut pugnes, ne intercaletur. Sed non audeo tibi omnia onera imponere; annum quidem utique teneto.

Cicero meus, modestissimus et suavissimus puer, tibi salutem dicit. Dionysium semper equidem, ut scis, dilexi, sed cotidie pluris facio, et mehercule in primis quod te amat nec tui mentionem intermitti sinit.

Please do this in a letter carefully addressed to reach me anyhow. You are away at this present moment of inaction, but you have promised me to be in town for the occasion, and remember to use your best endeavours and to employ all my friends, especially Hortensius, that my year of office may conclude without any extension. This commission should perhaps be accompanied by a request for you to fight that no extra days may be added to the calendar: but I hardly like to give you all this trouble. Anyhow insist on the year.

My son, a boy of charming manners, sends greetings to you. I have always liked Dionysius as you know, but I make more of him every day, especially because he is your admirer, and lets slip no chance of mentioning you.

X

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Athenis prid. K.
aut K. Quint. a. 703*

Ut
Athenas a.
d. VI Kal. Quinctiles veneram,
exspectabam ibi iam quartum diem
Pomptinum neque de eius adventu
certi quicquam habebam. Eram
autem totus, crede mihi, tecum et,
quamquam sine iis per me ipse,
tamen acrius vestigiis tuis monitus
de te cogitabam. Quid quaeris? non
mehercule alius ullus sermo nisi de
te. Sed tu de me ipso aliquid scire
fortasse mavis. Haec sunt. Adhuc
sumptus nec in me aut publice aut
privatim nec in quemquam comitum.
Nihil accipitur lege Iulia, nihil ab
hospite. Persuasum est omnibus meis
serviendum esse famae meae. Belle
adhuc. Hoc animadversum
Graecorum laude et multo sermone
celebratur. Quod superest, elaboratur
in hoc a me, sicut tibi sensi placere.
Sed haec tum laudemus, cum erunt
perorata. Reliqua sunt eius modi, ut
meum consilium saepe reprehendam,
quod non aliqua ratione ex hoc
negotio emersem. O rem minime
aptam meis moribus! o illud verum
ἔρδοι τις! Dices: "Quid adhuc?
nondum enim in negotio versaris."
Sane scio et puto molestiora restare.

X

CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.

*Athens, June 29 or
July 1, B.C. 51*

I
came
to Athens on the 25th of June, and I
have waited three days for
Pomptinus, but have heard nothing
certain of his coming. Believe me,
you are with me all the time, and,
though it did not need associations to
turn my thoughts towards you, still I
was reminded of you more than ever
by treading in your footsteps. Indeed
we talk of nothing else but you; but
perhaps you prefer to have news
about myself. So far no public body
or private person has spent money on
me or on my staff. I have not even
taken the barest necessities allowed
by the law of Julius, nor have I
billeted myself on anyone. My staff
have made up their minds that they
must uphold my good name. So far
everything has gone well: the Greeks
have noted it and are full of
outspoken praise. For the rest I am
endeavouring to act as I know you
would like. But let us reserve our
praise for the end of the story. In
other respects I often blame my
mistake in not having found some

Etsi haec ipsa fero equidem fronte, ut puto, et voltu bellissime, sed angor intimis sensibus; ita multa vel iracunde vel insolenter vel in omni genere stultitiae insulse adrogantur et dicuntur et tacentur cotidie; quae non, quo te celem, non perscribo, sed quia

method of escape from this flood of affairs. The business is little suited to my tastes. It is a true saying, “Cobbler, stick to your last.”^[175] You will say: “What, already? You have not yet begun your work.” Too true, and I fear worse is to come. I put up with things with cheerful brow and smiling face; but I suffer in my heart of hearts. There is so much ill temper and insolence, such stupid folly of every kind, such arrogant talk and such sullen silence to be put up with every day. I pass over this, not because I wish to conceal it, but

^{175.} ἔρδοι τις ἥν ἕκαστος εἰδεῖν τέχνην (Aristophanes, *Vespae* 1431).

δυσεκλάλητα sunt. Itaque admirabere meam βαθύτητα, cum salvi redierimus; tanta mihi μελέτη huius virtutis datur.

Ergo haec quoque hactenus; etsi mihi nihil erat propositum ad scribendum, quia, quid ageres, ubi terrarum esses, ne suspicabar quidem. Nec hercule umquam tam diu ignarus rerum mearum fui, quid de Caesaris, quid de Milonis nominibus actum sit; ac non modo nemo domo, ne Roma quidem quisquam, ut sciremus, in re publica quid ageretur. Quare, si quid erit, quod scias de iis rebus, quas putabis scire me velle, per mihi gratum erit, si id curaris ad me perferendum.

because to explain is difficult. You shall marvel at my self-restraint, when I return home safe. I have so much practice in the virtue.

Enough of this topic too. Though indeed I have nothing to make me write to you at all, because I have no idea of what you are doing or where you are, and I have never been so long ignorant about my own concerns—as to what has been done about the debt to Caesar and Milo’s money matters: and there has come no messenger from Rome much less from my house to inform me of political affairs. So, if you have information you may think I should like to know, I shall be delighted if you will take care to send it to me.

Quid est praeterea? Nihil sane nisi illud. Valde me Athenae delectarunt urbe dumtaxat et urbis ornamento et hominum amore in te et in nos quadam benevolentia; sed multa in^[176] ea philosophia sursum deorsum, si quidem est in Aristo, apud quem eram. Nam Xenonem tuum vel nostrum potius Quinto concesseram, et tamen propter vicinitatem totos dies simul eramus. Tu velim, cum primum poteris, tua consilia ad me scribas, ut sciam, quid agas, ubi quoque tempore, maxime quando Romae futurus sis.

I have only one thing to add. Athens pleases me greatly, that is the material city, its embellishments, your popularity and the kind feeling shown to me: but its philosophy is topsy-turvy, that is, if it is represented by Aristus with whom I am staying: for I gave up Xeno your friend and mine to Quintus. Still we are close neighbours and meet every day. Please write me as soon as possible of your plans, and tell me what you are doing, where you are from time to time, and especially when you will be in town.

XI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Athenis pr. Non.
Quint. a. 703*

Hui,
totiesne me
litteras dedisse Romam, cum ad te
nullas darem? At vero posthac
frustra potius dabo quam, si recte
dari potuerint, committam, ut non
dem. Ne provincia nobis prorogetur,
per fortunas! dum ades, quicquid
provideri poterit, provide.

[176](#). multum *M*: multa in *Reid*.

Non dici potest, quam flagrem
desiderio urbis, quam vix harum
rerum insulsiatam feram.

Marcellus foede in Comensi. Etsi
ille magistratum non gesserat, erat
tamen Transpadanus. Ita mihi videtur
non minus stomachi nostro quam
Caesari fecisse. Sed hoc ipse viderit.
Pompeius mihi quoque videbatur,
quod scribis Varronem dicere, in
Hispaniam certe iturus. Id ego
minime probabam; qui quidem
Theophani facile persuasi nihil esse
melius quam illum nusquam
discedere. Ergo Graecus incumbet.
Valet autem auctoritas eius apud
illum plurimum.

XI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Athens, July 6, B.C. 51

What, write so often to Rome, and
never a line to you! Well, in future,
rather than do such a thing as not to
write a letter that can reach you
safely, I will despatch a letter that
may go astray. In the name of
heaven, while you are in town, take
every possible precaution against the
term of my office

being extended. I cannot describe
how ardently I long for town, how
hard I find it to bear the stupidity of
life here.

Marcellus acted disgracefully over
the man from Comum:^{[177](#)} even if he
had not been a magistrate, still he
was a Transpadane. So Marcellus'
action seems to me as likely to anger
Pompey as Caesar; but that is his
own look-out. I agree with Varro's
statement, which you quote in your
letter, that Pompey will surely go to
Spain. I by no means approve of the
policy, and indeed I convinced
Theophanes easily that Pompey's
presence in Rome was the very best
course. So the Greek will put

Ego has pr. Nonas Quinctiles proficiscens Athenis dedi, cum ibi decem ipsos fuisset dies. Venerat Pomptinus, una Cn. Volusius; aderat quaestor; tuus unus Tullius aberat. Aphracta Rhodiorum et dicota Mytilenaeorum habebam et aliquid ἐπικώπων. De Parthis erat silentium. Quod superest, di iuvent!

Nos adhuc iter per Graeciam summa cum admiratione fecimus, nec mehercule habeo, quod adhuc quem accusem meorum. Videntur mihi nosse nostram causam et condicionem profectionis suae; plane serviunt existimationi meae. Quod superest, si verum illud est οἷαπερ ἡ δέσποινα, certe permanebunt. Nihil

pressure on Pompey; and his opinion weighs with him a great deal.

I despatch this letter on the 6th of July, being about to leave Athens, where I have stayed just ten days. Pomptinus has come along with Cn. Volusius. My quaestor is here. Your friend Tullius is the one absentee. I have some open boats of Rhodes and two-deckers from Mitylene and a few despatch boats. There is no news of the Parthians. For the rest, God help us.

So far our journey through Greece has provoked great admiration, and I have no fault at all to find with my staff at present. They seem to understand what my case is, and the terms on which they stand. They do everything to maintain my good name. For the rest, if the saying be true, “Like master, like man,”^[178] assuredly they will stick to their good behaviour,

¹⁷⁷. He had ordered him to be flogged, disregarding the fact that Caesar had sent 5,000 colonists to Transpadane Gaul. Magistrates of a *colonia* had the full *civitas*.

¹⁷⁸. The proverb ends τοῖα χὴ κύων (“the dog is like its mistress”) according to the Scholiast on Plato *De Repub.*, viii, 563.

enim a me fieri ita videbunt, ut sibi sit delinquendi locus. Sin id parum profuerit, fiet aliquid a nobis severius. Nam adhuc lenitate dulces sumus et, ut spero, proficimus

for they will see no excuse for misconduct in any act of mine. If example be futile, I must try severer means. So far I have been mild and kind, and I hope I am making headway. But I have looked forward

aliquantum. Sed ego hanc, ut Siculi dicunt, ἀνεξίαν in unum annum meditatus sum. Proinde pugna, ne, si quid prorogatum sit, turpis inveniar.

Nunc redeo, ad quae mihi mandas. In praefectis excusatio: iis, quos voles, deferto. Non ero tam μετέωρος, quam in Appuleio fui. Xenonem tam diligo quam tu, quod ipsum sentire certo scio. Apud Patronem et reliquos barones te in maxima gratia posui et hercule merito tuo feci. Nam mihi Ister dixit te scripsisse ad se mihi ex illius litteris rem illam curae fuisse, quod ei pergratum erat. Sed, cum Patro mecum egisset, ut peterem a vestro Ariopago, ὑπομνηματισμὸν tollerent, quem Polycharmo praetore fecerant, commodius visum est et Xenoni et post ipsi Patroni me ad Memmium scribere, qui pridie, quam ego Athenas veni, Mitilenas profectus erat, ut is ad suos scriberet posse id sua voluntate fieri. Non enim dubitabat Xeno, quin ab Ariopagitis invito Memmio impetrari non posset. Memmius autem aedificandi consilium abiecerat; sed erat Patroni iratus. Itaque scripsi ad eum accurate; cuius epistulae misi ad te exemplum.

Tu velim Piliam meis verbis consolere. Indicabo enim tibi, tu illi nihil dixeris. Accepi fasciculum, in quo erat epistula Piliae. Abstuli, aperui, legi. Valde scripta est

to playing patience, as the Sicilians say, for one year only. So fight for me, for fear extension of office might spoil my conduct.

To return to the commissions you have given me. Prefects have exemption from serving on a jury. Give the office to whom you will. I shall not be so *difficile*, as I was in the case of Appuleius. I am as fond of Xeno as you are, and I am sure he knows it. I have put you in well-deserved favour with Patro and the other blockheads. Ister has told me you have written to him that you learned from Patro's letter I was taking an interest in the point, much to his delight. But when Patro urged me to ask your Areopagus to cancel the minute they had made when Polycharmus was praetor, it seemed better to Xeno and afterwards to Patro himself that I should send a letter to Memmius, who had set out to Mitylenae the day before I arrived at Athens, asking him to inform his agents that the minute could be cancelled with his free consent. For Xeno was sure the Areopagus would refuse to act against his will. Memmius had abandoned his plan of building a house; but he was angry with Patro. I enclose a copy of the careful letter I wrote him.

Please convey my condolences to Pilia. I will tell you a secret you are not to repeat to her: I received the

συμπαθῶς. Brundisio quae tibi parcel containing her letter, took it out, opened and read it. It was written in terms of sympathy for Quintus. Please consider the letters you got from Brundisium without one from me as having

redditae sunt sine mea, tum been despatched when I was videlicet datas, cum ego me non indisposed. I won't ask you to accept belle haberem. Nam illam νομῆαν the lazy man's stock excuse, my ἀργίας^[179] excusationem ne business. Take great care to keep me acceperis. Cura, ut omnia sciam, sed well posted up in news, and still maxime ut valeas. greater care to preserve your health.

XII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in medio mari
med. m. Quint. a. 703*

Negotium
magnum est
navigare atque id mense Quintili.
Sexto die Delum Athenis venimus.
Pr. Nonas Quintiles a Piraeo ad
Zostera vento molesto; qui nos
ibidem Nonis tenuit. Ante VIII Idus
ad Ceo iucunde; inde Gyarum saevo
vento, non adverso; hinc Syrum,
inde Delum, utroque citius, quam
vellemus, cursum confecimus. Nam
nosti aphracta Rhodiorum; nihil,
quod minus fluctum ferre possit.
Itaque erat in animo nihil festinare
nec me Delo movere, nisi omnia
ἄκρωτήρια Γυρέων vidissem.

De Messalla ad te, statim ut
audivi, de Gyaro dedi litteras et—id
ipsum consilium nostrum—etiam ad
Hortensium, cui quidem valde
συνηγώνιον. Sed tuas de eius iudicii
sermonibus et mehercule omni de rei
publicae statu litteras exspecto
πολιτικώτερον quidem scriptas,
quoniam meos cum Thallumeto
nostro pervolutas libros, eius modi,
inquam, litteras, ex quibus ego, non
quid fiat (nam id vel Helonius, vir
gravissimus, potest efficere, cliens
tuus), sed quid futurum sit, sciam.

XII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

At sea, July, B.C. 51

A sea voyage is a big business,
especially in the month of July. Six
days after leaving Athens I came to
Delos. On the 6th of July I got from
the Piraeus to Zoster with a contrary
wind which kept us there on the 7th.
On the 8th we reached Ceos in fine
weather. From there we came to
Gyaros, with a wind strong, but not
contrary: thence to Syros, and from
Syros to Delos; in both cases sailing
quicker than we could have wished.
You know by this time what the open
boats of Rhodes are like, poor things
in a rough sea. So I have made up
my mind not to hurry and not to stir
from Delos until I see “all the peaks
of Gyrae” clear.

I sent you a letter about Messalla
at once from Gyaros as soon as I
heard, and another on my own
initiative to Hortensius, for I felt
much sympathy with him. I await a
letter from you to give me the gossip
about the verdict and about the
political situation, dealing, if I may
say so, more with public topics,

Cum haec leges, habebimus consules. Omnia perspicere

[179](#). νομαίαν ἀργίας Tyrrell: νομαναρία me MSS.

poteris de Caesare, de Pompeio, de ipsis iudiciis. Nostra autem negotia, quoniam Romae commoraris, amabo te, explica. Cui rei fugerat me rescribere, de strue laterum, plane rogo, de aqua, si quid poterit fieri, eo sis ammo, quo soles esse; quam ego cum mea sponte tum tuis sermonibus aestimo plurimi. Ergo tu id conficies. Praeterea, si quid Philippus rogabit, quod in tua re faceres, id velim facias. Plura scribam ad te, cum constitero. Nunc eram plane in medio mari.

since now, with the aid of Thallumetus, you are running through my books. I don't want a letter to tell me what is actually happening, for that tiresome fellow your client Helonius can do that: but I want to know what is likely to happen.

By the time you read this, consuls will have been

elected. You will be able to have clear views about Caesar and Pompey and the trials themselves. And please arrange my affairs, since you are staying in town. Oh, I forgot to answer one question about the brickwork: as to the aqueduct, without entering into particulars, please be as kind as you always are, if anything can be done. To the last item, my own views as well as your letters lead me to attach very great importance: so please get it done. Furthermore, if the contractor puts you any questions, please act as you would in your own case. I will write a longer letter, when I am on dry land. At present I am far out at sea.

XIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Ephesi VII K.
Sext. a. 703*

Ephesum
venimus a.
d. XI Kal. Sextiles sexagesimo et
quingentesimo post pugnam
Bovillanam. Navigavimus sine
timore et sine nausea, sed tardius
propter aphractorum Rhodiorum
imbecillitatem. De concursu
legationum, privatorum, et de
incredibili multitudine, quae mihi
iam Sami, sed mirabilem in modum
Ephesi praesto fuit, aut audisse te
puto aut “Quid ad me attinet?”
Verum tamen decumani, quasi
venissem cum imperio, Graeci quasi
Ephesio praetori se alacres
obtulerunt. Ex quo te intellegere
certo scio multorum annorum
ostentationes meas nunc in discrimen
esse adductas. Sed, ut spero, utemur
ea palaestra, quam a te didicimus,
omnibusque satis faciemus et eo
facilius, quod in nostra provincia
confectae sunt

XIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Ephesus, July 26, B.C.
51*

I
rea
che
d Ephesus on the 22nd of July, the
five hundred and sixtieth day after
the battle of Bovillae.^[180] The voyage
caused me no alarm and no sickness,
but was slow owing to the crankiness
of the open boats. I imagine you
have heard about the crowd of
legations and of private suitors and
about the astonishing number of
people who met me even at Samos,
and even more noticeably at
Ephesus; or you may say it does not
interest you. Still the tax-collectors
thrust themselves on my notice as
though I had come with an army
behind me, and the Greeks as if I
were governor of Asia. You will see
that the professions of my life are
now being put to the test. I hope I
shall employ the training I have
learned from you and satisfy
everybody, the more easily because
in my province the contracts have
been settled. But

¹⁸⁰. The murder of Clodius, Jan. 18, B.C. 52.

pactiones. Sed hactenus, praesertim cum cenanti mihi nuntiarit Cestius se de nocte proficisci.

Tua negotiola Ephesi curae mihi fuerunt, Thermoque tametsi ante adventum meum liberalissime erat pollicitus tuis omnibus, tamen Philogenem et Seium tradidi, Apollonidensem Xenonem commendavi. Omnino omnia se facturum recepit. Ego praeterea rationem Philogeni permutationis eius, quam tecum feci, edidi. Ergo haec quoque hactenus.

Redeo ad urbana. Per fortunas! quoniam Romae manes, primum illud praefulci atque praemuni, quaeso, ut simus annui, ne intercaletur quidem. Deinde exhauri mea mandata maximeque, si quid potest de illo domestico scrupulo, quem non ignoras, dein de Caesare, cuius in cupiditatem te auctore incubui, nec me piget. Et, si intellegis, quam meum sit scire et curare, quid in re publica fiat—fiat autem? immo vero etiam quid futurum sit, perscribe ad me omnia, sed diligentissime imprimisque, ecquid iudiciorum status aut factorum aut futurorum etiam laboret. De aqua, si curae est, si quid Philippus aget, animadvertes.

enough of this, especially as Cestius has interrupted my dinner with news that he is starting to-night.

I attended to your little jobs at Ephesus and although before my arrival Thermus had given the most lavish promises to all your people, still I introduced Philogenes and Seius to him, and recommended Xeno of Apollonis. He undertook to do everything. In addition I submitted to Philogenes an account of the sum I got from you by negotiating a bill of exchange. So enough of this too.

I return to town affairs. Since you are staying in Rome, in heaven's name, do support and establish my plea to be let off with one year of office without additions to the calendar. Execute all my commissions; particularly get over that hitch in my private affairs of which you are aware, and over the business with Caesar. It was you who led me to try to pay my debt, and I am glad. If you understand my *penchant* to know and trouble about what is happening in public life, or rather what is going to happen, write to me in full and with accuracy, especially whether there is any break-down at all in the trials that have been held or are going to be held. If you are interested about the

aqueduct, and if the contractor is at work, please give it your attention.

XIV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Trallibus VI K.
Sext. a. 703*

Antequa
m aliquo
loco consedero, neque longas a me
neque semper mea manu litteras
exspectabis; cum autem erit spatium,
utrumque praestabo. Nunc iter
conficiebamus aestuosa et
pulverulenta via. Dederam

XIV

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Tralles, July 27, B.C.

51

You must not expect long letters from me nor always letters in my own handwriting, till I have settled down somewhere. When I have time, I will guarantee both. I am now engaged on a hot and dusty journey. I wrote yesterday from Ephesus; to-day

Epheso pridie; has dedi Trallibus. In provincia mea fore me putabam Kal. Sextilibus. Ex ea die, si me amas, παράπηγμα ἐνιαύσιον commoveto. Interea tamen haec mihi, quae vellem, adferebantur, primum otium Parthicum, dein confectae pactiones publicanorum, postremo seditio militum sedata ab Appio stipendiumque eis usque ad Idus Quinctiles persolutum.

Nos Asia accepit admirabiliter. Adventus noster nemini ne minimo quidem fuit sumptui. Spero meos omnes servire laudi meae. Tamen magno timore sum, sed bene speramus. Omnes iam nostri praeter Tullium tuum venerunt. Erat mihi in

I write from Tralles. I expect to be in my province on the 1st of August. Let that day, if you love me, be notched^[181] as the first of my year of office. Meantime the following welcome news has reached me, that the Parthians are at peace; secondly that the contracts with the tax-farmers have been settled, and lastly that Appius has quelled a mutiny of his soldiers and paid them up to the 15th of July.

Asia has given me an astonishing welcome. My coming has cost no one a penny. I trust that my staff are cherishing my good name. I am very nervous: but I hope for the best. All of them have joined me except your

animo recta proficisci ad exercitum, aestivos menses reliquos rei militari dare, hibernos iuris dictioni.

Tu velim, si me nihilo minus nosti curiosum in re publica quam te, scribas ad me omnia, quae sint, quae futura sint. Nihil mihi gratius facere potes; nisi tamen id erit mihi gratissimum, si, quae tibi mandavi, confeceris imprimisque illud ἐνδόμυχον, quo mihi scis nihil esse carius. Habes epistulam plenam festinationis et pulveris; reliquae subtiliores erunt.

friend Tullius. I intend to go straight to my army, to devote the remaining summer months to military matters, and the winter to judicial business.

As you know that I am as interested as you in political business, please write to me everything that is happening and is likely to happen. You can do me no greater service, except the greatest service of all, which is to carry out my commissions, particularly that household matter with which you know I am greatly concerned. This letter is full of dust and hurry: others shall be more in detail.

XV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Laodiceae III
Non. Sext. a. 703*

Laodicea
m veni I
pridie Kal. Sextiles. Ex hoc die rea
clavum anni movebis. Nihil che
exoptatus adventu meo,

nihil carius. Sed est incredibile, quam me negotii taedeat, non habeat satis magnum campum ille tibi non ignotus cursus animi et industriae meae, praeclara opera cesset. Quippe, ius Laodiceae me dicere, cum Romae A. Plotius dicat, et, cum exercitum noster amicus habeat tantum, me nomen habere duarum legionum exilium? Denique haec non desidero, lucem, forum, urbem, domum, vos desidero. Sed feram, ut potero, sit modo annum. Si prorogatur, actum est. Verum perfacile resisti potest, tu modo Romae sis.

XV

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Laodicea, Aug. 3,
B.C. 51*

d Laodicea on the 31st of July. So notch that day as the beginning of my year of office. My arrival has been looked forward to with desire and longing.

[181](#). παράπηγμα ἐνιαύσιον corresponds to *clavus anni* of the next letter. The expression arose from the custom of driving a nail into the right wall of the Temple of Jupiter on the Ides of September every year to keep count of the years.

You would never believe how sick I am of the business and I cannot find sufficient scope for the wide interests and energy you know I possess, and do nothing noticeable. To think that I hold court in Laodicea, while A. Plotius does so at Rome, and that I have the nominal command of two skeleton legions, while Caesar has a huge army! However, it is not these advantages I miss: it is the world, the Forum, the city, my home and you. I will bear as best I can a year of office: an extension would kill me. Still we may combat that very easily if only you are at Rome.

Quaeris, quid hic agam. Ita vivam, ut maximos sumptus facio. Mirifice delector hoc instituto. Admirabilis abstinentia ex praeceptis tuis, ut verear, ne illud, quod tecum permutavi, versura mihi solvendum sit. Appi vulnera non refrico, sed apparent nec oculi possunt. Iter Laodicea faciebam a. d. III Non. Sextiles, cum has litteras dabam, in castra in Lycaoniam. Inde ad Taurum cogitabam, ut cum Moeragene signis collatis, si possem, de servo tuo deciderem.

“Clitellae bovi sunt impositae; plane non est nostrum onus.”

Sed feremus, modo, si me amas, sim annuus. Adsis tu ad tempus, ut senatum totum excites. Mirifice sollicitus sum, quod iam diu mihi ignota sunt ista omnia. Quare, ut ad te ante scripsi, cum cetera tum res publica cura ut mihi nota sit. Plura scribam. Tarde tibi redditu iri,^[182] sed dabam familiari homini ac domestico, C. Andronico Puteolano. Tu autem

¹⁸². *The text here is uncertain.*

saepe dare tabellariis
publicanorum poteris per magistrorum
scripturae et portus nostrarum
dioecesium.

You ask what I am doing. Upon my life I am spending a fortune. I am marvellously pleased with the rule of conduct I have formed: and you have taught me to be so admirably self-restrained that I fear I may have to borrow to pay off the money I took from you. I avoid opening the wounds which Appius has inflicted on the province: but they are patent and cannot be hidden. I travel from Laodicea on the 3rd of August, the date of this letter, to the camp in Lycaonia. Thence I intend to go to Taurus, so that I may settle the matter of your slave, if possible, by pitched battle with Moeragenes.

“’Tis the ox that bears the load, not I.”

I can endure; but, for heaven’s sake, let it be only for a year. You must be in town at the proper time to stir up every member of the House. I am marvellously anxious, because it is so long since I have had news: so, as I wrote before, give me news of political matters as well as other things. I will write more fully. [This letter I know] will be a long time in reaching you: but I am giving it to a trusty and intimate friend, C. Andronicus of

Puteoli. You, however, will be able to get the contractors for the pasture-dues and harbour-duties of

my districts to send yours by the tax-gatherers' messengers.

XVI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in itinere a
Synnada ad
Philomelium inter a.
d. V et III Id. Sext. a.
703*

Etsi in
ipso itinere
et via
discedebant

publicanorum tabellarii, et eramus in cursu, tamen surripiendum aliquid putavi spatii, ne me immemorem mandati tui putares. Itaque subsedi in ipsa via, dum haec, quae longiorem desiderant orationem, summatim tibi perscriberem. Maxima exspectatione in perditam et plane eversam in perpetuum provinciam nos venisse scito pridie Kal. Sextiles, moratos triduum Laodiceae, triduum Apameae, totidem dies Synnade. Audivimus nihil aliud nisi imperata ἐπικεφάλια solvere non posse, ὧνὰς omnium venditas, civitatum gemitus, ploratus, monstra quaedam non hominis, sed ferae nescio cuius immanis. Quid quaeris? taedet omnino eos vitae. Levantur tamen miserae civitates, quod nullus fit sumptus in nos neque in legatos neque in quaestorem neque in quemquam. Scito non modo nos foenum, aut quod e lege Iulia dari solet, non accipere, sed ne ligna quidem, nec praeter quattuor lectos et tectum quemquam accipere

quicquam, multis locis ne tectum
quidem, et in tabernaculo manere
plerumque. Itaque incredibilem in

XVI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*On the road from
Synnada to
Philomelium, between
Aug. 9 and 11, B.C. 51*

Though the tax-farmers' messengers are actually on their road and I am travelling, still I think I must snatch a moment for fear you may imagine I have forgotten your commission. So I sit down on the high road to scribble you a summary of what really calls for a long epistle. You must know that my arrival in this province, which is in a state of lasting ruin and desolation, was expected eagerly. I got here on the 31st of July. I stayed three days at Laodicea, three at Apamea, and as many at Synnas.^[183] Everywhere I heard the same tale. People could not pay the poll-tax: they were forced to sell out their investments: groans and lamentations in the towns, and awful conduct of one who is some kind of savage beast rather than a man. All the people are, as you may suppose, tired of life. However, the poor towns are relieved that they have had to spend nothing on me, my legates,

or a quaestor, or anyone. For you must know that I not only refused to accept pay, or what is a proper perquisite under the Julian law, but that none of us will take firewood or anything beyond four beds and a roof; and in many places we do not accept even a roof, but remain mostly under canvas. So extraordinary

[183](#). This name is found in three forms in classical authors—Synnada (neut. pl.), Synnada (fem. sing.), as in the superscription to this letter, and Synnas, as here.

modum concursus fiunt ex agris, ex vicis, ex domibus omnibus. Mehercule etiam adventu nostro reviviscunt. Iustitia, abstinentia, dementia tui Ciceronis itaque opiniones omnium superavit. Appius, ut audivit nos venire, in ultimam provinciam se coniecit Tarsum usque. Ibi forum agit. De Partho silentium est, sed tamen concisos equites nostros a barbaris nuntiabant ii, qui veniebant. Bibulus ne cogitabat quidem etiam nunc in provinciam suam accedere; id autem facere ob eam causam dicebant, quod tardius vellet decedere. Nos in castra properabamus, quae aberant bidui.

throng of people have come to meet me from farms and villages and every homestead. Upon my word my very coming seems to revive them. Your friend Cicero has won all hearts by his justice and self-restraint and kind bearing. When Appius heard of my arrival, he betook himself to the extreme border of the province, right up by Tarsus. There he holds court. There is no news of the Parthians, but chance arrivals report that they have cut up our cavalry. Even now Bibulus is not thinking of coming to his province: people say because he desires to be late in departing from it. I am hurrying into camp, which is two days' journey away.

XVII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in itinere ad
castra inter IV Id. et
prid. Id. Sext. a. 703*

Accepi
Roma sine I
epistula tua got
fasciculum litterarum; in quo, si a
modo valuisti et Romae fuisti, bun
Philotimi duco esse culpam, non
tuam. Hanc epistulam dictavi sedens
in raeda, cum in castra proficiscerer,
a quibus aberam bidui. Paucis diebus
habebam certos homines, quibus
darem litteras. Itaque eo me servavi.
Nos tamen, etsi hoc te ex aliis audire
malo, sic in provincia nos gerimus,
quod ad abstinentiam attinet, ut
nullus terruncius insumatur in
quemquam. Id fit etiam et legatorum
et tribunorum et praefectorum
diligentia; nam omnes mirifice
συμφιλοδοξοῦσιν gloriae meae.
Lepta noster mirificus est. Sed nunc
propero. Perscribam ad te paucis
diebus omnia. Cicerones nostros
Deiotarus filius, qui rex ab senatu
appellatus est

XVII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*On the same journey,
between Aug. 10 and
12, B.C. 51*

I
got
a
bundle of letters from Rome without one
from you. Supposing you are well
and in town, I imagine the fault was
Philotimus' and not yours. This letter
is dictated as I sit in my carriage on
my road to the camp, from which I
am distant two days' journey. In a
few days' time I have trusty
messengers: so I reserve myself for
that time. I should like you to hear
the news from others; but I can't
help saying that I am conducting
myself in the province with such
restraint that not a halfpenny is spent
on any of us. For that I have to thank
the conduct of the legates, tribunes
and praetors. For all of them take a
surprising pride in maintaining my
good name. Our friend Lepta is
wonderful. I am in a hurry now, and
will write everything in a few days'
time. The younger Deiotarus, who
was styled king by the Senate, has
taken the two boys to his court. So
long

secum in regnum. Dum in aestivis nos essemus, illum pueris locum esse bellissimum duximus.

Sestius ad me scripsit, quae tecum esset de mea domestica et maxima cura locutus, et quid tibi esset visum. Amabo te, incumbe in eam rem et ad me scribe, quid et possit, et tu censeas. Idem scripsit Hortensium de proroganda nostra provincia dixisse nescio quid. Mihi in Cumano diligentissime se, ut annui essemus, defensurum receperat. Si quicquam me amas, hunc locum muni. Dici non potest, quam invitus a vobis adsim; et simul hanc gloriam iustitiae et abstinentiae fore inlustriorem spero, si cito decesserimus, id quod Scaevolae contigit, qui solos novem menses Asiae praefuit.

Appius noster, cum me adventare videret, profectus est Tarsum usque Laodicea. Ibi forum agit, cum ego sim in provincia. Quam eius iniuriam non insector. Satis enim habeo negotii in sanandis vulneribus, quae sunt imposita provinciae; quod do operam ut faciam quam minima cum illius contumelia. Sed hoc Bruto nostro velim dicas, illum fecisse non belle, qui adventu meo, quam longissime potuerit, discesserit.

as I am in my summer camp, I fancied that would be the best place for them.

Sestius wrote me an account of his conversation with you about my pressing domestic affairs, and of your opinion. Please devote yourself to the business and write to me what can be done and what you think. Sestius told me that Hortensius has said something or other about extending my term of office. He undertook at Cumae to take good care that it should not outlast a year. If you have any regard for me, get that point fixed up squarely. I cannot describe my dislike to being away from you. Moreover I hope that my justice and restraint may become more famous, if I leave soon: for it was so in the case of Scaevola, who governed Asia only nine months.

On seeing that I was about to arrive, our friend Appius left Laodicea and went up to Tarsus. I am not offended at the slight he has done me by holding court while I am in the province, for I have enough business to heal the wounds that he has inflicted on it: and I try to do this with as little reflection on him as possible. But please tell our friend Brutus, that his father-in-law has not acted well in going away as far as he could on my arrival.

XVIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in castris ad
Cybistra
Cappadociae XI K.
Oct. a. 703*

Quam
vellem
Romae
esses, si
forte non es. Nihil enim certi
habebamus nisi accepisse nos tuas
litteras a. d. XIII Kal. Sextil. datas, in
quibus scriptum esset te in Epirum
iturum circiter Kal. Sextil. Sed, sive
Romae es sive in Epiro, Parthi
Euphraten transierunt

duce Pacoro, Orodís regis
Parthorum filio, cunctis fere copiis.
Bibulus nondum audiebatur esse in
Syria; Cassius in oppido Antiochia
est cum omni exercitu, nos in
Cappadocia ad Taurum cum exercitu,
ad Cybistra; hostis in Cyrrhestica,
quae Syriae pars proxima est
provinciae meae. His de rebus scripsi
ad senatum, quas litteras, si Romae
es, videbis putesne reddendas, et
multa, immo omnia, quorum
κεφάλαιον, ne quid inter caesa et
porrecta, ut aiunt, oneris mihi
addatur aut temporis. Nobis enim
hac infirmitate exercitus, inopia

XVIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

I
f
you
don

*In camp at Cybistra in
Cappadocia, Sept. 20,
B.C. 51*

't happen to be in town, I wish to
goodness you were. I have no
positive news beyond your letter
dated the 19th of July, in which you
said you were going to Epirus about
the 1st of August. But whether you
are at Rome or in Epirus, the
Parthians have crossed the Euphrates
under the leadership of

Pacorus, a son of the Parthian king
Orodes, with nearly all their forces.
There is no news of the presence of
Bibulus in Syria: Cassius is in the
town of Antioch with his whole
army. I am in Cappadocia near the
Taurus with my army close to
Cybistra. The enemy is in
Cyrrhestica, a district of Syria
adjoining my province. I have sent a
despatch to the Senate on the
situation. If you are in Rome, please
look at the despatch and say whether
you think it ought to be delivered:
and so for my other affairs, chief of
which is lest there be, as the saying

sociorum, praesertim fidelium, certissimum subsidium est hiems. Ea si venerit, nec illi ante in meam provinciam transierint, unum vereor, ne senatus propter urbanarum rerum metum Pompeium nolit dimittere. Quodsi alium ad ver mittit, non laboro, nobis modo temporis ne quid prorogetur. Haec igitur, si es Romae; sin abes, aut etiam si ades, haec negotia sic se habent. Stamus animis et, quia consiliis, ut videmur, bonis utimur, speramus etiam manu. Tuto consedimus copioso a frumento, Ciliciam prope conspiciente, expedito ad mutandum loco parvo exercitu, sed, ut spero, ad benevolentiam erga nos consentiente. Quem nos Deiotari adventu cum suis omnibus copiis duplicaturi eramus. Sociis multo fidelioribus utimur, quam quisquam usus est; quibus incredibilis videtur nostra et mansuetudo et abstinentia. Dilectus habetur

goes, any slip between the cup and the lip,^[184] I mean that I may not be burdened with an extension of office. Considering the weakness of my army, my want of allies, especially faithful allies, my most sure support is the winter weather. If winter comes and the enemy have not first crossed into my province, I am afraid the Senate may refuse to let Pompey leave Rome owing to fear of disturbance at home. But if it sends some one else by spring, I don't care, provided that there be no extension of my term of office. Those are my commissions, if you are in town. If you are out of town, or even if you are not, the situation is this. I am in excellent spirits; and I hope, as my plans are well laid, that I am not too sanguine about my preparations. I have pitched camp in a safe spot, well supplied on the score of corn, almost within sight of Cilicia, convenient for change of quarters, with an army small but, I hope, very loyal to me, which will be doubled by the arrival of Deiotarus with all his forces. I have found our allies far more loyal than any of my predecessors have found them. They cannot understand my mildness and self-abnegation. A levy is

¹⁸⁴. Lit. "Between the slaying and the offering of the victim."

civium Romanorum; frumentum ex agris in loca tuta comportatur. Si fuerit occasio, manu, si minus, locis nos defendemus. Quare bono animo es. Video enim te et, quasi coram adsis, ita cerno συμπάθειαν amoris tui. Sed te rogo, si ullo pacto fieri poterit, si integra in senatu nostra causa ad Kal. Ianuarias manserit, ut Romae sis mense Ianuario. Profecto nihil accipiam iniuriae, si tu aderis. Amicos consules habemus, nostrum tribunum pl. Furnium. Verum tua est opus adsiduitate, prudentia, gratia. Tempus est necessarium. Sed turpe est me pluribus verbis agere tecum.

Cicerones nostri sunt apud Deiotarum, sed, si opus erit, deducuntur Rhodum. Tu, si es Romae, ut soles, diligentissime, si in Epiro, mitte tamen ad nos de tuis aliquem tabellarium, ut et tu, quid nos agamus, et nos, quid tu agas quidque acturus sis, scire possimus. Ego tui Bruti rem sic ago, ut suam ipse non ageret. Sed iam exhibeo pupillum neque defendo; sunt enim negotia et lenta et inania. Faciam tamen satis tibi quidem, cui difficilius est quam ipsi; sed certe satis faciam utrique.

being held of Roman citizens: corn is being brought from the country into safe strongholds. Should occasion arise, I should defend myself by force, but otherwise I shall depend on my position. So be of good cheer. You are always in my mind's eye. and I understand your affectionate sympathy as if you were standing here. But I beseech you, if it can be arranged and supposing that my case is not debated in the House up to the first of January, to be in Rome during that month. I shall be treated fairly, if you are there. The consuls are my friends; Furnius the tribune of the people is devoted to me: but I want you with your ingratiating and skilful persistence. It is a critical time. But it would be a shame for me to press you further.

My son and nephew are staying with Deiotarus. If necessary, they shall be sent to Rhodes. If you are in Rome, send me a message with your usual regularity. And even if you are in Epirus, send me one of your messengers, that you may know my proceedings, and I may know your present and future plans. I am managing your friend Brutus' business better than he could himself. But I now hand my ward^[185] over to the creditors and refuse to set up any plea for him. They are an impracticable and impecunious lot.

However I shall satisfy you, which is more difficult even than satisfying Brutus. Indeed I will satisfy you both.

[185](#). Ariobarzanes, King of Cappadocia, who owed money to Brutus.

XIX

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in castris ad
Cybistra XI K. Oct. a.
703*

Obsignar
am iam
epistulam

eam, quam puto te modo perlegisse scriptam mea manu, in qua omnia continentur, cum subito Apellae tabellarius a. d. XI Kal. Octobres septimo quadragesimo die Roma celeriter (hui tam longe!) mihi tuas litteras reddidit. Ex quibus non dubito, quin tu Pompeium exspectaris, dum Arimino rediret, et iam in Epirum profectus sis, magisque vereor, ut scribis, ne in Epiro sollicitus sis non minus, quam nos hic sumus.

De Atiliano nomine scripsi ad Philotimum, ne appellaret Messallam. Itineris nostri famam ad te pervenisse laetor magisque laetabor, si reliqua cognoris. Filiolam tuam tibi caram ac^[186] iucundam esse gaudeo, eamque quam numquam vidi, tamen et amo et amabilem esse certo scio. Etiam atque etiam vale.

De Patrone et tuis condiscipulis quae de parietinis in Melita laboravi, ea tibi grata esse gaudeo. Quod scribis libente te repulsam tulisse eum, qui cum sororis tuae filii patruo

XIX

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*In the camp at
Cybistra, Sept. 20,
B.C. 51*

I
had
alre
ady

sealed the letter, which I fancy you must have just read, written in my own handwriting and containing a full account of events, when suddenly your letter was delivered to me on September 20th by a letter carrier of Apelles, who had done a journey express from Rome in forty-seven days. Ah, what a long way it is! It makes me sure that you awaited Pompey's return from Ariminum, and have now set out for Epirus, and I fear from your tone, that you may be in as great straits in Epirus as I am here.

I have written to my wife's steward not to dun Messalla for the money due from Atilius. I am delighted you have heard reports of my official progress, and I shall be still more delighted if you hear of my other good deeds. I am glad that you are pleased with your little daughter. I have never seen her, but I love her and I am sure she is lovable. Good-bye, again good-bye.

certarit, magni amoris signum. Itaque me etiam admonuisti, ut gauderem, nam mihi in mentem non venerat. “Non credo,” inquis. Ut

[186](#). *caram ac Müller: iam Romae MSS.: tam moratam Tyrrell.*

Talking of Patro and your friends of his school, I am glad you liked my efforts about the ruins in Melita. It is a sign of great affection on your part, to rejoice in the defeat of a man^{[187](#)} who opposed the uncle of your sister’s son. You have put it into my head to rejoice too. It had not occurred to me. You need not believe me, if you like: but really I

[187](#). Probably C. Hirrus, who had just failed to obtain the curule aedileship. He had previously stood for the augurate, when Cicero had been successful. Others, however, suggest M. Calidius, who had criticized Cicero’s oratorical style and prosecuted Q. Gallius in 64 B.C., when Cicero defended him.

libet; sed plane gaudeo, quoniam
τὸ νemesῶν interest τοῦ φθονεῖν.

am glad, because righteous
indignation is different from malice.

XX

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Cilicia a. 703
inter a. d. XII et IV K.
Ian.*

Saturnali
bus mane se
mihi

Pindenissitae dediderunt septimo et quinquagesimo die, postquam oppugnare eos coepimus. “Qui, malum! isti Pindenissitae qui sunt?” inquires; “nomen audiui numquam.” Quid ego faciam? num potui Ciliciam Aetoliam aut Macedoniam reddere? Hoc iam sic habeto, nec hoc exercitu nec hic tanta negotia geri potuisse. Quae cognosce ἐν ἐπιτομῇ; sic enim concedis mihi proxumis litteris. Ephesum ut venerim, nosti, qui etiam mihi gratulatus es illius diei celebritatem, qua nihil me umquam delectavit magis. Inde in oppidis iis, qua iter erat, mirabiliter accepti Laodiceam pridie Kal. Sextiles venimus. Ibi morati biduum perillustres fuimus honorificisque verbis omnes iniurias revellimus superiores, quod idem Colossis, dein Apameae quinque dies morati et Synnadis triduum, Philomeli quinque dies, Iconi decem fecimus. Nihil ea iuris dictione aequabilius, nihil lenius, nihil gravius. Inde in castra veni a. d. VII Kalendas Septembres. A. d. III

XX

CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.

*In Cilicia, between
Dec. 19 and 27, B.C.
51*

On the morning of the 17th of December the Pindenissitae surrendered to me, on the fifty-seventh day from the commencement of my siege. “The Pindenissitae!” you will exclaim, “Who the deuce are they? I never heard the name.” That is not my fault. Could I turn Cilicia into Aetolia or Macedonia? Take this for granted that with my army and in my position such a big business was impossible. Here is a synopsis of the affair. You agreed to that in your last letter. You are aware of my arrival at Ephesus, for you have congratulated me on the reception I got on the day of arrival, which delighted me beyond words. Thence, after a marvellous welcome in the towns on my way, I reached Laodicea on the 31st of July. I stayed there two days in great state and with nattering speeches took the sting out of all past injuries. I did the same at Colossae and during a stay of five

exercitum lustravi apud Iconium. Ex his castris, cum graves de Parthis nuntii venirent, perrexi in Ciliciam per Cappadociae partem eam, quae Ciliciam attingit, eo consilio, ut Armenius Artavasdes et ipsi Parthi

days at Apamea, three at Synnada, five at Philomelus and ten at Iconium. Nothing could be more fair, lenient or dignified than my legal decisions. From there I came to camp on the 24th of August. On the 28th I reviewed the army at Iconium. On receipt of grave news about the Parthians I left camp for Cilicia travelling through that part of Cappadocia which borders on Cilicia, intending that the Armenian Artavasdes and the Parthians themselves should realize they were cut off from entering Cappadocia. After camping five

Cappadocia se excludi putarent. Cum dies quinque ad Cybistra Cappadociae castra habuissem, certior sum factus Parthos ab illo aditu Cappadociae longe abesse, Ciliciae magis imminere. Itaque confestim iter in Ciliciam feci per Tauri pylas. Tarsum veni a. d. III Nonas Octobres. Inde ad Amanum contendi, qui Syriam a Cilicia in aquarum divertio dividit; qui mons erat hostium plenus sempiternorum. Hic a. d. III Idus Octobr. magnum numerum hostium occidimus. Castella munitissima nocturno Pomptini adventu, nostro matutino cepimus, incendimus. Imperatores appellati sumus. Castra paucos dies habuimus ea ipsa, quae contra Darium habuerat apud Issum

days at Cybistra in Cappadocia, I got information that the Parthians were far distant from that entrance into Cappadocia, and rather were threatening Cilicia. So I made a forced march into Cilicia by the gates of Taurus. I reached Tarsus on the 5th of October. Thence I hurried to Amanus, which divides Syria from Cilicia by its watershed, a mountain that has always been full of our enemies. Here on the 13th of October we cut up a large body of the enemy. I captured some strongly fortified posts by a night assault of Pomptinus and a day assault of my own: and we burned them. I was hailed as "General." For a few days I pitched camp at the very spot near Issus, where Alexander had camped against Darius. He was rather a

Alexander, imperator haud paulo melior quam aut tu aut ego. Ibi dies quinque morati direpto et vastato Amano inde discessimus. Interim (scis enim dici quaedam πανικά, dici item τὰ κενὰ τοῦ πολέμου) rumore adventus nostri et Cassio, qui Antiochia tenebatur, animus accessit, et Parthis timor iniectus est. Itaque eos cedentes ab oppido Cassius insecutus rem bene gessit. Qua in fuga magna auctoritate Osaces dux Parthorum vulnus accepit eoque interiit paucis post diebus. Erat in Syria nostrum nomen in gratia. Venit interim Bibulus; credo, voluit appellatione hac inani nobis esse par. In eodem Amano coepit loreolam in mustaceo quaerere. At ille cohortem primam totam perdidit centurionemque primi pili, nobilem sui generis, Asinium

better general than you or I. We plundered and devastated Amanos, and after a stay of five days took our departure. Meantime (for you know there are such words as “panic” and “the uncertainties of war”) report of my arrival gave heart to Cassius, who was shut up in Antioch, and it inspired fear in the Parthians. So, as the Parthians retreated from the town, Cassius pursued them and scored a success. In their retreat one of their leaders, Osaces, a man of high rank, was wounded and died a few days afterwards. I was in high favour in Syria. Meantime Bibulus came. I fancy he wanted to be my peer in the matter of that empty title. On this same mountain Amanos he begins his task of looking for a needle in a bottle of hay.^[188] But the whole of his first squadron was lost as well as Asinius Dento, a centurion of the first line and of noble

¹⁸⁸. Lit. “a bay leaf in a wedding cake.” They were baked on bay leaves.

Dentonem, et reliquos cohortis eiusdem et Sex. Lucilium, T. Gavi Caepionis locupletis et splendidi hominis filium, tribunum militum. Same plagam odiosam acceperat cum re tum tempore. Nos ad Pindenissum, quod oppidum munitissimum Eleutherocilicum omnium memoria in armis fuit. Feri homines et acres et omnibus rebus ad

blood,^[189] and other centurions of the same squadron, and a military tribune. Sex. Lucilius son of T. Gavius Caepio, who has wealth and position. It was really a mortifying reverse and inopportune. I was at Pindenissus, the most strongly fortified town in Eleutherocilicia and engaged in war so long as men can remember. The inhabitants were

defendendum parati. Cinximus vallo et fossa, aggere maximo, vineis, turre altissima, magna tormentorum copia, multis sagittariis, magno labore, apparatu, multis sauciis nostris, incolumi exercitu negotium confecimus. Hilara sane Saturnalia militibus quoque, quibus equis exceptis reliquam praedam concessimus. Mancipia venibant Saturnalibus tertiis. Cum haec scribebam in tribunali res erat ad HS [CXX]. Hinc exercitum in hiberna agri male pacati deducendum Quinto fratri dabam; ipse me Laodiceam recipiebam.

Haec adhuc. Sed ad praeterita revertamur. Quod me maxime hortaris et, quod pluris est quam omnia, in quo laboras, ut etiam Ligurino μῶμος satis faciamus, moriar, si quicquam fieri potest elegantius. Nec iam ego hanc continentiam appello, quae virtus voluptati

keen warriors, thoroughly prepared to withstand a siege. We compassed it with a stockade and ditch, with big entrenchments, penthouses, a tall tower, a large supply of artillery and a number of archers. With much toil and preparation I settled the business without loss of life, though many were wounded. I am keeping a festive holiday, as also are my soldiers, to whom I gave all the spoils except the horses. The captives were sold on the third day of the festival of Saturn.^[190] At the time of writing, the sum realized at the auction has reached about £100,000.^[191] I am giving my army to my brother Quintus to take into winter quarters in the more disturbed part of the province, while I am returning myself to Laodicea.

So much for that. To recur to old topics. As for the point of your exhortation, which is more important than anything else about which you are concerned—that I may satisfy even my carping Ligurian critic^[192]—may I die, if conduct could be more fastidious than mine. I am not going to talk of continence, a quality

¹⁸⁹. Or “noble in his own class” (i.e. a good soldier), or “a noble of his own kidney,” with a play on Asinius and *asinus*.

¹⁹⁰. Dec. 19.

¹⁹¹. 12,000,000 sesterces.

[192](#). Probably P. Aelius Ligur, who sided against Cicero at the time of his banishment.

resistere videtur. Ego in vita mea nulla umquam voluptate tanta sum adfectus, quanta adficio hac integritate, nee me tam fama, quae summa est, quam res ipsa delectat. Quid quaeris? fuit tanti. Me ipse non noram nee satis sciebam, quid in hoc genere facere possem. Recte πεφύσημαι. Nihil est praeclarius. Interim haec λαμπρά. Ariobarzanes opera mea vivit, regnat; ἐν παρόδῳ consilio et auctoritate et, quod insidiatoribus. eius ἀπρόσιτον me, non modo ἀδωροδόκητον praebui, regem regnumque servavi. Interea e Cappadocia ne pilum quidem. Brutum abiectum, quantum potui, excitavi; quem non minus amo quam tu, paene dixi, quam te. Atque etiam spero toto anno imperii nostri terruncium sumptus in provincia nullum fore.

Habes omnia. Nunc publice litteras Romam mittere parabam. Uberiores erunt, quam si ex Amano misissem. At te Romae non fore! Sed est totum in eo, quid Kalendis Martiis futurum sit. Vereor enim, ne, cum de provincia agetur, si Caesar resistet, nos retineamur. His tu si adesses, nihil timerem.

Redeo ad urbana, quae ego diu ignorans ex tuis iucundissimis litteris a. d. v Kal. Ianuarias denique

connoting resistance of pleasure: for nothing in my life has given me more pleasure than this rectitude. And it is not so much the enhancement of my reputation, though that is important, as the exercise of the virtue that delights me. I can tell you my exile has been worth while, for I did not understand myself nor realize of what I was capable in this line. I may well be puffed up. It is splendid. Meantime I have made a *coup* in this: it is thanks to me that Ariobarzanes lives and reigns a king. In my progress through the province I have saved a king and a kingdom by the weight of my advice and official position and by refusing to entertain even the visits much less the bribes of conspirators against him. Meantime from Cappadocia not the value of a hair. I stirred up Brutus out of his dejection as much as I could. I love him as well as you do. I had almost said as well as I do you. And I hope that during the whole of my year of office there will not be a penny's expense in my province.

That is the whole story. I am now preparing to send an official despatch to Rome. It will be richer in detail than if I had sent it from Amanus. But fancy your not being in town! Everything hangs on what

cognovi. Eas diligentissime Philogenes, libertus tuus, curavit perlonga et non satis tuta via perferendas.

happens on the 1st of March, for I fear, when the question of the provinces is under debate, that I may be kept here, if Caesar refuses to give up his province. Were you there to take part in the matter, I should have no fears.

To revert to city news, with which I was put in touch only on the 26th of December from your delightful letter. It was the letter which your freedman Philogenes brought to me with scrupulous care after a long and risky journey; for I have not received

Nam, quas Laeni pueris scribis datas, non acceperam. Iucunda de Caesare, et quae senatus decrevit, et quae tu speras. Quibus ille si cedit, salvi sumus. Incendio Plaetoriano quod Seius ambustus est, minus moleste fero. Luceius de Q. Cassio cur tam vehemens fuerit, et quid actum sit, aveo scire.

Ego, cum Laodiceam venero, Quinto, sororis tuae filio, togam puram iubeor dare. Cui moderabor diligentius. Deiotarus, cuius auxiliis magnis usus sum, ad me, ut scripsit, cum Ciceronibus Laodiceam venturus erat. Tuas etiam Epiroticas exspecto litteras, ut habeam rationem non modo negotii, verum etiam otii tui. Nicanor in officio est et a me liberaliter tractatur. Quem, ut puto, Romam cum litteris publicis mittam, ut et diligentius perferantur, et idem

the letter which you say was entrusted to the slaves of Laenius. It was glad tidings that you wrote me about Caesar and the decree of the House and your own hopes. If Caesar falls in with this, I shall be safe from any extension of office. I am not much concerned that Seius was singed in Plaetorius' fire.^[193] I want to know why Luceius was so keen about Q. Cassias and what has happened.

I am commissioned to celebrate the coming of age of Quintus, your sister's son, on arrival at Laodicea. I shall keep a careful hold upon him. Deiotarus, who has been of great help to me, has written that he will come to me at Laodicea with the two boys. I am awaiting another letter from you from Epirus, that I may have an account not only of your

ad me certa de te et a te referat. Alexis quod mihi totiens salutem adscribit, est gratum; sed cur non suis litteris idem facit, quod meus ad te Alexis facit? Phemio quaeritur κέρας. Sed haec hactenus. Cura, ut valeas, et ut sciam, quando cogites Romam. Etiam atque etiam vale.

Tua tuosque Thermo et praesens Ephesi diligentissime commendaram et nunc per litteras ipsumque intellexi esse perstudiosum tui. Tu velim, quod antea

work-a-day life, but of your holiday life. Nicanor is doing his duty by me, and is being well treated. I think I shall send him to Rome with my official despatch, that it may be promptly delivered and at the same time that he may bring me certain news about you and from you. I am pleased that Alexis so often sends greetings to me; but why cannot he put them in a letter of his own, as Tiro, who is my Alexis, does for you. I am searching for a horn for Phemius.^[194] But enough now. Keep your health and let me know when you intend to go to town. Good-bye, again good-bye.

I have been at pains to recommend your interests and your people to Thermus, both personally at Ephesus and now by letter, and I have gathered that he is very solicitous on your behalf. Please execute

^{193.} M. Plaetorius Cestianus was condemned for extortion, and M. Seius as an accessory after the fact.

^{194.} A musical slave belonging to Atticus.

ad te scripsi, de domo Pammeni des operam, ut, quod tuo meoque beneficio puer habet, cures, ne qua ratione convellatur. Utrique nostrum honestum existimo; tum mihi erit pergratum.

XXI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Laodiceae Id.
Febr. a. 704*

Te in
Epirum

salvum venisse et, ut scribis, ex sententia navigasse vehementer gaudeo, non esse Romae meo tempore pernecessario submolesto fero. Hoc me tamen consolor uno, spero te istic iucunde hiemare et libenter requiescere. C. Cassius, frater Q. Cassi, familiaris tui, pudentiores illas litteras miserat, de quibus tu ex me requiris, quid sibi voluerint, quam cas, quas postea misit, quibus per se scribit confectum esse Parthicum bellum. Recesserant illi quidem ab Antiochia ante Bibuli adventum, sed nullo nostro εὐημερήματι; hodie vero hiemant in Cyrrhestica, maximumque bellum impendet. Nam et Orodi, regis Parthorum, filius in provincia nostra est, nec dubitat Deiotarus, cuius filio pacta est Artavasdis filia, ex quo sciri potest, quin cum omnibus copiis ipse prima aestate Euphraten transiturus sit. Quo autem die Cassi litterae victrices in senatu recitatae sunt, datae Nonis Octobribus, eodem meae tumultum nuntiantes. Axius noster ait nostras auctoritatis plenas

fuisse, illis negat creditum. Bibuli
nondum erant allatae; quas certo scio
plenas timoris fore.

my former commissions to look after Pammenes' house, so that the boy may not be robbed of what he owes to your kindness and mine. This I think will redound to our honour and will please me much.

XXI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

I
am
ver

Laodicea, Feb. 13,
B.C. 50

y glad that you have reached Epirus safely, and that you report a voyage to your liking. But I am rather upset that you are absent from Rome at a moment so critical for me. However I have one consolation: I hope you will have a pleasant winter where you are and a nice rest. You ask me the purport of a letter that C. Cassius, the brother of Q. Cassius, your friend, sent me. The letter he wrote is more modest than a subsequent epistle in which he claimed to have ended the Parthian war. The Parthians to be sure had retired from Antioch before the arrival of Bibulus: but it was not thanks to any *coup de main* of our troops. To-day the enemy is wintering in Cyrrhestica and a serious war is imminent: for the son of Orodes the king of the Parthians is in a Roman province, and Deiotarus, to whose son the daughter of Artavasdes is betrothed, a very competent authority, is positive that

the king himself will cross the Euphrates with all his forces in the early summer. On the very day on which Cassius' despatch, dated the 7th of October, announcing victory was read in the Senate, came mine announcing trouble. My friend Axius says that Cassius' despatch gained no belief and mine was considered worthy of attention. Bibulus' despatch had not yet arrived: but I know for a fact that it will express alarm.

Ex his rebus hoc vereor, ne, cum Pompeius propter metum rerum novarum nusquam dimittatur, Caesari nullus honos a senatu habeatur, dum hic nodus expediatur, non putet senatus nos, antequam successum sit, oportere decedere nec in tanto motu rerum tantis provinciis singulos legates praeesse. Hic, ne quid mihi prorogetur, quod ne intercessor quidem sustinere possit, horreo, atque eo magis, quod tu abes, qui consilio, gratia, studio multis rebus occurreres. Sed dices me ipsum mihi sollicitudinem struere. Cogor, ut velim ita sit; sed omnia metuo. Etsi bellum ἀκροτελεύτιον habet illa tua epistula, quam dedisti nauseans Buthroto: "Tibi, ut video et spero, nulla ad decedendum erit mora." Mallem "ut video," nihil opus fuit "ut spero." Acceperam autem satis celeriter Iconi per

This makes me fear that the Senate may pay no respect to Caesar's demands, refusing to let Pompey quit Rome, when revolution is imminent. Until this trouble is unravelled, it may decline to allow me to leave the province before my successor comes, and not be willing to entrust such important provinces in troublous times to legates. So I shudder to think that the term of my office may be extended without even any tribune being able to veto it; and the more so on account of your absence, when you might interfere in many cases with your advice, influence and efforts. You will say I am raising imaginary alarms. I am forced to hope that my alarms may be idle, but everything frightens me. Though your letter written at Buthrotum in sickness had a charming *finale*. "As I see and hope, there will be nothing to hinder your

publicanorum tabellarios a Lentuli triumpho datas. In his γλυκύπικρον illud confirmas, moram mihi nullam fore, deinde addis, si quid secus, te ad me esse venturum. Angunt me dubitationes tuae; simul et vides, quas acceperim litteras. Nam, quas Hermonis centurionis caculae ipse scribis te dedisse, non accepi. Laeni pueris te dedisse saepe ad me scripseras. Eas Laodiceae denique, cum eo venissem, III Idus Februar. Laenius mihi reddidit datas a. d. x Kal. Octobres. Laenio tuas commendationes et statim verbis et reliquo tempore re probabo. Eae litterae cetera vetera habebant, unum

departure,” still I should prefer the phrase “as I see” and there was no need for the words “and hope.” I have received a letter dated just after the triumph of Lentulus, which was brought post haste to Iconium by the tax-farmers’ messengers. In it you repeat that bitter-sweet saying, that there will be no delay, with a postscript, that, if anything goes wrong, you yourself will come to me. I am tortured by the doubts you express: and you may see which of your letters I have received, for I have not got the letter which you say was handed to Hermon the centurion’s orderly. You have repeatedly told me you entrusted a letter to the slaves of Laenius. That letter, which was dated the 21st of September, was handed to me at last by Laenius on my arrival at Laodicea on the 11th of February. I will show Laenius at once in word and in the future in deed that your recommendation carries weight. Besides old topics the letter had

hoc novum de Cibyratis pantheris. Multum te amo, quod respondisti M. Octavio te non putare. Sed posthac omnia, quae recta non erunt, pro certo negato. Nos enim et nostra sponte bene firmi et mehercule auctoritate tua inflammati vicimus omnes (hoc tu ita reperies) cum abstinentia tum iustitia, facilitate, clementia. Cave putes quicquam

one fresh one, the panthers from Cibyra. I am indebted to you for telling M. Octavius that you thought it would be impracticable. But in future give a direct “no” to any undesirable requests. Firm fixed in my own determination and fired by the weight of your opinion, I have overcome everybody as you will find by my justice, self-abnegation and easy courtesy. People were never

homines magis umquam esse miratos quam nullum terruncium me obtinente provinciam sumptus factum esse nec in rem publicam nec in quemquam meorum praeterquam in L. Tullium legatum. Is ceteroqui abstinens, sed Iulia lege transitans, ^[195] semel tamen in diem, non, ut alii solebant, omnibus vicis (praeter eum semel nemo accepit) facit, ut mihi excipiendus sit, cum terruncium nego sumptus factum. Praeter eum accepit nemo. Has a nostro Q. Titinio sordes accepimus.

Ego aestivis confectis Quintum fratrem hibernis et Ciliciae praefeci. Q. Volusium, tui Tiberi generum, certum hominem et mirifice abstinentem, misi in Cyprum, ut ibi pauculos dies esset, ne cives Romani. pauci qui illic negotiantur, ius sibi dictum negarent; nam evocari ex insula Cyprios non licet. Ipse in Asiam profectus sum Tarso Nonis Ianuariis, non mehercule dici potest qua admiratione Ciliciae civitatum maximeque Tarsensium. Postea vero quam Taurum transgressus sum, mirifica exspectatio Asiae nostrarum dioecesium, quae sex mensibus imperii mei nullas meas acceperat litteras, numquam hospitem

¹⁹⁵. transitans *Manutius*: transitam *M*: pransitans *Peerlkamp*: in transitu *Tyrrell*.

more astonished than to learn that not a farthing has been spent during my tenure of office, either on public objects or on any of my staff, except on my legate L. Tullius. He has behaved well on the whole, but under the Julian law on one occasion *en passage* and for the day's needs, and not as others would at every hamlet, he did take something. He is the sole offender; and forces me to add a rider to my remark that not a farthing has been spent upon us. Besides him no one has taken a penny. That blot I owe to my friend Q. Titinius.

When the camp was struck at the end of the summer, I put my brother Quintus in charge of the winter camp and of Cilicia. Q. Volusius, son-in-law of your friend Tiberius, a safe man and wonderfully unselfish, I have sent to Cyprus, ordering him to stay a few days, that the few Roman citizens in business there may not say they have no facilities for legal process: the inhabitants cannot be summoned to a court outside the island. I myself set out for Asia from Tarsus on the fifth of January. I cannot describe how the cities in Cilicia and especially the people of Tarsus looked up to me. After crossing the Taurus, I found Asia, that is so far as my district extends, very keen to welcome me. For during the six months of my

viderat. Illud autem tempus quotannis ante me fuerat in hoc quaestu. Civitates locupletes, ne in hiberna milites reciperent, magnas pecunias dabant, Cyprii talenta Attica cc; qua ex insula (non ὑπερβολικῶς sed verissime loquor) nummus nullus me obtinente erogabitur. Ob haec beneficia, quibus illi obstupescunt, nullos honores mihi nisi verborum decerni sino, statuas, fana, τέθριππα prohibeo, nec sum in ulla re alia molestus civitatibus—sed fortasse tibi, qui haec praedicem de me. Perfer, si me amas; tu enim me haec facere voluisti. Iter igitur ita per Asiam feci, ut etiam fames, qua nihil miserius est, quae tum erat in haec mea Asia (messis enim nulla fuerat), mihi optanda fuerit. Quacumque iter feci, nulla vi, nullo iudicio, nulla contumelia, auctoritate et cohortatione perfeci, ut et Graeci et cives Romani, qui frumentum compresserant, magnum numerum populis pollicerentur. Idibus Februariis, quo die has litteras dedi, forum institueram agere Laodiceae Cibyraticum et Apamense, ex Idibus Martiis ibidem Synnadense, Pamphylium (tum Phemio dispiciam κέρας), Lycaonium, Isauricum; ex Idibus Maiis in Ciliciam, ut ibi

administration, there had been no requisitions and

not a single case of billeting. Before my time this season had been devoted every year to the pursuit of gain. The richer states used to pay large sums to escape from having soldiers billeted on them for the winter. The people of Cyprus used to pay nearly £50,000,^[196] while under my administration, in literal truth, not a penny will be demanded. I will take no honours except speechifying in return for these kindnesses which have so amazed people. I allow neither statues, nor shrines, nor sculptured chariots: and I don't annoy the states in any other respects—but perhaps I may annoy you by my egotism. Bear with it from your regard for me. It was you who wished me to act as I have. My tour through Asia was such that even the crowning misery of famine, which existed in my province owing to the failure of the crops, gave me a welcome opportunity. Wherever I went, without force, without legal process, without hard words, by my personal influence and exhortations, I induced Greeks and Roman citizens, who had stored corn, to promise a large quantity to the communities. On the 13th of February, the date on which I despatch this letter, I have arranged to try cases from Cibyra and Apamea

Iunius consumatur, velim tranquille a Parthis. Quinctilis, si erit, ut volumus, in itinere est per provinciam redeuntibus consumendus. Venimus enim in provinciam Laodiceam Sulpicio et Marcello consulibus pridie Kalendas Sextiles.

at Laodicea; from the 15th of March, from Synnada, Pamphylia (when I will look out for a horn for Phemius), Lycaonia and Isaurum at the same place. After the 15th of May, I set out to spend June in Cilicia: I hope without being troubled by the Parthians. July, if things turn out as I hope, is to be spent on my journey back through the province. I entered the province at Laodicea during the consulship of Sulpicius and Marcellus on the 31st of

[196](#). 200 Attic talents, which were of the value of £243 15s.

Inde nos oportet decedere a. d. III Kalendas Sextiles. Primum contendam a Quinto fratre, ut se praefici patiat, quod et illo et me invitissimo fiet. Sed aliter honeste fieri non potest, praesertim cum virum optimum, Pomptinum, ne nunc quidem retinere possim. Rapit enim hominem Postumius Romam, fortasse etiam Postumia.

Habes consilia nostra; nunc cognosce de Bruto. Familiares habet Brutus tuus quosdam creditores Salaminiorum ex Cypro, M. Scaptium et P. Matinium: quos mihi maiorem in modum commendavit. Matinium non novi. Scaptius ad me in castra venit. Pollicitus sum curaturum me Bruti causa, ut ei Salaminii pecuniam solverent. Egit

July. I ought to quit it on the 30th of July. First, however, I must ask my brother Quintus to be good enough to take charge, which will be against the grain with us both. But it will be the only fair course, especially since even now I cannot keep that excellent fellow Pomptinus; for Postumius is dragging him back to town, and perhaps Mrs Postumius too.

Those are my plans. Now let me tell you about Brutus. Among his intimates your friend Brutus has some creditors of the people of Salamis in Cyprus, M. Scaptius and P. Matinius, whom he recommended to me warmly. Matinius I have not met: Scaptius came to see me in camp. For the sake of Brutus I

gratias. Praefecturam petivit. Negavi me cuiquam negotianti dare (quod idem tibi ostenderam. Cn. Pompeio petenti probaram institutum meum, quid dicam Torquato de M. Laenio tuo, multis aliis?); sin praefectus vellet esse syngraphae causa, me curaturum, ut exigeret. Gratias egit, discessit. Appius noster turmas aliquot equitum dederat huic Scaptio, per quas Salaminios coaceret, et eundem habuerat praefectum; vexabat Salaminios. Ego equites ex Cypro decedere iussi. Molestus tulit Scaptius. Quid multa? ut ei fidem meam praestarem, cum ad me Salaminii Tarsum venissent et in iis Scaptius, imperavi, ut pecuniam solverent. Multa de syngrapha, de Scapti iniuriis. Negavi me audire; hortatus sum, petivi etiam pro

meis in civitatem beneficiis, ut negotium conficerent, denique dixi me coacturum. Homines non modo non recusare, sed etiam hoc dicere, se a me solvere. Quod enim praetori dare consueverant, quoniam ego non acceperam, se a me quodam modo dare, atque etiam minus esse

promised that the people of Salamis should settle their debts to him. The fellow thanked me, and asked for the post of prefect. I informed him I always refused business men, as I have told you. This rule Cn. Pompeius accepted when he made a similar request. So did Torquatus, M. Laenius, and many others. However, I told Scaptius that if he wanted the post on account of his bond, I would see that he got paid. He thanked me and took his leave. Our friend Appius had given him some squadrons to put pressure on the people of Salamis, and had also given him the office of prefect. He was causing trouble to the people of Salamis. I gave orders that his cavalry should leave the island. That annoyed him. In short, to keep faith with him, I ordered the people, when they came along with Scaptius to see me at Tarsus, to pay the money. They had a good deal to say about the bond, and about the harm that Scaptius had done them. I refused to listen. I prayed and besought them to

settle the business in consideration of the good that I had done their state. Finally, I threatened to compel them. So far from refusing to settle, the people said that really they would be paying out of my pocket, in the sense that I had refused to take the present usually given to the governor, which they admitted

aliquanto in Scapti nomine quam in vectigali praetorio. Collaudavi homines. "Recte," inquit Scaptius, "sed subducamus summam." Interim, cum ego in edicto translaticio centesimas me observaturum haberem cum anatocismo anniversario ille ex syngrapha postulabat quaternas. "Quid ais?" inquam, "possumne contra meum edictum?" At ille profert senatus consultum Lentulo Philippoque consulibus, VT, QVI CILICIAM OBTINERET, IVS EX ILLA SYNGRAPHA DICERET. Cohorruī primo; etenim erat interitus civitatis. Reperio duo senatus consulta isdem consulibus de eadem syngrapha. Salaminii cum Romae versuram facere vellent, non poterant, quod lex Gabinia vetabat. Tum iis Bruti familiares freti gratia Bruti dare volebant quaternis, si sibi senatus consulto caveretur. Fit gratia Bruti senatus consultum, VT NEVE SALAMINIIS, NEVE QVI EIS DEDISSET, FRAVDI ESSET. Pecuniam numerarunt. At postea venit in mentem

would be more than the amount they owed to Scaptius. I praised their attitude. "Very well," said Scaptius; "but let us reckon up the total." Now in my traditionary edict^[197] I had fixed the rate of interest at 12 per cent compound interest, reckoned by the year. But Scaptius demanded 48 per cent in accordance with the terms of the bond. I declared that I could not break the rule laid down in my edict. But he produced a decree of the Senate, made in the consulship of Lentulus and Philippus,^[198] ordering that the governor of Cilicia should give judgement according to the bond. At first I was horror stricken, for it spelled ruin to the community. I find there are two decrees of the Senate in the same year about this identical bond. When the people of Salamis wanted to raise a loan in town to pay off another, they were obstructed by a law of Gabinius which forbade lending to provincials. Then these intimates of Brutus, depending on his support, professed willingness to lend at 48 per cent, if they were protected by a decree of the Senate. Brutus induced the Senate to make a decree that the transaction between the people of Salamis and the money-lenders should be exempted from the provisions of the law. They paid down the money. Afterwards it came into the heads of the

[197](#). The edict is called *translaticium*, because it was handed down with alterations from governor to governor.

[198](#). B.C. 56.

faeneratoribus nihil se iuvare illud senatus consultum, quod ex syngrapha ius dici lex Gabinia vetaret. Tum fit senatus consultum, VT EX EA SYNGRAPHA IVS DICERETVR, non ut alio iure ea syngrapha^[199] esset quam ceterae, sed ut eodem. Cum haec disseruissem, seducit me Scaptius; ait se nihil contra dicere, sed illos putare talenta cc se debere. Ea se velle accipere. Debere autem illos paulo minus. Rogat, ut eos ad ducenta perducam. “Optime,” inquam. Voco illos ad me remoto Scaptio. “Quid? vos quantum,” inquam, “debetis?” Respondent CVI. Refero ad Scaptium. Homo clamare. “Quid? opus est,” inquam, “rationes conferatis?” Adsidunt, subducunt; ad nummum convenit. Illi se numerare velle, urguere, ut acciperet. Scaptius me rursus seducit, rogat, ut rem sic relinquam. Dedi veniam homini impudenter petenti; Graccis querentibus, ut in fano deponerent, postulantibus non concessi. Clamare omnes, qui aderant, nihil impudentius Scaptio, qui centesimis cum anatocismo contentus non esset; alii nihil stultius. Mihi autem impudens magis quam stultus videbatur; nam aut bono nomine centesimis contentus non^[200] erat aut

money-lenders that the decree would be futile, because Gabinus’ law forbade any legal process on the bond. Then the Senate passed a decree that the bond should be good at law, giving this bond the same validity as other bonds and nothing more. When I pointed this out, Scaptius took me aside. He said that he had no objection to my ruling; but that the people of Salamis imagined they owed him nearly £50,000. That he wanted to get that sum, but that they owed rather less. He begged me to induce them to fix it at that amount. “Very well,” said I. I sent Scaptius away, and summoned the people and asked them the amount of the debt. They replied something over £25,000. I consulted Scaptius again. He was loud in his protests. I said that the only plan was for them to check their accounts. They sat down and made out the account. It agreed to a penny with their statement. They wanted to pay, and begged him to receive the money. Again Scaptius led me aside, and asked me to let the matter stand over. The request was impertinent, but I consented. I would not listen to the complaints of the Greeks and their demand to deposit the sum in the

non bono quaternas centesimas sperabat.

Habes meam causam. Quae si Bruto non probatur, nescio, cur illum amemus. Sed avunculo eius certe probabitur, praesertim cum senatus consultum modo factum sit, puto, postquam tu es profectus, in

[199](#). IVS—syngrapha is added by Boot.

[200](#). non is added by Ernesti.

creditorum causa ut centesimae perpetuo faenore ducerentur. Hoc quid intersit, si tuos digitos novi, certe babes subductum. In quo quidem, ὁδοῦ πάρεργον, L. Lucceius M. f. queritur apud me per litteras summum esse periculum, ne culpa senatus his decretis res ad tabulas novas perveniat; commemorat, quid olim mali C. Iulius fecerit, cum dieculam duxerit: numquam rei publicae plus. Sed ad rem redeo. Meditare adversus Brutum causam meam, si haec causa est, contra quam nihil honeste dici potest, praesertim cum integram rem et causam reliquerim.

Reliqua sunt domestica. De ἐνδομύχῳ probo idem quod tu

temple treasury. The bystanders all declared that the conduct of Scaptius was outrageous in refusing 12 per cent with compound interest. Others said he was a fool. He seemed to me to be more of a knave than a fool: for either he was not content with 12 per cent on good security, or he hoped for 48 per cent on very doubtful security.

There is my case. If Brutus does not approve, there is no reason why I should be friendly with him. Certainly his uncle will approve, especially since a decree of the Senate has been passed (after you left

Rome, I think) in the matter of money-lenders, that 12 per cent simple interest shall be the rate. The difference between the two totals you will already have arrived at, if I do not belie your skill as a ready-reckoner. *Apropos* of this, by the way, L. Lucceius, son of Marcus, writes me a petulant letter that there is great danger of a general repudiation of debts resulting from these decrees. He recalls the harm that C. Julius did once when he allowed a little postponement of the day of payment: public credit never received a worse blow. But to return to my point. Think over my case against Brutus, if it is a case, when there are no fair arguments on the

Postumiae filio, quoniam Pontidia nugatur. Sed vellem adesses. A Quinto fratre his mensibus nihil exspectaris; nam Taurus propter nives ante mensem Iunium transiri non potest. Thermum, ut rogas, creberrimis litteris fulcio. P. Valerium negat habere quicquam Deiotarus rex eumque ait a se sustentari. Cum scies, Romae intercalatum sit necne, velim ad me scribas certum, quo die mysteria futura sint. Litteras tuas minus paulo exspecto, quam si Romae esses, sed tamen exspecto.

other side, especially as I have left the matter as it stood.

To wind up with family matters. As to my *boudoir* business, I agree with you in preferring Postumia's son,^[201] since Pontidia is playing the fool. But I wish you were there. You must expect no letters from Quintus at this season. The snows prevent passage of the Taurus until June. I am supporting Thermus, as you request, by frequent letters. As for P. Valerius, Deiotarus says that he has nothing and is his pensioner. When you know whether there are to be additions to the calendar at Rome or not, please write me positive news as to the date of the Mysteries. I look forward to your letters rather less eagerly than if you were in town; still I do look forward to them.

²⁰¹. Servius Sulpicius, as a husband for Tullia.

**M. TULLI CICERONIS
EPISTULARUM AD
ATTICUM
LIBER SEXTUS**

I

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Laodiceae VI K.
Mart a. 704*

Accepi
tuas litteras

a. d. quintum Terminalia Laodiceae;
quas legi libentissime plenissimas
amoris, humanitatis, officii,
diligentiae. Iis igitur respondebo non

Iliad, vi, 235

χρύσεα

χαλκείων (sic enim postulas) nec
οικονομίαν meam instituam, sed
ordinem conservabo tuum.
Recentissimas a Cybistris te meas
litteras habere ais a. d. x Kalendas
Octobres datas et scire vis, tuas ego
quas acceperim. Omnes fere, quas
commemoras, praeter eas, quas
scribis Lentuli pueris et Equotutico
et Brundisio datas. Quare non
οἷχεται tua industria, quod vereris,
sed praeclare ponitur, si quidem id
egisti, ut ego delectarer. Nam nulla
re sum delectatus magis.

Quod meam βαθύτητα in Appio
tibi, liberalitatem etiam in Bruto
probo, vehementer gaudeo; ac
putaram paulo secus. Appius enim ad
me ex itinere bis terve
ὑπομεμφιμοίρους litteras miserat,
quod quaedam a se constituta
rescinderem. Ut si medicus, cum
aegrotus alii medico traditus sit,

CICERO'S LETTERS TO ATTICUS BOOK VI

irasci velit ei medico, qui sibi
successerit, si, quae ipse in curando
constituerit, mutet ille, sic Appius,
cum ἐξ ἀφαιρέσεως provinciam
curarit, sanguinem miserit, quicquid
potuit, detraxerit, mihi tradiderit
enectam,

I

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

I
got
you

*Laodicea, Feb. 23,
B.C. 50*

r letter on the 5th day before the
Terminalia^[202] at Laodicea. I was
delighted at its tone of affection,
kindness, and obliging zeal. I will
not pay “gold for brass” (for that is
what you ask for), nor will I start an
arrangement of my own, but will
keep to your order. You say that the
last letter you got from me was from
Cybistra dated the 21st of
September, and you want to know
which of yours I have received.
Almost all you mention except those
which you say were entrusted to
Lentulus’ servants at Equotuticus
and Brundisium. So your energy is
not a dead loss as you fear, but has
been well spent, if you aimed at
giving me pleasure. For nothing has
ever given me more pleasure.

I am exceedingly glad that you
approve of my reserve in the case of
Appius and my generosity even in
the matter of your friend Brutus. I
had feared you might not quite like
it. For Appius on his journey sent me

two or three letters showing pique, because I revoked some of his enactments. It is as if a doctor, when a patient has been placed under the care of another, should be angry with his successor for changing his prescription. So Appius, having starved the province, let blood, and tried every lowering treatment, hands it to me drained of

[202](#). i.e. the 19th of Feb., the Terminalia being on the 23rd.

προσανατρεφομένην eam a me non libenter videt, sed modo suscenset, modo gratias agit. Nihil enim a me fit cum ulla illius contumelia; tantum modo dissimilitudo meae rationis offendit hominem. Quid enim potest esse tam dissimile quam illo imperante exhaustam esse sumptibus et iacturis provinciam, nobis eam obtinentibus nummum nullum esse erogatum nec privatim nec publice? Quid dicam de illius praefectis, comitibus, legatis etiam? de rapinis, de libidinibus, de contumeliis? Nunc autem domus mehercule nulla tanto consilio aut tanta disciplina gubernatur aut tam modesta est quam nostra tota provincia. Haec non nulli amici Appi ridicule interpretantur, qui me idcirco putent bene audire velle, ut ille male audiat, et recte facere non meae laudis, sed illius contumeliae causa. Sin Appius, ut Bruti litterae,

life and cannot bear to see it being fed up by me. Sometimes he is angry, sometimes he thanks me; for no act of mine has reflected on his policy. It is only the difference of my *regime* that annoys him. There is a very wide difference between a province worn out by expense and losses under his rule and not having to pay a penny out of private or public purse under my administration. I need not mention his prefects, his staff and his legates, the acts of robbery, of rape and insult. But now, upon my word, no private house is managed with such judgement or such economy, or is so well ordered as my whole province. Some friends of Appius put an absurd construction on my policy and declare that I am seeking popularity to damage him, and am acting honourably, not for the sake of my own reputation, but to cause him

quas ad te misit, significabant, gratias nobis agit, non moleste fero, sed tamen eo ipso die, quo haec ante lucem scribebam, cogitabam eius multa inique constituta et acta tollere.

Nunc venio ad Brutum, quem ego omni studio te auctore sum complexus, quem etiam amare coeperam: sed ilico me revocavi, ne te offenderem. Noli enim putare me quicquam maluisse, quam ut mandatis satis facerem, nee ulla de re plus laborasse. Mandatorum autem mihi libellum dedit, isdemque de rebus tu mecum egeras. Omnia sum diligentissime persecutus. Primum ab Ariobarzane sic contendi, ut talenta, quae mihi pollicebatur, illi daret. Quoad mecum rex fuit, perbono loco res erat; post a Pompei procuratoribus sescentis premi coeptus est.

Pompeius autem cum ob ceteras causas plus potest unus quam ceteri omnes, tum quod putatur ad bellum Parthicum esse venturus. Ei tamen sic nunc solvitur, tricensimo quoque die talenta Attica xxxiii et hoc ex tributis. Nec inde satis efficitur in usuram menstruam. Sed Gnaeus noster clementer id fert; sorte caret,

shame. However, if Appius, as the letter from Brutus which you forward to me shows, expresses his thanks, I am content: but the very day on which I write this letter before dawn I am thinking of annulling many of his wrong enactments and decisions.

I come now to the matter of Brutus. On your advice I zealously cultivated his friendship, I had even begun to feel a real liking for him: but there I pull myself up for fear I should vex you. For do not imagine that there is anything I should prefer better than to execute his commission, or anything on which I have taken more pains. He gave me a volume of commissions, and you spoke to me about his affairs. I have done my best with all of them; first of all I induced Ariobarzanes to pay him the money he promised me. So long as his highness was with me the business was on a good footing: but later the king was dunned by scores of agents from

Pompey. Pompey has more influence than anyone for many reasons and because it is rumoured that he will come to conduct the war against the Parthians. Even to him however payment is made on the following terms. On every thirtieth day some £8,000 is paid and that by tribute imposed on the king's

usura nec ea, solida contentus est. Alii neque solvit cuiquam nec potest solvere; nullum enim aerarium, nullum vectigal habet. Appi instituto tributa imperat. Ea vix in faenus Pompei quod satis sit efficiunt. Amici regis duo tresve perdivites sunt, sed ii suum tam diligenter tenent quam ego aut tu. Equidem non desino tamen per litteras rogare, suadere, accusare regem. Deiotarus etiam mihi narravit se ad eum legatos misisse de re Bruti; eos sibi responsum rettulisse illum non habere. Et mehercule ego ita iudico. nihil illo regno spoliatus, nihil rege egentius. Itaque aut tutela cogito me abdicare aut ut pro Glabrione Scaevola faenus et impendium recusare. Ego tamen, quas per te Bruto promiseram praefecturas, M. Scaptio, L. Gaudio, qui in regno rem Bruti procurabant, detuli; nec enim in provincia mea negotiabantur. Tu autem meministi nos sic agere, ut, quot vellet praefecturas, sumeret, dum ne negotiatori. Itaque duas

subjects. Even such a sum will not cover the amount of monthly interest. However our friend Gnaeus is an easy-going creditor. He is willing to forgo his capital and is content with interest, and that not in full. The king pays no one else and has no means to pay. He has no treasury and no regular tribute: he levies taxes on the method of Appius. They are scarcely sufficient to pay the interest on Pompey's money. His highness has two or three very wealthy friends, but they look after their own pockets as well as you or I. Still I do not cease to write dunning, coaxing and scolding his highness. Deiotarus too has told me that he has sent messengers to him about his debt to Brutus: and they came back with the reply that he has no assets. I can quite believe it, for I have never seen a kingdom more plundered or a king more needy. So I am thinking of resigning my guardianship, or, as Scaevola did for Glabrio, of repudiating both capital and interest. However I have conferred the office of prefect, which I promised Brutus through you, on M. Scaptius and L. Gavius, who are his agents in the kingdom; for they were not conducting their business in my province. You will remember that my principle was that he might have as many offices of prefect at his disposal as he liked, provided he did

ei praeterea dederam. Sed ii, quibus petierat, de provincia decesserant.

Nunc cognosce de Salaminiiis, quod video tibi etiam novum accidisse tamquam mihi. Numquam enim ex illo audivi illam pecuniam esse suam; quin etiam libellum ipsius habeo, in quo est: "Salaminii pecuniam debent M. Scaptio et P. Matinio, familiaribus meis." Eos mihi commendat; adscribit etiam et quasi calcar admovet intercessisse se pro iis magnam pecuniam. Confeceram, ut solverent centesimis sexennii ductis cum renovatione singulorum annorum. At Scaptius quaternas postulabat. Metui, si impetrasset, ne tu ipse me amare desineres; nam ab edicto meo recessissem et civitatem in Catonis et in ipsius Bruti fide locatam meisque beneficiis ornatam funditus perdidissem. Atque hoc tempore ipso impingit mihi epistulam Scaptius Bruti rem illam suo periculo esse, quod nec mihi umquam Brutus dixerat nec tibi, etiam ut praefecturam Scaptio deferrem. Id vero per te exceperamus, ne negotiatori; quodsi cuiquam, huic tamen non. Fuerat enim praefectus Appio et quidem habuerat turmas equitum, quibus inclusum in curia

not give them to business men: so I offered him

two others besides. But the gentlemen for whom he asked them had left my province.

Now to talk about the people of Salamis, a matter which I see came as a surprise to you as it did to me. Brutus never told me that that money was his. Indeed I have his own memorandum stating "The people of Salamis owe money to M. Scaptius and P. Matinius, my friends." He recommends these gentlemen to me, and to spur me adds a postscript that he has gone security to them for a large sum. I had arranged that they should pay in compound interest for six years at 12 percent. But Scaptius demanded 48 per cent, I was afraid, if he got his request, that you too would cease to be my friend, for I should have departed from the terms of my own edict, and have ruined utterly a state enjoying the protection of Cato and Brutus himself and distinguished by my attentions. At this very point Scaptius thrusts a letter of Brutus into my hand, stating what Brutus had never told me or you, that Brutus himself was the party concerned, and asking me to give the office of prefect to his agent. But that was the very proviso I had authorized you to make, that no office could be given to a business

senatum Salamine obsederat, ut fame senatores quinque morerentur. Itaque ego, quo die tetigi provinciam, cum mihi Cyprii legati Ephesum obviam venissent, litteras misi, ut equites ex insula statim decederent. His de causis credo Scaptium iniquius de me aliquid ad Brutum scripsisse. Sed tamen hoc sum animo.

Si Brutus putabit me quaternas centesimas oportuisse decernere, cum tota provincia singulas observarem itaque edixissem, idque etiam acerbissimis faeneratoribus probaretur, si praefecturam negotiatori denegatam queretur, quod ego Torquato nostro in tuo Laenio, Pompeio ipsi in Sex. Statio negavi et iis probavi, si equites deductos moleste feret, accipiam equidem dolorem mihi illum irasci, sed multo maiorem non esse eum talem, qualem putassem. Illud quidem fatebitur Scaptius, me ius dicente sibi omnem pecuniam ex edicto meo auferendi potestatem fuisse. Addo etiam illud, quod vereor tibi ipsi ut probem. Consistere usura debuit, quae erat in edicto meo. Deponere volebant: impetravi a Salaminiis, ut

man, above all to such a fellow as Scaptius. For he had been a prefect of Appius, and indeed had had some squadrons of cavalry, which he had used to beset the Senate at Salamis in their own chamber, so that five Members of the House died of starvation. Accordingly on the day I reached the province, since an embassy from Cyprus had already met me at Ephesus, I sent orders that his cavalry should leave the island at once. This, I fancy, had led Scaptius to write somewhat bitterly about me to Brutus. However, my attitude

is this. If Brutus thinks that I ought to have allowed 48 per cent, when throughout my province I have recognized only 12 per cent, and have fixed this rate in my edict, with the approval of the most grasping usurers; if he complains of my refusal to give office to a business man, which I made also to our friend Torquatus in the case of your acquaintance Laenius, and to Pompey himself in the case of Sex. Statius, without annoying either of them; if he is angry at the disbanding of his cavalry, well I shall be sorry that he is angry with me, but I shall be far sorrier at discovering he is not the man I imagined he was. Scaptius will admit that he had the opportunity of getting by my decision all the money allowed by my edict. I will add a point which I

silerent. Veniam illi quidem mihi dederunt, sed quid iis fiet, si huc Paulus venerit? Sed totum hoc Bruto dedi; qui de me ad te humanissimas litteras scripsit, ad me autem, etiam cum rogat aliquid, contumaciter, adroganter, ἀκοινονοήτως solet scribere. Tu autem velim ad eum scribas de his rebus, ut sciam, quo modo haec accipiat; facies enim me certiore.

Atque haec superioribus litteris diligenter ad te perscripseram, sed plane te intellegere volui mihi non excidisse illud, quod tu ad me quibusdam litteris scripsisses, si nihil aliud de hac provincia nisi illius benevolentiam deportassem, mihi id satis esse. Sit sane, quondam ita tu vis, sed tamen cum eo, credo, quod

fear you may not like, the interest allowed by my edict ought to have ceased to run.^[203] The people of Salamis wished to deposit the sum in a temple; but I begged them not to raise the point. They gave way to me: but what will happen to them if Brutus' brother-in-law, Paulus, comes here? I allowed Brutus all this privilege: and he has written very kind letters about me to you; but to me, even when he asks a favour, he writes in an arrogant, bold tone and uncivilly. Please write to Brutus about the matter, that I may know how he takes it. You can inform me.

To be sure, I had given you the full story in a former letter: but I wanted you to understand clearly that I had not forgotten a remark in one of your letters, that if I took nothing else away from this province except Brutus' good-will, that would be enough. Be it as you wish, provided it can be so

²⁰³. If the money was deposited in a temple.

sine peccato meo fiat. Igitur meo decreto soluta res Scaptio stat. Quam id rectum sit, tu iudicabis; ne ad Catonem quidem provocabo. Sed noli me putare ἐγκελεύσματα illa tua abiecisce, quae mihi in visceribus haerent. Flens mihi meam famam commendasti; quae epistula tua est, in qua non eius mentionem facias? Itaque irascatur, qui volet; patiar. Τὸ

without loss of honour to me. So I have given judgement that the payment of the people of Salamis to Scaptius is good at law. The equity of this course I will leave to your consideration. I will not even appeal to Cato: but don't think I have let slip your exhortations. They are fixed in my heart. With tears in your eyes, you told me to think of my

Aristophanes,
Acharnians, 659

γὰρ εὔ μετ'
ἐμοῦ,

praesertim cum sex libris tamquam
praedibus me ipse obstrinxerim,
quos tibi tam valde probari gaudeo.
E quibus unum ἱστορικὸν requiris de
Cn. Flavio, Anni filio. Ille vero ante
decemviros non fuit, quippe qui
aedilis curulis fuerit, qui magistratus
multis annis post decemviros
institutus est. Quid ergo profecit,
quod protulit fastos? Occultatam
putant quodam tempore istam
tabulam, ut dies agendi peterentur a
paucis. Nec vero pauci sunt auctores
Cn. Flavium scribam fastos
protulisse actionesque composuisse,
ne me hoc vel potius Africanum (is
enim loquitur) commentum putes.
Οὐκ ἔλαθέ σε illud de gestu
histrionis. Tu scelesti suspicaris, ego
ἀφελῶς scripsi. De me imperatore
scribis te ex Philotimi litteris
cognosse; sed credo te, iam in Epiro
cum esses, binas meas de omnibus
rebus accepisse, unas a Pindenisso
capto, alteras Laodicea,

reputation. Is there any letter of
yours which does not touch on the
topic? So let who will be angry. I can
put up with it. "The right is on my
side," especially since I have bound
myself to good conduct, with six
volumes^[204] for bail. I am glad you
like the books so much, though there
is one point of history which you
question, that about Cn. Flavius, the
son of Annius. He did not flourish
before the days of the decemviri,
since he held a curule aedileship,
which was instituted long after their
time. What good then did he do by
publishing the official calendar? It is
thought that at one time the calendar
was not exposed in public, so that a
privileged few might be the sole
source of information as to days
propitious for business. Moreover,
several authorities maintain that this
Cn. Flavius was the first man to
publish the calendar and to draw up
a digest of the forms of legal
procedure. So don't think that I, or
rather my spokesman Africanus,
invented a fiction. You took my
remark about the actor's mannerism,
and suspected a satirical meaning:^[205]
but I wrote in all *naïveté*. You tell me
that Philotimus wrote to you about
my being hailed emperor; but I
fancy that, now you are in Epirus,
you have got my two letters about
the business, one from Pindenissus

after its capture, another from Laodicea, both

[204](#). The *De Republica*.

[205](#). That it was a hit at Hortensius.

utrasque tuis pueris datas. Quibus de rebus propter casum navigandi per binos tabellarios misi Romam publice litteras.

De Tullia mea tibi adsentior scripsique ad eam et ad Terentiam mihi placere. Tu enim ad me iam ante scripseras: “Ac vellem te in tuum veterem gregem rettulisses.” Correcta vero epistula Memmiana nihil negotii fuit; multo enim malo hunc a Pontidia quam illum a Servilia. Quare adiunges Saufeiū nostrum, hominem semper amantem mei, nunc, credo, eo magis, quod debet etiam fratris Appi amorem erga me cum reliqua hereditate crevisse; qui declaravit, quanti me faceret, cum saepe tum in Bursa. Ne tu me sollicitudine magna liberaris.

Furni exceptio mihi non placet; nee enim ego ullum aliud tempus timeo, nisi quod ille solum excipit. Sed scriberem ad te de hoc plura, si Romae esses. In Pompeio te spem omnem otii ponere non miror. Ita res est, removendumque censeo illud “dissimulantem.” Sed enim οἰκονομία si perturbator est, tibi assignato. Te enim sequor σχεδιάζοντα.

delivered to your slaves. For fear of accidents at sea, I sent the public despatch on my campaign to Rome in duplicate by different carriers.

As to my daughter Tullia I agree with you, and I have written to her and her mother giving my consent. For a former letter of yours to me said “I could wish you had returned to your old associates.” There was no occasion to alter the letter that came from Memmius: for I much prefer to accept this candidate from Pontidia than the other from Servilia. So get our friend Saufeiū to help you in this business. He always liked me, and now I trust he will like me all the more, since he is bound to have inherited his brother Appius’ liking for me along with the rest of his inheritance, and Appius often expressed great affection for me, especially in the trial of Bursa. Indeed you will relieve me of a source of great anxiety.

I do not like Furnius’ proviso; there is nothing else I fear, except the point which he makes his sole proviso.^[206] I would write to you more fully on the point, if you were in Rome. I am not surprised that you

Cicerones pueri amant inter se, discutunt, exercentur, sed alter, uti dixit Isocrates in Ephoro et Theopompo, frenis eget, alter calcaribus. Quinto togam puram

depend entirely on Pompey for keeping the peace. That is quite right, and I think you must delete your phrase “insincere.” If the order of my paragraphs is muddled, you have yourself to blame, as I am following your own harum-scarum way.

My son and nephew are fond of one another, learn their lessons and take their exercise together: but to quote Isocrates’ remark about Ephorus and Theopompus, one wants the rein and the other the spur.

[206](#). Apparently a proposal by a tribune that the governors of Syria and Cilicia could quit their provinces at the end of the year, provided the Parthians were not aggressive.

Liberalibus cogitabam dare; mandavit enim pater. Ea sic observabo, quasi intercalatum non sit. Dionysius mihi quidem in amoribus est; pueri autem aiunt eum furenter irasci; sed homo nec doctior nec sanctor fieri potest nec tui meique amantior. Thermum, Silium vere audis laudari. Valde honeste se gerunt. Adde M. Nonium, Bibulum, me, si voles. Iam Scrofa vellem haberet, ubi posset; est enim lautum negotium. Ceteri infirmant πολίτευμα Catonis. Hortensio quod causam meam commendas, valde gratum. De Amiano spei nihil putat esse Dionysius. Terenti nullum vestigium adgnovi. Moeragenes certe periit. Feci iter per eius

I intend to celebrate Quintus’ coming of age^{[\[207\]](#)} on the feast of Bacchus.^{[\[208\]](#)} His father asked me to do this, and I shall act on the assumption that there will be no addition to the calendar. Dionysius is in my good graces: but the boys say he is liable to mad fits of temper. However one could not get a master of more learning and better character and more liking for you and me. The praise you hear of Thermus and Silius is deserved: they conduct themselves in very honourable fashion. You may praise M. Nonius, Bibulus, and myself too, if you like. I only wish Scrofa had scope for his tact. He is a fine fellow. The rest do little credit to Cato’s caucus. I am

possessionem, in qua animal reliquum nullum est. Haec non noram tum, cum Democrito tuo cum locutus sum. Rhosica vasa mandavi. Sed heus tu! quid cogitas? in felicatis lancibus et splendidissimis canistris holusculis nos soles pascere; quid te in vasis fictilibus appositurum putem? Κέρας Phemio mandatum est; reperietur, modo aliquid illo dignum canat.

Parthicum bellum impendet. Cassius ineptas litteras misit, necdum Bibuli erant allatae. Quibus recitatis puto fore ut aliquando commoveatur senatus. Equidem sum in magna animi perturbatione. Si, ut opto, non prorogatur nostrum negotium, habeo Iunium

much obliged to you for recommending my case to Hortensius. As to Amianus Dionysius says there is no help. I have met with no trace of Terentius. Moeragenes has certainly been killed. I made a tour through his district and found not a living thing. I did not know this, when I spoke to your agent Democritus. I have ordered the Rhosian ware for you. But what the deuce will you serve up in porcelain, when you are accustomed to give us vegetarian fare on fern-pattern plates and in magnificent baskets? I have ordered a horn for Phemius, and one will be got. I only hope that his tune will be worthy of the instrument.

A war with the Parthians is imminent. Cassius' despatch was futile, Bibulus' has not yet come. I think the reading of it will stir the House to action at last. I am very anxious myself. If, as I hope, my tenure of office is not extended, I have June and July

[207](#). On coming of age, which took place at about 15 or 16, the Roman boy left off the purple-bordered *toga praetexta* and assumed the pure white *toga virilis*.

[208](#). March 17.

et Quinctilem in metu. Esto; duos quidem menses sustinebit Bibulus. Quid illo fiet, quem reliquero, praesertim si fratrem? quid me

to fear. Very good. Bibulus can check them for two months, but what will happen to the man whom I leave behind, especially if he be my

autem, si non tam cito decedo? Magna turba est. Mihi tamen cum Deiotaro convenit, ut ille in meis castris esset cum suis copiis omnibus. Habet autem cohortes quadringenarias nostra armatura XXX, equitum CIO CIO. Erit ad sustentandum, quoad Pompeius veniat; qui litteris, quas ad me mittit, significat suum negotium illud fore. Hiemant in nostra provincia Parthi; exspectatur ipse Orodes. Quid quaeris? aliquantum est negotii.

De Bibuli edicto nihil novi praeter illam exceptionem, de qua tu ad me scripseras, “nimis gravi praeiudicio in ordinem nostrum.” Ego tamen habeo ἰσοδυναμοῦσαν, sed tectiorem, ex Q. Muci P. f. edicto Asiatico, EXTRA QVAM SI ITA NEGOTIVM GESTVM EST, VT EO STARI NON OPORTEAT EX FIDE BONA, multaque sum secutus Scaevolae, in iis illud, in quo sibi libertatem censent Graeci datam, ut Graeci inter se disceptent suis legibus. Breve autem edictum est propter hanc meam διαίρεσιν, quod duobus generibus edicendum putavi. Quorum unum est provinciale, in quo est de rationibus civitatum, de aere alieno, de usura, de syngraphis; in eodem omnia de publicanis, alterum, quod sine edicto satis commode transigi non potest, de

brother? Or what will be my own fate, if I do not depart so speedily? It is a great bother. However Deiotarus has decided to join my camp in full force. He has thirty squadrons of four hundred men each armed in our fashion, and two thousand cavalry. He can hold out till Pompey comes. A letter he writes to me presumes that he will conduct the campaign. The Parthians spend the winter in a Roman province. Orodes is expected in person. You may take my word it is a big business.

As to Bibulus’ edict there is no new feature, except that proviso of which you wrote “it is a very grave reflection on our order.”^[209] However I have a similar proviso, in more circumspect language, borrowed from the Asiatic edict of Q. Mucius, son of Publius, “Provided that the agreement is not such as contravenes equity.” I have followed Scaevola in many details, among them in the stipulation which the Greeks hold as the salvation of their freedom, that Greek cases are to be settled according to Greek law. The edict is short on account of the division I have made, as I considered it fell better under two heads. The one concerns provincial matters and deals with town accounts, debt, the rate of interest, contracts, and includes all matters referring to the tax-collectors. The second head,

embracing matters which cannot properly be settled without an

[209](#). Bibulus had excepted from debts recoverable in his court cases in which *vis* or *dolus malus* had been used. The clause was directed against *publicani* and *negotiatores* who belonged to the *equites*.

hereditatum possessionibus, de bonis possidendis, vendendis, magistris faciendis, quae ex edicto et postulari et fieri solent. Tertium de reliquo iure dicundo ἄγραφον reliqui. Dixi me de eo genere mea decreta ad edicta urban a accommodatum. Itaque curo et satis facio adhuc omnibus. Graeci vero exsultant, quod peregrinis iudicibus utuntur. “Nugatoribus quidem,” inquires. Quid refert? tamen se αὐτονομίαν adeptos putant. Vestri enim, credo, graves habent Turpionem sutorium et Vettium mancipem.

De publicanis quid agam, videris quaerere. Habeo in deliciis, obsequor, verbis laudo, orno; efficio, ne cui molesti sint. Τὸ παραδοξότατον, usuras eorum, quas pactionibus adscripserant, servavit etiam Servilius. Ego sic. Diem statuo satis laxam, quam ante si solverint, dico me centesimas ducturum; si non solverint, ex pactione. Itaque et Graeci solvunt tolerabili faenore, et publicanis res est gratissima, si illa iam habent pleno modio, verborum honorem, invitationem crebram.

edict, deals with inheritance, ownership and sale, the appointment of official receivers, matters where suits are wont to be brought and settled in accordance with the terms of an edict. A third head dealing with the rest of judicial procedure I left unwritten. I stated that in such matters my decrees would be based on those of Rome. I observe this rule, and so far satisfy everybody. The Greeks are jubilant at having foreign jurors. You may say that the jurors are wasters: however the Greeks flatter themselves that they have got home rule, and your own jurors are men of the lofty standing of Turpio the shoe maker and Vettius the broker.

You ask how I am dealing with the tax-gatherers. I pet them, indulge them, praise and honour them: and take care they trouble no one. It is very odd that the rates of interest specified in their bonds were upheld even by Servilius. My procedure is this. I name a day fairly remote, before which, if the debtors pay up, I lay down that I shall allow only 12 per cent. But, if they have not paid,

Quid plura? sunt omnes ita mihi familiares, ut se quisque maxime putet. Sed tamen μηδὲν αὐτοῖς—scis reliqua.

De statua Africani (ὃ πραγμάτων ἀσυγκλώστων sed me id ipsum delectavit in tuis litteris) ain tu? Scipio hic Metellus proavum suum nescit censorem non

judgement will be according to the bond. Accordingly the Greeks pay their debts at a fair rate of interest, and the farmers are gratified, provided they get their fill of compliments and invitations. In short, they are all so intimate with me that each man thinks himself my special favourite. But still you know the old saw.^[210]

As to the statue of Africanus (what a medley of topics! but that was the delightful feature of your letter, to my mind), do you really mean that Metellus Scipio does not know his great-grandfather

^{210.} The quotation is incomplete, and the ending of it unknown. Probably it contained advice either against trusting or humouring people too much.

fuisse? Atqui nihil habuit aliud inscriptum nisi cos. ea statua, quae ad Opis nuper^[211] posita in excelso est. In illa autem, quae est ad Πολυκλέους Herculem, inscriptum est CENS;^[212] quam esse eiusdem status, amictus, anulus, imago ipsa declarat. At mehercule ego, cum in turma inauratarum equestrium, quas hic Metellus in Capitolio posuit, animadvertissem in Serapionis subscriptione Africani imaginem, erratum fabrilē putavi, nunc video Metelli. Ο ἀνιστορησίαν turpem! Nam illud de Flavio et fastis, si secus est, commune erratum est, et tu belle ἠπόρησας, et nos publicam prope

was never censor? Certainly the statue which has lately been placed on high near the temple of Ops has only the inscription COS. But the statue near the Hercules of Polycles bears the inscription CENS.: and the pose, the dress, the ring and the likeness prove that it is a statue of the same person. As a matter of fact, when among the crowd of gilded knights placed by Metellus on the Capitol, I noticed a likeness of Africanus with the name Serapio on the pedestal, I thought it was a workman's error, but now I see it is Metellus' mistake. What gross ignorance of history! For that

opinionem secuti sumus, ut multa apud Graecos. Quis enim non dixit Εὐπολιν, τὸν τῆς ἀρχαίας, ab Alcibiade navigante in Siciliam deiectum esse in mare? Redarguit Eratosthenes; adfert enim, quas ille post id tempus fabulas docuerit. Num idcirco Duris Samius, homo in historia diligens, quod cum multis erravit, inridetur? Quis Zaleucum leges Locris scripsisse non dixit? Num igitur iacet Theophrastus. si id a Timaeo, tuo familiari, reprehensum est? Sed nescire proavum suum censorem non fuisse turpe est, praesertim cum post eum consulem nemo Cornelius illo vivo censor fuerit.

Quod de Philotimo et de solutione HS [XXDC] scribis, Philotimum circiter Kal. Ianuarias in Chersonesum audio venisse. At mi ab eo nihil adhuc. Reliqua mea Camillus scribit se accepisse. Ea quae

[211](#). nuper Boot; per te MSS.

[212](#). *I have adopted Tyrrell's transposition of COS. (= CONSUL) and CENS. (= CENSOR) though with doubts of its correctness.*

sint, nescio et aveo scire. Verum haec posterius et coram fortasse commodius.

misconception about Flavius and the calendar, if it is such, is widely held: and you were quite right in having doubts about it. I have followed the view which is almost universal, as Greek authors often do. Every one says that Eupolis, the poet of the old Comedy, was thrown into the sea by Alcibiades on his voyage to Sicily. Eratosthenes confutes this, producing plays exhibited by him after that date. But that is no reason for laughing at Duris of Samos, who is an accurate historian, because he follows a vulgar error. All historians agree that Zaleucus drew up laws for the Locrians. It is not therefore fatal to Theophrastus, if he is called to account for that by your friend Timaeus. But not to know that one's great-grandfather was not censor is shocking, especially as after his consulship no Cornelius was censor during his lifetime.

As for your remarks about Philotimus and the payment of £182,000, [\[213\]](#) I hear that Philotimus came to the Chersonese about the beginning of January, but so far I have heard nothing from him. Camillus writes that he has received my balance. I don't know how

[213](#). 20,600,000 sesterces.

much it is, and I should like to know. However, we can discuss this

Illud me, mi Attice, in extrema fere parte epistulae commovit; scribis enim sic: Τί λοιπόν; deinde me obsecras amantissime, ne obliviscar vigilare et ut animadvertam, quae fiant. Num quid de quo inaudisti? Etsi nihil eius modi est; πολλοῦ γε καὶ δεῖ. Nec enim me fefellisset nec falleret. Sed ista admonitio tua tam accurata nescio quid mihi significare visa est.

De M. Octavio iterum iam tibi rescribo te illi probe respondisse; paulo vellem fidentius. Nam Caelius libertum ad me misit et litteras accurate scriptas et de pantheris et civitatibus. Rescripsi alterum me moleste ferre, si ego in tenebris laterem, nec audiretur Romae nullum in mea provincia nummum nisi in aes alienum erogari, docuique nec mihi conciliare pecuniam licere nec illi capere monuique eum, quem plane diligo, ut, cum alios accusasset, cautius viveret; illud autem alterum alienum esse existumatione mea, Cibyratas imperio meo publice venari.

Lepta tua epistula gaudio exsultat; etenim scripta belle est meque apud eum magna in gratia posuit. Filiola tua gratum mihi fecit, quod tibi diligenter mandavit, ut mihi salutem adscriberes, gratum etiam Pilia, sed illa officiosius, quod mihi, quem iam pridem numquam vidit. Igitur tu quoque salutem

later and more conveniently when we meet.

That remark at the end of your letter, my dear Atticus, upset me. You used the phrase, "What more is there to say," and follow it by a most affectionate warning not to forget to be on the watch and to keep an eye on events. Have you heard anything about any of my staff? I am sure there has been no wrong-doing, *pas du tout*. It could not have escaped my notice, and it will not. But your earnest entreaty seemed to hint something.

As for M. Octavius, I repeat that your reply was excellent. I could wish it had been in more positive terms. For Caelius has sent me a freedman of his and a carefully worded letter about panthers and an offer from the townships to furnish contributions. I replied that the second item is annoying, if my conduct is still a secret and the news has not reached town that in my province no money is exacted except in satisfaction of debts: and I have told him that it would be improper for me to allow payment and for him to take it. I have a sincere regard for him and have warned him that after his prosecution of other people he should conduct himself on more careful lines. As to the second point I have told him it would be a blot on my escutcheon that the people of

Cibyra should have a public hunt during my governorship.

Lepta leaps with joy over your letter: for it was nicely written and puts me in his good graces. Your tiny daughter has done me a favour in ordering you earnestly to send me her greetings. It was kind of Pilia and very dutiful of your daughter to send greetings to one whom as yet she has never met. So please

utriusque adscribito. Litterarum datarum dies pr. Kal. Ianuar. suavem habuit recordationem clarissimi iuris iurandi, quod ego non eram oblitus. Magnus enim praetextatus illo die fui. Habes ad omnia. Non ut postulasti, χρύσεα χαλκείων, sed paria paribus respondimus.

Ecce autem alia pusilla epistula, quam non relinquam ἀναντιφώνητον. Bene mehercule potuit Lucceius Tusculanum, nisi forte (solet enim) cum suo tibicine. Et velim scire, qui sit eius status. Lentulum quidem nostrum omnia praeter Tusculanum proscrispisse audio. Cupio hos expeditos videre, cupio etiam Sestium, adde sis Caelium; in quibus omnibus est

Iliad vii, 93

Αἰδέσθην μὲν ἀνήνασθαι, δεῖσαν δ' ὑποδέχθαι.

De Memmio restituendo ut Curio cogitet, te audisse puto. De Egnati Sidicini nomine nec nulla nec magna

give my greetings to both of them in return. The date of your letter, the last day of December, reminded me pleasantly of the famous and unforgotten oath I took.^[214] I was a Pompey in state robes that day. There you have my answer to all your points: not as you asked “gold for copper,” but like for like.

There was another short letter which I will not leave unanswered. Lucceius to be sure was able to do something for the villa at Tusculum, unless perhaps there was the old obstacle of the flute player^[215]; and I should like to know its condition. Our friend Lentulus I hear has advertised all his property except that at Tusculum. I should like to see these gentlemen free from debt as well as Sestius and you may add Caelius too. To all of them one may apply the quotation, “ashamed to refuse, but yet afraid to take.” I suppose you have heard of Curio’s

spe sumus. Pinarium, quem mihi commendas, diligentissime Deiotarus curat graviter aegrum. Respondi etiam minori.

Tu velim, dum ero Laodiceae, id est ad Idus Maias, quam saepissime mecum per litteras colloquare, et cum Athenas veneris (iam enim sciemus de rebus urbanis, de provinciis, quae omnia in mensem Martium sunt conlata), utique ad me tabellarios mittas. Et heus tu! iamne vos a Caesare per Herodem talenta Attica ^L extorsistis? in quo, ut audio, magnum odium Pompei suscepistis. Putat enim suos nummos vos

idea to recall Memmius. As for the debt due from Egnatius of Sidicinum, I have some hope, but not much. Deiotarus is taking very great care of Pinarius, whom you recommended to me, in a serious illness. So there is my answer to your little letter.

While I am at Laodicea, which will be up to the 15th of May, please correspond with me as often as possible, and on your arrival at Athens at any rate send me letter carriers, since by that time we shall know what has been done in town and about the provinces, of which the affairs are settled in March. By the bye have you yet got Herodes to wring from Caesar that £12,000? I hear you have excited the animosity of Pompey in the matter. He thinks that

²¹⁴. Cicero refers to the day on which he laid down the consulship. Cf. *Ad Fam.* v, 2.

²¹⁵. Or “prop.” But the whole passage is uncertain.

comedis, Caesarem in Nemore aedificando diligentiores fore. Haec ego ex P. Vedio, magno nebulone, sed Pompei tamen familiari, audiui. Hic Veditus mihi obviam venit cum duobus essedis et raeda equis iuncta et lectica et familia magna, pro qua, si Curio legem pertulerit, HS centenos pendat necesse est. Erat praeterea cynocephalus in essedo,

you have snapped up money which was his, and that it will not lessen Caesar's energy in building a palace near the sacred grove of Diana. This bit of news came to me from P. Veditus, a shady character, but an intimate of Pompey. The fellow met me on the road with two chariots, a carriage and horses and a litter and a large following. If Curio

nec deerant onagri. Numquam vidi hominem nequiores. Sed extremum audi. Deversatus est Laodiceae apud Pompeium Vindullum. Ibi sua deposuit, cum ad me profectus est. Moritur interim Vindullus; quae res ad Magnum Pompeium pertinere putabatur. C. Vennonius domum Vindulli venit. Cum omnia obsignaret, in Vedianas res incidit. In his inventae sunt quinque imagunculae matronarum, in quibus una sororis amici tui hominis “bruti,” qui hoc utatur, et illius “lepidi,” qui haec tam neglegenter ferat. Haec te volui παραστορήσαι. Sumus enim ambo belle curiosi.

Unum etiam velim cogites. Audio Appium πρόπυλον Eleusine facere. Num inepti fuerimus, si nos quoque Academiae fecerimus? “Puto,” inquires. Ergo id ipsum scribes ad me. Equidem valde ipsas Athenas amo. Volo esse aliquod monumentum; odi falsas inscriptiones statuarum alienarum. Sed, ut tibi placebit, faciesque me, in quem diem Romana incidunt

carries his law,^[216] he will have to pay £1 apiece. Besides other things, there was a dog-faced baboon in a chariot, and some wild asses. I never met such a rascal. But listen to the end of the story, At Laodicea Vedius put up with Pompeius Vindullus, and left his belongings with him, while he came to meet me. Meantime Vindullus died, and his property is supposed to go to Pompeius Magnus. C. Vennonius went to the house and, while sealing all the goods, found Vedius’ baggage. Among this baggage there were five little busts of Roman married ladies, among them one of the sister of your friend Brutus—a brute indeed to be acquainted with the fellow—and one of the wife of Lepidus, whose easy conduct agrees with the meaning of his name. I wanted to tell you this little tale *en passant*, for we are both nice gossips.

There is one thing I wish you to consider. I hear that Appius is putting up a porch at Eleusis. Shall I look a fool, if I do so in the Academy? I dare say you may think so: say so plainly, if you do. I am very fond of the city of Athens. I should like it to have some memorial of myself. I dislike lying titles on the statues of other folk. But as you think best. And please let me know the date of the

[216](#). In *Ad Fam.* viii, 6 a *lex viaria* and a *lex alimentaria* are mentioned. Possibly travellers with a large retinue were taxed under the first of these.

mysteria, certiore, et quo modo
hiemaris. Cura, ut valeas. Post
Leutricam pugnam die
septingentesimo sexagesimo quinto.

mysteries at Rome, and how you
are passing the winter. Keep well. I
write this on the seven hundred and
sixty-fifth day after the battle of
Leuctra.[\[217\]](#)

II

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Laodiceae in. m.
Mai. a. 704*

Cum
Philogenes,
libertus tuus, Laodiceam ad me
salutandi causa venisset et se statim
ad te navigaturum esse diceret, has ei
litteras dedi, quibus ad eas rescripsi,
quas acceperam a Bruti tabellario. Et
respondebo primum postremae tuae
paginae, quae mihi magnae
molestiae fuit, quod ad te scriptum
est a Cincio de Stati sermone; in quo
hoc molestissimum est, Statium
dicere a me quoque id consilium
probari. Probari autem? De isto
hactenus dixerim, me vel plurima
vincla tecum summae coniunctionis
optare, etsi sunt amoris artissima;
tantum abest, ut ego ex eo, quo
astricti sumus, laxari aliquid velim.
Illum autem multa de istis rebus
asperius solere loqui saepe arbitror.
In hac autem peregrinatione
militiae nostrae saepe incensum ira
vidi, saepe placatum. Quid ad
Statium scripserit, nescio. Quicquid
actus de tali re fuit, scribendum
tamen ad libertum non fuit. Mihi
autem erit maxumae curae, ne quid
fiat secus, quam re se quemque
praestare, ac maxumae partes istius

II

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Laodicea, May, B.C.
50*

Your freedman Philogenes has
come to visit me at Laodicea and
tells me that he is on the point of
sailing to join you: so I give him this
letter in reply to your letter which I
got from Brutus' letter-carrier. First I
will answer your last page which
caused me much concern:—that is
about Cincius' communication on
the talk he had with Statius. I was
particularly concerned at Statius'
remark that the plan had my
approval. Approval indeed! I need
only say thus much. I wish the ties of
friendship to be as many and close as
possible between us, though none
can be so close as those of our
common liking. I am far from
wanting the tie between us to be
relaxed. Quintus however to my
knowledge will often use bitter
language on his private affairs, and
often I have pacified his anger, as I
think you know. On my late tour or
military campaign I have seen him
often fly in a temper and often calm
again. I don't know what he wrote to

Statius; whatever he meant to do, he ought not to have informed a freedman. However I will do my best to prevent any course contrary to our wishes and to propriety. In a case like this it is not enough for a man to make himself responsible for his own conduct only: and

[217](#). Cicero refers thus to the killing of Clodius on Jan. 18, 52 B.C., comparing it with the defeat of the Spartans by Epaminondas at Leuctra in 371 B.C.

officii sunt pueri Ciceronis sive iam adulescentis; quod quidem illum soleo hortari. Ac mihi videtur matrem valde, ut debet, amare teque mirifice. Sed est magnum illud quidem, verum tamen multiplex pueri ingenium; in quo ego regendo habeo negotii satis.

Quoniam respondi postremae tuae paginae prima mea, nunc ad primam revertar tuam. Peloponnesias civitates omnes maritimas esse hominis non nequam, sed etiam tuo iudicio probati, Dicaearchi, tabulis credidi. Is multis nominibus in Trophoniana Chaeronis narratione Graecos in eo reprendit, quod mare tantum secuti sint, nec ullum in Peloponneso locum excipit. Cum mihi auctor placeret (etenim erat ἱστορικώτατος et vixerat in Peloponneso), admirabar tamen et vix adcredens communicavi cum Dionysio. Atque is primo est commotus, deinde, quod de isto

indeed the principal share of responsibility attaches to the boy, or young man as he is now, Quintus. This I am always telling him. To me he seems to love his mother greatly, as he should, and to be extremely fond of you. He is a lad of high but complex character, and I have enough to do to guide his conduct.

Having devoted my first page to answering your last, I will now return to your first. I relied on the maps of Dicaearchus, a writer of no mean standing and an authority you accept, for the information that all the states of the Peloponnese bordered on the sea. In the account of the cave of Trophonius, which he puts into the mouth of Chaeron, he blames the Greeks on many scores for sticking to the sea coast; and he does not except a single district in the Peloponnese. He was a very accurate historian and lived in the Peloponnese, so that his evidence

Dicaearcho non minus bene existumabat quam tu de C. Vestorio, ego de M. Cluvio, non dubitabat, quin ei crederemus. Arcadiae censebat esse Lepreon quoddam maritimum; Tenea autem et Aliphera et Tritia νεόκτιστα ei videbantur, idque τῷ τῶν νεῶν καταλόγῳ confirmabat, ubi mentio non fit istorum. Itaque istum ego locum totidem verbis a Dicaearcho transtuli. "Phliasios" autem dici sciebam, et ita fac ut habeas; nos quidem sic habemus. Sed primo me ἀναλογία deceperat, Φλιοῦς, Ὀποῦς, Σιποῦς, quod Ὀπούντιοι, Σιπούντιοι. Sed hoc continuo correximus.

Laetari te nostra moderatione et continentia video.

Tum id magis faceres, si adesses. Atque hoc foro, quod egi ex Idibus Februariis Laodiceae ad Kal. Maias omnium dioecensium praeter Ciliciae, mirabilia quaedam effecimus. Ita multae civitates omni aere alieno liberatae, multae valde levatae sunt, omnes suis legibus et iudiciis usae αὐτονομίαν adeptae revixerunt. His ego duobus generibus facultatem ad se aere alieno liberandas aut levandas dedi,

seemed trustworthy. Still I was surprised and communicated my doubts to Dionysius. Dionysius was startled at first, but finally accepted his authority, since he had as good an opinion of Dicaearchus as you have of C. Vestorius or I of M. Cluvius. Arcadia he agreed had a seaport Lepreon: but Tenea, Aliphera and Tritia were, he considered, more modern, a view he supported by the omission of these places from Homer's catalogue of the ships. Accordingly I borrowed the passage from Dicaearchus in so many words. I know that Phliasii is the proper form. Please make it so in your copy. I read it in mine. But first of all thinking of Phlious I was misled by a vicious analogy of Opuntii from Opous and Sipuntii from Sipous. But I altered it at once.

I see that you are pleased at my unselfish moderation.

You would be more pleased, if you were here. In this very assize which I have been holding at Laodicea from the 13th of February to the 1st of May for all the districts except Cilicia, I have done wonders. See how many states have been freed from debt and how many have had their burden lightened. All have revived on acquiring home rule, and using their own enactments in law. I have given them in two ways the

uno, quod omnino nullus in imperio meo sumptus factus est (nullum cum dico, non loquor ὑπερβολικῶς), nullus, inquam, ne terruncius quidem. Hac autem re incredibile est quantum civitates emeruerint. Accessit altera. Mira erant in civitatibus ipsorum furta Graecorum, quae magistratus sui fecerant. Quaesivi ipse de iis, qui annis decem proximis magistratum gesserant. Aperte fatebantur. Itaque sine ulla ignominia suis umeris pecunias populis rettulerunt. Populi autem nullo gemitu publicanis, quibus hoc ipso lustro nihil solverant, etiam superioris lustri reddiderunt. Itaque publicanis in oculis sumus. “Gratis,” inquis, “viris.” Sensimus. Iam cetera iuris dictio nec imperita et clemens cum admirabili facilitate; aditus autem ad me minime provinciales; nihil per cubicularium; ante lucem inambulabam domi ut olim candidatus. Grata haec et magna mihiq̄ue nondum laboriosa ex illa vetere militia. Nonis Maiis in Ciliciam cogitabam. Ibi cum Iunium

chance of freeing themselves or relieving themselves from debt. First by causing them no expense during my administration (and in saying no expense I mean literally not one farthing), which has helped them astonishingly out of their trouble. Secondly the states had suffered from surprising corruption in their own countrymen, that is to say their magistrates. I questioned the men who had held the office of magistrate during the last ten years. They concealed nothing. So without exposure they took on their own backs the repayment of the money: and the communities which had paid the tax-farmers nothing for the present five years have now without any complaints paid up arrears for the last five years too. So I am the apple of their eye to the tax-farmers. “Grateful fellows,” you exclaim. Yes I have experienced their gratitude. The rest of my judicial conduct has been enlightened, but mild and marvellously courteous. There has been none of the difficulty of access so characteristic of provincial governors; and no backstairs jobbery. Before daybreak I walk up and down in my house, as I did of yore when a candidate for office. This is popular and a great boon, and I have not felt it a burden owing to my old training.

On the 15th of May I intend to go to Cilicia.

mensem consumpsissem (atque utinam in pace! magnum enim bellum inpendet a Parthis), Quinctilem in reditu ponere. Annuae enim mihi operae a. d. III Kal. Sextil. emerentur. Magna autem in spe sum mihi nihil temporis prorogatum iri. Habebam acta urbana usque ad Nonas Martias; e quibus intellegebam Curionis nostri constantia omnia potius actum iri quam de provinciis. Ergo, ut spero, prope diem te videbo.

Venio ad Brutum tuum, immo nostrum; sic enim mavis. Equidem omnia feci, quae potui aut in mea provincia perficere aut in regno experiri. Omni igitur modo egi cum rege et ago cotidie per litteras scilicet. Ipsum enim triduum quadriduumve mecum habui turbulentis in rebus, quibus eum liberavi. Sed et tum praesens et postea creberrimis litteris non destiti rogare et petere mea causa, suadere et hortari sua. Multum profeci, sed quantum, non plane, quia longe absum, scio. Salaminios autem (hos enim poteram coercere) adduxi, ut totum nomen Scaptio vellent solvere, sed centesimis ductis a proxuma quidem syngrapha nec perpetuis, sed renovatis quotannis. Numerabantur nummi: noluit Scaptius. Tu qui ais Brutum cupere aliquid perdere? Quaternas habebat in syngrapha.

After spending the month of June there (and I pray it may be in peace, for a serious war with the Parthians is certainly coming), July I shall spend on my journey home. I shall have served my year on July the 30th. I have great hopes that my tenure of office may not be extended. I have the city gazette up to the 7th of March. I gather that, thanks to the persistence of my friend Curio, appointments to the province will be the last business to be considered. So, as I hope, I shall see you soon.

I come now to Brutus, your friend or rather mine, since you prefer it. I have done everything that I could accomplish in my own province or attempt in the kingdom of Cappadocia. I have taken every measure with the king and still do so daily—by letter. The king himself was in my company only for three or four days and at a crisis in his affairs, from which I released him. But both then in person and subsequently in repeated letters I have continually begged and besought him in my own name and advised and persuaded him in his own interest. My efforts have borne fruit: but how much at this distance I cannot tell for certain. The people of Salamis however, whom I could influence, I have induced to consent to settle all their debt with Scaptius, but with interest at 12 per cent calculated from the

Fieri non poterat, nec, si posset, ego
pati possem. Audio omnino
Scaptium

date of the last contract, and not at
simple but compound interest. The
money was counted down: but
Scaptius refused to take it. What
kind of a figure do you cut, who say
that Brutus will make a sacrifice?
Forty-eight per cent was written in
the bond. It was an impossible sum.
It could not be paid nor could I have
permitted it. I hear after all that

paenitere. Nam, quod senatus
consultum esse dicebat, ut ius ex
syngrapha diceretur, eo consilio
factum est, quod pecuniam Salaminii
contra legem Gabiniam sumpserant.
Vetabat autem Auli lex ius dici de ita
sumpta pecunia. Decrevit igitur
senatus, ut ius diceretur ex ista
syngrapha. Nunc ista habet iuris
idem quod ceterae, nihil praecipui.
Haec a me ordine facta puto me
Bruto probaturum; tibi nescio;
Catonem certe probabo.

Sed iam ad te ipsum revertor. Ain
tandem, Attice, laudator integritatis
et elegantiae nostrae,

“ausus es hoc ex ore tuo——,”

inquit Ennius, ut equites Scaptio
ad pecuniam cogendam darem, me
rogare? An tu, si mecum esses, qui
scribis morderi te interdum, quod
non simul sis, paterere me id facere,
si vellem? “Non amplius,” inquis,
“quinquaginta.” Cum Spartaco
minus multi primo fuerunt. Quid

Scaptius is sorry. As to his
argument from a decree of the
Senate ordering judgement to be
given according to the bond, the
reason for that was that in borrowing
the money the people of Salamis
contravened the law of Gabinus.
Aulus’ law forbade that judgement
should be given for money so
borrowed. So the Senate decreed that
judgement might be given on that
particular bond. Now the bond in
question has the same validity as
other bonds, and no special
privilege. I fancy Brutus will admit
that my behaviour has been proper. I
do not know if you will take that
view, but certainly Cato will.

Now I come back to yourself. My
dear friend, you have praised the
nice honour of my conduct “and can
you dare with your own mouth,” as
Ennius says, ask me to give Scaptius
cavalry to collect his debts? Or
would you, if you were here,—you
who say that you chafe sometimes at

tandem isti mali in tam tenera insula non fecissent? Non fecissent autem? immo quid ante adventum meum non fecerunt? Inclusum in curia senatum habuerunt Salaminium ita multos dies, ut interierint non nulli fame. Erat enim praefectus Appi Scaptius et habebat turmas ab Appio. Id me igitur tu, cuius mehercule os mihi ante oculos solet versari, cum de aliquo officio ac laude cogito, tu me, inquam, rogas, praefectus ut Scaptius sit? Alias hoc statueramus, ut negotiatorem neminem, idque Bruto probaramus. Habeat is turmas? Cur potius quam

cohortes? Sumptu iam nepos evadit Scaptius. "Volunt," inquit, "principes." Scio; nam ad me Ephesum usque venerunt flentesque equitum scelera et miserias suas detulerunt. Itaque statim dedi litteras, ut ex Cypro equites ante certam diem decederent, ob eamque causam, tum ob ceteras Salaminii nos in caelum decretis suis sustulerunt. Sed iam quid opus equitatu? solvunt enim Salaminii; nisi forte id volumus

not being with me,—would you suffer me to do such a thing, if I wanted? "Not more than fifty men," you say. Spartacus had fewer men than that at first. The blackguards would have done indescribable damage in such a weak island. Do you say, they would have refrained? Look at the damage they did before I came here. They kept the members of the local Senate prisoners in their Chamber for so long that some died of hunger. For Scaptius was a prefect of Appius, and was allowed some cavalry. Your face is always before my eyes, when I think of duty and honour, and can you, you, I repeat, ask me to give the fellow the office of prefect? I had settled in other cases never to give the office to a man of business, a course which had won the approval of Brutus: and is a fellow like Scaptius to have cavalry? Why should he not be content with a

company of foot? He is beginning to live in spendthrift style. The leading people of Salamis insist, he declares. Of course; that is why they came to me and with tears told me of his men's atrocities and their own miseries. Accordingly I sent a letter at once ordering the cavalry to quit Cyprus by a certain day, and that, as well as other acts of mine, has caused the people of Salamis to praise me to the skies in their decrees. There is no need of cavalry

armis efficere, ut faenus quaternis centesimis ducant. Et ego audebo legere umquam aut attingere eos libros, quos tu dilaudas, si tale quid fecero? Nimis, inquam, in isto Brutum amasti, dulcissime Attice, nos vereor ne parum. Atque haec scripsi ego ad Brutum scripsisse te ad me. Cognosce nunc cetera.

Pro Appio nos hic omnia facimus, honeste tamen, sed plane libenter. Nec enim ipsum odimus et Brutum amamus, et Pompeius mirifice a me contendit, quem mehercule plus plusque in dies diligo. C. Caelium quaestorem huc venire audisti. Nescio, quid sit: sed Pammenia illa mihi non placent. Ego me spero Athenis fore mense Septembri. Tuorum itinerum tempora scire sane velim. Εὐήθειαν Semproni Rufi cognovi ex epistula tua Corcyraea. Quid quaeris? invideo potentiae Vestori.

Cupiebam etiam nunc plura garrere, sed lucet; urget turba, festinat Philogenes. Valebis igitur et valere Piliam et Caeciliam nostrum iubebis litteris et salvebis a meo Cicerone.

now, for the people are ready to pay, —unless perhaps I want to use force to make them pay 48 per cent interest. Were I to do such a thing, I could never venture to read or touch those volumes which you praise. You, my dear fellow, have had far too much regard for Brutus in the matter. I perhaps not enough. I have informed Brutus of the drift of your letter. Now for the remaining topics.

I am pleased to do all I can for Appius here consistently with my honour. I do not dislike him and I like Brutus: and Pompey, for whom I have a higher regard every day, is surprisingly importunate. You have heard that C. Caelius comes here as quaestor. I don't know why, but I don't like that affair of Pammenes. I hope to be at Athens in the month of September. Please let me know the dates of your travels. I understood the *naïveté* of Sempronius Rufus from your letter written in Corcyra. I am really quite jealous of the influence Of Vestorius.

I should like to keep on chatting, but day dawns, the crowd is pressing in and Philogenes is in a hurry. Good-bye, give my greetings to Pilia, when you write, and to your daughter: and accept greetings from my son.

III

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in Cilicia m. Iun.
ante V K. Quint. a.
704*

Etsi nil
sane
habebam

novi, quod post accidisset, quam dedissem ad te Philogeni, liberto tuo, litteras, tamen, cum Philotimum Romam remitterem, scribendum aliquid ad te fuit. Ac primum illud, quod me maxime angebat—non quo me aliquid iuvare posses. Quippe, res enim est in manibus, tu autem abes longe gentium;

πολλὰ δ' ἐν μεταχίμῳ
νότος κυλίνει κύματ' εὐρείης ἀλός.

Obrepat dies, ut vides (mihi enim a. d. III Kal. Sextil. de provincia decedendum est), nec succeditur. Quem relinquam, qui provinciae praesit? Ratio quidem et opinio hominum postulat fratrem, primum quod videtur esse honos, nemo igitur potior; deinde quod solum habeo praetorium. Pomptinus enim ex pacto et convento (nam ea lege exierat) iam a me discesserat; quaestorem nemo dignum putat; etenim est “levis, libidinosus, tagax.” De fratre autem primum illud est. Persuaderi ei non posse arbitror; odit enim provinciam, et hercule nihil

III

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Cilicia, before June
26, B.C. 50*

Though I have no fresh news, since I handed a letter for you to your freedman Philogenes, still I must write you a line, since I am sending Philotimus back to Rome. First a thing which gives me much anxiety—not that you can help me at all—for the business is in hand, and you are far away in a foreign land

“and by south wind tossed
Between us rolls the wide estranging sea.”

The days steal on, as you see (for I am due to leave my province on the 30th of July), and no successor is appointed. Whom can I leave in charge? Policy and public opinion point to my brother: first because it is right that he should have the honour by preference to anyone else, and secondly because he is the only officer of praetorian rank that I have: for Pomptinus, who came out on that condition, has left me already according to his agreement. My quaestor is notoriously unsuitable; he is “unsteady, wanton and lightfingered.” There is one

odiosius, nihil molestius. Deinde, ut mihi nolit negare, quidnam mei sit officii? cum bellum esse in Syria magnum putetur, id videatur in hanc provinciam erupturum, hic praesidii nihil sit, sumptus annuus decretus sit, videaturne aut pietatis esse meae fratrem relinquere aut diligentiae nugarum aliquid relinquere? Magna igitur, ut vides, sollicitudine adficio, magna inopia consilii. Quid quaeris?

toto negotio nobis opus non fuit. Quanto tua provincia melior! Decedes, cum voles, nisi forte iam decessisti; quem videbitur, praeficies Thesprotiae et Chaoniae. Necdum tamen ego Quintum conveneram, ut iam, si id placeret, scirem, possetne ab eo impetrari: nee tamen, si posset, quid vellem, habebam. Hoc est igitur eius modi.

Reliqua plena adhuc et laudis et gratiae, digna iis libris, quos dilaudas, conservatae civitates, cumulate publicanis satis factum, offensus contumelia nemo, decreto iusto et severo perpauci, nec tamen quisquam, ut queri audeat, res gestae dignae triumpho; de quo ipso nihil cupide agemus, sine tuo quidem consilio certe nihil. Clausula est

objection to my brother's appointment,—he will probably refuse, as he hates provincial life. Certes, it is a hateful bore. Then, supposing he does not like to refuse, what is my proper course? Seeing that a great war is likely in Syria, which will apparently break forth into this district, where there is no protection and only the ordinary supplies have been voted for the year, it would certainly seem unnatural to leave my brother, and careless to leave some nincompoop. As you see I am troubled greatly and badly want advice. In short I

made a mistake over the whole matter. Your sphere is far preferable. You can depart at pleasure; and perhaps you have left already. You can put Thesprotia and Chaonia^[218] in charge of anyone you like. I have not yet met my brother to know whether he would consent, if I want him to take it over; nor, should he consent, am I settled in my plans. So much for that.

The rest so far is full of honour and glory and worthy of the volumes which you praise. Communities have found salvation, the whole body of tax-collectors has been satisfied, no one has been annoyed by ill-considered conduct, very few by the severity of upright justice—none so that he could dare complain—and a

difficilis in tradenda provincia. Sed haec deus aliquis gubernabit.

De urbanis rebus scilicet plura tu scis; saepius et certiora audis; equidem doleo non me tuis litteris certiolem fieri. Huc enim odiosa adferebantur de Curione, de Paulo; non quo ullum periculum videam stante Pompeio vel etiam sedente, valeat modo; sed mehercule Curionis et Pauli, meorum familiarium, vicem doleo. Formam igitur mihi totius rei publicae, si iam es Romae aut cum eris, velim mittas, quae mihi obviam veniat, ex qua me fingere possim et praemeditari, quo animo accedam ad urbem. Est enim quiddam advenientem non esse peregrinum atque hospitem. Et, quod paene praeterii, Bruti tui causa,

campaign has been conducted in a way that deserves a triumph, though I shall not seek it greedily, nor seek it at all without your advice. The conclusion is difficult in the matter of handing over the province. But some god will direct my course.

About doings in town of course you know more, as your information comes more frequently and more surely. I am sorry that you do not pass on your news in a letter, for tiresome tidings have reached me about Curio and Paulus, not that there would seem anything to fear, if Pompey keeps his influence or even his inactivity. Only let him recover his health. But I am annoyed for Curio and Paulus, my friends. So, if you are now in town, or when you are there, please send me a sketch of the political situation to meet me on my way, that I may mould my conduct upon it and bethink me of the proper spirit in which to approach Rome. It is something not to arrive as a foreigner and a stranger. There was one point I nearly omitted. As I have said often, I have

[218](#). The country round Atticus' house in Epirus.

ut saepe ad te scripsi, feci omnia. Cyprii numerabant; sed Scaptius centesimis renovato in singulos annos faenore contentus non fuit.

done everything for your friend Brutus. The people of Cyprus were paying down the money. Scaptius was not content with 12 per cent

Ariobarzanes non in Pompeium prolixior per ipsum quam per me in Brutum. Quem tamen ego praestare non poteram; erat enim rex perpauper, aberamque ab eo ita longe, ut nihil possem nisi litteris; quibus pugnare non destiti. Summa haec est. Pro ratione pecuniae liberalius est Brutus tractatus quam Pompeius. Bruto curata hoc anno talenta circiter c, Pompeio in sex mensibus promissa cc. Iam in Appi negotio quantum tribuerim Bruto, dici vix potest. Quid est igitur, quod laborem? Amicos habet meras nugas, Matinium, Scaptium. Qui quia non habuit a me turmas equitum, quibus Cyprum vexaret, ut ante me fecerat, fortasse suscenset, aut quia praefectus non est, quod ego nemini tribui negotiatori, non C. Vennonio, meo familiari, non tuo, M. Laenio, et quod tibi Romae ostenderam me servaturum; in quo perseveravi. Sed quid poterit queri is, qui, auferre pecuniam cum posset, noluit? Scaptio, qui in Cappadocia fuit, puto esse satis factum. Is a me tribunatum cum accepisset, quem ego ex Bruti litteris ei detulissem, postea scripsit ad me se uti nolle eo tribunatu.

Gavius est quidam, cui cum praefecturam detulissem Bruti rogatu, multa et dixit et fecit cum quadam mea contumelia, P. Clodi canis. Is me nec proficiscentem Apameam prosecutus est, nec, cum

compound interest. Ariobarzanes is not more accommodating to Pompey for his own sake than to Brutus for mine. Still I could not go bail for him, for he is a very needy monarch and I was such a long way off that I could only press him on paper, as I did continually. The conclusion is this. In proportion to the sum lent, Brutus has been treated more liberally than Pompey: for Brutus there has been got this year about £24,400. To Pompey has been promised £48,800 within six months. In the business of Appius, my concessions to Brutus are almost incalculable. I have no reason to distress myself. Brutus' friends are men of straw, Matinius, and Scaptius, who is perhaps angry because he could not get troops to harry Cyprus as he had done before my time, or because he was not made a prefect, an office I have not granted to any man of business, not to C. Vennonius, my friend, nor to your friend M. Laenius. I have persevered in the course that I told you at Rome I should keep: but a man who refused to take his money, when he could, cannot grumble. The other Scaptius who was in Cappadocia I think is satisfied. First of all he accepted a military tribuneship from me, which a letter from Brutus had persuaded me to offer him; but he wrote me

postea in castra venisset atque inde
discederet, num quid vellem, rogavit,
et fuit aperte mihi nescio quare

afterwards that he did not want to
take it up.

There is a person Gavius, who,
after I had offered him a post as
prefect at Brutus' request, said and
did a good deal to disparage me. He
is Clodius' puppydog. He did not
condescend to be one of my escort
when I left Apamea, nor, when he
came into camp later and was
leaving it, did he ask if I had any
commissions. For some unknown
reason he was an

non amicus. Hunc ego si in
praefectis habuissem, quem tu me
hominem putares? Qui, ut scis,
potentissimorum hominum
contumaciam numquam tulerim,
ferrem huius adseculae? etsi hoc plus
est quam ferre, tribuere etiam aliquid
beneficii et honoris. Is igitur Gavius,
cum Apameae me nuper vidisset
Romam proficiscens, me ita
appellavit, ut Culleolum vix
auderem: "Unde," inquit, "me iubes
petere cibaria praefecti?" Respondi
lenius, quam putabant oportuisse, qui
aderant, me non instituisse iis dare
cibaria, quorum opera non essem
usus. Abiit iratus. Huius nebulonis
oratione si Brutus moveri potest,
licebit eum solus ames, me aemulum
non habebis. Sed illum eum futurum
esse puto, qui esse debet. Tibi tamen
causam notam esse volui et ad ipsum
haec perscripsi diligentissime.

open enemy of mine. If I had
counted such a fellow among my
prefects, you might doubt what kind
of creature I am. You know I will not
brook discourtesy from men of
power, and should I put up with it
from this hanger-on? Though, to be
sure, gracious bestowal of honour is
something more than putting up with
a man. So Gavius, when on his road
to Rome he saw me lately at
Apamea, addressed me as I should
scarcely address Culleolus. "Where,"
said he, "am I to look for my
pickings?" I answered less sternly
than those present thought proper,
that I was not accustomed to give
pickings to men whose services I had
not used. He went off in a temper. If
Brutus listens to the talk of such a
shady customer, you may have him
to yourself. I shall not be your rival.
But I think he will behave all right.

Omnino (soli enim sumus) nullas umquam ad me litteras misit Brutus, ne proxime quidem de Appio, in quibus non inesset adrogans, ἀκοινονόητον aliquid. Tibi autem valde solet in ore esse:

Lucilius.

“Granius autem
Non contemnere se et reges odisse superbos.”

In quo tamen ille mihi risum magis quam stomachum movere solet. Sed plane parum cogitat, quid scribat aut ad quem.

Q. Cicero puer legit, ut opinor, et certe, epistulam inscriptam patri suo. Solet enim aperire idque de meo consilio, si quid forte sit, quod opus sit sciri. In ea autem epistula erat idem illud de sorore quod ad me. Mirifice conturbatum vidi puerum. Lacrimans

mecum est questus. Quid quaeris? miram in eo pietatem, suavitatem humanitatemque perspexi. Quo maiorem spem habeo nihil fore aliter, ac deceat. Id te igitur scire volui.

Ne illud quidem praetermittam. Hortensius filius fuit Laodiceae gladiatoribus flagitiose et turpiter. Hunc ego patris causa vocavi ad cenam, quo die venit, et eiusdem

However I wanted you to know the circumstances, and I have recounted the matter very fully to Brutus. Between ourselves Brutus has never sent me a letter, not even lately about Appius, without a touch of arrogance and intolerance. You often quote the lines,

“But Granius too
Has self-conceit and hates the pride of kings.”

However in this business he excites my laughter rather than my rage, and evidently he does not consider sufficiently what he writes and to whom.

The young Quintus, I fancy, yes I am sure, read your letter addressed to his father, for he usually opens his father’s letters—and that by my advice—in case there is anything he ought to know. The letter contained that same passage about your sister that you wrote to me. The boy was awfully upset. He

came to me complaining in tears. I saw much good feeling in him, and a kind and courteous disposition, which increases my hope for a satisfactory issue to the matter: so I want you to know it.

There is one thing I must not pass over. The young Hortensius, during the gladiatorial exhibition at Laodicea, behaved in a shameful and scandalous way. For his father’s sake

patris causa nihil amplius. Is mihi dixit se Athenis me exspectaturum, ut mecum decederet. "Recte," inquam; quid enim dicerem? Omnino puto nihil esse, quod dixit; nolo quidem, ne offendam patrem, quem mehercule multum diligo. Sin fuerit meus comes, moderabor ita, ne quid eum offendam, quem minime volo.

Haec sunt; etiam illud. Orationem Q. Celeris mihi velim mittas contra M. Servilium. Litteras mitte quam primum; si nihil, nihil fieri vel per tuum tabellarium. Piliae et filiae salutem. Cura, ut valeas.

I invited him to my table on the day of his arrival, and for the same father's sake treated him handsomely.^[219] He said that he would await my departure in Athens, that we might go home together. I could only say, "Very well." But I don't fancy at all that he meant what he said. I hope not, lest I offend his father, who is my very good friend. But if he comes in my suite, I will arrange so as to avoid offence to a man I don't want to offend.

So much for that, there is one thing more. Please send me Q. Celer's speech against M. Servilius. Write to me at your first opportunity. If there is no news, write to say so, or even send a verbal message. Give my love to your wife and daughter. Keep well.

IV

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in itinere paulo
post Non. Iun. a. 704*

Tarsum
venimus

Nonis Iuniis. Ibi me multa moverunt, magnum in Syria bellum, magna in Cilicia latrocinia, mihi difficilis ratio administrandi, quod paucos dies habebam reliquos annui muneris, illud autem difficillimum, relinquendus erat ex senatus consulto,

qui praeesset. Nihil minus probari poterat quam quaestor Mescinius. Nam de Caelio nihil audiebamus. Rectissimum videbatur fratrem cum imperio relinquere; in quo multa molesta, discessus noster, belli periculum, militum improbitas, sescenta praeterea. O rem totam odiosam! Sed haec fortuna viderit, quoniam consilio non multum uti licet.

Tu, quando Romam salvus, ut spero, venisti, videbis, ut soles, omnia, quae intelleges nostra interesse, imprimis de Tullia mea,

IV

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*On the road, shortly
after June 5, B.C. 50*

I
came

to Tarsus on the 5th of June. There I was upset by many troubles: a big war in Syria, big cases of robbery in Cilicia, my difficulty in arranging things, considering there are only a few days left of my year of office: but the hardest problem of all is that, according to a decree of the Senate, some one must be left

[219](#). or “did nothing more for him.”

in charge. The quaestor Mescinius is by no means a suitable person. Of Caelius I hear nothing. The proper thing seems to be to leave my brother with military power, but that involves many difficulties—our separation, risk of war, mutiny in the troops, a thousand other hazards. A hateful business altogether. But fortune must look to it, since reason serves our purpose little.

You, having come safe to Rome, as I hope, will as usual look to everything that concerns me, especially the matter of my daughter,

cuius de condicione quid mihi placeret, scripsi ad Terentiam, cum tu in Graecia esses; deinde de honore nostro. Quod enim tu afuisti, vereor, ut satis diligenter actum in senatu sit de litteris meis.

Illud praeterea μυστικώτερον ad te scribam, tu sagacius odorabere. Τῆς δάμαρτός μου ὁ ἀπελεύθερος (οἶσθα, ὃν λέγω) ἔδοξέ μοι πρώην, ἐξ ὧν ἀλογευόμενος παρεφθέγγετο, πεφυρακέναι τὰς ψήφους ἐκ τῆς ὡνῆς τῶν ὑπαρχόντων τοῦ Κροτωνιάτου τυραννοκτόνου. Δέδοικα δὴ, μή τι νοήσης. Εἰς δήπου τοῦτο δὴ περισκεψάμενος τὰ λοιπὰ ἐξασφάλισαι. Non queo tantum, quantum vereor, scribere; tu autem fac, ut mihi tuae litterae volent obviae. Haec festinans scripsi in itinere atque agmine. Piliae et puellae Caeciliae bellissimae salutem dices.

about whose marriage settlement I have written to Terentia expressing my intentions, since you were in Greece. Then please look after my triumph. For as you were absent from town, I fear the Senate hardly paid sufficient attention to my despatch.

The following point I will write to you in dark phrases: your cleverness will scent my meaning. My wife's freedman (you know whom I mean) seemed to me lately from casual words of his to have cooked his accounts on the sale of the goods of the Crotonian tyrannicide.^[220] I fear you have noticed something. Look into this matter yourself alone, and secure what is left. I cannot write all my fears. Take care that your letter flies to meet me. I write in haste on the march and with my army. Give my love to your wife and to your very charming little daughter.

²²⁰. T. Annius Milo, who assumed the name Milo in honour of the well-known athlete of Croton of that name. The freedman referred to is Phylotimus. From v, 8 it appears that he bought for Cicero at the sale of Milo's property.

V

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. in castris V K.
Quint. a. 704*

Nunc
quidem

profecto Romae es. Quo te, si ita est, salvum venisse gaudeo; unde quidem quam diu afuisti, magis a me abesse videbare, quam si domi esses; minus enim mihi meae notae res erant, minus etiam publicae. Quare velim, etsi, ut spero, te haec legente aliquantum iam viae processero, tamen obvias mihi litteras quam argutissimas de omnibus rebus crebro mittas, imprimis de quo scripsi ad te antea. Τῆς ξυναόρου τῆς ἐμῆς οὐξελεύθερος ἔδοξέ μοι θαμὰ βατταρίζων καὶ ἀλύων ἐν τοῖς ξυλλόγοις καὶ ταῖς λέσχαις ὑπό τι πεφυρακέναι τὰς ψήφους ἐν τοῖς ὑπάρχουσιν τοῖς τοῦ Κροτωνιάτου. Hoc tu indaga, ut soles, ast hoc magis. Ἐξ ἄστεως ἐπταλόφου στείχων παρέδωκεν μνῶν κδ', μη' ὀφειλημα τῷ Καμίλλῳ, ἐαυτόν τε ὀφείλοντα μνᾶς κδ' ἐκ τῶν Κροτωνιατικῶν καὶ ἐκ τῶν Χερρωνησιτικῶν μη' καὶ μνᾶς κληρονομήσαι χμ', χμ'. Τούτων δὲ μηδὲ ὀβολὸν διευθετῆσθαι πάντων ὀφειληθέντων τοῦ δευτέρου μηνὸς τῇ νομηνίᾳ. Τὸν δὲ ἀπελεύθερον αὐτοῦ ὄντα ὁμώνυμον τῷ Κόνωνος

V

CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.

*In camp, June 26, B.C.
50*

You must certainly be at Rome now. If you are, I am glad of your safe arrival. So long as you were away from town, you seemed to me to be further off than if you were in Rome, for I heard less of my own business and less of the business of the state. So please send plenty of chatty letters on every kind of subject to meet me, though I hope, when you read this, I shall be well on my journey home. Above all write me on the subject I raised in my former letter. From the stuttering hesitation of my wife's freedman in our meetings and talks I infer that he has been cooking his accounts a little in the matter of the sale of the Crotonian's^[221] goods. Investigate the matter with your usual care, but pay still more attention to this. When leaving the city of the seven hills he tendered an account of debts of some £100 and £200^[222] to Camillus, and put himself down as owing £100 from Milo's goods and £200 from the property in the Chersonese, and as having inherited two sums of

πατρὶ μηδὲν ὀλοσχερῶς
πεφροντικέναι. Ταῦτα οὖν πρῶτον
μέν, ἵνα πάντα σώζηται, δεύτερον δέ,
ἵνα μηδὲ τῶν τόκων ὀλιγωρήσης τῶν
ἀπὸ τῆς προεκκειμένης ἡμέρας.
Ὅσας αὐτὸν ἠνέγκαμεν, σφόδρα
δέδοικα· καὶ γὰρ παρῆν πρὸς ἡμᾶς
κατασκευόμενος

£2,600,^[223] of which not a penny had
been paid, though all were due on
the 1st of the second month. Milo's
freedman, Timotheus, the namesake
of Conon's father, he said, had never
given a thought to the matter. Now
first try and secure the whole
amount, and secondly don't overlook
the interest from the afore-mentioned
day. All the time I had to endure him,
I was much upset. He came to me to
spy out

²²¹. i.e. T. Annius Milo.

²²². 24 and 48 minae, worth a little over £4
each.

²²³. 640 minae.

καί τι σχεδὸν ἐλπίσας· ἀπογνοὺς
δ' ἄλόγως ἀπέστη ἐπειπὼν “εἴκω·
αἰσχρὸν τοι δηρὸν τε μένειν”—
Iliad, ii, 298 meque

obiurgavit vetere proverbio τὰ μὲν
διδόμενα—. Reliqua vide et,
quantum fieri potest, perspiciamus.

Etsi annum tempus prope iam
emeritum habebamus (dies enim
xxxiii erant reliqui), sollicitudine
provinciae tamen vel maxime
urgebamur. Cum enim arderet Syria
bello, et Bibulus in tanto maerore
suo maximam curam belli sustineret,
ad meque legati eius et quaestor et
amici eius litteras mitterent, ut
subsidio venirem, etsi exercitum
infirmum habebam, auxilia sane
bona, sed ea Galatarum, Pisidarum,

the land, and had some hopes.
When he lost them, he left without
an explanation, saying: “I give in,
’Twere shame to tarry long,” and
casting in my teeth the old proverb
“take the goods the gods provide
you.”^[224] Look after the rest, and let
us investigate the matter as
thoroughly as possible.

Though I have nearly served my
year (for only thirty-three days
remain), still I am greatly concerned
about my province. Syria is ablaze
with war, and Bibulus is burdened
with its cares in the midst of his own
great sorrow,^[225] and his legates,
quaestor and friends write to me to
go to his aid: so, although the army I
have is weak—the auxiliaries

Lyciorum (haec enim sunt nostra robora), tamen esse officium meum putavi exercitum habere quam proxume hostem, quoad mihi praeesse provinciae per senatus consultum liceret. Sed, quo ego maxime delectabar, Bibulus molestus mihi non erat, de omnibus rebus scribebat ad me potius. Et mihi decessionis dies λεληθότως obrepebat. Qui cum advenerit, ἄλλο πρόβλημα, quem praeficiam, nisi Calvus quaestor venerit; de quo adhuc nihil certi habebamus.

Cupiebam mehercule longiorem epistulam facere, sed nec erat res, de qua scriberem, nec iocari prae cura poteram. Valebis igitur et puellae salutem Atticulae dices nostraeque Piliae.

certainly are good, Galatians, Pisidians, Lycians, the main strength of my force—I have thought it my duty to keep an army facing the foe, so long as I am authorized by the Senate’s decree to be in charge of my province. But what pleases me greatly is that Bibulus gives no trouble. He writes to me about any other topic by preference, and the day of my departure creeps on unnoticed. When it arrives, there is the further problem of my substitute, unless my quaestor Calvus comes, of whom so far I have no news.

I should like to write a longer letter, but I have no news, and care keeps me from jesting; so good-bye, and love to your little daughter and to your wife.

[224](#). This proverb is referred to in Plato’s *Gorgias* 499c, and given in full by Olympiodorus in the form τὰ ἐκ τῆς τύχης διδόμενα κόσμει “make the best of what fortune gives.”

[225](#). The murder of his sons in Egypt.

VI

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Rhodi circ. IV Id.
Sext. a. 704*

Ego, dum
in provincia
omnibus rebus Appium orno, subito
sum factus accusatoris eius socer. “Id
quidem,” inquis, “di adprobent!” Ita
velim teque ita cupere certo scio.
Sed, crede mihi, nihil minus putaram
ego, qui de Ti. Nerone, qui mecum
egerat, certos homines ad mulieres
miseram; qui Romam venerunt factis
sponsalibus. Sed hoc spero melius;
mulieres quidem valde intellego
delectari obsequio et comitate
adulescentis. Cetera noli
ἐξακανθίζειν.

Sed heus tu! πρὸς εἰς δῆμον
Athenis? placet hoc tibi? Etsi non
impediebant mei certe libri. Non
enim ista largitio fuit in cives, sed in
hospites liberalitas. Me tamen de
Academiae προπύλῳ iubes cogitare,
cum iam Appius de Eleusine non
cogitet? De Horterisio te certo scio
dolere; equidem excrucior; decreram
enim cum eo valde familiariter
vivere.

Nos provinciae praefecimus
Caelium. “Puerum,” inquis, “et
fortasse fatuum et non gravem et non
continentem!” Adsentior; fieri non

VI

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Rhodes, circa Aug.
10, B.C. 50*

While in my province I show
Appius every honour, suddenly I find
myself father-in-law of Dolabella his
accuser. You invoke heaven’s
benison. So say I, and you I know
are sincere. Believe me, it was the
last thing I had expected. Indeed I
had even sent trusty agents to
Terentia and Tullia about the suit of
Ti. Nero, who had made proposals to
me: but they arrived in town only
when the betrothal was over.
However I hope the better course has
been taken. I understand that my
women folk are highly pleased with
the young man’s obliging and
courteous temper. As for the rest,
don’t pick holes in him.

Good gracious! Do you approve
of corn doles to Athens? My own
books to be sure do not forbid such a
dole, for it was not a largesse to
fellow-citizens, but a graceful
present in return for hospitality. Still
do you encourage me in the matter
of the porch for the Academy, when
Appius has abandoned his design of
a porch at Eleusis? I am sure you are

potuit aliter. Nam, quas multo ante tuas acceperam litteras, in quibus ἐπέχειν te scripseras, quid esset mihi faciendum de relinquendo, eae me pungebant; videbam enim, quae tibi essent ἐποχῆς causae, et erant eaedem mihi.

Puero tradere? fratri autem? Illud non utile nobis. Nam praeter fratrem nemo erat, quem sine contumelia quaestori, nobili praesertim, anteferebam. Tamen, dum impendere Parthi videbantur, statueram fratrem relinquere aut etiam rei publicae causa contra senatus consultum ipse remanere. Qui posteaquam incredibili felicitate discesserunt, sublata dubitatio est. Videbam sermones: “Hui, fratrem reliquit! Num est hoc non plus annum obtinere provinciam? Quid, quod senatus eos voluit praeesse provinciis, qui non praefuissent? At hic triennium!” Ergo haec ad populum. Quid, quae tecum? Numquam essem sine cura, si quid iracundius aut contumeliosius aut negligentius, quae fert vita

sorry about the news of Hortensius. Personally I am distracted: for it had been my intention to live on intimate terms with him.

I have put Caelius in charge of my province. “A mere boy” you will object, “and perhaps silly, and lacking in dignity and self-control.” I agree; but there was no alternative. The letter I got from you some time ago, in which you said you suspended judgement as to what I ought to do about my substitute, caused me a pang; for I understood the grounds

of your hesitation and felt them myself. Could I hand it over to a boy? But ought I to hand it over to my brother? The latter is prejudicial to my own interests. My brother was the only man it would not be an insult to prefer to the quaestor, especially as that officer was of noble birth. Still, while the Parthians seemed threatening, I determined to leave my brother in charge, or even to run counter to the decree of the Senate and for the sake of the Republic remain here myself. Their marvellously opportune retirement removed my doubts. I foresaw the world’s comment. “So he has left his brother in charge! Is this holding a province for one year only? And what about the decree of the Senate that ex-governors should not be

hominum. Quid, si quid filius puer et puer bene sibi fidens? qui esset dolor? quem pater non dimittebat teque id censere moleste ferebat. At nunc Caelius non dico equidem “quod egerit—,” sed tamen multo minus laboro. Adde illud. Pompeius, eo robore vir, iis radicibus, Q. Cassium sine sorte delegit, Caesar Antonium; ego sorte datum offenderem, ut etiam inquireret in eum, quem reliquisset? Hoc melius, et huius rei plura exempla, senectuti quidem nostrae profecto aptius.

At te apud eum, di boni, quanta in gratia posui. Eique legi litteras non tuas, sed librarii tui.

Amicorum litterae me ad triumphum vocant, rem a nobis, ut ego arbitror, propter hanc *παλιγγενεσίαν* nostram non neglegendam. Quare tu quoque, mi Attice, incipe id cupere, quo nos minus inepti videamur.

eligible? Why, his brother was governor for three years.” These are the arguments for the public; but for you I have private reasons. I should have been in constant anxiety as to some exhibition of temper or overbearingness or negligence; for such things will happen. Perhaps his son, a mere headstrong lad, would have given me cause for distress: his father would not send him away, and was annoyed with you for saying that he ought. As for Caelius, I cannot say that I am unconcerned about his past behaviour: but still I am far less concerned. Then there is another point. Pompey (and think of his power and position) chose Q. Cassius without regard to the lot, and Caesar too chose Antony. I could not affront Caelius who had been given to me by lot, and so make him a spy on the actions of my successor. No; my present course is better, accords well with precedent and is well suited to my time of life. But,

heavens, how I have put you in his good books. I read him a letter, not in your own hand, but in that of your secretary.^[226]

Friends write me to come home to my triumph, a matter, I think, in view of my political renaissance, hardly to be neglected. So I hope, my dear Atticus, that you will look

forward to it too, to make me appear less foolish.

VII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Tarsi ante III K.
Sext. a. 704*

Quintus
filius pie

sane me quidem certe multum hortante, sed currentem, animum patris sui sorori tuae reconciliavit. Eum valde tuae litterae excitarunt. Quid quaeris? confido rein, ut volumus, esse.

Bis ad te antea scripsi de re mea familiari, si modo tibi redditae litterae sunt, Graece ἐν αἰνιγμοῖς. Scilicet nihil est movendum; sed tamen ἀφελῶς percontando de nominibus Milonis et, ut expediat, ut mihi receperit, hortando, aliquid tu proficies.

Ego Laodiceae quaestorem Mescinium exspectare iussi, ut confectas rationes lege Iulia apud duas civitates possem relinquere. Rhodum volo puerorum causa, inde quam primum Athenas, etsi etesiae valde refiant; sed plane volo his magistratibus; quorum voluntatem in supplicatione sum expertus. Tu tamen mitte mihi, quaeso, obviam litteras, numquid putes rei publicae nomine tardandum esse nobis. Tiro ad

VII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

Tarsus, before July
30, B.C. 50

The boy Quintus has contrived to reconcile his father to your sister. He showed the proper feeling of a son, and I gave him much encouragement, which he received nothing loath. He was greatly moved by your letter. I trust that matters are as we wish.

I have written to you twice about a domestic matter of mine in Greek and in riddles, if only my letters have reached you. Don't take decided steps: but still you may do some good by questioning the man simply about Milo's accounts, and urging him to settle the business as he promised.

I have ordered my quaestor Mescinius to wait at Laodicea, so that in accordance with the Julian law I may leave copies of my accounts in two cities. I want to go to Rhodes for the sake of the boys, thence as soon as possible to Athens, though the Etesian winds are very contrary. But I wish to reach Rome

during the magistracy of men whose good-will I experienced over that thanksgiving in my honour. However please send a letter to meet me, saying if you think there can be any political reason for delay.

[226](#). Presumably dictated to him by Cicero himself.

te dedisset litteras, nisi eum graviter aegrum Issi reliquissem. Sed nuntiant melius esse. Ego tamen angor; nihil enim illo adulescente castius, nihil diligentius.

Tiro would have written you a letter, but I left him at Issus seriously ill. However a message has reached me that he is better. Still I am upset: for he is a model youth and very attentive.

VIII

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Ephesi K. Oct. a.
704*

Cum instituissem ad te scribere calamumque sumpsissem, Batonius e navi recta ad me venit domum Ephesi et epistulam tuam reddidit pridie Kal. Octobres. Laetatus sum felicitate navigationis tuae, opportunitate Piliae, etiam hercule sermone eiusdem de coniugio Tulliae meae. Batonius autem miros terrores ad me attulit Caesarianos, cum Lepta etiam plura locutus est, spero falsa, sed certe horribilia, exercitum nullo modo dimissurum, cum illo praetores designates, Cassium tribunum pl., Lentulum consulem facere, Pompeio in animo esse urbem relinquere.

Sed heus tu! numquid moleste fers de illo, qui se solet anteferre patruo sororis tuae filii? at a quibus victus! Sed ad rem.

Nos etesiae vehementissime tardarunt; detraxit xx ipsos dies etiam aphractus Rhodiorum. Kal. Octobr. Epheso conscendentes hanc epistulam dedimus L. Tarquitio simul e portu egredienti, sed expeditius naviganti. Nos Rhodiorum aphractis ceterisque

VIII

CICERO TO ATTICUS, GREETING.

*Ephesus, Oct. 1, B.C.
50*

J
ust
as I

had determined to write to you and had taken up my pen, Batonius came straight from his ship to my house at Ephesus and gave me your letter on the 29th of September. I am delighted about your good voyage, and your opportune meeting with your wife and also at her remarks about the marriage of my daughter. But Batonius brought news that was simply awful about Caesar, and was even more frank in conversation with Lepta. I hope his news is false: it was certainly terrifying. He says that Caesar will refuse to disband his army, that the officials elect, praetors, Cassius the tribune and Lentulus the consul take his part, and that Pompey thinks of leaving Rome.

But by the by, are you so sorry for the fellow that thinks himself superior to the uncle of your sister's son? What fine opponents to beat him! But to business.

The Etesian winds have hindered me much: the open Rhodian boats

longis navibus tranquillitates
aucupaturi eramus; ita tamen
properabamus, ut non posset magis.

too caused me a delay of exactly
twenty days. On the 1st of October,
as I am embarking from Ephesus, I
give this letter to L. Tarquitius, who
is leaving the harbour at the same
time, but sailing by a faster boat. I
have had to wait for fair weather
owing to the undecked boats and
other war vessels of the Rhodians.
However I am hurrying as fast as
possible.

De raudusculo Puteolano gratum.
Nunc velim dispicias res Romanas,
videas, quid nobis de triumpho
cogitandum putes, ad quem amici me
vocant. Ego, nisi Bibulus, qui, dum
unus hostis in Syria fuit, pedem
porta non plus extulit quam domi^[227]
domo sua, adniteretur de triumpho,
aequo animo essem. Nunc vero
αἰσχρὸν σιωπᾶν. Sed explora rem
totam, ut, quo die congressi erimus,
consilium capere possimus.

Sat multa, qui et properarem et ei
litteras darem, qui aut mecum aut
paulo ante venturus esset. Cicero tibi
plurimam salutem dicit. Tu dices
utriusque nostrum verbis et Piliae
tuae et filiae.

Many thanks for paying the man
of Puteoli^[228] his pence. Now please
consider politics, and see what you
think I should do about the triumph,
to which my friends invite me. I
should have been quite happy, had
not Bibulus been trying for a
triumph, though the man never set
his foot outside his house so long as
there was one enemy in Syria any
more than he set foot out of his
house in town when he was consul.
But as it is “’twere base to hold one’s
peace.”^[229] But consider the whole
matter, that we may be able to decide
something on the day we meet.

That’s enough, considering I am in
a hurry and am giving this letter to a
man who will arrive at the same time
as myself or just before me. My son
pays you his best respects. Please
give the compliments of both of us
to your wife and daughter.

IX

CICERO ATTICO SAL.

*Scr. Athenis Id. Oct. a.
704*

In Piraeaea
cum

exissem pridie Idus Octobr., accepi ab Acasto, servo meo, statim tuas litteras. Quas quidem cum exspectassem iam diu, admiratus sum, ut vidi obsignatam epistulam, brevitatem eius, ut aperui, rursus σύγχυσιν litterularum, quia solent tuae compositissimae et clarissimae esse, ac, ne multa, cognovi ex eo, quod ita scripseras, te Romam venisse a. d. XII Kal. Oct. cum febris. Percussus vehementer nec magis, quam debui, statim quaero ex Acasto. Ille et tibi et sibi visum et ita se domi ex tuis

[227](#). domi is added by Tyrrell and Purser.

IX

CICERO TO ATTICUS,
GREETING.

*Athens, Oct. 15, B.C.
50*

As soon as I landed in port on the 14th of Oct. I received your letter from my slave Acastus. I have been looking forward to it so long that I was surprised at its brevity, as I looked at the letter before breaking the seal. Again, when I opened it, I was startled at the illegibility of the scribble, for your hand is generally very fine and legible. In short I gathered from the style of writing that you had arrived in town, as you stated, on the 19th of Sept., suffering from an attack of fever. Much disturbed, as I was bound to be, I questioned my slave. He said that both he

[228](#). Vestorius.

[229](#). Euripides; Frag. αἰσχροὺν σιωπᾶν βαρβάρους δ' ἔαν λέγειν.

audisse, ut nihil esset incommode. Id videbatur approbare, quod erat in extremo, febriculam tum te habentem scripsisse. Sed te amavi tamen admiratusque sum, quod nihilo minus ad me tua manu scripsisses. Quare de hoc satis. Spero enim, quae tua prudentia et temperantia est, et hercule, ut me iubet Acastus, confido te iam, ut volumus, valere.

A Turrano te accepisse meas litteras gaudeo. Παραφύλαξον, si me amas, τὴν τοῦ φυρατοῦ φιλοτιμίαν αὐτότατα. Hanc, quae mehercule mihi magno dolori est (dilexi enim hominem), procura, quantulumcumque est, Precianam hereditatem prorsus ille ne attingat. Dices nummos mihi opus esse ad apparatus triumphi. In quo, ut praecipis, nec me κενὸν in expetendo cognosces nec ἄτυφον in abiciendo.

Intellexi ex tuis litteris te ex Turrano audisse a me provinciam fratri traditam. Adeo ego non perspexeram prudentiam litterarum tuarum? Ἐπέχειν te scribebas. Quid erat dubitatione dignum, si esset quicquam, cur placeret fratrem et talem fratrem relinqui? Ἀθέτησις ista mihi tua, non ἐποχὴ videbatur. Monebas de Q. Cicerone puero, ut eum quidem neutiquam relinquerem. Τοῦμὸν ὄνειρον ἐμοί. Eadem omnia, quasi conlocuti essemus, vidimus.

and you thought that it was nothing serious and that he had gathered as much from your people. This view seemed to be supported by a remark at the end of your letter that at the time of writing you had a touch of fever. However I was greatly surprised and pleased at your writing to me in your own hand under the circumstances. So I will say no more. For I hope considering your careful and temperate life—and to be sure Acastus bids me be confident—that you are now as well as I could wish.

I am glad you got my letter from Turranius. Keep a very strict eye, as you love me, on the untimely designs of that cooker of accounts Philotimus. As to this legacy from Precius, which is a great sorrow to me—for I loved him indeed—don't let the fellow lay a finger on it, small as it is. You will say that I want money for the outfit of my triumph. You shall see that following your advice I will not show foolish vanity in seeking a triumph, nor be phlegmatic enough to refuse it.

I gather from your letter that you heard from Turranius I had given over my province to my brother. Do you imagine that I overlooked the cautious tone of your letter? You wrote that you were doubtful. There could have been no reason for

Non fuit faciendum aliter, meque ἐπιχρονία ἐποχή tua dubitatione liberavit. Sed puto te accepisse de hac re epistulam scriptam accuratius.

doubts, if there had been grounds for leaving a brother and such a brother in charge. I took your doubts for dogmatic rejection. You warn me on no account to leave the young Quintus. Your words repeat my dream. The same vision came to us both, as though we had talked it over. There was nothing else to be done, and your long doubt has relieved me of hesitation. But I fancy you must have already got a letter on this topic written in more detail.

Ego tabellarios postero die ad vos eram missurus; quos puto ante ventures quam nostrum Saufeium. Sed eum sine meis litteris ad te venire vix rectum erat. Tu mihi, ut polliceris, de Tulliola mea, id est de Dolabella, perscribes, de re publica, quam praevideo in summis periculis, de censoribus, maximeque de signis, tabulis quid fiat, referaturne. Idibus Octobribus has dedi litteras, quo die, ut scribis, Caesar Placentiam legiones IIII. Quaeso, quid nobis futurum est? In arce Athenis statio mea nunc placet.

END OF VOL. I.

I mean to send letter-carriers to you to-morrow, who I fancy will arrive before our friend Saufeius: but it was hardly proper that he should come to you without a letter from me. Please write me fully, as you promise, about my little daughter, that is about her husband Dolabella, about the political situation in which I foresee much trouble, about the censors, and above all about the business of statues and pictures, and whether the matter will come up before the Senate.^[230] The 15th of October is the date of this letter, a day on which you say Caesar is going to bring four legions to Placentia. I wonder what will be our fate. My present quarters on the Acropolis at Athens seem to me the best place.

²³⁰. The censors had fixed a limit on private expenditure on works of art: but their edict

required the confirmation of the Senate before it became law.

CHRONOLOGICAL ORDER OF THE LETTERS.^[231]

I. 5 November, 68^[232]

6 November or December, 68

7 February, 67

8 February, 67

9 February, 67

10 Before July, 67

11 July or August, 67

3 Late in 67

4 Early in 66

1 July, 65

2 July, 65

12 January 1, 61

13 January 25, 61

14 February 13, 61

15 March 15, 61

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17 December 5, 61

18 January 20, 60

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20 May, 60

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4 April, 59

5 April, 59

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[231](#). In many cases the dates and order are only approximate and authorities differ about them. I have generally accepted the dates given in the Teubner edition.

[232](#). Some date this letter early in 67, and the next towards the end of January, 67.

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1. P. [52](#), corrected “ὅππως” to “ὅππως”.
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3. P. [156](#), corrected “δε” to “δὲ”.
4. P. [359](#), corrected “ἔρδοι τις ἦν ἕκαστος εἰδεῖη τέχνην” to “ἔρδοι τις ἦν ἕκαστος εἰδεῖη τέχνην”.
5. Silently corrected typographical errors in punctuation and spelling in the index which didn't agree with the text.
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